TOWN OF
AMHERST
MASSACHUSETTS

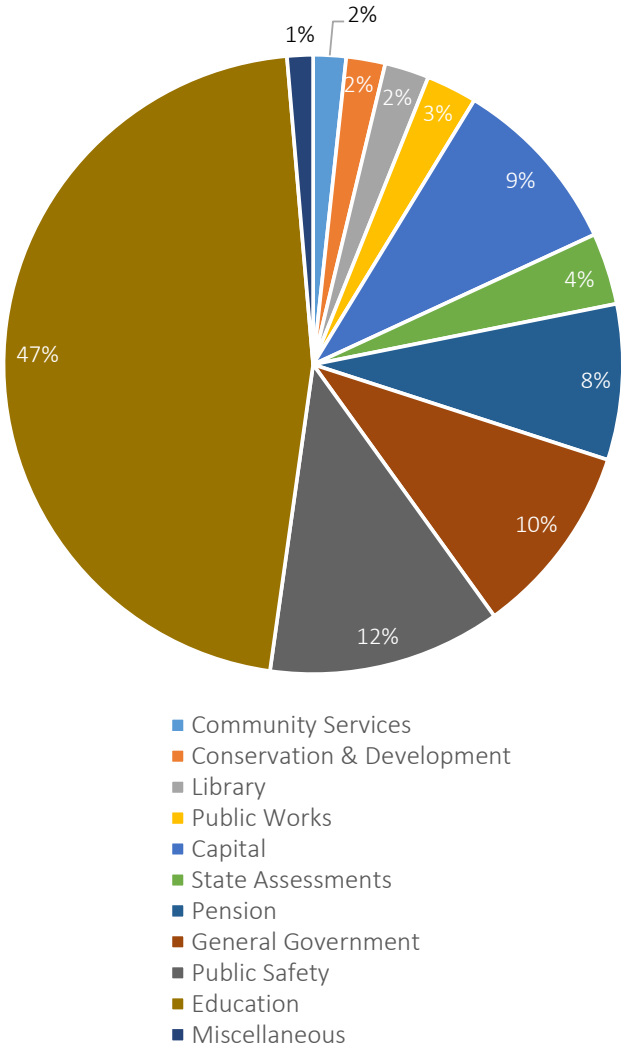
FISCAL YEAR 2026 PROPOSED BUDGET

JULY 1, 2025 - JUNE 30, 2026

Learn more at
www.amherstma.gov/budget

Town of Amherst: Fiscal Year 2026 Budget Proposal

Total Spending Plan	$103,261,100



Highlights

Challenging Fiscal Environment

Cost pressures, especially rising health insurance costs, required difficult decisions to align the budget with fiscal realities, the Council's Policy Goals, Budget Guidelines, and subsequent budget guidance. This FY26 budget prioritizes essential services, addresses aging infrastructure, and invests in capital needs.

Funding for Schools

Increases funding for the Regional Schools budget by 4.81%. Increases funding for the Elementary School budget by 5%, including 1% one-time bridge funding (from Free Cash) to support the transition from three elementary schools to two and the relocation of the 6th grade.

Freeze of 6.4 Town Positions

A 4% increase for Town departments required freezing 6.4 positions to close the budget gap. Preserves existing jobs and provides funds to meet health insurance obligations and honor collective bargaining and other staff commitments.

Commitment to DEI and Sustainability

Fully funds DEI and Sustainability initiatives. Amherst remains a leader in Climate Action and Racial Equity.

Support for New Initiatives

Continues funding for implementation of the new Rental Registration bylaw, Recreation's youth Morning Movement program, and provides staff support for capital projects.

Fiscal Outlook

Looking forward, Amherst faces annual budget shortfalls that could undermine the ability to deliver essential services in the years to come. The Town must calibrate its budgets to meet the revenues available. Short-term, yearly cutbacks are unsustainable. Town staff will seek to engage decision-makers in thoughtful, long-range fiscal planning, innovation in service delivery, and collaboration across all levels of government.

Budget Calendar

- May 5, 2025 - Budget Presentation
- May 6, 2025: Finance Commitee Begins Budget Review
- May 12, 2025: Finance Committee Public Hearing
- June 16, 2025: Town Council Vote

More Information

- Visit the Town's website for more information on all Town activities.
- For more information on the budget, click here.

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Executive Summary

"Public money ought to be touched with the most scrupulous consciousness of honor."

- Thomas Paine

Town Manager's Budget Message

May 1, 2025

Dear Residents of Amherst and Members of the Town Council:

In accordance with Section 5.4 of the Amherst Home Rule Charter, it is my privilege to submit the FY26 Budget for the Town of Amherst, the seventh year of our new form of government.

This Budget includes all Town operations, including Municipal, Schools, Library, and Capital for the fiscal year spanning July 1, 2025 to June 30, 2026 (FY26). This submission includes the five-year Capital Improvement Program. The Operating Budget and Capital Improvement Program will allocate necessary funds needed to provide the services described for FY26. The budget amounts to $103,261,100, and represents an increase of $5,187,694, or 5.3% from the adopted FY25 Budget. The Capital Improvement Program reflects an investment of $9,663,408 (including debt; excluding grants) for FY26, determined by allocating 10.265% of the tax levy to capital expenditures. The budget is balanced using existing revenue streams and one-time funds and does not require the use of an override.

The Town of Amherst budget includes five components:

a. Municipal budget (which includes the Town's four enterprise funds);
b. Elementary School budget;
c. Library budget;
d. Amherst-Pelham Regional School District budget; and,
e. Capital Improvement Program.

Other important budget documents include:

a. Community Preservation Act (CPA) budget; and,
b. Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) budget.

Section 5.4 of the Town Charter requires that "proposed budgets adopted by the Amherst School Committee, Regional School Committee, and Library Trustees shall be submitted to the Town Manager." It also requires the Town Manager to "submit to the Town Council a proposed budget for the ensuing fiscal year, including municipal, school and library components as determined by the Town Manager, with an accompanying budget message and supporting documents."

As required by the Town Charter, these documents were submitted to the Town Council on this date and simultaneously filed with the Town Clerk and have been published on the Town Bulletin Board. All documents may be found here: https://www.amherstma.gov/3584/Upcoming-Budget.

Sincerely,

Paul Bockelman
Town Manager

Budget Highlights

- Challenging Fiscal Environment:
  - Cost pressures, especially rising health insurance costs, required difficult decisions to align the budget with fiscal realities, the Council's Policy Goals, Budget Guidelines, and subsequent budget guidance. This FY26 budget prioritizes essential services, addresses aging infrastructure, and invests in capital needs.
- Met Town Council Goal of Funding for Schools:
  - The budget increases funding for the Regional Schools budget by 4.81%.
  - The budget increases funding for the Elementary School budget by 5%, including 1% of one-time bridge funding (from Free Cash) to support the transition from three elementary schools to two and the relocation of the 6th grade.
- 6.4 Town Positions Frozen:
  - Contractual obligations including all collective bargaining agreements, cost-of-living adjustments and steps, debt service, and assessments for the retirement system are included in this budget.
  - Even with a 4% increase, 6.4 Town positions were required to be frozen to close the budget gap. This action preserves existing jobs and provides funds to meet health insurance obligations and honor collective bargaining and other staff commitments.
- Reduced Funding for Capital
  - Capital funding was reduced from 10.5% of the levy to 10.265% of the levy. This reduction was done reluctantly as I balanced competing Town Council goals. It amounts to a $151,376 reduction in funds available for capital.
- Commitment to DEI and Sustainability:
  - The budget fully funds DEI and Sustainability initiatives ensuring Amherst remains a leader in Climate Action and Racial Equity.
- Continued Support for Recent Initiatives:
  - The budget continues funding for implementation of the new Rental Registration bylaw, Recreation's youth programming such as the successful Morning Movement and Mentoring programs, and provides staff support for numerous capital projects.
- Fiscal Outlook:
  - Looking forward, Amherst faces annual budget shortfalls that could undermine the ability to deliver essential services – by the Town, schools, and library – in the years to come. The Town must calibrate its budgets to meet the revenues available and seek additional funding.
  - Short-term, yearly cutbacks are unsustainable. Town staff will look to engage decision-makers in thoughtful, long-range fiscal planning, innovations in service delivery, and collaborations across all levels of government.

FY26 Budget: Balancing Priorities, Building the Future

We began the FY26 budget process knowing the path ahead would demand difficult choices. In fact, the Town Council's Budget Guidelines acknowledged the difficult decisions that were anticipated for the coming fiscal year. The fiscal pressures forecasted in last year's planning have only intensified, with ongoing cost increases—particularly in health insurance.

It's important to recognize that the requests from the schools continue to present fiscal challenges. Compounding this, after the adoption of the Town Council's Budget Policy Guidelines, the Council subsequently voted to recommend the Town Manager increase funding for both the Regional School Budget and the Elementary School Budget beyond the levels originally planned. While this action affirms our shared commitment to supporting public education, it has required difficult trade-offs elsewhere in the municipal budget.

The FY26 budget I have submitted aligns with the Town Council's Budget Policy Guidelines and, to the extent feasible given the Town's financial constraints, supports the Town Council's 2025 policy goals. It balances maintaining quality municipal services with the need to address Amherst's aging infrastructure and capital assets. It continues to advance Amherst's vision of innovation, equity, and sustainability while responding realistically to our fiscal environment.

As part of our commitment to long-term financial stewardship and to responsibly close the budget gap, this budget includes the freezing of 6.4 vacant positions across Town departments. While this was a very difficult decision, it reflects our determination to maintain fiscal balance while continuing to deliver high-quality services to the community.

Freezing these vacancies—rather than resorting to layoffs—allowed us to preserve jobs and protect our dedicated workforce. Supporting our employees has been a guiding principle throughout this budget process. This approach also enables us to meet our commitments for health insurance, honor our collective bargaining partners by funding FY26 cost-of-living adjustments (COLAs) and step increases. This explicitly acknowledges both the rising cost of living and the invaluable contributions of Town staff.

We recognize that each of the positions that is not being filled plays a role in advancing our mission, and this step was not taken lightly. We will work closely with departments to manage workloads and set realistic expectations, while continuing to explore ways to minimize the operational impacts of these freezes.

In tandem with these efforts, we are planning targeted management restructuring aimed at improving cohesion and efficiency across the organization. These changes are designed to strengthen communication, enhance coordination, and streamline service delivery—ensuring our leadership structure is aligned with the Town's evolving needs. More details on these changes will be shared in the coming weeks.

At the same time, we are actively identifying additional cost-saving opportunities to ease budget pressures over the long term. These transitions offer more than just financial necessity—they provide an opportunity to reimagine how we govern. By embracing change, we can modernize operations, foster collaboration, and align leadership around a shared vision of public service.

Whether through technology, interdepartmental collaboration, or data-driven decision-making, we remain committed to positioning Amherst as a leader in municipal best practices—demonstrating that smart, intentional innovation can both save money and enhance service.

The FY26 budget maintains our commitment to essential services while acknowledging the tension between community needs and available resources. It is a responsible, balanced plan that upholds the Town's core values and financial principles. We continue to be a state-wide leader in Climate Action and Racial Equity and we continue to invest in what matters most: Education, Public Safety, Public Health, our infrastructure, and services for our seniors and youth.

I am presenting a budget for the Regional School District that provides an increase of 4.81% over the FY25 budget. This meets the full request voted by the Regional School District Committee. This is higher than the budget guidelines adopted by the Town Council but is in keeping with the Town Council's most recent recommendation. It should be noted that the Regional School District budget depends on the actions of our partner towns—Leverett, Pelham, and Shutesbury. A major source of attention for the rest of 2025 will be to work collaboratively with the School Superintendent, Regional School Committee, Town Council, and our partner towns to agree on a plan to ensure long-term financial sustainability for the District.

I am presenting a budget for the Elementary Schools that increases 5%. This is less than requested by the School Committee but higher than the budget guidelines adopted by the Town Council. However, it is in keeping with the Town Council's most recent recommendation. To support this budget, I am requesting that the Town Council appropriate 4% plus an additional 1% in one-time bridge funding to support the transition to two elementary schools from the current three schools and relocation of the 6th grades. These funds would come from Free Cash, a non-recurring source which means this additional 1% will not be available next year. These near-term measures must be paired with a broader, forward-looking strategy rooted in honest dialogue, shared responsibility, and a commitment to sustainable excellence for all of Amherst.

In this moment of transition and challenge, Amherst is poised to lead with clarity and purpose. The FY26 budget reflects our community's values and our collective responsibility to plan wisely, act boldly, and build a resilient future together.

Climate Action

Amherst continues to lead in addressing the urgent challenges of climate change. Guided by the Town's Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resiliency Plan (CAARP), we are pursuing strategic, actionable steps to reduce emissions, enhance sustainability, and build community resilience. It was just announced that the Town has been designated a Climate Leader Community by the Commonwealth. This designation is proof of the Town's position as a clean energy leader in Massachusetts, working to reduce greenhouse gas emissions. This designation unlocks access to over one million dollars in clean energy projects.

Town staff are actively working to update the FY27 capital inventory to map the Town's transition away from fossil fuels, ensuring that upcoming investments in facilities, infrastructure, and equipment reflect our long-term sustainability commitments. This effort will guide both near-term decisions and long-range planning to decarbonize municipal operations.

Town departments continue to coordinate on reducing emissions and improving energy efficiency in existing facilities. The Sustainability Director and Facilities Manager are working together to ensure that all heating system replacements are designed to avoid fossil fuel use and to increase the overall energy performance of our buildings. This budget also provides continued support for regional partnerships such as the ValleyBike program, which promotes low-emissions transportation options.

More details on Amherst's climate vision and next steps are outlined in the Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resiliency Plan, which continues to serve as our guiding document for a cleaner, more resilient future.

Community Health, Safety, and Social Justice

Amherst remains firmly committed to the well-being of all its residents through a comprehensive approach that weaves together public safety, health, and social equity. These interconnected priorities are foundational to our vision of a thriving, inclusive community.

The Town's public safety model continues to evolve to meet changing needs while staying grounded in core values of equity, responsiveness, and care. The Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service (CRESS) Department—established to provide an unarmed response to nonviolent situations—remains an important part of that approach. Under new leadership, CRESS is working with its partners in Fire and Police to refine protocols, define its operational mission, and respond effectively to community needs.

As the department transitions away from a major state grant that helped launch its work, two vacant community responder positions will be frozen in FY26. This difficult decision reflects broader fiscal constraints, but it does not signal a retreat from our commitment to this pioneering department. CRESS remains a vital component of the Town's infrastructure of support for its residents, and the Town will continue to nurture its establishment and growth.

In line with the need for financial balance across departments, the FY26 budget also includes the freezing of one vacant position in the Police Department and one vacant position in the Fire Department. Recruiting for these two departments will continue to fill the other vacancies that remain. These actions help stabilize the Town's budget while avoiding layoffs and preserving core services. We are working closely with department leadership to manage these changes and ensure continued responsiveness to public safety needs.

The Public Health, Recreation, and Senior Services Departments are key partners in the work of ensuring our residents are safe and healthy. Now, more than ever, public safety and community services departments are working in partnership to address the complex needs of our most vulnerable residents.

Equity remains a guiding principle in how we design and deliver services. The Department of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) plays a critical leadership role in helping the Town build inclusive practices, address systemic inequities, and foster a more just community and it is fully funded in this budget. DEI collaborates across departments and with community partners to advance initiatives that center racial and social justice in municipal operations, from hiring practices to public engagement. The budget includes funding for the Recreation Department's very successful Morning Movement and Mentoring program and recognizes the growing aquatics program by creating a separate revolving fund.

Our commitment to neighborhood stability and housing equity also continues through the ongoing implementation of the Residential Rental Property Bylaw, adopted by the Town Council last April. This bylaw and associated regulations will help protect tenants' rights, improve housing quality, and strengthen the social fabric of our neighborhoods.

Together, these departments form a coordinated and values-driven system to promote safety, health, and equity across Amherst. While fiscal pressures have required difficult decisions, our focus remains clear: to protect core

services, uphold community values, and invest in the people and systems that support a safer, healthier, and more just Amherst for all.

Housing and Economic Vitality

In FY26, Amherst continues to prioritize housing and economic development, even as budget constraints require sharper focus and strategic choices. The work ahead reflects both the Town Council's adopted goals and the practical necessity of aligning limited resources with long-term community needs.

A top priority for FY26 is reforming zoning bylaws to reduce the time and costs associated with new housing development. These changes aim to encourage a broader range of housing options that support affordability, equity, and neighborhood stability. Zoning updates will also be used to stimulate economic development, particularly in the downtown and village centers, where increasing density and mixed-use development can broaden the tax- base and help create vibrant, walkable neighborhoods.

The creation of a year-round shelter remains a high priority. Town staff are working closely with regional and nonprofit partners to identify viable pathways to expand shelter capacity and services. This ambitious goal will need substantial support from State funding and strong community partnerships.

Amherst's distinguished higher education institutions—the University of Massachusetts flagship campus, Amherst College, and Hampshire College—continue to serve as the bedrock of our local economy. Recognizing their vital role and the Town resources they rely upon, we are actively working to identify shared opportunities for housing and economic development, ensuring that growth is both mutually beneficial and consistent with the Town's long-term planning goals. The Strategic Partnership Agreements with the University and with Amherst College have established a key framework for this collaboration including substantial financial support for the Town, schools and library, and conversations with Hampshire College continues with the aim of establishing a similar partnership.

As we look ahead, we will begin preparing for a comprehensive update of the Town's Master Plan, which will guide growth, land use, infrastructure investment, and economic strategy over the coming decade. This work will require deep community engagement and significant staff and consultant capacity—resources the Town must begin to identify and plan for in the coming years.

Even in a constrained fiscal environment, the Town is actively pursuing state and federal funding opportunities to support essential infrastructure improvements, including sidewalks, bike paths, and public amenities that enhance quality of life and economic vitality.

Though FY26 demands difficult trade-offs, the Town remains focused on creating a strong foundation for equitable development, smart growth, and vibrant neighborhoods. This work is central to Amherst's identity and future prosperity.

Administration and Leadership

Effective and values-driven administration is the foundation of a strong, resilient local government. In FY26, Amherst remains committed to the sound management of its financial resources, the long-term fiscal health of the Town, and the development of a high-performing, diverse municipal workforce.

The Town pledges to uphold its reputation for prudent financial stewardship, making difficult but necessary decisions to preserve stability in the face of rising costs and constrained revenues. A key step in closing the FY26 budget gap was the freezing of 6.4 vacant positions across Town departments. While challenging, this disciplined approach helped avoid layoffs and allowed the Town to honor its commitments to current employees to meet its obligations to provide health insurance and retirement benefits, along with cost-of-living adjustments and step increases. Freezing these positions underscores the need for structural changes to ensure services can be delivered efficiently, equitably, and sustainably over the long term.

In response, the Town is reviewing targeted management restructuring to create efficiencies, improve communication, increase cohesion across departments, and align leadership structures with organizational goals. These changes are designed to enhance coordination, streamline decision-making, and create a more adaptive and responsive organization. Additional innovations are being considered to reduce expenses and improve service outcomes for residents. For instance, Town staff are working to improve the Town's web presence and functionality in preparation for a comprehensive update in fiscal year 27.

At the core of Amherst's administration is a commitment to its people—both the community and the municipal workforce. The Town actively invests in the development, supervision, and support of staff across all departments, fostering a culture of collaboration, service, and accountability. As part of this commitment, in FY26 we will adopt policies and procedures to incorporate anti-racism and anti-discrimination training as part of onboarding for new employees, reinforcing the Town's goal of building a proactively anti-racist and non-discriminatory workplace. We are working to embed these values in daily operations to guide both internal and external service delivery.

Looking ahead, Amherst will continue to refine its organizational structure and management practices to adapt to fiscal realities while advancing strategic goals. Strong, ethical leadership—grounded in transparency, equity, and long-term vision—will remain central to navigating the challenges of today and preparing for the opportunities of tomorrow.

Infrastructure Management, Maintenance, and Land Stewardship

Amherst remains steadfast in its commitment to responsible stewardship of public infrastructure and land, even in a year shaped by budget constraints and reduced capital investment as a percentage of the tax levy. While balancing these fiscal realities, the Town continues to advance critical infrastructure priorities that will serve the community for generations to come.

At the forefront are the Town's four major capital building projects, each representing a cornerstone of Amherst's long-term vision:

- The new elementary school—now under construction—will deliver a net-zero facility that supports modern learning and student wellness. It will also produce ongoing cost savings by eliminating fossil fuel costs and consolidate two elementary schools into one.
- The renovation and expansion of the Jones Library will revitalize a beloved community resource and expand access to educational, cultural, and historical programming. The Town's $15.8 million investment will leverage nearly $30 million in outside funding.
- Replacing the Department of Public Works facility is imperative to meet the operational needs of the 21st century and to provide proper facilities for our hard-working employees. This is the highest priority for capital replacement in the coming year.

- A new Fire/EMS station continues to be a high priority, as the Town works to improve response times and ensure the safety of both residents and first responders. The Town is actively working to identify a suitable location for this important facility.

While these transformative projects move forward, the Town remains focused on core infrastructure needs—particularly the repair of roads and sidewalks and the construction of new sidewalk connections to enhance safety, mobility, and walkability in neighborhoods across Amherst. Roads, in particular, require significant investment and the Town will continue to seek increases in State funding, seek State grants, and allocate additional Town funds when available. Maintenance of these assets is a key priority, even as the Town works within a constrained capital envelope.

Recognizing the aging condition of several municipal facilities, the Town has initiated assessments and long-term planning for repairs and modernization of existing buildings. Town staff are utilizing much needed maintenance funds to ensure our aging current buildings are able to serve us well into the future. These efforts ensure that smaller but essential facilities are not overlooked in the shadow of large-scale projects.

Importantly, all capital planning is guided by a climate lens, ensuring that every investment supports the Town's Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resilience Plan (CAARP). Energy efficiency, fossil fuel reduction, and environmental sustainability are key considerations in both construction and maintenance decisions.

To stretch local dollars and pursue these priorities without overburdening taxpayers, the Town continues to aggressively seek and leverage external funding sources. These include:

- Community Preservation Act (CPA) funds for historical preservation, affordable housing, open space, and recreation.
- Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) funds for community infrastructure and social services.
- PARC and MassWorks grants, along with other competitive state and federal opportunities, to support park development, transportation improvements, and economic revitalization.

Despite the necessary reduction in the percentage of the tax levy allocated to capital, Amherst has not lost sight of its broader capital needs. Strategic planning, disciplined project management, and cross-departmental collaboration will continue to guide the Town's approach to building, maintaining, and caring for the infrastructure and land that define Amherst's quality of life.

Town Council, Community, and Strategic Relationships

A key priority for the Town continues to be the cultivation and strengthening of collaborative relationships across all levels of our community and government. I remain committed to open and effective communication with the Town Council, residents, and institutional and governmental partners, ensuring that the work of the Town is transparent, responsive, and aligned with our shared goals.

This year, we have continued to build on our strategic relationships with our higher education institutions—one of Amherst's most defining and impactful community features. We are proud to have formalized Strategic Partnership Agreements with both the University of Massachusetts Amherst and Amherst College, creating frameworks for ongoing collaboration, shared initiatives, and mutual support. Looking ahead, we are actively working to establish a similar agreement with Hampshire College, further reinforcing our commitment to productive and respectful partnerships with all of Amherst's higher education institutions.

Recognizing the unique financial and land-use challenges that come with hosting the flagship state university, the Town is also working closely with our state legislators to advocate for equitable Payments in Lieu of Taxes (PILOT) reforms to recognize the impacts of the state-owned land on the Town. With a significant portion of our land occupied by the University, fair and predictable PILOT payments will be an essential element in maintaining the fiscal health of the Town and ensuring that we can continue to provide high-quality services to all residents.

The Town Council – the Town's highest elected officials - and Town Manager continue to enjoy a strong and respectful partnership which is essential as we tackle the significant challenges ahead. To support this relationship, I will continue to meet with Councilors at their convenience, foster ongoing dialogue, share updates, and ensure that each Councilor's concerns and insights are heard. The Town Council's extensive performance review of the Town Manager is a source of excellent feedback and guidance to improve the Town Manager's performance.

To better connect with the community at large, the Town Manager holds open coffee hours and produces a monthly detailed report of activities in the Town Manager Report. Staff are working on strategic improvements to the Town's website designed to increase clarity for residents navigating common issues, make important information easier to find, and enhance the overall user experience. The Town is also exploring the use of AI and other technological innovations to strengthen the website's search functionality, making it more intuitive and helpful for users seeking answers and resources.

Through these efforts—grounded in communication, collaboration, and innovation—we strive to foster a strong sense of community, build trust, and create lasting partnerships that support Amherst's goals and values.

Operating Budgets

The Financial Indicators Presentation on November 4, 2024 showed a budget that could increase responsibly at the rate of 3%. Subsequently, the Town Council's Budget Policy Guidelines adopted December 16, 2024 established this 3% increase as one of its guidelines. The guidelines also recommended that staff adjust revenue projections with a focus on areas where forecasts had proven to be conservative.

After refining budget numbers and reviewing the Governor's budget, I presented a recommendation that the overall Town budget be increased by 4%. Town staff believed that while these projections were more aggressive than we normally projected, they were within a reasonable range.

Historically, funds were allocated proportionately across the four major areas of government: Town, Elementary Schools, Regional Schools, and Library. This would have been a 4% increase for each budget. The longstanding budget practice was changed this year in response to the Town Council's vote on April 7, 2025 to recommend the Regional School budget increase by 4.81% and the elementary school budget increase up to 5%.

The Regional School Committee voted on March 31st to request a $905,670 increase in its budget, an increase of 4.81%. The overall increase for the Regional School budget for all four towns is 6.5%. The Town's share represents reverting to the assessment method in the regional agreement.

The Amherst School Committee, which oversees the Town's three elementary schools, voted to request a $1.62 million increase in its budget, an increase of 6%.

This increase is not in compliance with the Town Council's guidelines nor with the Town Council's April 7th vote to recommend an increase up to 5%. The 6% increase is beyond the capacity of the current budget and cannot be met without either (a) reducing other School, Town, and/or Library budgets; (b) utilizing additional one-time money; or

(c) seeking an operating budget override of Proposition 2 ½. None of these options are palatable nor are any of the options in keeping with the Town Council's Budget Policy Guidelines or subsequent guidance.

Amherst Schools are recognized as some of the finest in the state. This, in large part, is due to the Town's continued strong financial commitment to the schools. Amherst has one of the highest per student expenditures in the state and is projecting declining enrollments into the future.

While additional revenues are always needed, the paramount challenge lies in aligning the operations of the School Districts with the available revenue streams to sustain chosen programs.

FY26: Revenues

Property taxes and State Aid are projected to be stable with a moderate increase. Local Receipts are projected to increase by 8.1% as we have budgeted these less conservatively than in past years.

Property Taxes: Property tax revenues are projected to increase by 3.5%, not counting the debt override. New Growth is projected to remain strong, evidenced by several housing and mixed-use developments currently under construction in Town.

Local Receipts: These are the most economic driven revenues in Town meaning they can fluctuate from one year to the next. This requires a more conservative budgeting approach taking into account prior year receipts and looking at current year activity. Per the Town Council's budget guidelines, we have made projections that are less conservative even though this is a concern in uncertain economic times. Key changes include:

- $300,000 or 20.0% increase to motor vehicle excise.
- $80,400 or 13.0% increase for hotel/motel and meals excise.
- $35,054 or 3.5% increase to licenses and permits.
- $25,000 or 70.2% increase to fines & forfeits.
- $350,000 or 233.3% increase to investment income.
- -$225,000 or -66.2% decrease to miscellaneous which is the result of reclassifying outside funding from Amherst College and University to recognize that they are restricted to their stated purposes.

State Aid: Despite some new funding, the Town's local share of State Aid remains stagnant. We project State Aid based on the Governor's FY26 budget proposal which includes a small increase of 2.2% in Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA), although we note the House budget provides no increase. The overall increase for all State Aid categories is expected to be 2.8% due to minimal increases in UGGA and Chapter 70 and a possible significant increase in the charter assessment reimbursement.

Other Financing Sources: We project a 17.9% increase in ambulance funding for FY26 reflecting increased funding for planned capital purchases of new equipment for the Fire/EMS department. Enterprise fund reimbursements are up 9.5% based on increases to the water and sewer enterprise fund FY26 operating budgets.

FY26: Expenditures

My proposed FY26 Town of Amherst Budget includes the following:

Budget	FY25 Recap	FY26 Proposed	Change ($)	Change (%)
Municipal	$ 28,363,385	$ 29,497,920	$ 1,134,535	4.0%
Amherst Schools	$ 26,970,419	$ 28,318,940	$ 1,348,521	5.0%
Regional Schools	$ 18,838,338	$ 19,744,008	$ 905,670	4.8%
Libraries (tax support)	$ 2,302,071	$ 2,394,154	$ 92,083	4.0%
Subtotal	$ 76,474,213	$ 79,955,022	$ 3,480,809	4.6%

Budget	FY25 Recap	FY26 Proposed	Change ($)	Change (%)
Capital	$ 7,912,047	$ 9,663,408	$ 1,751,361	22.1%
Retirement, OPEB, etc..	$ 8,190,994	$ 8,377,403	$ 186,409	2.3%
Assessments, Other	$ 5,496,152	$ 5,265,267	$ (230,885)	-4.2%
Total	$ 98,073,406	$ 103,261,100	$ 5,187,694	5.3%

FY26: Town Council Actions

As part of the FY26 budget process, I request that the Town Council:

Approve the general fund budget including the elementary schools and library.

Approve the regional school district budget.

Approve the four enterprise fund budgets.

Approve the capital improvement program.

Approve debt authorizations of $1.1 million for public safety radio system replacement.

Approve creation of revolving fund for the Aquatics Program in accordance with MGL Chapter 44, Section 53E ½.

FY26: Next Steps

Upon receipt of the Town Manager's proposed budget, Section 5.5(a) of the Charter states that the Town Council shall immediately refer the budget to the Finance Committee.

The Finance Committee is required to hold a public hearing on the proposed budget. The public hearing is scheduled to be held on May 12, 2025. The Finance Committee is required to "thoroughly review the budget and make a presentation and recommendation to the full Town Council within 30 days of referral."

Over the course of the next four weeks, the Finance Committee will review the specific components of the budget and make a recommendation to the Town Council.

The Town Council shall adopt the budget, with or without amendments, by June 30, 2025.

Each of the component budgets included in this comprehensive Town budget has gone through a thorough review by staff and committees including the:

- Amherst School Committee;
- Board of Library Trustees;
- Amherst-Pelham Regional School Committee;
- Joint Capital Planning Committee;
- Community Preservation Act Committee; and
- Community Development Block Grant Advisory Committee.

The referenced set of budget documents provides a complete financial plan for all Town funds and Town activities for FY26. I have also included supporting documents and historical budgets for your reference. The budget documents explain the proposed budgets for all Town agencies in fiscal terms, priorities, and programs. They outline proposed financial policies for FY26, describe important features of the budgets, indicate major variations from FY25, provide reasons for these changes, and provide a summary of the Town's debt position.

The public can learn more about this budget as follows:

- All documents can be found on the Town's website here: https://www.amherstma.gov/3584/UpcomingBudget.
- The Finance Committee will meet seven times in May to review the budget department-by-department. These meetings will be on Tuesdays at 2:00 PM and Thursdays at 9:00 AM on the following dates: May 6th, May 8th, May 13th, May 15th, May 20th, May 22nd, and May 27th. All meetings are open to the public.
- The Finance Committee will hold a public hearing on the budget on May 12th at 6:30 p.m. This meeting is open to the public and public comment is welcome.

Conclusion

This FY26 budget reflects the Town's commitment to delivering excellent services while making the difficult but necessary choices required to maintain fiscal stability. We are prioritizing investments in our public schools and essential services, recognizing that doing so requires real trade-offs and careful stewardship of limited resources.

The budget supports the Town Council's strategic priorities, preserves core services, and leans into opportunities for innovation, recognizing that new approaches and big-picture thinking will be critical to overcoming our financial constraints.

We remain focused on long-term sustainability. This proposal is grounded in realistic and responsible planning that balances the immediate needs of the community with the long-term health of the Town. By continuing to work together—with creativity, discipline, and a shared sense of purpose—we can meet this moment and build a stronger, more resilient Amherst.

Acknowledgements

The creation of this year's budget has been shaped by extraordinary collaboration and a deep sense of shared responsibility across the entire Town government and community members. While the financial pressures and constraints facing the Town continue to be significant, our ability to present a balanced, forward-thinking budget reflects the commitment and ingenuity of an exceptional team with a steadfast commitment to Amherst's long-term wellbeing.

I am especially grateful for the thoughtful collaboration and creative problem-solving demonstrated by outgoing Finance Director Melissa Zawadzki, Assistant Town Manager David Ziomek, Comptroller Holly Drake, Treasurer/Collector Jennifer LaFountain, and Council Clerk/Strategic Planning and Legislative Affairs Officer Athena O'Keeffe. This team worked tirelessly and cohesively in partnership with me throughout a challenging budget season, especially after receiving the recommendation from the Town Council on April 7th to fund the Regional Schools at 4.81% and Elementary Schools at up to 5%. This vote came very late in budget preparation process but our team was able to pivot and meet the Town Council's recommendation.

Their dedication, transparency, and professionalism were key to navigating this tough but necessary choice. Through many discussions, projections, recalibrations, late nights, and weekends, their strong teamwork allowed us to deliver a sound and responsible budget. Each of them brought not only technical expertise but also compassion and a deep understanding of the long-term needs of our community.

Equally important to this work are our partners across other Town functions. I want to thank Library Director Sharon Sharry, whose leadership in crafting a comprehensive Library budget continues to serve the community well, combining Town support with vital resources from State Aid and the Jones Library Trust. I also acknowledge the thoughtful stewardship of Superintendent Xiomara Herman and the School Department's Executive Director of Operations & Finance Shannon Bernacchia in developing robust elementary and regional school district budgets.

The Community Preservation Act Committee (CPAC) thoroughly reviewed funding requests and made thoughtful prioritization decisions with care and fairness. Similarly, the Joint Capital Planning Committee (JCPC) provided invaluable input as we weighed critical capital needs against fiscal limitations, helping to ensure that our Capital Improvement Program remains strategic and sustainable.

This budget is more than a financial document – it is the product of countless hours of hard work by a group of individuals who care deeply about Amherst and the people who live, study, and work here. I am proud to work alongside such a talented and committed team, and I am confident our collective efforts have resulted in a budget that reflects our values, priorities, and a shared vision of Amherst's future.

To every department head, Town employee, elected official, resident, and community partner who contributed to this process: thank you. Your voices, insights, and partnership are what make this effort not only possible, but meaningful.

Together, we have crafted a budget that meets the moment and positions Amherst for a strong and promising future.

What's New?

FY26: Municipal & Enterprise Fund Budget Requests

My recommended FY26 Town of Amherst Budget includes the following:

	FY25 Recommendation	Dollar Change from FY24	Percent Change from FY24
Municipal Budget	$29,497,920	$1,134,535	4.0%
Water Fund	$7,002,500	$1,280,000	22.4%
Sewer Fund	$6,986,725	$276,050	4.1%
Solid Waste Fund	$640,119	$32,672	5.4%
Transportation Fund	$738,984	-$136,039	-15.5%

FY26: Municipal Budget Highlights

All contractual obligations, including all collective bargaining agreements, debt service, and assessments for the retirement system are included in this budget. There are no additions to the municipal budget. The budget includes:

- Funding to provide for the increased cost of health insurance for employees a $648,304 increase
- Funding to honor the current and projected collective bargaining agreements and non-union cost-of-living-adjustments for employees;
- Freezing 6.4 full-time equivalent positions spread across six departments to meet the Town Council's budget guidelines.

FY26: Enterprise Funds Highlights

- Water and sewer rates are proposed to increase significantly to support the investments needed in these vital areas (22.86% for water; 18.80% for sewer). Even with these increases, the Town's water and sewer rates are below the State average and in line with our neighboring communities.
- The Water Fund budget will increase $1,280,000 or 22.4% from the FY25 budget. This increase is driven by higher operating costs, higher capital, and debt payments for infrastructure projects.
- The Sewer Fund budget will increase $276,050 or 4.1% from the FY25 budget. This increase is driven by higher operating costs, higher capital, and debt payments for infrastructure projects. This increase appears lower because supplemental appropriations were added later in FY25. The FY26 increase would have been 18.7% without the additional funds voted in the Fall.
- The Solid Waste Fund budget will increase $32,672 or 5.4% from the FY25 budget.
- The Transportation Fund budget will decrease $136,039 or 15.5% from the FY25 budget. This decrease is driven by reduced capital funding for the current fiscal year.

Town Council Goals & Budget Guidelines

Paul Bockelman, Town Manager

CC: Dr. E. Xiomara Herman, Superintendent of Schools
Amherst School Committee
Regional School Committee
Sharon Sharry, Library Director
Library Trustees

FROM: Town Council

DATE: December 16, 2024

RE: FY26 Budget Guidelines

The Town Council provides these guidelines to assist in developing the FY26 budget for submission to the Council on May 1, 2025. This budget will require difficult decisions. Absent new, ongoing sources of revenue, the Town, Schools, and Library will be hard pressed to provide essential and desired public services, make needed capital investments, and make progress on our policy goals.

Our recommendations and broader guidelines are based on FY26 budget projections presented at the November 4, 2024 Financial Indicators meeting. They should be revised as new information becomes available and provided to elected officials in a timely manner.

I. Summary of FY26 Budget Recommendations

Projections indicate an expected overall revenue increase of 3.2% over FY25, not including debt exclusion revenue. The Council makes the following major recommendations regarding the general budget guidelines, revenue and expense projections, capital budget, and use of fiscal year surpluses:

- General Budget Guidelines:
  - Do not consider a Proposition 2½ override to support the budget
  - Avoid taking on new initiatives unless a source of revenue is identified to maintain the initiative in future years
  - The four major budget functional areas should provide a projection of operating expenses, showing FY26 through FY29, and how they can fit into a projected 3-3.5% yearly increase in revenue
- Revenue Projections:
  - Adjust revenue projections as more information becomes available, with a focus on areas where forecasts have proven to be conservative
- Expense Projections:
  - Provide the four major functional operating budget areas 3% year-over-year increases
  - Maintain the contribution to Other Post-Employment Benefits at $600,000, the FY25 level
  - If revised projections indicate further surpluses:
    - Prioritize increasing the Amherst Regional Assessment FY25 base to its full FY25 Assessment amount (Assessment plus Additional Support) prior to calculating the 3% year-over-year increase
    - Distribute proportionately to the four operating budgets, unless the remaining funds to be distributed would result in more than an additional 0.5% year-over-year increase to each major functional area, at

which point, consult the Finance Committee regarding how best to distribute the funds before consulting with the Budget Coordinating Group

- Capital Budget:
  - Allocate 10.5 % of property tax revenue to the Capital Budget
  - The Finance Committee should hold additional discussion on the financing models
  - Present a five-year Capital Improvement Program that is within the Financing Plan
  - Prioritize projects that can lower operating costs or receive federal direct tax credits with any tax credits received allocated to the Capital Stabilization Fund
- Budget Surpluses included in certified free cash:
  - Maintain Free Cash at 5% and General Stabilization at 10% of our revenue budget
  - Transfer to Reparations Stabilization the amount received in Cannabis taxes
  - Allocate the bulk of the surplus revenues to Capital Stabilization Fund
  - Allocate some funds to the next year's Capital Budget or for FY26 needs not identified during the JCPC process or to accomplish policy goals

Explanations for these recommendations as well as other recommendations, including for Enterprise Funds, are below.

II. FY26 General Budget Guidelines

The recommendations and broad guidelines will impose tight budgets across the four major budget functional areas (Town, Elementary Schools, Regional Schools, and Library). Sixty-six percent (66%) of Amherst's revenues come from property taxes, which are capped at a 2.5% year-over-year increase, plus new growth. Local receipts are highly dependent upon the health of the economy and state aid has not kept up with inflation, requiring Amherst to cover more of its costs through local revenues.

Fiscal sustainability requires all revenue and expenditure plans be viewed in a multi-year context. Doing this requires all four functional areas to assess budgets to understand the difficult choices needed to reach a balanced Town budget. In addition, our schools must address already identified structural budgeting issues resulting from the decline in student enrollment and the recent use of one-time funds to supplement operating budgets.

The FY26 budget must balance and focus on providing essential services and maintaining and improving our infrastructure and capital assets. The services currently provided are important for many residents and businesses, even if not deemed essential. Across all departments we face increased labor costs, including a projected 10-15% increase in health insurance costs. Addressing climate change will impose costs as we shift away from fossil fuels; to reduce these costs, we must also invest in renewable energy sources. We urge you to seek improvements in all departments to reduce expenses, enhance efficiency, and improve outcomes. We strongly advise that the Town avoid taking on new initiatives unless a source of revenue is identified to maintain the initiative in future years.

Amherst taxes are already high. Moreover, Amherst voters have committed to paying for a new elementary school with a tax increase for the debt service. The debt exclusion impact is expected to begin in FY25 with fuller impact in FY26. Therefore, we advise against a budget that would require passage of a Proposition 2½ override.[1]

We recommend that the four major budget functional areas provide a projection of operating expenses, showing FY26 through FY29, and how they can fit into a projected 3-3.5% yearly increase in revenue. It is important to understand the extent of stress over more than one year.

III. Revenue Projections - Recommendations and Comments

Overall revenue is projected to increase in FY26 by 4.6%, which includes projected revenue from property taxes, local receipts, state aid, the debt exclusion for the new elementary school, and other financing sources. If the debt exclusion is removed, overall revenue is projected to increase by 3.2%. We recognize that these projections

[1] See Proposition 2½ and Tax Rate Process | Mass.gov

will be updated in the coming months as additional information becomes available. The projected revenue increase needs to cover cost increases in wages, benefits, supplies, building and infrastructure repairs and maintenance, and more.

With the exception of Local Receipts, the Council accepts the revenue projections from the November Financial Projections.

Property tax revenues are projected to increase by 5.6%, reflecting the allowable 2.5% increase plus new growth and debt exclusion revenue. If the debt exclusion revenue is removed, the projected levy limit increases by 3.5%. This revenue is fairly predictable. The FY26 new growth projection of $650,000 is conservative and below recent experiences. The Council urges you to consider whether this projection should be increased, once the Town has more information on future projects and permits.

You project a 6.7% increase in local receipts, largely based on increases in motor vehicle excise taxes, hotel/motel and meals excise taxes, and investment income. Local Receipts are sensitive to the economy and are particularly uncertain given the upcoming federal administration change. Yet, this appears to be an area where adjustments to projections may be appropriate. Projections in many of these lines have been notably low for the past several years, contributing to substantial end of year surpluses. We urge you to adjust these projections as more information becomes available, especially where forecasts have proven to be conservative. Yet, we also acknowledge that, if adjusted, interest rate decreases and economic downturns will require a reduction in this revenue source in future budgets, thereby putting additional pressure on revenues in future years.

You projected flat state aid, but we recognize that these projections will be updated in January, when the Governor releases her budget. Growth in state aid continues to be less than needed to support cost increases for services and capital investment. Notably, Chapter 90 aid has been flat for decades, and Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA) and Chapter 70 education aid have failed to keep up with inflation.

The Council generally supports continuation of the policy that reserve funds should not be used to support recurring expenses. If there is a significant reduction of projected revenue for FY26, the Budget Coordinating Group should meet to provide advice. In an emergency or unique circumstance, we would consider the use of reserves as potentially necessary to avoid disruption in essential services.

IV. Expense Projections (Non-Capital) – Recommendations and Comments

Past budget practice has allocated an equal percentage increase in operating budgets for four major budget functional areas. Exceptions have been rare, small, and for only one year.

Consistent with this practice, the November Financial Projections propose a 3% increase for each of the four major budget functional areas. Consistent with June 2024 Council votes, they also exclude the one-time ARPA budget support for the region in the FY25 base.

We concur with the 3% equal increases across the four major budget functional areas. We also recommend budgeting Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB) at the FY25 allocation of $600,000, not increasing it, as proposed at the Financial Indicators meeting and continuing this budget amount in future years.

The Projections show a deficit budget. We accept that updated revenue projections are likely to offset this projected deficit, but you will need to plan carefully to deliver a balanced budget. If there are further projected surpluses after revenue and expense projections are updated, we recommend the following:

- First, prioritize including the full FY25 Region Assessment for Amherst (Assessment plus Additional Support) in the Region's FY25 base (A-P Regional School District Assessment line) to calculate the 3% year-over-year increase. At the time of the projections, this would result in a FY26 budget of $19,403,488, an increase of $366,103 compared to that shown in the November Projections.

- Second, distribute the funds proportionately to the four operating budgets, unless the remaining funds to be distributed would result in more than an additional 0.5% year-over-year increase to each major functional area, at which point, we recommend consulting the Finance Committee regarding how best to distribute the funds prior to consultation with Budget Coordinating Group.

A 3% increase in Amherst's Regional School assessment will not necessarily result in a 3% increase to the Region's overall budget. The Regional School assessment will be determined by agreement of member towns to a budget and assessment method proposed by the Regional School Committee. It is important that we achieve an agreement that is sensitive to Amherst's financial resources. The Council will work with you to explain our financial challenges and ensure that Amherst's assessment is consistent with these Guidelines.

We realize you will face challenges maintaining current services and achieving Policy Goals with these recommendations. You should consider our Policy Goals when developing the FY26 budget, with explicit recognition of instances where allocations or decisions reflect the Goals. We urge you to make tradeoffs explicit where Goals conflict with available resources.

The Council supports expense reduction strategies, such as regionalization, the responsible reassignment of costs outside of the General Fund, aggressive cost-comparisons, operational changes to achieve greater efficiency, and negotiation of fair, affordable, and sustainable labor contracts.

V. Capital Budget – Recommendations and Comments

The capital budget includes debt service obligations for prior capital projects, regional school debt assessments, and funding for new capital projects. Given the large backlog of public way repairs, major projects borrowing, and increases in construction and equipment costs that exceed the annual tax levy growth rate, we support your recommendation to fund capital at 10.5% of the tax levy.

The Council is committed to the four major building projects (Elementary School, DPW, Fire/EMS, and Library). The funding strategy for these projects includes multi-year efforts to increase the Capital Stabilization Fund, decrease debt obligation, continue solid bond ratings, and maintain the annual budget allocation for the Capital Improvement Program at 10.5%.

Funding for the new elementary school is included in both revenue and expenditure budgets, due to taxpayer approval of a debt exclusion. The increases in these funds to pay off the debt will result in misleading year-over-year percentage increases in both Revenues and Capital Budget. We recommend you note this when discussing the budget.

Bids for the project came in below budget, although issuance of a final contract was delayed due to an unsuccessful challenge from two of the bidders.

Completion of the project will result in operating savings beginning in FY27, and how to allocate savings among municipal operations will need discussion in FY26.

At the November 18, 2024 Council Meeting, you presented multiple options for financing the already authorized Jones Library project debt and the expected costs of the DPW and Fire/EMS buildings. We need to proceed with the DPW and Fire/EMS station projects and should not wait any longer than necessary to get started. We urge you to focus first on DPW given the deterioration of the building. We recommend an additional Finance Committee discussion on the financing models.

The proposed Financing Plans severely restrict the funds available for other pressing capital needs, including Amherst's share of regional school district's maintenance needs. We look to you to present a five-year Capital Improvement Program (CIP), advised by the Joint Capital Planning Committee (JCPC), that meets high priority needs, views capital investments with a climate lens, and manages these needs within the Financing Plan.

We expect that you will make progress on Climate goals within our capital budget for buildings and vehicles. We may also have the opportunity to recoup some of this investment from the new federal direct tax credits to municipal governments. We recommend you prioritize projects that can lower operating costs or receive federal direct tax credits, with any tax credits received allocated to the Capital Stabilization Fund or future fiscal year capital budgets.

Capital investments are supported by means other than the capital budget, including the use of Community Preservation Act (CPA), CDBG, PARC grants, MassWorks, and more. The Capital Improvement Plan should take this into consideration, and municipal needs should receive priority for funding from CPA and CDBG funds.

VI. Budget Surpluses

It is prudent fiscal management to have an end of year surplus of up to 5% of the budget. If the Town meets this target, the year-end surplus will be approximately $5.01 million. The Council accepts that these are one-time funds that should not be used for ongoing operating expenses. The Council proposes the following guidelines for the allocation of end-of-year surpluses after Free Cash is certified.

We support year-end closeout transfers that prioritize maintaining Free Cash at 5% and General Stabilization at 10% of our revenues, as indicated by the Town's Financial Management Policies & Objectives.[2]

In 2021 we established a Reparations Stabilization Fund and in 2022 we adopted a policy, based on the financial health of the Town, to annually transfer to the fund in an amount equal to the certified cannabis tax revenue for the previous year, not to exceed $205,000, until the Town's contribution equals $2 million. We recommend continuing this practice at the end of the FY25 fiscal year.

In 2022, the Council established the Capital Stabilization Fund to separate funds needed for major buildings from General Stabilization. After meeting the above transfers, we recommend prioritizing allocating the bulk of the surplus revenues to this Fund. However, you may choose to allocate some end-of-year surplus funds to the next year's Capital Budget, to supplement available cash capital spending through the JCPC process or address needs for FY26 not identified when JCPC made its recommendation when the CIP was developed or to address goals of the Town Council and Town Manager

VII. Enterprise Funds

The Town has four Enterprise Funds that operate like separate businesses. Both the Water and Sewer Enterprise Funds have large upcoming capital costs. You should propose rates to generate sufficient revenues to balance projected and unanticipated expenses and interdepartmental costs, so that situations like the FY24 Sewer Fund deficit are not repeated.

We also recommend a policy for new water or sewer line extensions that both assess a connection fee and require the developer to pay the full costs of constructing the extensions. Current users have contributed to reserves in these funds; new developments should pay an entry fee to gain the benefits of this past investment.

VIII. Other ways to Support Services and the Budget

Robust contributions from tax-exempt organizations are essential for the health of the Town. Aligning requests with an institution's own goals may provide synergy and support for enhanced gifts to the Town. It is important to execute strategic agreements with Amherst College and Hampshire College. We note that Boston and other municipalities are reviewing tax-exempt entity partnership agreements. In addition, Williams has supported Williamstown with multi-million investments and Smith has made a multi-year gift of $500,000 to Northampton. We appreciate the University's support of education costs for children who live in University-owned housing and value the recent enhanced Strategic Partnership Agreement. It is critical that this support continues, is re-evaluated frequently, and that negotiations for a new agreement begin well in advance of the expiration date.

[2] https://www.amherstma.gov/DocumentCenter/View/19874

We must advocate on a state level to increase state aid. State PILOT payments must recognize that developed State-owned land is a greater cost to municipalities than conservation or forested land. We support continued advocacy for increases in UGGA, Chapter 70, Chapter 90, and other programs that support municipal budgets, local taxation options, and increased state aid.

Grants also supplement the budget. Aggressive pursuit of grants to offset costs and expand services can support new initiatives or allow the Town to reallocate funds to different expenditures.

IX. Conclusion

The Council appreciates the collaboration on the budget and financial management between you and the Town Council. We appreciate your efforts and that of Melissa Zawadzki, Holly Drake, Jennifer LaFountain, Athena O'Keeffe, and many other members of the staff to inform Councilors about the budget, the challenge to manage Town finances, and efforts to generate revenue to meet expenses and achieve the community's goals. The Council looks forward to continued collaboration as you develop and manage future budgets.

Town Council Performance Goals

Each year, the Town Council establishes goals for the Town Manager. These goals are instrumental in guiding the work of the Town Manager and Town departments. Below is a crosswalk that illustrates how this budget proposal supports the goals set by the Town Council.

Goal Areas and Action Items:	Budget:
I. Climate Action Objective: To continue to make progress on the Council's Climate Action Goals guided by the Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resilience Plan (CAARP) to prepare the Town to be resilient in the face of climate change. • Update the FY27 Capital Inventory (Charter Sec. 5.7(a)) to include criteria and priorities for the transition of municipal buildings, vehicles, and equipment away from the use of fossil fuels • Seek Climate Leader Community Designation and accompanying funding from Department of Energy Resources (DOER) • Consistent with state law and regulations, and as feasible, support the development of climate action focused bylaws that would reduce greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions and reduce reliance on fossil fuels • Support the development of a Battery Energy Storage (BESS) bylaw • Continue to support development of the Waste Hauler Bylaw • Continue to support development of the Solar Bylaw	• Maintained Sustainability Department and continued capital sustainability allocation of $250,000 to support climate initiatives. • Designated Climate Leader Community unlocking significant new funding opportunities from the State Department of Environmental Resources. • Existing staff assigned to assist in the development of the Waste Hauler bylaw; $75,000 has been allocated for outside consulting work to develop a Request for Proposals. • Current staff to address other objectives.
II. Community Health and Safety and Social Justice Objective: To ensure the health and safety of the residents of Amherst and continue making advances in racial equity and social justice. • Conduct an assessment of the Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service (CRESS) Program and report back to the Council by June 30,2025 • Organize a review of public safety protocols for responding to and handling public safety calls involving all residents including minors, in order to recommend changes to those protocols, if appropriate; Work with the APD to review and update, if appropriate, selected policies of the APD. This review shall be including but not limited to: Use of force policy, consent searches, and low-level and pretextual stops • Work with the Council to identify and propose revisions to policies, bylaws, and regulations to dismantle discrimination • Provide training regarding racial equity to the Town Council	• CRESS assessment is underway and supported by grant funds and existing staff support to work with the outside assessment team. • Current Recreation and DEI staff are exploring opportunities to expand youth empowerment programing. • Funding for the successful Morning Movement and Mentoring programs incorporated in the Recreation Department's budget. • DEI Staff is expanding their monthly staff programming to

• Explore options to increase senior accessible transportation offerings • Propose a plan for the creation of a Resident Oversight Board (consistent with the Council's November 14, 2022 vote) • Develop a plan for addressing critical space and program needs at the Senior Center • Create and submit a Complete Streets Tier 2 Prioritization Plan to the Mass Department of Transportation • Create a timeline for updating the Amherst Bicycle & Pedestrian Network Plan	include a specific training for the Town Council. • Senior Center staff are exploring funding opportunities including grants to expand senior accessible transportation. • Funds have been appropriated for renovations to the Bangs Community Center. • Current staff to address other objectives.
III. Housing and Economic Vitality Objective: To ensure the present and future economic well -being of the Town and ensure access to safe, affordable and attainable housing for low- and moderate-income residents, as set forth in the Town Council's Comprehensive Housing Policy. • Propose revisions to zoning bylaws and regulations that shorten the time and lower the costs of permitting new housing construction • Continue to work towards the establishment of a year-round shelter including presentation of a funding plan to the Town Council • Work with UMass Amherst, Amherst College, and Hampshire College to identify economic development and housing creation opportunities. • Propose changes to the ADU zoning regulations to bring them into compliance with state law and EOHLC regulations • Propose revisions to zoning bylaws to increase and support economic development throughout the Town • Begin work on adopting a new Master Plan within the time required by the Charter • Pursue Executive Office of Economic Development (EOED) Mass downtown initiatives and associated funding for sidewalk work and amenities	• Work on the master plan projected in the Capital Improvement Program to start in FY27. • Current staff to address other objectives.

IV. Administrative Leadership Objective: Effectively and appropriately administer the operations and finances of the Town pursuant to the Home Rule Charter, ensure the Town's long-term financial health, and effectively develop, supervise and manage the Town's workforce, fostering a proactive anti-racist, non-discriminatory culture throughout town departments. • Incorporate anti-racism and anti-discrimination training into onboarding processes	• Human Resources Department to incorporate anti-racism and anti-discrimination training as part of onboarding.
V. Infrastructure Management, Maintenance & Land Stewardship Objective: To maintain and manage the Town's capital and public assets. • Form and appoint building committee/s for the Fire/EMS and DPW buildings and present schematic designs to the Council for the DPW, with cost estimates, with a goal of going out to bid in CY2026 • Facilitate a conversation with the Town Council on how to prioritize future road and sidewalk repairs and new sidewalks • Assess the current condition of the Wastewater Treatment Plant and present a plan that will address these issues, including a funding plan for improvements and repairs • Address critical infrastructure needs for water and sewer to comply with state and federal laws • Maintain a list of prioritized future road and sidewalk repairs and new sidewalks that is available to the public and updated annually • Propose an entry fee for outside entities/municipalities/new users when connecting to the Town of Amherst water and/or sewer systems (such as linkage fees) • Provided that the funding for the Trustee share, grants and other non-taxpayer share of the Jones Project is secured and the budget is no more than$46.1 million, sign a contract and break ground on the Jones Library renovation and expansion project	• Funding for a comprehensive study of the needs of the wastewater treatment facility included in Sewer Enterprise Fund. • Capital projects manager funded to support building committees for new elementary school and library and for new Fire/EMS and Public Works buildings. • Current staff to address other objectives.
VI. Town Council, Community, & Strategic Relationships Objective: To maintain, develop, and increase positive relationships and communications with the Town Council, residents, and local and state entities. • Pursue strategic partnership agreements with Amherst College and Hampshire College	• Strategic partnership agreement with Amherst College signed. • Strategic partnership agreement with Hampshire College under discussion. • Ongoing discussions with State legislators and others in the

• Work with our legislators to explore the possibility of revising state legislation regarding Payments in Lieu of Taxes (PILOT) involving state-owned land	State to address inequities in State payments in lieu of taxes for state-owned land.

Budget Calendar & Process

Task/Meeting	**Date**
Financial Indicators Presentation	November 13, 2024
Budget Public Forum	November 18, 2024
Budget Policy Guidelines Approved	December 16, 2024
Governor's Budget Proposal Released	January 22, 2025
Budget Presentation to Town Council	May 5, 2025
Finance Committee Review Process	May 6, 2025 to May 27, 2025
Budget Public Hearing	May 12, 2025
Town Council Vote	June 16, 2025

The chart above outlines key tasks and dates in the budget process. A tremendous amount of work goes on behind the scenes by staff to develop the budget document and prepare information for the meetings above. Please note that the Amherst Pelham Regional School District budget may follow a timeline different than the one above due to budget approvals required in other member towns. You can find more information on the entire budget calendar by visiting the website below: https://www.amherstma.gov/3584/Upcoming-Budget

The public can get involved in the budget process at any public meeting by giving public comment. The best way to get involved is to voice your ideas at the budget forum or the public hearing. An email to your elected official is another great way to share your thoughts on the budget.

Consolidated Spending Summary

CONSOLIDATED SPENDING SUMMARY - TOWN MANAGER'S PROPOSED BUDGET

	FY 2026 General Fund	FY 2026 Water Fund	FY 2026 Sewer Fund	FY 2026 Solid Waste Fund	FY 2026 Transportation Fund	FY 26 COMBINED FUNDS (memo only)	FY 25 COMBINED FUNDS (memo only)	Change FY 26 - 25	Percent Change
REVENUES									
Property Tax	71,726,978	-	-	-	-	71,726,978	67,803,711	3,923,267	5.8%
Local Receipts/User charges	7,576,917	7,002,500	6,986,725	640,119	738,984	22,945,245	20,927,108	2,018,137	9.6%
State Aid	18,918,007	-	-	-	-	18,918,007	18,407,077	510,930	2.8%
Other Financing Sources	5,039,198	-	-	-	-	5,039,198	4,851,155	188,043	3.9%
TOTAL REVENUES	**103,261,100**	**7,002,500**	**6,986,725**	**640,119**	**738,984**	**118,629,428**	**111,989,051**	**6,640,377**	**5.9%**
EXPENDITURES									
OPERATING BUDGET									
Town	29,497,920	3,571,564	4,150,288	578,982	612,283	38,411,037	36,594,217	1,816,820	5.0%
Elementary Schools	28,049,236	-	-	-	-	28,049,236	26,970,419	1,078,817	4.0%
Elementary Schools (1% add'l from Free Cash)	269,704					269,704			
A-P Regional School District (Assessment)	19,744,008	-	-	-	-	19,744,008	18,838,338	905,670	4.8%
Lones Library (Tax Support)	2,394,154	-	-	-	-	2,394,154	2,302,071	92,083	4.0%
Subtotal OPERATING BUDGET	**79,955,022**	**3,571,564**	**4,150,288**	**578,982**	**612,283**	**88,868,139**	**84,705,046**	**3,893,390**	**4.6%**
CAPITAL BUDGET									
Debt Service - Debt Exclusion	2,125,643		-	-	-	2,125,643	674,837	1,450,806	0.0%
Debt Service - Current	1,940,645	1,394,904	1,150,623	-	-	4,486,172	4,856,454	(370,282)	-7.6%
Debt Service - ProJected	123,255	-	-	-	-	123,255	59,791	63,464	106.1%
Cash Capital (Tax Support)	4,799,865	-	-	-	-	4,799,865	4,136,548	663,317	16.0%
Subtotal Tax Funded Capital	**8,989,408**	**1,394,904**	**1,150,623**	-	-	**11,534,935**	**9,727,630**	**1,807,305**	**18.6%**
Cash Capital (Non-Tax Support/Other)	674,000	1,000,000	710,000	-	24,000	2,408,000	1,761,500	646,500	36.7%
Subtotal CAPITAL	**9,663,408**	**2,394,904**	**1,860,623**	-	**24,000**	**13,942,935**	**11,489,130**	**2,453,805**	**21.4%**
MISCELLANEOUS									
Assessment - Retirement System	7,777,403	367,098	371,804	61,137	75,799	8,653,241	8,489,857	163,384	1.9%
Assessment - Regional Loclup Facility	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
OPEB	600,000	79,000	150,000	-	26,902	855,902	855,902	-	0.0%
Reserve Fund	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
Subtotal MISCELLANEOUS	**8,377,403**	**446,098**	**521,804**	**61,137**	**102,701**	**9,509,143**	**9,345,759**	**163,384**	**1.7%**
Total APPROPRIATIONS	**97,995,833**	**6,412,566**	**6,532,715**	**640,119**	**738,984**	**112,320,217**	**105,539,935**	**6,510,579**	**6.2%**
UNAPPROPRIATED USES									
Reserve for Abatements & Exemptions	348,007	-	-	-	-	348,007	972,055	(624,048)	-64.2%
State Assessments (Cherry Sheet)	3,859,368	-	-	-	-	3,859,368	3,448,594	410,774	11.9%
Cherry Sheet Offsets	1,040,360	-	-	-	-	1,040,360	1,058,155	(17,795)	-1.7%
Other Amounts to be Raised	17,532	589,934	454,010	-	-	1,061,476	970,313	91,163	9.4%
Subtotal UNAPPROPRIATED USES	**5,265,267**	**589,934**	**454,010**	-	-	**6,309,211**	**6,449,117**	**(139,906)**	**-2.2%**
							(1)		
TOTAL BUDGET PLAN	**103,261,100**	**7,002,500**	**6,986,725**	**640,119**	**738,984**	**118,629,428**	**111,989,051**	**6,640,377**	**5.9%**
$ Change from Prior year	**5,187,694**	**1,280,000**	**276,050**	**32,672**	**(136,039)**				
% Change from Prior Year	**5.3%**	**22.4%**	**4.1%**	**5.4%**	**-15.5%**				

Organizational Section

"To serve is beautiful, but only if it is done with joy and a whole heart and a free mind."

- Pearl S. Buck

Community Profile

The Town of Amherst is located in the bucolic Pioneer Valley of Western Massachusetts. It is a diverse, inclusive community offering a broad range of educational, recreational, and cultural opportunities.

Host to Amherst College, Hampshire College, and the flagship campus of the University of Massachusetts, the Town enjoys a tradition of open, professional, and high-quality government services, excellent education, extensive open space and agriculture resources, and respect for its history.

County	Hampshire
Government	Town Council, 13 Member Council w/ President and Vice President Town Manager
Location	Bordered by: Hadley to the west; Sunderland and Leverett to the north; Shutesbury, Pelham, and Belchertown to the east; and Granby and South Hadley to the south. 23 miles from Springfield, 18 miles from Greenfield, 50 miles from Pittsfield, 87 miles from Boston, and 157 miles from New York City
Land Area	27.7 square miles
Population	1950 - 10,856 1960 - 13,718 1970 - 26,331 1980 - 33,229 1990 - 35,228 2000 - 34,874 2010 - 37,819 2020 - 39,263
Density (persons per square mile)	1950 - 392 1960 - 495 1970 - 951 1980 - 1,199 1990 - 1,272 2000 - 1,259 2010 - 1,370 2020 - 1,417
Elevation at Town Hall	312 feet above sea level
Topographical characteristics	Valley plateau within a circle of hills
USGS Topo Plates	Belchertown, Mount Holyoke, Williamsburg, Shutesbury
Longitude / Latitude	42 22' 25" N, 72 31' 15" W

Budget Guide

The budget is divided into five sections:

1. Introductory Section: This section serves as a standalone summary of the entire budget. It includes a message from the Town Manager, an outline of significant changes to the budget, the goals of the Town Council and Town Manager, information about the budget process and important dates in that process, and a financial summary of the proposed budget and historical spending. This is the section to read if you only have a few minutes and want a quick understanding of the budget proposal.

2. Organizational Section: This section, which includes this guide, explains how to read the budget, general demographic information and history of the Town, the organization of municipal departments, and departmental staffing information. This part of the budget is designed to provide a deeper understanding of the Town and municipal government.

3. Financial Section: No budget is complete without lots of numbers and tables. You will find plenty of that in this section, which includes high level summaries of the various funds the Town operates, detailed breakdowns of departmental budgets and historical spending. This section is perfect for anyone who wants to see the big financial picture or dig into the detailed departmental spending plans. On the next page, there is a breakdown of the departmental spending plans to make it easier to navigate.

4. Informational Section: This section provides various pieces of information including financial comparisons to other communities, the Capital Improvement Program, debt management information, the financial policies of the Town, a glossary, and an acronym table. By the time you get to this section, you're ready to see how Amherst compares to similar communities and review the policies that guide decision making.

5. Appropriation Orders: This section includes all of the votes that the Town Council will consider for FY26. In any given year, these votes will include the operating budgets, the capital improvement program, the community preservation act recommendation, and authorization of any new debt obligations.

Financial Section Map:

The Financial Section is organized by fund type which includes the General Fund, Enterprise Funds, Grant Funds, and Revolving Funds. Each fund is explained in more detail below. In addition to being organized by fund type, each section begins with high level summary information and then drills down into greater detail.

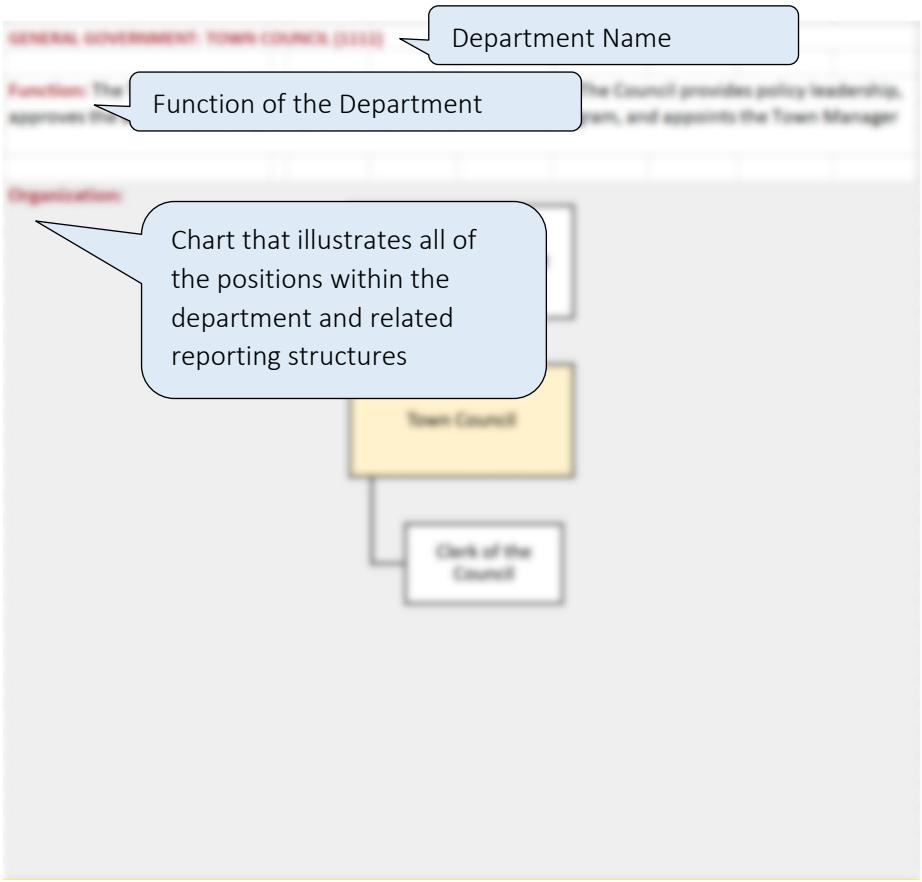
1. General Fund: The primary operating fund for the Town, it is used for the annual budget and collects all monies that are not specifically designated for another purpose. Major sources of funds include property taxes, state aid, and local receipts. This is the largest and most important fund.

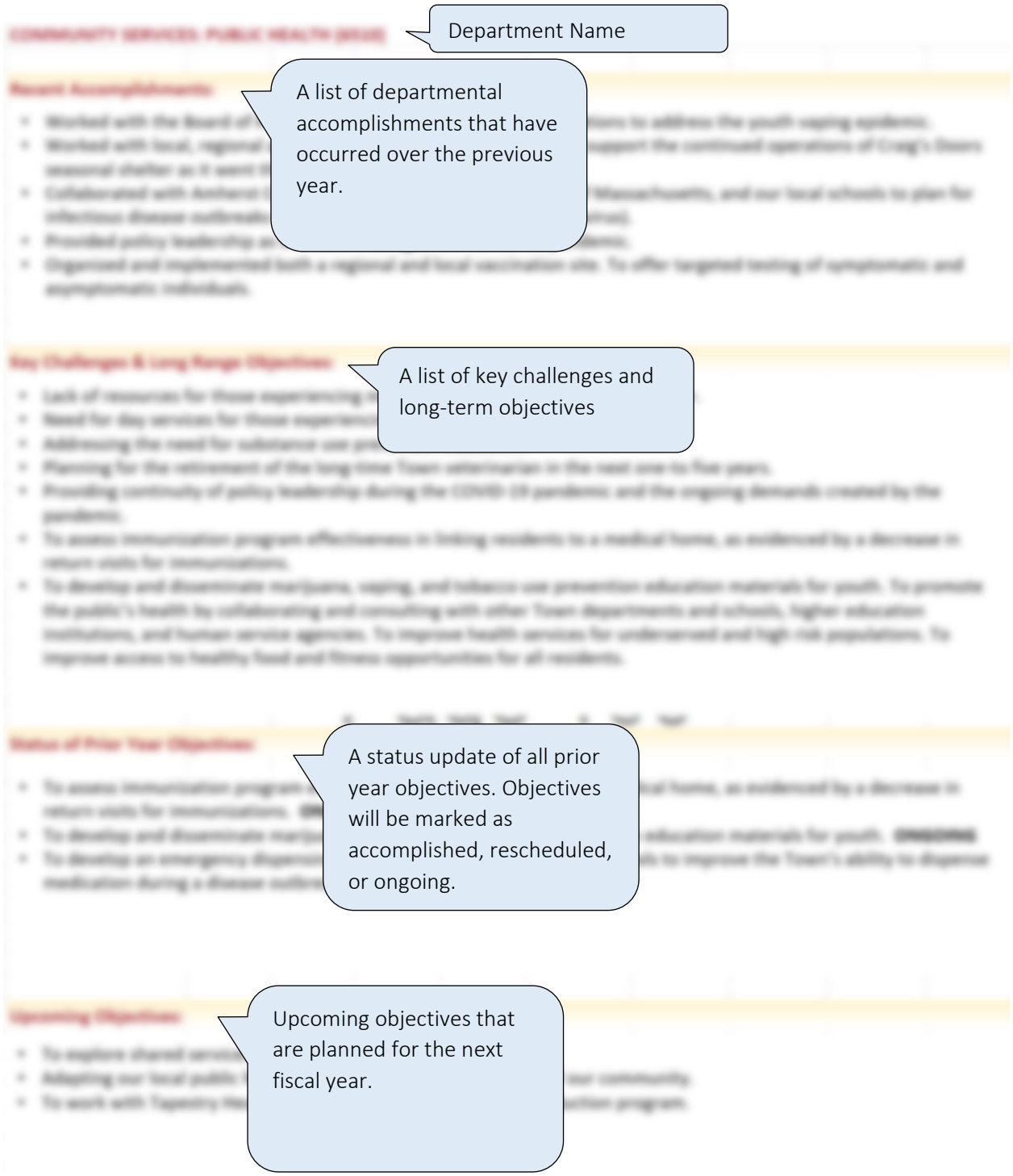
2. Enterprise Funds: These funds are established to manage the business-like services of the Town. For example, the Water Enterprise fund manages the provision of water to Town residents and the resulting billing and collection of funds. In addition, Enterprise Funds account for any capital investments in the particular service and related debt. The Town operates four Enterprise Funds: water, sewer, transportation, and solid waste.

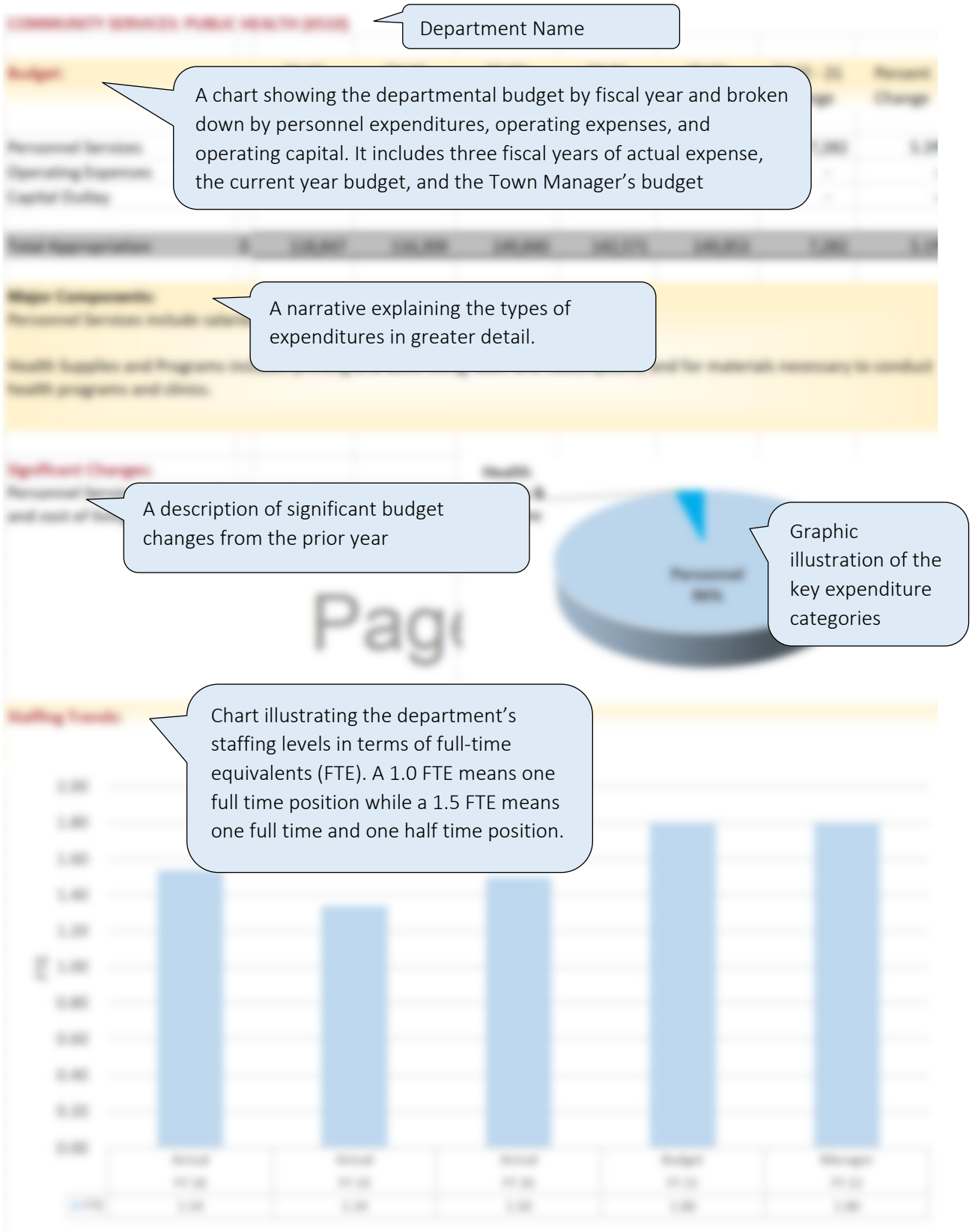
3. Grant Funds: The Town is particularly strong at finding and being awarded grants from private, state, and Federal agencies. The revenues and expenditures associated with a grant are accounted for in a separate grant fund. This ensures that grant monies are not intermingled with other Town funds.

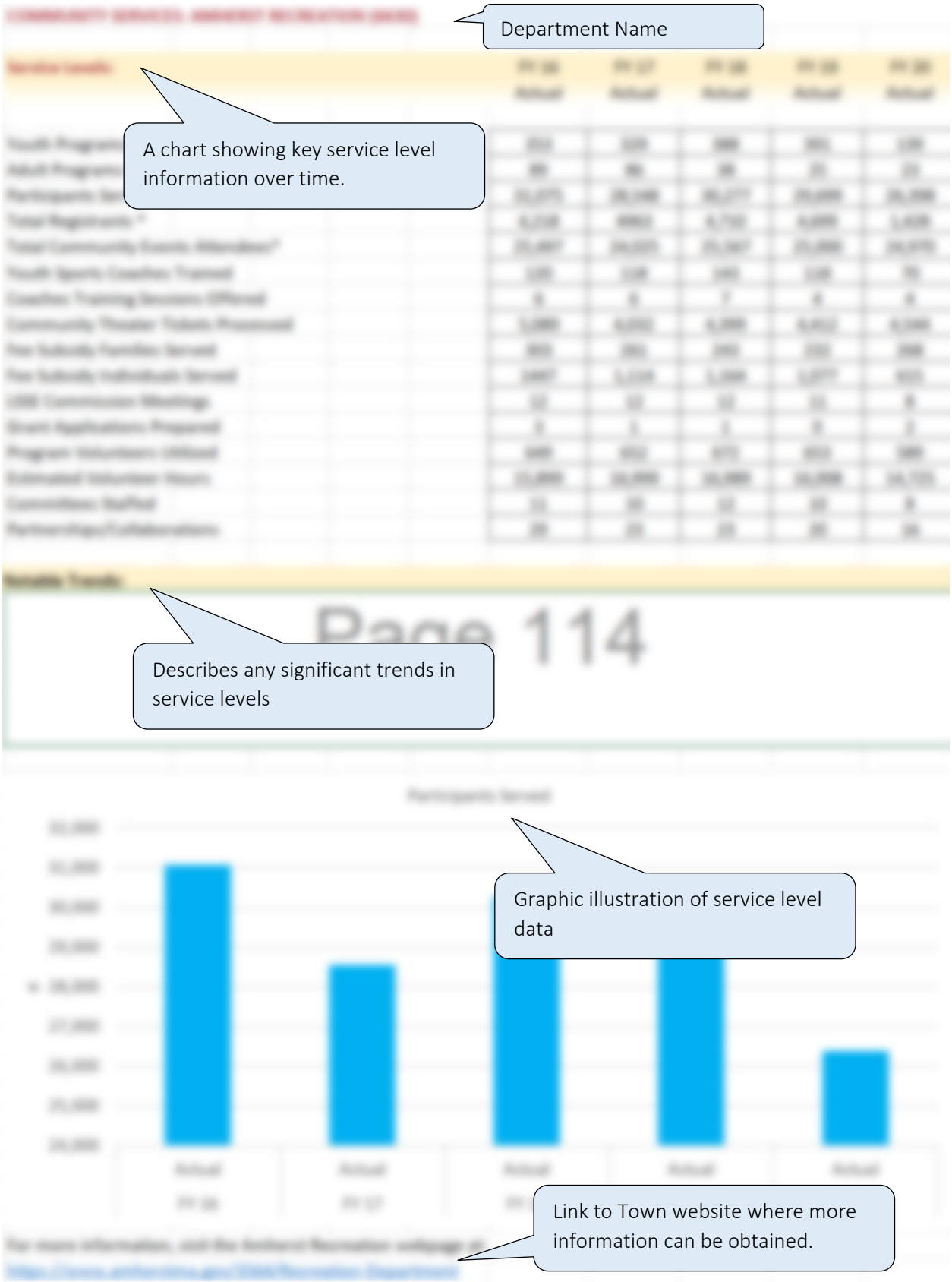
4. Revolving Funds: The Town operates a number of programs that charge fees for services. One example is the Recreation Department which charges participation fees for some of its programming. These fees are collected in a revolving fund and then used to pay for the costs associated with service provided. Using the previous example, funds could be used to pay for an instructor to teach a class. It is called a revolving fund because any surplus balance at year end carries over to the next year and can be used to support programming.

Within the Financial Section, each department has its own section that provides greater detail on its budget. The following graphics break down the different sections for each department.




Department Name
A list of departmental accomplishments that have occurred over the previous year.
A list of key challenges and long-term objectives
A status update of all prior year objectives. Objectives will be marked as accomplished, rescheduled, or ongoing.
Upcoming objectives that are planned for the next fiscal year.


Department Name
A chart showing the departmental budget by fiscal year and broken down by personnel expenditures, operating expenses, and operating capital. It includes three fiscal years of actual expense, the current year budget, and the Town Manager's budget
A narrative explaining the types of expenditures in greater detail.
A description of significant budget changes from the prior year
Graphic illustration of the key expenditure categories
Chart illustrating the department's staffing levels in terms of full-time equivalents (FTE). A 1.0 FTE means one full time position while a 1.5 FTE means one full time and one half time position.


Department Name
A chart showing key service level information over time.
Describes any significant trends in service levels
Graphic illustration of service level data
Link to Town website where more information can be obtained.

Frequently Asked Questions

What new programs or initiatives are included in this budget proposal?

There are no new programs or initiatives in this budget. Projects started previously continue including new departments like CRESS, DEI, and Sustainability; new programs like Rental Registration and Morning Movement and Mentoring; and expanded hours for the special capital projects coordinator.

What programming reductions are being proposed?

6.4 positions were frozen with no funding available for FY26. These positions impact six departments.

How does this budget proposal affect my property taxes?

This proposal operates within the allowable 2.5% increase to the tax levy. It does not require an override which is an increase above and beyond the normal amount. The exact tax rate will not be determined until the end of the calendar year and is dependent upon additional factors such as new development in Town. Actual tax increases are based on a property's assessed value.

How can I get involved and/or voice my opinion on this budget proposal?

There are mulitple ways to get involved. First, you may want to check the budget calendar which can be found here. This outlines when different departments will be reviewed by Finance Committee. The Finance Committee will hold a formal public hearing on the entire budget on May 12th. You may want to attend one of these meetings and share your thoughts. Other ways include visiting the Town's website particpating in other public events that will be posted on the Town wide calendar related to the budget. You can also always email the Town Council at TownCouncil@AmherstMA.gov or the Town Manager at TownManager@AmherstMA.gov.

When will the budget be discussed at a public meeting?

The budget proposal is being presented to the Town Council on May 5th. Other important dates can be found on the budget calendar.

How do I proposed a project for funding?

The Town accepts capital project proposals from residents. The window for submitting requests is closed for this year but will open up again in the Fall. The Town Manager is open to suggestions and proposals throughout the year.

Future Challenges

Amherst, like many communities, confronts numerous challenges spanning financial, regulatory, and operational areas. Below, we outline the key challenges along with strategies to address them.

Challenge: Funding Level Service Budgets

Strategy :

- Overall budget: Continue to study budget results and refine budget projections to ensure budget projections are accurate and maintain a strong fiscal position.
- Regional School District budget:
    - Work with leaders in the three district towns, Regional School District School Committee, and district leadership to develop a shared understanding of budget capacity of the four towns and enrollment trends and budget needs of the district to adopt multi-year projections for the towns and the district.
    - Study the feasibility of consolidating the high school and middle school into one facility, eliminating the need to maintain and invest in two facilities.
- Elementary School district budget:
    - Identify and incorporate projected costs savings with the opening of the new net-zero energy Fort River Elementary School. Savings may include lower electricity and heating expenses, reduced staffing due to consolidation of two schools, and efficiencies gained by a new, state-of-the-art building.
    - Study the impact of the relocated 6th grade on the district's budget and examine alternatives.
- Library budget:
    - Identify and incorporate potential cost savings due to temporary closure of Jones Library during construction.
    - Identify and incorporate projected costs savings with the opening of the new renovated Jones Library. Project savings may include lower electricity and heating expenses and efficiencies offered by a new, state-of-the-art building.
- Municipal budget:
    - Identify and incorporate projected costs savings with the eventual opening of new public works and fire stations. Projected savings may include lower electricity and heating expenses and efficiencies offered by new, state-of-the-art buildings.
    - Study staffing needs of Town departments to ensure staffing is aligned with the mission and goals of the Town.

Challenge: Aging infrastructure

Strategy :

- Continue to advance construction of the four major building projects (Public Works facility, Fire/EMS station, Jones Library, and Elementary School). The new elementary school project is moving forward on schedule and on budget. The Jones Library project is moving forward with projected start date in mid-June. Next steps for the Fire/EMS and Public Works buildings

involve initiating schematic design for the Public Works building and identifying a site for the Fire Station.

- Continue to advocate for State funding programs for municipal buildings like the Fire/EMS station and Public Works buildings.
- Invest in our current buildings paying special attention to roofs, HVAC, and ADA access utilizing the comprehensive analysis of all municipal buildings that is in process.
- Maintain a budget to make investments in facilities and equipment to prolong their lifespan. This budget reduced the percentage of the tax levy allocated to capital improvements at 10.265% for FY 26. This should return to 10.5% in FY27.
- Prioritize roads and sidewalks to address the backlog of paving needs by investing at least $1.5 million annually, utilizing both Town and State Chapter 90 funds, with the possibility of additional funding if available. Advocating for additional State Aid in the Chapter 90 program over multiple years is a priority.

Challenge: Reducing the Town's reliance on fossil fuels

Strategy:

- Promote and expand Community Choice Aggregation in concert with the City of Northampton and Town of Pelham to provide a sustainable, affordable option Amherst residents to purchase electricity.
- Continue to allocate $250,000 in the Capital Improvement Program each year to make targeted investments to move away from fossil fuels.
- Implement strategies identified in the Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resilience Plan.
- Continue to develop a Solar Bylaw for the Town.

Challenge: Confronting systemic racism

Strategy:

- Conduct an operational assessment of the CRESS department to ensure the Department is meeting its goals and the needs of the community.
- Continue funding for the Department of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) to identify and implement initiatives that promote DEI such as enhancing staff diversity and broadening community engagement.
- Fund and support the development of a Reparations initiative within the frameworks of the law.
- Continue to expand the multi-department initiatives to provide programming for youth, such as the Morning Movement and Mentoring program.
- Review the recommendations to create a Resident Oversight Board and incorporate any funding needs in future budgets.

Challenge: Improving the condition of recreational facilities

Strategy:

- Collaborate with the Amherst Pelham Regional School District to build a new track and field at the High School this summer.
- Acquire new field maintenance equipment to better maintain the fields in service.

- Work with the Regional School District to properly account for the costs of maintenance and use of Town and School facilities.
- Secure funding (Town and grant) and implement improvements to parks, pools, and recreational fields and courts.
- Advance plans to create new recreational opportunities at the Town's newly acquired Hickory Ridge property.

Challenge: Increasing a broad range of housing including market and affordable housing and identifying a permanent shelter for those experiencing homelessness

Strategy:

- Advance projects to increase the Town's affordable housing supply, including developments at the East Street School site, the Belchertown Road site, and the home-ownership opportunities project on Ball Lane.
- Allocate staff resources to work with state and local partners to secure funding and develop a permanent shelter with supportive services for those experiencing homelessness at the recently purchased former VFW site on Main Street.
- Identify additional sites suitable for rental and ownership housing opportunities.
- Propose zoning changes to promote construction of new housing and develop additional housing under the State's ADU law.

Challenge: Water /sewer infrastructure improvements and funding

Strategy:

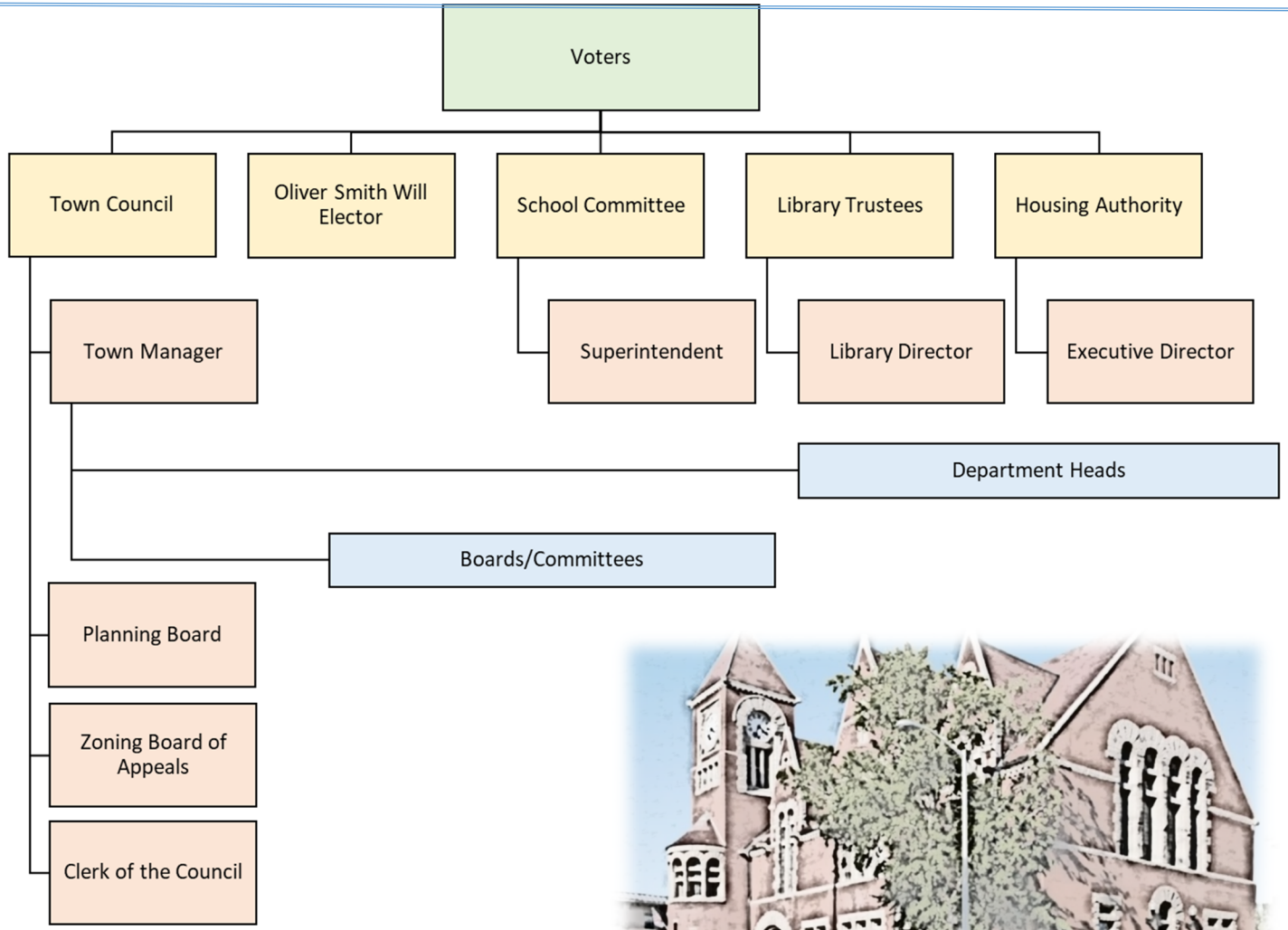
- Complete construction of a new Centennial Water Treatment Facility in Pelham utilizing funds secured through the State Revolving Fund.
- Complete replacement of the Gravity Belt Thickener and make other improvements in the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- Conduct a comprehensive needs assessment of the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- Develop an entry fee for outside entities/municipalities/new users when connecting to the Town of Amherst water and/or sewer systems.
- Investigate alternative rate setting strategies for water and sewer users.
- Seek regional opportunities to expand use of the Wastewater Treatment Facility and identify water sources in different watersheds to improve resiliency.

Challenge: Promoting and sustaining robust economic activity in Town to broaden the tax base

Strategy:

- Develop design standards for continued improvements to the downtown area.
- Review Town regulations and operations to reduce barriers to opening and operating a business.
- Work with the University and colleges to invest in the Town and develop economic development opportunities.
- Review the Zoning Bylaw and other policies to promote economic development, diverse housing options, and support for an increased year-round population.

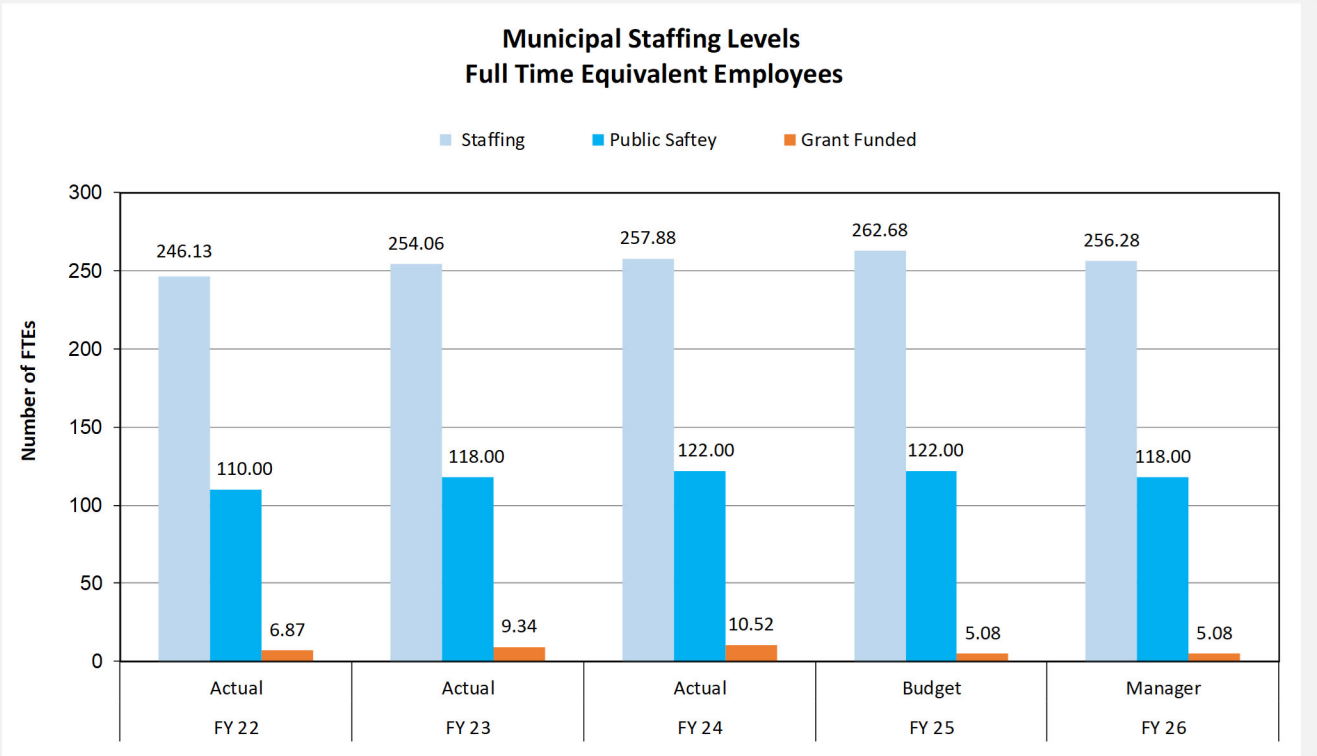
Organizational Chart



Staffing Summary

Full and Part Time Benefited Employees in Full Time Equivalents

Department:	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change
MUNICIPAL BUDGET						
Town Council	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.00
Town Manager	4.40	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
Finance	12.60	12.50	12.50	12.50	11.50	(1.00)
Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion	0.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	0.00
Human Resources	2.50	2.00	2.00	2.56	2.56	0.00
Information Technology	4.58	4.58	4.58	4.58	4.58	0.00
Town Clerk	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
Facilities Maintenance	5.00	5.00	5.00	5.80	5.80	0.00
Total General Government	32.83	32.83	32.83	34.19	33.19	(1.00)
Police Facility	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00
Police	48.00	48.00	48.00	48.00	47.00	(1.00)
Fire/EMS	47.00	47.00	51.00	51.00	50.00	(1.00)
Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service	2.00	10.00	10.00	10.00	8.00	(2.00)
Communications Center	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	11.00	0.00
Animal Welfare	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00
Total Public Safety	110.00	118.00	122.00	122.00	118.00	(4.00)
Public Works Administration	4.04	4.04	4.04	4.04	4.04	0.00
Highway	13.00	13.00	13.00	13.00	12.00	(1.00)
Street and Traffic Lights	0.34	0.34	0.34	0.34	0.34	0.00
Equipment Maintenance	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
Tree and Ground Maintenance	7.50	7.50	7.50	7.50	7.50	0.00
Total Public Works	27.88	27.88	27.88	27.88	26.88	(1.00)
Conservation	5.00	5.00	5.00	4.00	4.00	0.00
Sustainability	0.00	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	0.00
Planning Department	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	0.00
Inspections	10.00	10.00	10.00	13.00	13.00	0.00
Total Conservation & Development	19.50	19.50	19.50	22.50	22.50	0.00
Public Health	1.80	1.80	1.80	2.00	2.00	0.00
Senior Center	3.33	3.36	3.18	3.42	3.42	0.00
Amherst Recreation	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.45	(0.40)
Pools	0.35	0.35	0.35	0.35	0.35	0.00
Golf Course	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	1.20	0.00
Total Community Services	11.53	11.56	11.38	11.82	11.42	(0.40)
TOTAL GENERAL FUND	**201.74**	**209.77**	**213.59**	**218.39**	**211.99**	**(6.40)**
Water Supply and Distribution	18.35	18.35	18.35	18.35	18.35	0.00
TOTAL WATER FUND	**18.35**	**18.35**	**18.35**	**18.35**	**18.35**	**0.00**
Sewer Maintenance	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00	0.00
Wastewater Treatment Plant	16.34	16.34	16.34	16.34	16.34	0.00
TOTAL SEWER FUND	**18.34**	**18.34**	**18.34**	**18.34**	**18.34**	**0.00**
Solid Waste Facility	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
TOTAL SOLID WASTE FUND	**3.00**	**3.00**	**3.00**	**3.00**	**3.00**	**0.00**
Parking Facilities	4.70	4.60	4.60	4.60	4.60	0.00
TOTAL TRANSPORTATION FUND	**4.70**	**4.60**	**4.60**	**4.60**	**4.60**	**0.00**
						0.00
MUNICIPAL BUDGET TOTAL	**246.13**	**254.06**	**257.88**	**262.68**	**256.28**	**(6.40)**



Notables Trends:

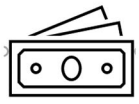
In FY26, a total of 6.4 positions were frozen to meet budgetary constraints. These frozen positions are distributed across several departments, including Town Hall, CRESS, Fire, Police, and Recreation. The breakdown of the frozen positions is as follows:

- Customer Assistant (1.4 FTE)
- Laborer (1.0 FTE)
- Patrol Officer (1.0 FTE)
- Firefighter/ EMT (1.0 FTE)
- Community Responder (2.0 FTE)

Employee Cost Breakdown:

The cost of an employee to the Town is comprised of the components below. Depending on the type of employee, the Town may incur some or all of these costs.

Wages



Life Insurance

Workers Compensation

Health Insurance

Medicare Tax

Paid Time Off

Pension

Unemployment

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Financial Section

"Do what you can, with what you have, where you are."

- Theodore Roosevelt

Revenue & Expenditure Summary

	FY 23 ACTUAL	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 RECAP	FY 26 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg
REVENUES						
PROPERTY TAX						
Base Levy	59,375,443	61,851,998	64,415,149	67,269,595	2,854,446	4.4%
2.5% Allowable Increase	1,484,386	1,546,300	1,610,379	1,681,740	71,361	4.4%
Estimated New Growth	948,557	1,005,459	1,244,067	650,000	(594,067)	-47.8%
General Override						
Levy Limit	**61,808,386**	**64,403,757**	**67,269,595**	**69,601,335**	**2,331,740**	**3.5%**
Debt Exclusion			691,807	2,125,643	1,433,836	207.3%
Maximum Allowable Levy	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,961,402	71,726,978	3,765,576	5.5%
Excess Levy Capacity	(83,203)	(87,135)	(157,691)	0		
Subtotal PROPERTY TAX	**61,725,183**	**64,316,622**	**67,803,711**	**71,726,978**	**3,923,267**	**5.8%**
LOCAL RECEIPTS						
Motor Vehicle Excise	1,959,748	2,026,029	1,500,000	1,800,000	300,000	20.0%
Hotel/Motel and Meals Excise	799,432	915,231	620,000	700,400	80,400	13.0%
Cannabis Tax	105,537	74,334	-	0	-	--
Penalties and Interest	305,727	250,777	254,900	254,900	-	0.0%
PILOT	822,136	844,948	857,698	857,698	-	0.0%
Fees	60,923	18,246			-	--
Rentals	140,006	148,969	139,599	139,599	-	0.0%
Departmental Revenue	1,151,131	1,072,381	843,678	843,678	-	0.0%
Licenses and Permits	1,308,024	1,729,213	991,914	1,026,968	35,054	3.5%
Special Assessments	1,220,293	1,284,146	1,278,074	1,278,074	-	0.0%
Fines and Forfeits	34,739	59,550	35,600	60,600	25,000	70.2%
Investment Income	747,676	1,931,628	150,000	500,000	350,000	233.3%
Miscellaneous (see notes section)	565,825	568,444	340,000	115,000	(225,000)	-66.2%
Subtotal LOCAL RECEIPTS	**9,221,197**	**10,923,898**	**7,011,463**	**7,576,917**	**565,454**	**8.1%**
STATE AID						
Chapter 70	6,217,473	6,280,773	6,383,109	6,460,884	77,775	1.2%
Charter Assessment Reimbursement	153,318	144,627	105,081	291,037	185,956	177.0%
Unrestricted General Govt Aid	9,752,342	10,064,417	10,366,349	10,594,409	228,060	2.2%
Veterans Benefits	100,733	124,597	126,970	143,291	16,321	12.9%
Exempt Vets, Blind, Surv. Spouses, Elderly	39,721	40,209	33,179	53,792	20,613	62.1%
State Owned Land	296,770	326,060	334,234	334,234	-	0.0%
Offset Receipts						--
School Lunch	-	-	-	0	-	--
School Choice Tuition			885,882	868,257	(17,625)	-2.0%
Public Libraries			172,273	172,103	(170)	-0.1%
Subtotal STATE AID	**16,560,357**	**16,980,683**	**18,407,077**	**18,918,007**	**510,930**	**2.8%**
OTHER FINANCING SOURCES						--
Ambulance Fund	2,710,200	3,164,290	2,947,500	3,474,000	526,500	17.9%
Community Preservation Act (debt service only	488,720	443,460	520,250	176,550	(343,700)	-66.1%
Enterprise Fund Reimbursements	859,362	725,209	952,965	1,043,944	90,979	9.5%
Overlay Surplus	-	-	-	0	-	--
Miscellaneous	175,000	275,000	430,440	344,704	(85,736)	-19.9%
Free Cash	4,425,901	4,518,349	-	0	-	--
Stabilization Fund	13,109,345		-	0	-	--
Subtotal OTHER FINANCING SOURCES	**21,768,528**	**9,126,308**	**4,851,155**	**5,039,198**	**188,043**	**3.9%**
TOTAL REVENUES	**109,275,265**	**101,347,510**	**98,073,406**	**103,261,100**	**5,187,694**	**5.3%**

	FY 23 ACTUAL	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 RECAP	FY 26 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg
EXPENDITURES						
OPERATING BUDGET						
Town	24,956,759	25,393,309	28,363,385	29,497,920	1,134,535	*4.00%*
Elementary Schools	24,911,285	25,876,274	26,970,419	28,049,236	1,078,817	*4.00%*
Elementary Schools (1% add'l from Free Cash)				269,704	269,704	*1.00%*
A-P Regional School District (Assessment)	17,254,803	17,772,017	18,838,338	19,744,008	905,670	*4.81%*
Jones Library (Tax Support)	2,073,998	2,213,530	2,302,071	2,394,154	92,083	*4.00%*
Subtotal OPERATING BUDGET	**69,196,845**	**71,255,130**	**76,474,213**	**79,955,022**	**3,480,809**	**4.6%**
CAPITAL BUDGET						
Debt Service - Debt Exclusion			674,837	2,125,643	1,450,806	215.0%
Debt Service - OTHER NOT TAX FUNDED (CPA/O	563,720	518,460	595,250	251,550	(343,700)	-57.7%
Debt Assessment - Region	388,331	372,018	388,922	485,000	96,078	24.7%
Debt Service - Current	269,868	297,272	1,909,199	1,204,095	(705,104)	-36.9%
Debt Service - Projected		-	59,791	123,255	63,464	106.1%
Cash Capital (Tax Support)	4,879,699	5,396,272	4,136,548	4,799,865	663,317	16.0%
Subtotal Tax Funded Capital	**6,101,618**	**6,584,022**	**7,764,547**	**8,989,408**	**1,224,861**	**15.8%**
Tax Capital Less Debt Exclusion, CPA, Other	5,537,898	6,065,562	6,494,460	6,612,215	117,755	1.8%
% Net Tax Levy	9.7%	10.2%	10.5%	10.265%		
Cash Capital (Prior FY vote in Current FY)						
Cash Capital (Reserves)		1,326,562			-	
Cash Capital (Ambulance Fund)		334,516	147,500	674,000	526,500	356.9%
Subtotal CAPITAL	**6,101,618**	**8,245,100**	**7,912,047**	**9,663,408**	**1,751,361**	**22.1%**
MISCELLANEOUS						
Assessment - Retirement System	6,922,799	7,500,609	7,590,994	7,777,403	186,409	2.5%
Assessment - Regional Lockup Facility	-	-	-	0	-	--
Other	17,035,246	3,518,349				--
OPEB	500,000	550,000	600,000	600,000	-	0.0%
Reserve Fund						--
Subtotal MISCELLANEOUS	**24,458,045**	**11,568,958**	**8,190,994**	**8,377,403**	**186,409**	**2.3%**
Total APPROPRIATIONS	**99,756,508**	**91,069,189**	**92,577,254**	**97,995,833**	**5,418,579**	**5.9%**
UNAPPROPRIATED USES						
Reserve for Abatements & Exemptions			972,055	348,007	(624,048)	-64.2%
State Assessments (Cherry Sheet)	3,349,817	3,521,322	3,448,594	3,859,368	410,774	11.9%
Cherry Sheet Offsets			1,058,155	1,040,360	(17,795)	-1.7%
Other Amounts to be Raised	6,993	7,168	17,348	17,532	184	1.1%
Subtotal UNAPPROPRIATED USES	**3,356,810**	**3,528,490**	**5,496,152**	**5,265,267**	**(230,885)**	**-4.2%**
TOTAL BUDGET PLAN	**103,113,319**	**94,597,679**	**98,073,406**	**103,261,100**	**5,187,694**	**5.3%**
SURPLUS / (SHORTFALL)	**6,161,946**	**6,749,831**	**-**	**-**		

Long Range Financial Outlook

	FY 23 ACTUAL	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 RECAP	FY 26 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg	FY 27 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 28 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 29 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 30 PROJ	$ Chg
REVENUES														
PROPERTY TAX														
Base Levy	59,375,443	61,851,998	64,415,149	67,269,595	2,854,446	4.4%	69,601,335	2,331,740	71,991,368	2,390,033	74,441,152	2,449,784	76,952,181	2,511,029
2.5% Allowable Increase	1,484,386	1,546,300	1,610,379	1,681,740	71,361	4.4%	1,740,033	58,293	1,799,784	59,751	1,861,029	61,245	1,923,805	62,776
Estimated New Growth	948,557	1,005,459	1,244,067	650,000	(594,067)	-47.8%	650,000	-	650,000	-	650,000	-	650,000	-
General Override														
Levy Limit	**61,808,386**	**64,403,757**	**67,269,595**	**69,601,335**	**2,331,740**	**3.5%**	**71,991,368**	**2,390,033**	**74,441,152**	**2,449,784**	**76,952,181**	**2,511,029**	**79,525,986**	**2,573,805**
Debt Exclusion			691,807	2,125,643	1,433,836	207.3%	2,899,294	773,651	3,165,794	266,500	3,260,569	94,775	3,273,657	13,088
Maximum Allowable Levy	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,961,402	71,726,978	3,765,576	5.5%	74,890,662	3,163,684	77,606,946	2,716,284	80,212,750	2,605,804	82,799,643	2,586,893
Excess Levy Capacity	(83,203)	(87,135)	(157,691)	0			-		-		-		-	
Subtotal PROPERTY TAX	**61,725,183**	**64,316,622**	**67,803,711**	**71,726,978**	**3,923,267**	**5.8%**	**74,890,662**	**3,163,684**	**77,606,946**	**2,716,284**	**80,212,750**	**2,605,804**	**82,799,643**	**2,586,893**
LOCAL RECEIPTS														
Motor Vehicle Excise	1,959,748	2,026,029	1,500,000	1,800,000	300,000	20.0%	1,845,000	45,000	1,881,900	36,900	1,919,538	37,638	1,957,929	38,391
Hotel/Motel and Meals Excise	799,432	915,231	620,000	700,400	80,400	13.0%	714,408	14,008	728,696	14,288	743,270	14,574	758,135	14,865
Cannabis Tax	105,537	74,334	-	0	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Penalties and Interest	305,727	250,777	254,900	254,900	-	0.0%	254,900	-	254,900	-	254,900	-	254,900	-
PILOT	822,136	844,948	857,698	857,698	-	0.0%	857,698	-	857,698	-	857,698	-	857,698	-
Fees	60,923	18,246			-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Rentals	140,006	148,969	139,599	139,599	-	0.0%	142,391	2,792	145,239	2,848	148,144	2,905	151,106	2,963
Departmental Revenue	1,151,131	1,072,381	843,678	843,678	-	0.0%	860,552	16,874	877,763	17,211	895,318	17,555	913,224	17,906
Licenses and Permits	1,308,024	1,729,213	991,914	1,026,968	35,054	3.5%	1,047,507	20,539	1,068,458	20,950	1,089,827	21,369	1,111,623	21,797
Special Assessments	1,220,293	1,284,146	1,278,074	1,278,074	-	0.0%	1,278,074	-	1,278,074	-	1,278,074	-	1,278,074	-
Fines and Forfeits	34,739	59,550	35,600	60,600	25,000	70.2%	60,600	-	60,600	-	60,600	-	60,600	-
Investment Income	747,676	1,931,628	150,000	500,000	350,000	233.3%	350,000	(150,000)	350,000	-	350,000	-	350,000	-
Miscellaneous (see notes section)	565,825	568,444	340,000	115,000	(225,000)	-66.2%	117,300	2,300	119,646	2,346	122,039	2,393	124,480	2,441
Subtotal LOCAL RECEIPTS	**9,221,197**	**10,923,898**	**7,011,463**	**7,576,917**	**565,454**	**8.1%**	**7,528,430**	**(48,487)**	**7,622,973**	**94,543**	**7,719,407**	**96,434**	**7,817,770**	**98,363**
STATE AID														
Chapter 70	6,217,473	6,280,773	6,383,109	6,460,884	77,775	1.2%	6,486,728	25,844	6,512,674	25,947	6,538,725	26,051	6,564,880	26,155
Charter Assessment Reimbursement	153,318	144,627	105,081	291,037	185,956	177.0%	291,037	-	291,037	-	291,037	-	291,037	-
Unrestricted General Govt Aid	9,752,342	10,064,417	10,366,349	10,594,409	228,060	2.2%	10,806,297	211,888	11,022,423	216,126	11,242,872	220,448	11,467,729	224,857
Veterans Benefits	100,733	124,597	126,970	143,291	16,321	12.9%	143,291	-	143,291	-	143,291	-	143,291	-
Exempt Vets, Blind, Surv. Spouses, Elderly	39,721	40,209	33,179	53,792	20,613	62.1%	53,792	-	53,792	-	53,792	-	53,792	-
State Owned Land	296,770	326,060	334,234	334,234	-	0.0%	334,234	-	334,234	-	334,234	-	334,234	-
Offset Receipts														
School Lunch	-	-	-	0	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
School Choice Tuition			885,882	868,257	(17,625)	-2.0%	868,257	-	868,257	-	868,257	-	868,257	-
Public Libraries			172,273	172,103	(170)	-0.1%	172,103	-	172,103	-	172,103	-	172,103	-
Subtotal STATE AID	**16,560,357**	**16,980,683**	**18,407,077**	**18,918,007**	**510,930**	**2.8%**	**19,155,739**	**237,732**	**19,397,812**	**242,073**	**19,644,311**	**246,499**	**19,895,323**	**251,012**
OTHER FINANCING SOURCES						--								0
Ambulance Fund	2,710,200	3,164,290	2,947,500	3,474,000	526,500	17.9%	2,500,000	(974,000)	2,950,000	450,000	2,950,000	-	2,950,000	-
Community Preservation Act (debt service only	488,720	443,460	520,250	176,550	(343,700)	-66.1%	472,200	295,650	457,300	(14,900)	457,300	-	457,300	-
Enterprise Fund Reimbursements	859,362	725,209	952,965	1,043,944	90,979	9.5%	1,011,001	(32,943)	1,041,331	30,330	1,072,570	31,240	1,104,748	32,177
Overlay Surplus	-	-	-	0	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Miscellaneous	175,000	275,000	430,440	344,704	(85,736)	-19.9%	-	(344,704)	-	-	-	-	-	-
Free Cash	4,425,901	4,518,349	-	0	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Stabilization Fund	13,109,345		-	0	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Subtotal OTHER FINANCING SOURCES	**21,768,528**	**9,126,308**	**4,851,155**	**5,039,198**	**188,043**	**3.9%**	**3,983,201**	**(1,055,997)**	**4,448,631**	**465,430**	**4,479,870**	**31,240**	**4,512,048**	**32,177**
TOTAL REVENUES	**109,275,265**	**101,347,510**	**98,073,406**	**103,261,100**	**5,187,694**	**5.3%**	**105,558,031**	**2,296,931**	**109,076,362**	**3,518,330**	**112,056,339**	**2,979,977**	**115,024,783**	**2,968,445**

	FY 23 ACTUAL	FY 24 ACTUAL	FY 25 RECAP	FY 26 PROPOSED	$ Chg	% Chg	FY 27 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 28 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 29 PROJ	$ Chg	FY 30 PROJ	$ Chg
EXPENDITURES														
OPERATING BUDGET														
Town	24,956,759	25,393,309	28,363,385	29,497,920	1,134,535	4.00%	30,235,368	737,448	30,991,252	755,884	31,766,034	774,781	32,560,184	794,151
Elementary Schools	24,911,285	25,876,274	26,970,419	28,049,236	1,078,817	4.00%	28,750,467	701,231	29,469,229	718,762	30,205,959	736,731	30,961,108	755,149
Elementary Schools (1% add'l from Free Cash)				269,704	269,704	1.00%		(269,704)						
A-P Regional School District (Assessment)	17,254,803	17,772,017	18,838,338	19,744,008	905,670	4.81%	20,237,608	493,600	20,743,548	505,940	21,262,137	518,589	21,793,691	531,553
Jones Library (Tax Support)	2,073,998	2,213,530	2,302,071	2,394,154	92,083	4.00%	2,454,008	59,854	2,515,358	61,350	2,578,242	62,884	2,642,698	64,456
Subtotal OPERATING BUDGET	**69,196,845**	**71,255,130**	**76,474,213**	**79,955,022**	**3,480,809**	**4.6%**	**81,677,451**	**1,722,429**	**83,719,387**	**2,041,936**	**85,812,372**	**2,092,985**	**87,957,681**	**2,145,309**
CAPITAL BUDGET														
Debt Service - Debt Exclusion			674,837	2,125,643	1,450,806	215.0%	2,899,294	773,651	3,165,794	266,500	3,260,569	94,775	3,273,657	13,088
Debt Service - OTHER NOT TAX FUNDED (CPA/O	563,720	518,460	595,250	251,550	(343,700)	-57.7%	315,250	63,700	375,000	59,750	370,000	(5,000)	365,000	(5,000)
Debt Assessment - Region	388,331	372,018	388,922	485,000	96,078	24.7%	800,000	315,000	800,000	-	800,000	-	800,000	-
Debt Service - Current	269,868	297,272	1,909,199	1,204,095	(705,104)	-36.9%	2,768,043	1,563,948	2,374,482	(393,561)	2,305,797	(68,685)	2,260,831	(44,966)
Debt Service - Projected		-	59,791	123,255	63,464	106.1%	200,000	76,745	200,000	-	200,000	-	200,000	-
Cash Capital (Tax Support)	4,879,699	5,396,272	4,136,548	4,799,865	663,317	16.0%	3,295,264	(1,504,601)	3,933,658	638,394	4,253,297	319,639	4,555,490	302,193
Subtotal Tax Funded Capital	**6,101,618**	**6,584,022**	**7,764,547**	**8,989,408**	**1,224,861**	**15.8%**	**10,277,851**	**1,288,443**	**10,848,934**	**571,083**	**11,189,663**	**340,729**	**11,454,978**	**265,315**
Tax Capital Less Debt Exclusion, CPA, Other	5,537,898	6,065,562	6,494,460	6,612,215	117,755	1.8%	7,063,307		7,308,140		7,559,094	250,954	7,816,321	257,227
% Net Tax Levy	9.7%	10.2%	10.5%	10.265%			10.50%		10.50%		10.50%	0.0%	10.50%	0.0%
Cash Capital (Prior FY vote in Current FY)														
Cash Capital (Reserves)		1,326,562			-			-		-		-		-
Cash Capital (Ambulance Fund)		334,516	147,500	674,000	526,500	356.9%	-	(674,000)	450,000	450,000	450,000	-	450,000	-
Subtotal CAPITAL	**6,101,618**	**8,245,100**	**7,912,047**	**9,663,408**	**1,751,361**	**22.1%**	**10,277,851**	**614,443**	**11,298,934**	**1,021,083**	**11,639,663**	**340,729**	**11,904,978**	**265,315**
MISCELLANEOUS														
Assessment - Retirement System	6,922,799	7,500,609	7,590,994	7,777,403	186,409	2.5%	8,244,047	466,644	8,738,690	494,643	9,263,011	524,321	9,818,792	555,781
Assessment - Regional Lockup Facility	-	-	-	0	-	--	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other	17,035,246	3,518,349				--						-		-
OPEB	500,000	550,000	600,000	600,000	-	0.0%	650,000	50,000	700,000	50,000	750,000	50,000	800,000	50,000
Reserve Fund						--						-		-
Subtotal MISCELLANEOUS	**24,458,045**	**11,568,958**	**8,190,994**	**8,377,403**	**186,409**	**2.3%**	**8,894,047**	**516,644**	**9,438,690**	**544,643**	**10,013,011**	**574,321**	**10,618,792**	**605,781**
Total APPROPRIATIONS	**99,756,508**	**91,069,189**	**92,577,254**	**97,995,833**	**5,418,579**	**5.9%**	**100,849,349**	**2,853,517**	**104,457,011**	**3,607,662**	**107,465,046**	**3,008,035**	**110,481,451**	**3,016,405**
UNAPPROPRIATED USES														
Reserve for Abatements & Exemptions			972,055	348,007	(624,048)	-64.2%	719,914	371,907	744,412	24,498	769,522	25,110	795,260	25,738
State Assessments (Cherry Sheet)	3,349,817	3,521,322	3,448,594	3,859,368	410,774	11.9%	3,975,149	115,781	4,094,404	119,254	4,217,236	122,832	4,343,753	126,517
Cherry Sheet Offsets			1,058,155	1,040,360	(17,795)	-1.7%	1,040,360	-	1,040,360	-	1,040,360	-	1,040,360	-
Other Amounts to be Raised	6,993	7,168	17,348	17,532	184	1.1%	17,532	-	17,532	-	17,532	-	17,532	-
Subtotal UNAPPROPRIATED USES	**3,356,810**	**3,528,490**	**5,496,152**	**5,265,267**	**(230,885)**	**-4.2%**	**5,752,955**	**487,688**	**5,896,707**	**143,752**	**6,044,649**	**147,942**	**6,196,905**	**152,255**
TOTAL BUDGET PLAN	**103,113,319**	**94,597,679**	**98,073,406**	**103,261,100**	**5,187,694**	**5.3%**	**106,602,304**	**3,341,204**	**110,353,718**	**3,751,414**	**113,509,695**	**3,155,977**	**116,678,356**	**3,168,660**
SURPLUS / (SHORTFALL)	**6,161,946**	**6,749,831**	**-**	**-**			**(1,044,273)**		**(1,277,357)**		**(1,453,357)**		**(1,653,572)**	

Summary of Municipal Budgeting & Accounting

Developing and managing the annual budget is a multi-step process that spans the entire year. Below is a breakdown of the key tasks performed in each month. The months that these tasks occur may vary from year to year.

September

- Town staff begin to develop financial projections for the following year and create the budget calendar that will include key milestones.
- The Community Preservation Act Committee (CPAC), which develops recommendations for how to expend Community Preservation Act (CPA) funds, begins its process by requesting proposals from the community.

October

- Department heads review fees and fee-based programs and provide guidance on whether the fee should change for the following fiscal year.
- Department heads begin working on their capital improvement program requests for the following fiscal year. In addition, the resident capital request form is posted on the Town website.
- CPAC reviews proposals for CPA funds including listening to presentations from requestors.
- The first quarter budget report is prepared. The quarterly budget reports are posted online and provide the Town Council with information on the condition of the current year's budget.

November

- Proposals to change fees are finalized including possible changes to water and sewer rates.
- The Financial Indicators report is presented to the Town's elected bodies (Town Council, School Committee, and Board of Library Trustees).
- The Budget Coordinating Group (BCG) meets to agree upon a budget schedule for the next few months and to share any other pertinent information.
- A budget forum is held. The budget forum, required by the Town Charter, provides an opportunity for residents to provide input or feedback before the budget is developed.
- The Finance Committee develops Budget Guidelines for the Town Council to adopt. Budget guidelines provide parameters to the Town Manager that help guide the development of the budget.
- CPAC holds a public hearing on the proposals it received. Residents can offer feedback on the proposals to help inform the recommendation from CPAC.

December

- Town staff update their sections of the budget document including service levels.
- The first round of budget and capital meetings is held by the Finance Department with department heads.

January

- The Town Manager meets with department heads to review their budget and capital requests.
- Budget additional proposals are reviewed, and possible reductions are discussed if needed.
- The Governor releases information on State Aid funding levels.
- The Capital Improvement Program begins to take shape based on the meetings with department heads.

- The second quarter budget report is prepared.

February
- The budget document is assembled and the Town Manager's budget proposal is drafted.
- The Capital Improvement Program, including the capital inventory, is presented to the Joint Capital Planning Committee (JCPC) for feedback. JCPC begins its review process.

March
- JCPC continues to review the Capital Improvement Program and makes a final recommendation to the Town Manager.
- The Library, Elementary School, and Amherst Pelham Regional School District must finalize their budget proposals and submit them to the Town Manager by April 1st.

April
- The Town Manager finalizes the budget document and Capital Improvement Program.
- Changes to the water and sewer rate are presented to Town Council.
- The Regional School District budget is presented to the Town Council. A budget hearing is held on the Region's budget. The Region budget is often considered on a different timeline than the rest of the budget because of the timing of Town Meetings in the other Towns that belong to the Region.
- The third quarter budget report is prepared.

May
- The budget proposal and Capital Improvement Program are presented to the Town Council. These items are referred to the Finance Committee for review.
- The Finance Committee holds a public hearing on the budget and Capital Improvement Program.
- The Finance Committee meets with each department to review its budget proposals.
- The Town Council votes on the Region's budget proposal and related debt assessment.

June
- The Finance Committee completes its review of the budget and Capital Improvement Program and provides a recommendation to the Town Council.
- The Town Council reviews the recommendation from the Finance Committee and votes on the annual budget, the Capital Improvement Program, water and sewer rates, and Community Preservation Act budget.
- The Town Council may also vote on borrowing authorizations related to the budget if applicable in that given year.

July
- The new budget goes into effect.
- Finance Office staff disseminates the information to department heads and updates the financial accounting system.

August
- Finance office staff close out the prior fiscal year and calculate any deficit or surplus.
- Finance office staff prepare financial reports required by the State.
- Finance office prepares for the annual audit.

- The fourth quarter budget report is prepared.

While the annual budget process can seem complex, it ultimately comes down to balancing the Town's revenues and expenditures. This is very similar to the process that individuals would use to calculate their personal budget for the month or year. For the Town, the first step is calculating its revenue for the year. This involves making projections as the exact amount of revenues from most sources is not known at the time the budget is developed. Below are key revenue areas for the Town:

Property Tax: This is by far the largest revenue source for the Town. Each year, a property tax rate is calculated and billed to all property owners (unless exempt). For businesses, this includes personal property like equipment used to operate the business. Residents pay their property taxes quarterly.

Local Receipts: The Town collects revenues for a variety of services it provides. Some examples include providing licenses and permits, charging for specific services, and payments in lieu of taxes. All of these receipts help support the budget of the Town.

State Aid: The State allocates funds to cities and towns for a variety of purposes. The two largest sources are Chapter 70 for education and Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA).

Other Financing Sources: The Town receives a few smaller sources of revenues including reimbursements from the State and indirect costs charges to Enterprise funds.

Once a conservative estimate of revenues is created, the next step is to project the expenditures of the Town. The Town Council plays a role in this process by providing budget guidelines that specify how much operating budgets can increase. Outside of the operating budgets, costs for capital, debt, retirement assessments and other state assessments are calculated. The end result is a projection of expenses for the Town.

The projection of revenues is coupled with the projection of expenditures to determine if budget reductions are necessary or if there are funds available to invest in the goals of the Town.

Fund Structure by Department

The General Fund is the primary funding source for the Town's operations. All of the major revenue sources of the Town go into the General Fund. The Town Council, through the annual budget process, appropriates expenditures in the General Fund. In addition to the General Fund, there are several other funds used to manage specific activities such as recreation programs, water/sewer, transportation, solid waste, and ambulance billing. The chart below illustrates how various departments and activities are funded.

	General Fund	Recreation Revolving	Water	Sewer	Transportation	Solid Waste	Ambulance
Town Council	A						
Town Manager	A						
Finance	A						A
Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion	A						
Human Resources	A						
Employee Benefits	A						
Information Technology	A						A
Town Clerk/Elections	A						
Facilities	A						
Insurance	A		A	A	A	A	
General Services	A						
Police	A				A		
Fire/EMS	A						A
CRESS	A						
Dispatch	A						
Animal Control	A						
Public Works	A		A	A	A	A	
Conservation	A						
Planning	A						
Inspection Services	A						
Public Health	A						
Senior Center	A						
Veterans Services	A						
Recreation	A	A					

Reserves

Reserves are a key component to maintaining the fiscal health of the Town and are maintained for three strategic reasons:

1. To be used for emergency expenditures such as damaged bridge or a failure of a major building system.
2. To be used as a stabilizing revenue source during an economic downtown when other revenues drop.
3. To save up for large initiatives like a new building.

Amherst has reserves for each of these reasons. The table below provides an approximate breakdown of Town reserves as of May 1, 2025

Reserve Type	Purpose	Amount	Policy
Free Cash	Emergencies	$2,677,607	5% of Budget
General Stabilization Fund	Revenue Stability	$10,356,502	10% of Budget
Reparations Stabilization Fund	Reparations	$578,521	$2,000,000 Funding Goal
Capital Stabilization Fund	Capital Projects	$11,982,044	No Limit
Water Retained Earnings	Water Enterprise	$1,685,541	30% to 50% of Budget
Sewer Retained Earnings	Sewer Enterprise	$1,354,856	30% to 50% of Budget
Transportation Retained Earnings	Transportation Enterprise	$298,220	30% to 50% of Budget
Solid Waste Retained Earnings	Solid Waste Enterprise	$211,132	30% to 50% of Budget

The Town's policy is to maintain a reserve balance of 5% of the operating budget in Free Cash at all times. This emergency fund is the highest priority. The next priority is to maintain a balance of 10% of the operating budget in General Stabilization Fund. This policy goal is based on the amount of funding needed to sustain the Town budget for two to three years of an economic downturn. The next priority is the reparations fund where the Council has set a goal of raising $2 million by allocating an amount equivalent to annual cannabis revenues each year. The final priority is the capital stabilization fund where currently the goal is to save up as much as possible to support the four building projects and possibly pay for one of the projects outright to avoid interest costs.

The retained earnings reserve accounts are specific to the Town's Enterprise Funds. These budgets are smaller but vital so the policy goal is higher. The 30% to 50% target is based on the amount of funding needed to sustain operations for two to three years of an economic downturn.

Budget Assumptions

The annual budget is developed several months before the fiscal year begins. There are many unknowns at the time the budget is being developed and as a result, a number of assumptions must be made. These assumptions are made by the Town's professional finance staff based on past experience and expectations for the future. These assumptions are updated and refined as newer and better information is gathered. Below is a summary of the key assumptions that guided this year's budget.

Revenues

New growth is the addition to the tax rolls each year from new construction, renovations, additions, or other enhancements to properties. Town staff estimate new growth conservatively by looking at the volume and types of building permits that have been issued. The FY26 budget uses a figure of $650,000 for new growth, which is similar to previous years. During economic slowdowns, this figure may be reduced and similarly this number may be increased when there are several large construction projects going on in Town.

Local receipts include multiple revenue sources derived from economic activity in Town. These revenue sources fluctuate with the local economy. The Town's local receipts took a big hit in FY21 due to the pandemic. As a result, the budget for local receipts was reduced drastically. As we look to FY26, local receipts are expected to continue rising toward the averages from prior years.

Expenditures

Wages and staffing are projected by taking the existing workforce and projecting it forward one year considering contractual changes that might increase pay and cost of living adjustments. Placeholders are used for vacant positions that are in the process of being filled.

Health insurance is one of the more unstable line items in the operating budget. While we know the health insurance rate, we do not know exactly how many employees will decide to enroll in the Town's health insurance each year. To help mitigate this unknown, we project a modest increase in plans each year.

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General Fund Revenue Summary & Detail

Overview

The following section provides a summary and additional details about the revenue sources that support the General Fund budget.

GENERAL FUND REVENUES SUMMARY

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 -25 Change	Percent Change
Property Tax	$	59,206,034	61,725,183	64,316,622	67,803,711	71,726,978	3,923,267	5.8%
Local Receipts	$	8,189,855	9,221,197	10,923,898	7,011,463	7,576,917	565,454	8.1%
State Aid	$	15,981,149	16,560,357	16,980,683	18,407,077	18,918,007	510,930	2.8%
Other Financing Sources	$	9,097,939	21,768,528	9,126,308	4,851,155	5,039,198	188,043	3.9%
Total Revenues	$	92,474,977	109,275,265	101,347,510	98,073,406	103,261,100	5,187,694	5.3%

Property Tax:

Description: Funds raised through the annual levy of taxes on real estate property. This funding source can increase/decrease due to changes in the level of property values, increases in the tax base from new development, and

State Aid:

Description: Funds provided to the Town from the State for specific purposes. These funds are partially offset by State Assessments in the expenditure budget. The two largest categories are Chapter 70 for education and Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA). Revenues are decided by the State Legislature and aligned with the fiscal health of the economy.

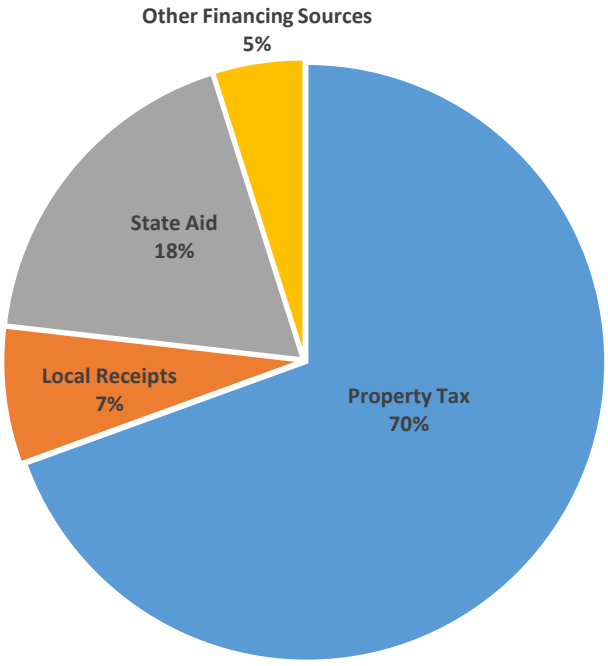
Local Receipts:

Description: Funds generated through a variety of different local activities such as recreation programming, licenses, permits, motor vehicle excise tax, Payment In Lieu of Taxes (PILOT) payments, penalties and fines. These revenues

Other Financing Sources:

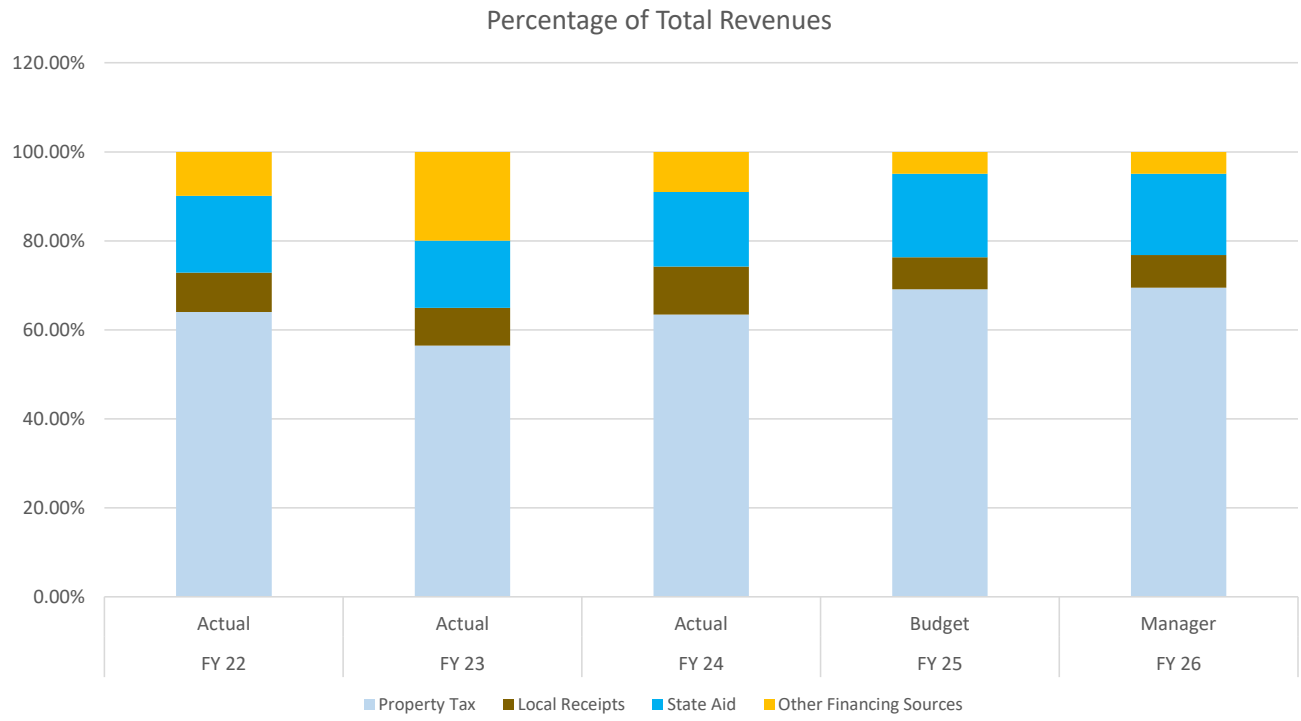
Description: Monies transferred in from other areas like enterprise funds, the ambulance fund, or the community preservation act. This also includes tranfers from free cash to the stabilization fund, capital stabilization fund, and reperations fund.

FY26 Allocation of Revenue Sources



GENERAL FUND REVENUES SUMMARY

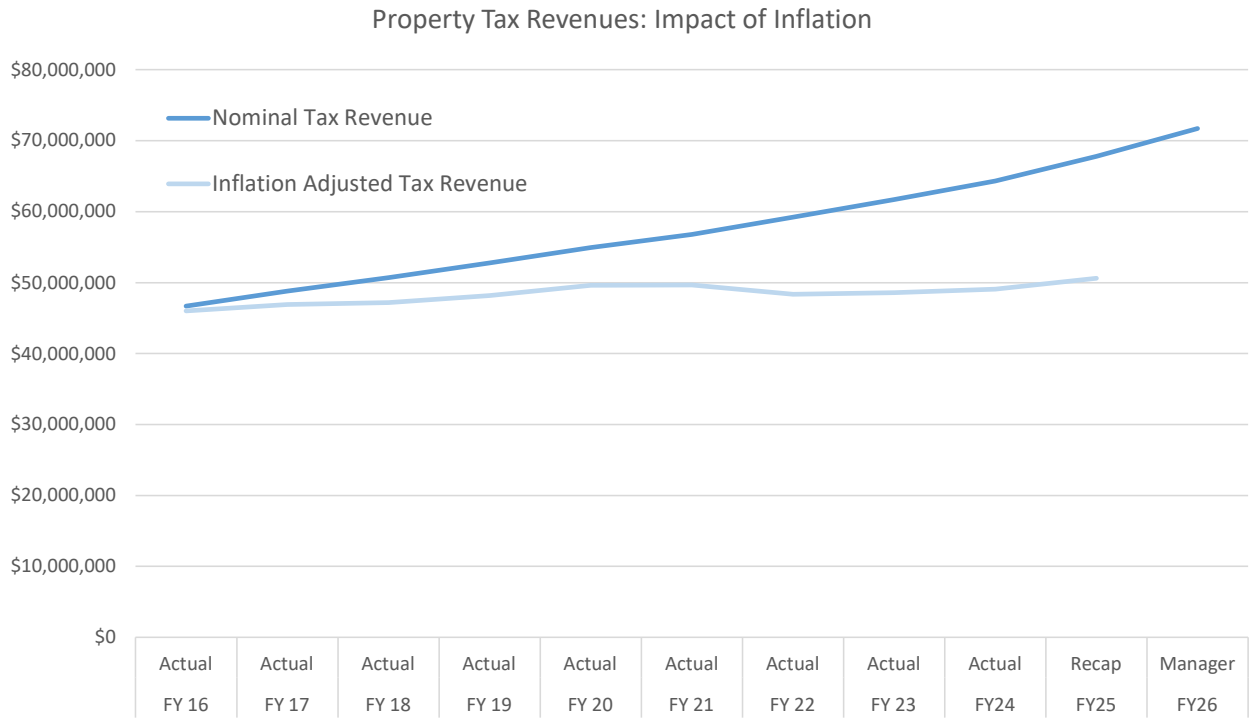
Service Levels:	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager
As a % of total revenues					
Property Tax	64.02%	56.49%	63.46%	69.14%	69.46%
Local Receipts	8.86%	8.44%	10.78%	7.15%	7.34%
State Aid	17.28%	15.15%	16.75%	18.77%	18.32%
Other Financing Sources	9.84%	19.92%	9.00%	4.95%	4.88%



Notable Trends:
The Town continues to see an increased reliance on property tax revenues to support the annual budget as State Aid revenue lags behind. In particular, the Town receives almost zero new funding from the State each year for education programming. New Growth has "grown" in importance as new construction contributes to the rise in the level of property taxes supporting the budget as more housing is added each year.

REVENUES: PROPERTY TAXES

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Recap	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Property Tax								
Base Levy	$	57,197,439	59,375,443	61,851,998	64,415,149	67,269,595	2,854,446	4.4%
2.5% Allowable Increase	$	1,429,936	1,484,386	1,546,300	1,610,379	1,681,740	71,361	4.4%
New Growth	$	735,892	948,557	1,005,459	1,244,067	650,000	(594,067)	-47.8%
General Override	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	
Levy Limit	$	59,363,267	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,269,595	69,601,335	2,331,740	3.5%
Debt Exclusion	$	-	-	-	691,807	2,125,643	1,433,836	207.3%
Maximum Allowable Levy	$	59,363,267	61,808,386	64,403,757	67,961,402	71,726,978	3,765,576	5.5%
Excess Levy Capacity	$	(157,233)	(83,203)	(87,135)	(157,691)	-	157,691	-100.0%
Subtotal Property Tax	$	59,206,034	61,725,183	64,316,622	67,803,711	71,726,978	3,923,267	5.8%



Notable Trends

Property tax revenues have steadily increased over the past decade, as shown on the chart above. These revenues, when adjusted for inflation, have risen at a much slower rate**.** Inflation index used: Boston-Cambridge-Newton, MA-NH, all urban consumers, not seasonally adjusted. The economic benefits of new housing developments can be seen in the table above. The row labeled New Growth shows the addition to the tax levy from new construction and property improvements throughout Town. Without New Growth, the Town would need to find other ways to increase revenues or reduce expenditures.

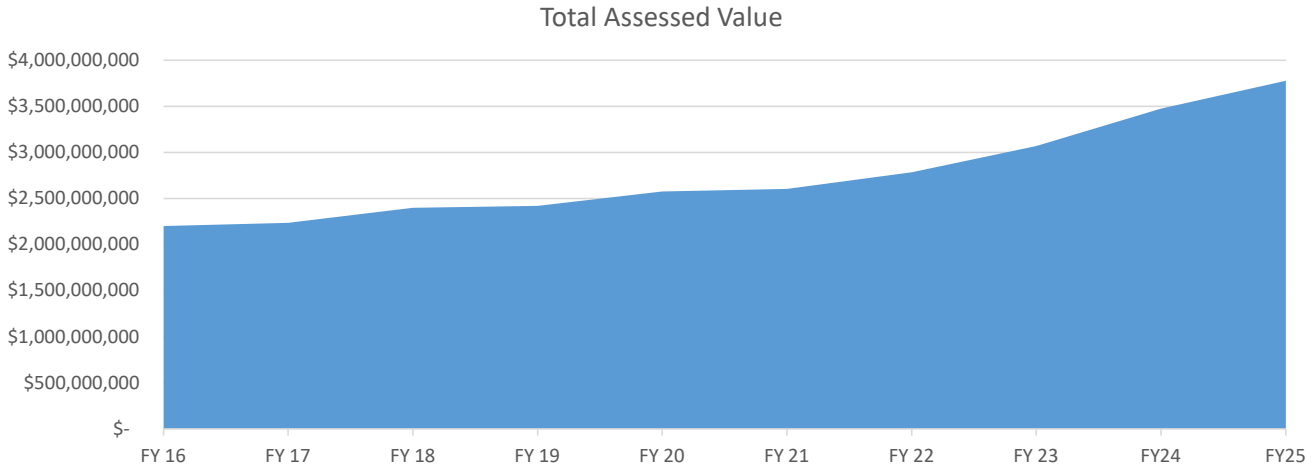
REVENUES: PROPERTY TAXES

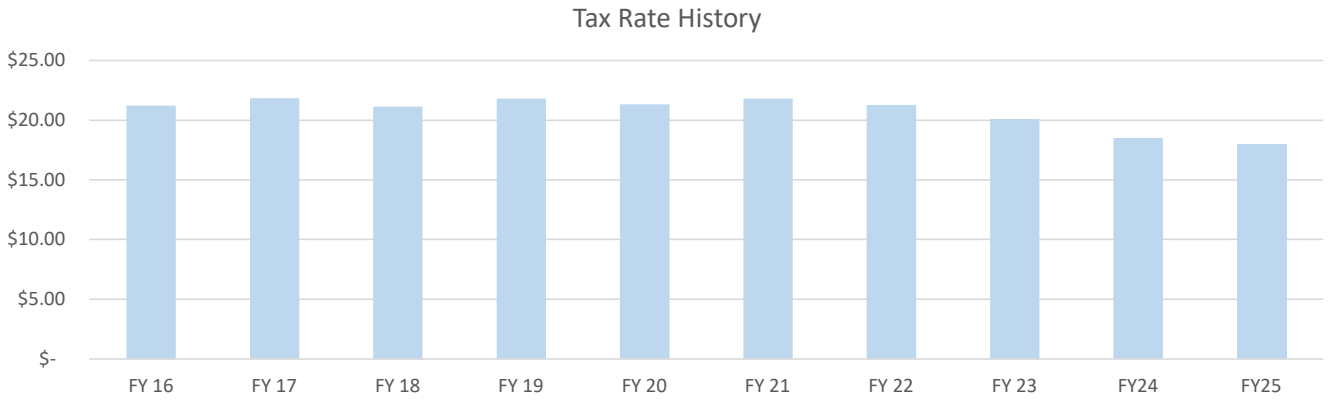
Property Tax Overview:

Funds raised through the annual levy of taxes on real estate property. The Assessor's Office is responsible for determining the value of all properties in Town and for calculating the annual levy. The Assessor is required to update property values according to a cycle set by the State.

Each year, the property tax levy is legally allowed to increase by 2.5%. In addition to the 2.5% allowable increase, the tax levy can grow if the tax base expands by way of new growth (new development). New growth is comprised of large projects like the construction of new buildings or smaller projects like home improvements.

The chart below illustrates the recent history of the Town's total assessed value. This includes residential, commercial, industrial, and personal property assessed values.



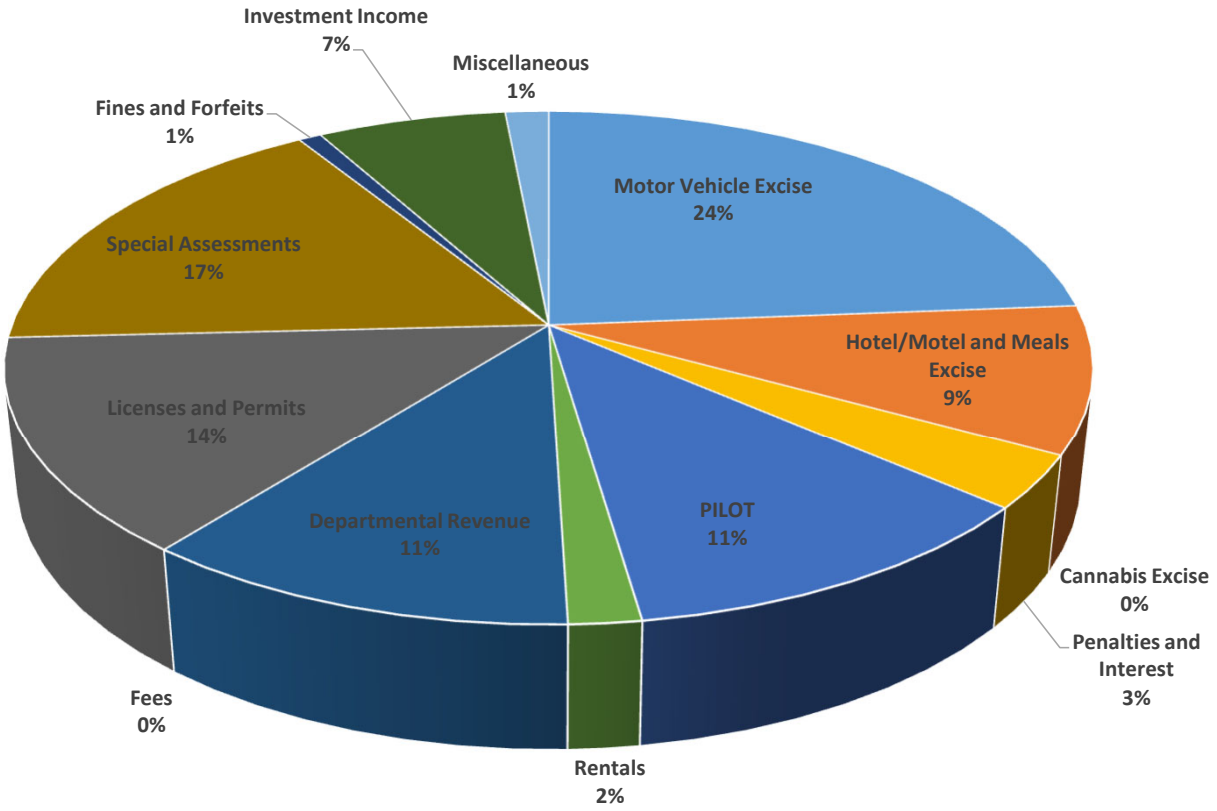


Notable Trends:
Total Assessed Value directly impacts the tax rate. A recent history of the Town's tax rate can be seen above. The Town's tax rate has remained relatively stable over the past ten years and declined in the past couple of years. Rising property values along with New Growth have contributed to the increase in Total Assessed Value that has stabilized the tax rate since 2015.

REVENUES: LOCAL RECEIPTS

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Recap	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Local Receipts								
Motor Vehicle Excise	$	1,971,770	1,959,748	2,026,029	1,500,000	1,800,000	300,000	20.0%
Hotel/Motel and Meals Excise	$	676,061	799,432	915,231	620,000	700,400	80,400	13.0%
Cannabis Excise	$	134,328	105,537	74,334	-	-	0	--
Penalties and Interest	$	440,697	305,727	250,777	254,900	254,900	0	--
PILOT	$	822,182	822,136	844,948	857,698	857,698	0	--
Rentals	$	131,295	140,006	148,969	139,599	139,599	0	--
Departmental Revenue	$	963,964	1,151,131	1,072,381	843,678	843,678	0	--
Fees	$	243,318	60,923	18,246	-	-	0	--
Licenses and Permits	$	1,339,497	1,308,024	1,729,213	991,914	1,026,968	35,054	3.5%
Special Assessments	$	946,554	1,220,293	1,284,146	1,278,074	1,278,074	0	--
Fines and Forfeits	$	56,584	34,739	59,550	35,600	60,600	25,000	70.2%
Investment Income	$	117,058	747,676	1,931,628	150,000	500,000	350,000	233.3%
Miscellaneous	$	346,547	565,825	568,444	340,000	115,000	(225,000)	-66.2%
Subtotal Local Receipts	$	8,189,855	9,221,197	10,923,898	7,011,463	7,576,917	565,454	8.1%

FY26 Allocation of Local Receipts Revenue



REVENUES: LOCAL RECEIPTS

Local Receipt Overview:

Locally generated revenues, other than real and personal property taxes. The table below shows what is included in a few of the major categories of local receipts. Many of these revenue sources fluctuate based on the health of the local economy.

Departmental Revenue	$$
General Government	
Certificate of Municipal Lien	$ 14,592
Collector's Fees	$ 13,581
Certified Copy Fees	$ 20,000
Passport Application Fees	$ -
Other Departmental Fees	$ 15,135
Public Safety	
Police Off Duty Service/Other Fees	$ 51,797
Fire Department Inspections	$ 46,926
Public Works	$ 5,489
Conservation, Planning, Inspections	
Planning Board Fees	$ 11,007
Certificates of Inspections	$ 50,167
Other Departmental Fees	$ 41,925
Community Services	
Recreation	$ 158,100
Pools	$ 70,543
Cherry Hill	$ 226,144
Medicaid Reimbursement	$ 118,272
Total Departmental Revenues	$ 843,678

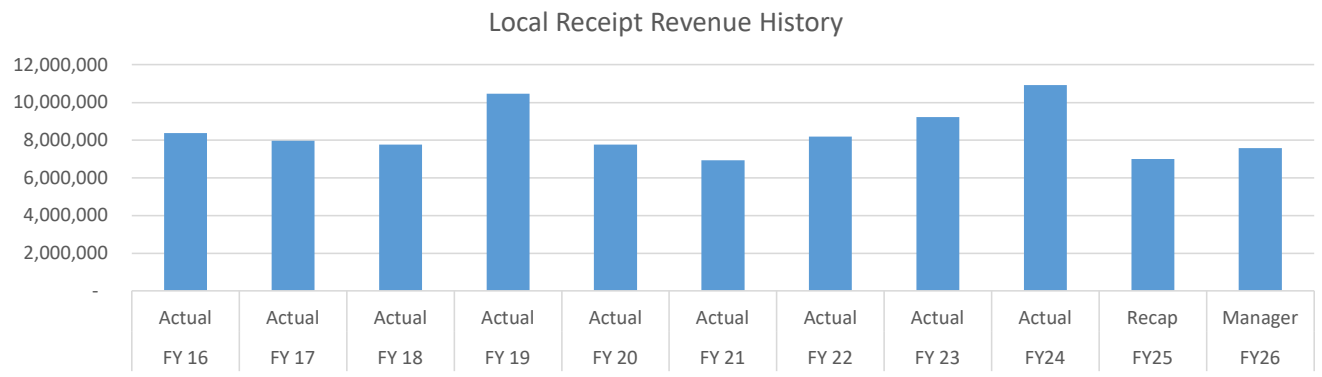
Licenses & Permits	$$
General Government	
CATV License	$ 2,526
Town Clerk Licenses	$ 2,960
Public Safety	
Dog Licenses	$ 5,995
Other Permits	$ 54,768
Public Works	$ 14,838
Inspection Services and Health	
Alcohol Licenses	$ 133,803
Building Permits	$ 323,576
Electrical Permits	$ 175,000
Rental Registration	$ 190,000
Other Licenses and Permits	$ 123,502
Total Licenses & Permits	$ 1,026,968

Miscellaneous	
Amherst College	$ -
UMass Strategic Partnership	$ 25,000
UMass Hotel/Motel Occupancy	$ 90,000
Transportation Reimbursement	$ -
Hopkinton Bill Revenue	$ -
Total Miscellaneous	$ 115,000

Special Assessments	
UMass PVTA Assessment	$ 1,041,908
Five College PVTA Assessment	$ 236,166
Special Assessment	
Total Special Revenue Funds	$ 1,278,074

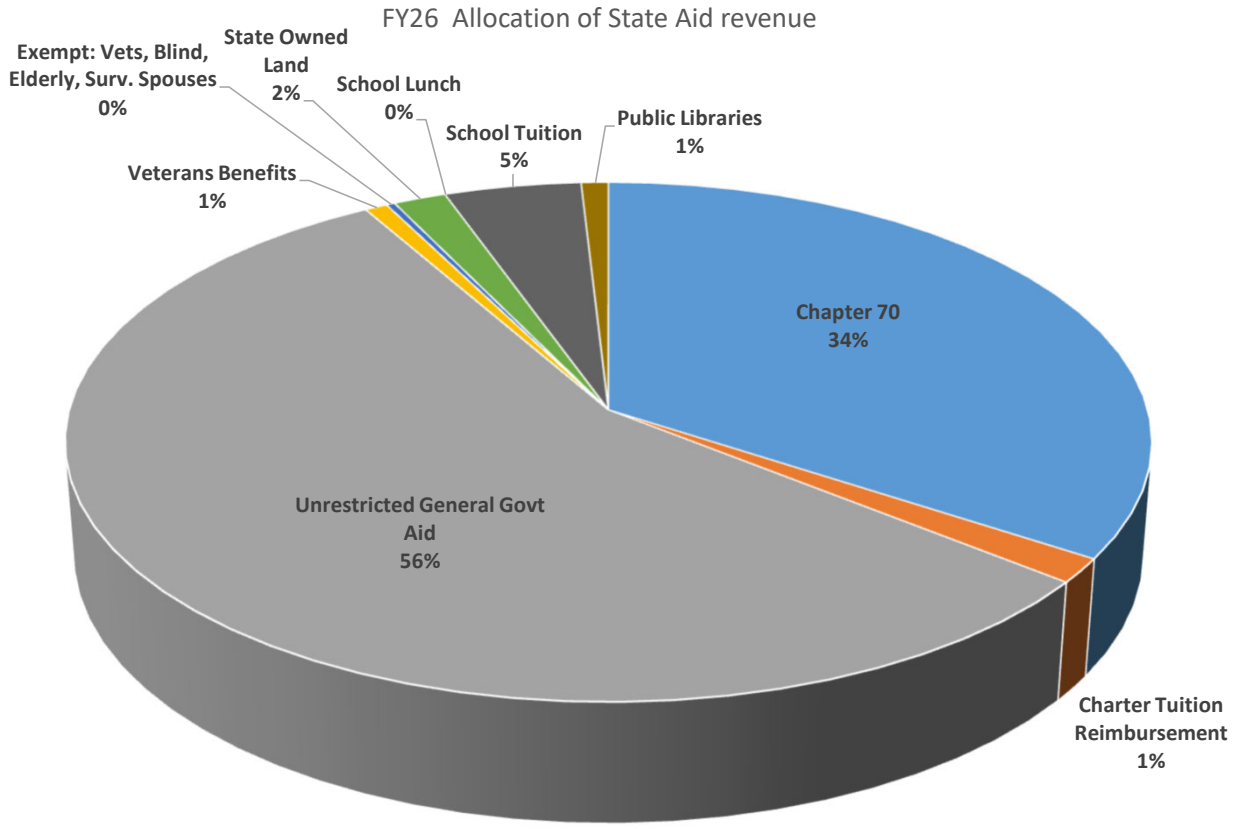
Notable Trends:

One of the largest factors influencing local receipts is construction throughout Town. Permit revenues associated with construction vary significantly from year to year depending on the size of the projects.



REVENUES: STATE AID

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
State Aid								
Chapter 70	$	6,153,573	6,217,473	6,280,773	6,383,109	6,460,884	77,775	1.2%
Charter Tuition Reimbursement	$	161,600	153,318	144,627	105,081	291,037	185,956	177.0%
Unrestricted General Govt Aid	$	9,281,670	9,752,342	10,064,417	10,366,349	10,594,409	228,060	2.2%
Veterans Benefits	$	111,977	100,733	124,597	126,970	143,291	16,321	12.9%
Exempt: Vets, Blind, Elderly, Surv.	$	41,126	39,721	40,209	33,179	53,792	20,613	62.1%
State Owned Land	$	231,203	296,770	326,060	334,234	334,234	0	--
Offset Receipts								
School Lunch	$				-	-	0	--
School Tuition	$				885,882	868,257	(17,625)	-2.0%
Public Libraries	$				172,273	172,103	(170)	-0.1%
Subtotal State Aid	$	15,981,149	16,560,357	16,980,683	18,407,077	18,918,007	510,930	2.8%



REVENUES: STATE AID

State Aid Overview:

The Town receives various different forms of State Aid each year:

Chapter 70 aid is targeted for education spending.

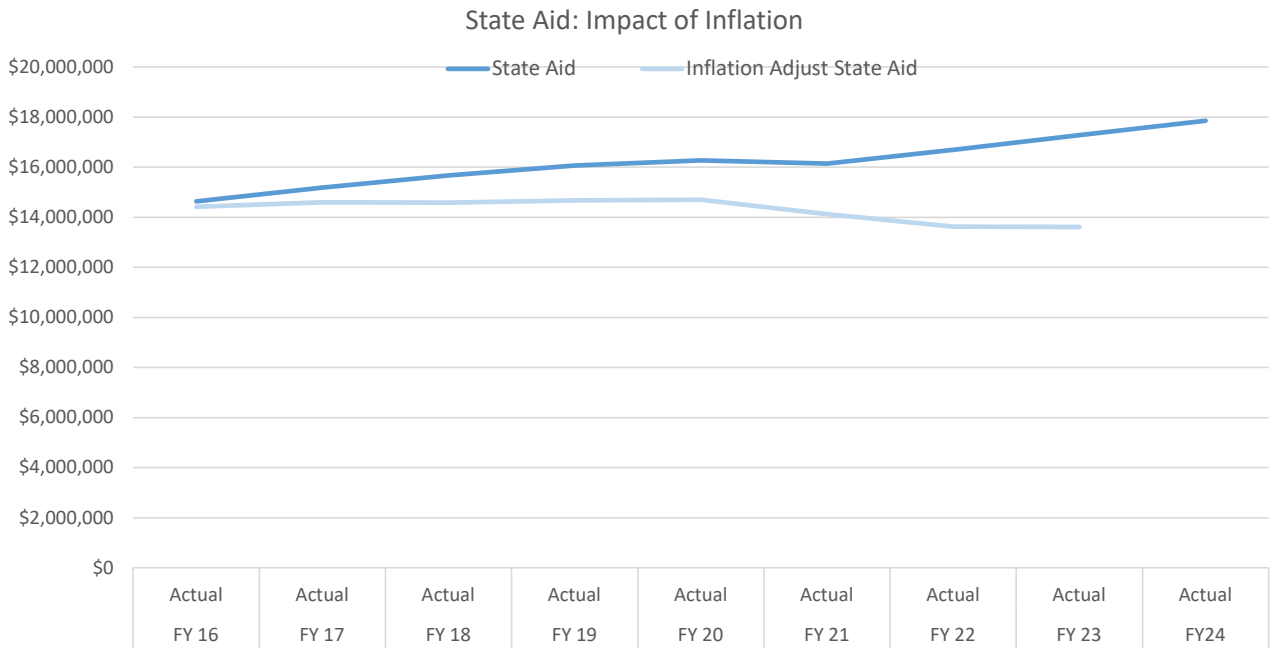
Charter Tuition Reimbursement is a small offsetting revenue based on the amount of tuition the Town pays each year.

Unrestricted General Government Aid (UGGA) is flexible in its use and goes to support all Town departments.

Veterans Benefits is a partial reimbursement from the State tied to the amount of benefits the Town pays out to its veterans each year.

Exempt: Vets, Blind, Elderly, Surviving Spouses is a state reimbursement for an exemption to property taxes provided to eligible tax payers.

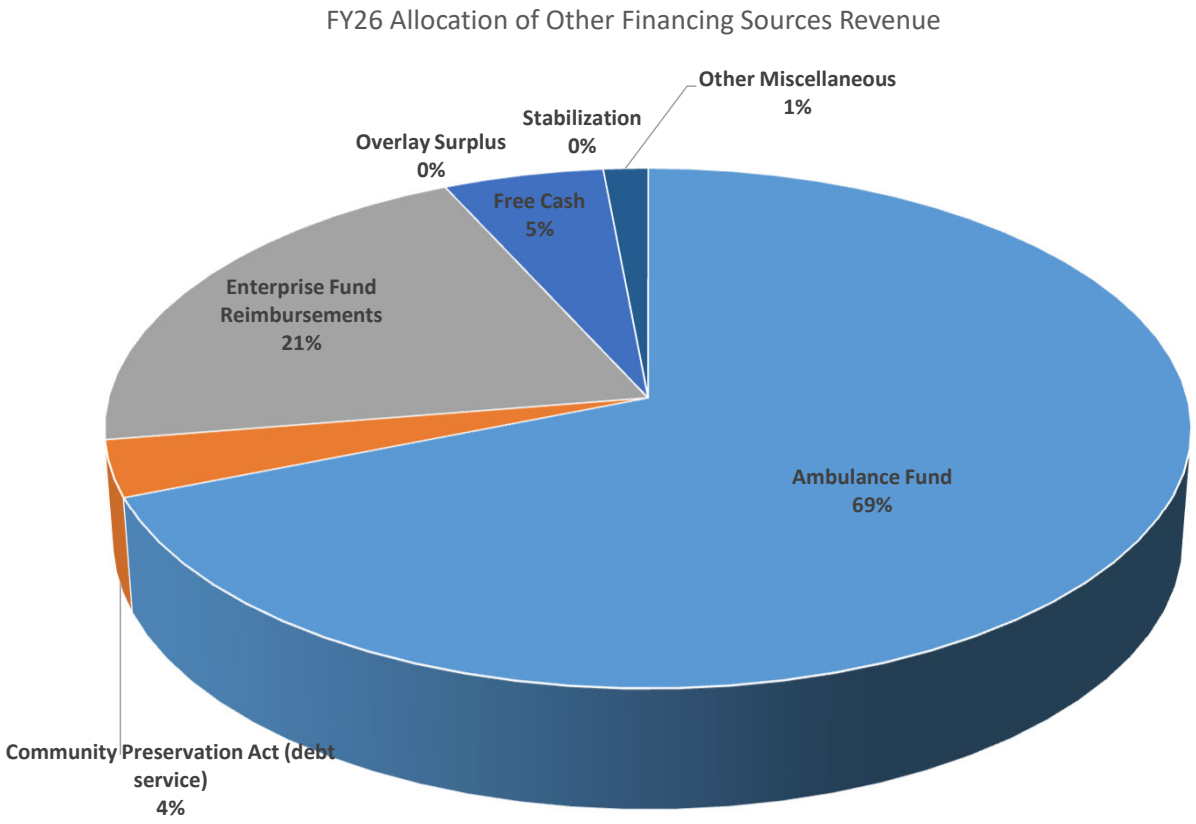
State Owned Land is a payment from the State for all of the land it owns in Town, primarily on the University Campus.



Notable Trends:
As reflected in the chart above, State Aid revenues show an increase over the past decade. However, these revenues, when adjusted for inflation, have actually remained relatively flat. (Inflation index used: Boston-Cambridge-Newton, MA-NH, all urban consumers, not seasonally adjusted.) The Town works with its legislators and professional organizations like the Massachusetts Municipal Association to advocate for increases to key State Aid accounts. The bottom line is that State Aid has not kept pace with inflation even as the State has experienced a surge in tax revenues. This puts pressure on other revenue categories and the entire budget.

REVENUES: OTHER FINANCING SOURCES

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Other Financing Sources								
Ambulance Fund	$	2,000,000	2,710,200	3,164,290	2,947,500	3,474,000	526,500	17.9%
Community Preservation Act (debt	$	388,148	488,720	443,460	520,250	176,550	(343,700)	-66.1%
Enterprise Fund Reimbursements	$	803,190	859,362	725,209	952,965	1,043,944	90,979	9.5%
Overlay Surplus	$	-	-	-	-	-	0	--
Free Cash	$	5,070,079	4,425,901	-	-	269,704	269,704	--
Stabilization	$	-	13,109,345	4,518,349	-	-	0	--
Other Miscellaneous	$	836,522	175,000	275,000	430,440	75,000	(355,440)	-82.6%
Subtotal Other Financing Sources	$	9,097,939	21,768,528	9,126,308	4,851,155	5,039,198	188,043	3.9%



REVENUES: OTHER FINANCING SOURCES

Other Financing Sources Overview:

These funds are transferred in from other sources.

The ambulance fund is a receipt reserved for appropriation fund and it collects all revenues related to the Town's ambulance services (such as insurance billings). Each year, the Town allocates an amount of funding to support operating expenses related to the ambulance fund which are contained within the general fund budget.

The Community Preservation Act (CPA) has the ability to recommend projects that will be paid for by way of borrowing. The annual debt service payment related to these projects comes from the CPA fund and is reflected in this section.

The Town provides an array of administrative services to the enterprise funds including payroll, purchasing, human resources, and technology support. The Town bills the enterprise funds an indirect charge to account for these services. The payment of the indirect charges by enterprise funds is reflected as a revenue in this section.

There are a few other sources such as using free cash, stabilization funds, or overlay surplus to support the budget.

Notable Trends:

The ambulance fund revenues have experienced some volatility due to the following factors: loss of Hadley contract, increase in billing rates, and COVID-19. As a result, this revenue source dropped in FY22 but has begun to grow again.

Enterprise fund reimbursements have also taken a hit because of the pandemic. Water and sewer funds experienced a decrease in revenues due to lower consumption caused by the closure of the colleges and University. The transportation fund realized a drop in revenues from a decline in parking fees during the pandemic. The FY26 budget projects water and sewer funds returning to expected reimbursement levels. However, transportation revenues are still lagging behind.

In FY23, there was a large one time appropriation of funding into the new capital stabilization fund. A smaller appropriation was made in FY24 and will continue if Free Cash balances allow.

For FY22-26, the Other Miscellaneous category also includes Comcast funding to help offset the debt service costs for installing municipal fiber throughout Town.

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General Fund Expenditure Summary & Detail

Overview

The following section provides a summary and additional details about the departmental expenditures within the General Fund budget.

GENERAL FUND EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
General Government	$	7,607,046	7,995,444	8,091,960	9,347,108	10,395,522	1,048,414	11.2%
Public Safety	$	10,964,464	11,352,673	11,585,581	12,507,916	12,519,571	11,655	0.1%
Public Works	$	2,498,653	2,465,372	2,542,144	2,754,697	2,728,991	(25,706)	-0.9%
Conservation & Development	$	1,626,777	1,647,683	1,685,621	1,985,524	2,088,515	102,991	5.2%
Community Services	$	1,420,544	1,495,588	1,488,002	1,768,140	1,765,321	(2,819)	-0.2%
Total Appropriation	$	24,117,485	24,956,759	25,393,309	28,363,385	29,497,920	1,134,535	4.0%

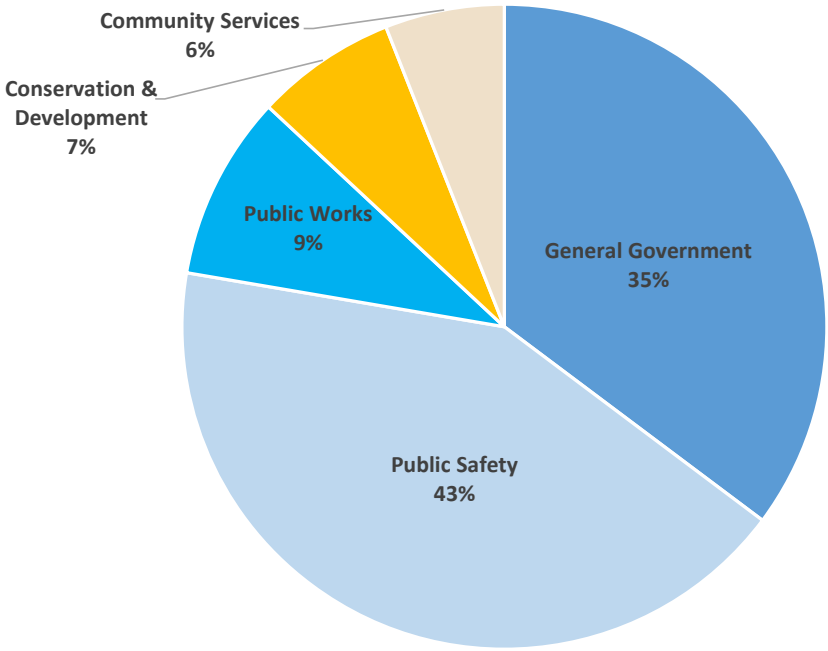
Significant Budget Changes:

The overall municipal operating budget is increasing by 4%. The largest increase is in General Government where the health insurance and other employee benefit expenses are held. Funds for estimated contractual settlements are also held in this functional area. Five of six collective bargaining agreements are in negotiation for FY26. One position was frozen in this functional area. The small increase in Public Safety is the net of the budgeted increases for the one settled collective bargaining agreement with the firefighters union offset by the reductions due to freezing four positions. The Public Works decrease is due to the freezing of one position. Increases in Conservation and Development are due to funds being added for the new rental registration program as well changes in job classifications. Community Services also sees a slight decrease due to the freezing of .4 FTE. Operating budgets for all Town departments were level funded which will result in financial challenges in the future.

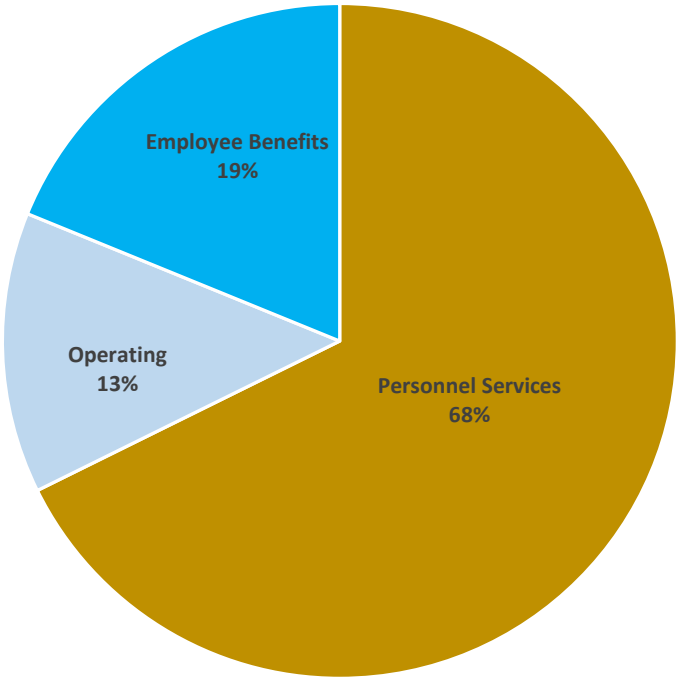
(Photo of Town Hall)

GENERAL FUND EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

FY26 Allocation of Budget by Function:



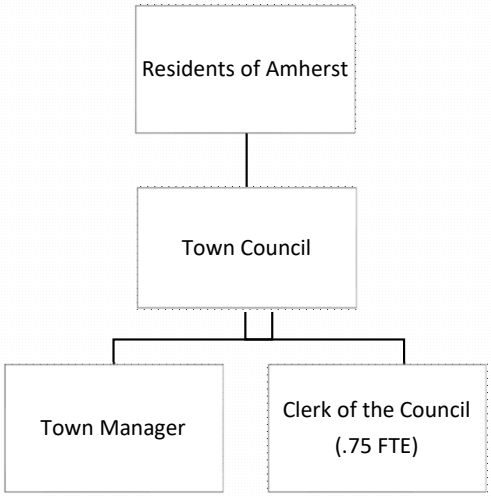
FY26 Allocation of Budget by Expenditure Type:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

Function: The Town Council is the legislative body for the Town. The Council provides policy leadership, approves the annual operating budget and capital improvement program, and appoints the Town Manager.

Organization:



(Photo of Town Council)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed the 2024 Town Manager Evaluation, adopted 6 policy goals and 7 management goals for the Town Manager for 2025, reflecting Town Council priorities, and adopted FY26 Financial Guidelines.
- Approved the FY25 budget with commitments to climate action, community health & safety, economic vitality, housing affordability, major capital investments, and racial equity & social justice.
- Continued to make significant progress on the Elementary School Building Project and recommitted to the Jones Library Building renovation and addition. Maintained focus on the Department of Public Works facility and a Fire/EMS Station.
- Took action on Rental Registration and Nuisance Property bylaws.
- Continued to support affordable housing and homelessness projects.
- Requested refiling of Ranked Choice Voting Legislation and expressed continued support of special legislation to establish a Property Transfer Fee.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To engage the community by continuing district meetings and listening sessions.
- To continue to monitor and support progress towards achieving Amherst's Sustainability Goals.
- To continue work to make Amherst an anti-racist community.
- To review and implement a plan that allows the Town to proceed with the four major capital projects.
- To support the priorities identified in the 5-year capital plan.
- To adopt and revise zoning bylaws to make them consistent with the Master Plan.
- To continue to address priorities associated with the comprehensive housing plan.
- To continue to take actions in support of economic development.
- To continue to identify ways to improve residents' civic engagement.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To review and revise general and zoning bylaws. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To adopt complementary strategies to policing that advance racial equity and social justice. **ONGOING**
- To review and adopt a FY25 comprehensive capital plan. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To develop guidelines for the FY26 budget and review & adopt the FY25 budget. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To evaluate the Town Manager. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To complete changes and additions to the Refuse Collection and Recyclable Materials Bylaw, to include composting and a pay-as-you-throw fee structure. **ONGOING**
- To review and consider recommendations from various Town committees, including the African Heritage Reparation Assembly, Community Safety and Social Justice Committee, and Solar Bylaw Working Group. **ONGOING**
- To work with legislators to advocate for funding and policy changes that benefit Amherst residents. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

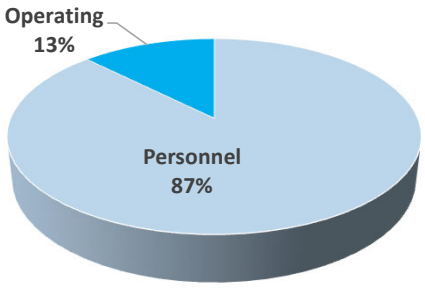
- To review and revise general and zoning bylaws.
- To adopt complementary strategies to policing that advance racial equity and social justice.
- To review and adopt a FY26 comprehensive capital plan.
- To develop guidelines for the FY27 budget and review & adopt the FY26 budget.
- To evaluate the Town Manager for 2025 and continue to examine improvements to the annual evaluation process.
- To complete changes and additions to the Refuse Collection and Recyclable Materials Bylaw, to include composting and a pay-as-you-throw fee structure.
- To review and consider actions on recommendations from various Town committees, including the African Heritage Reparation Assembly, Community Safety and Social Justice Committee, and Solar Bylaw Working Group.
- To work with legislators to advocate for funding and policy changes that benefit Amherst residents.
- To act on Charter Review Committee recommendations.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

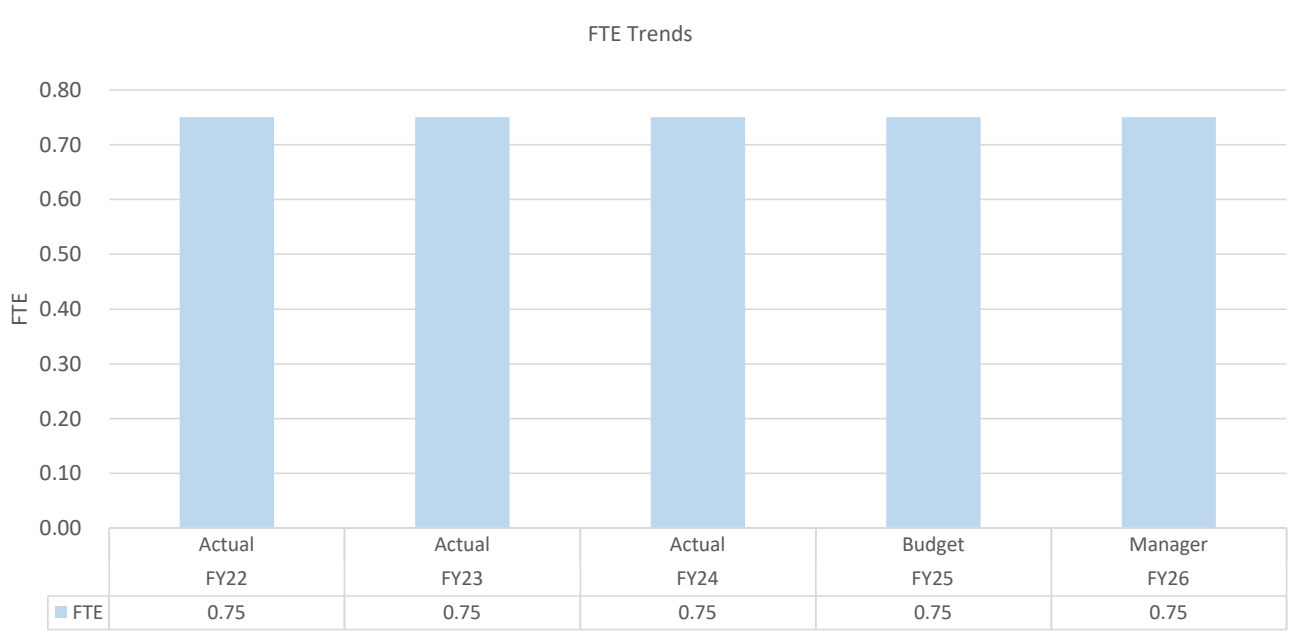
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	138,591	139,392	148,590	222,457	234,280	11,823	5.3%
Operating Expenses	$	17,355	15,177	10,369	33,500	33,500	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	155,947	154,569	158,959	255,957	267,780	11,823	4.6%

Major Components:
Personnel Services include stipends for the 13 member Council at $10,000 each and $12,000 for the Council President. It also includes stipends for the 5 member school committee at $3,000 each and $4,000 for the Chair. This section also includes 75% of the salary for the Clerk of the Council. Operating expenses include funds for training, travel, and other miscellaneous expenditures.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services increasing due to projected step increases.



Staffing Trends:



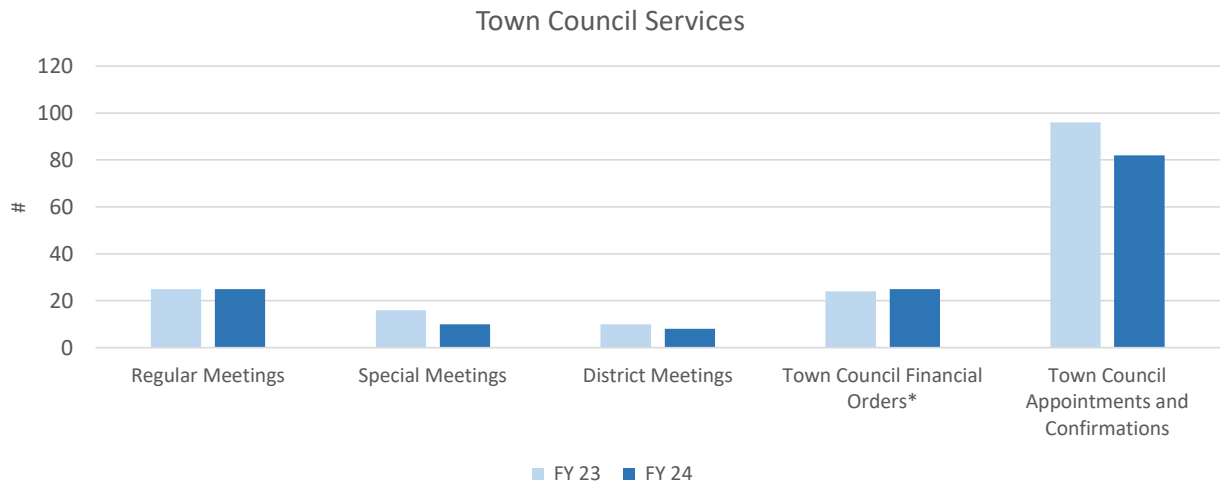
GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN COUNCIL (1111)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Regular Meetings	25	26	25	25	25
Special Meetings	32	44	24	16	10
District Meetings	10	11	9	10	8
Town Council Financial Orders*	120	37	40	24	25
Town Council Appointments and Confirmations	137	114	118	96	82
Long Term Use & Permanent	15	14	16	12	14
Changes to Public Ways					
Open Meeting of the Residents	0	0	0	0	0
Proclamations/Resolutions/Commemorations	38	28	25	21	26
Forums	6	11	8	5	9
Finance Committee Meetings	24	41	25	25	26
Community Resource Committee Meetings	26	35	27	25	24
Town Service and Outreach Committee Meetings	31	25	24	20	22
Governance, Organization & Legislation					
Committee Meetings	26	29	25	20	20
Free Petitions	0	0	0	0	0
Initiative Measures	0	0	0	0	0
Voter Veto	0	0	0	0	0
Zoning Bylaw Amendments	3	4	9	0	1
General Bylaw Amendments	3	7	3	5	2

* Prior to FY21, included non-financial Town Council Orders.

Notable Trends:

None.

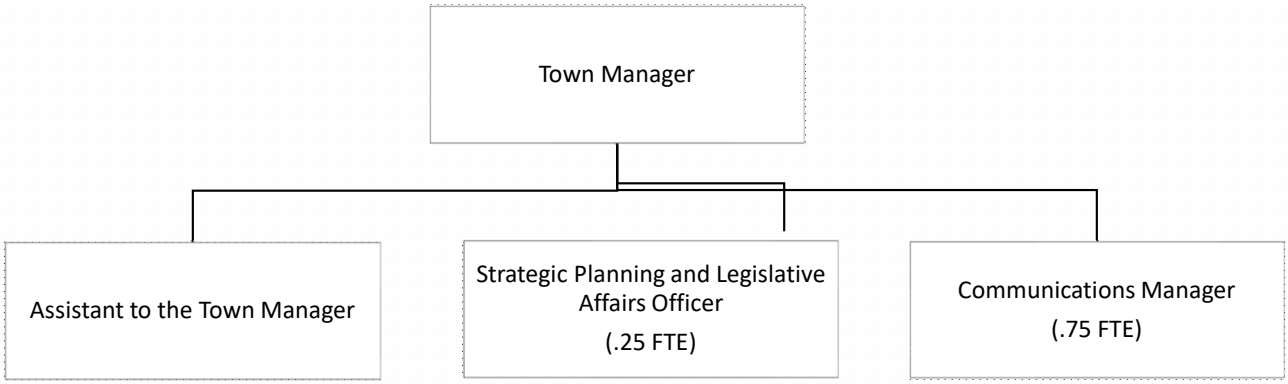


For more information, visit the Town Council's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3435/Town-Council

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

Function: The Town Manager serves as the chief executive officer of the Town and is responsible to the Town Council for the proper operation of Town affairs for which the Town Manager is given responsibility under the Amherst Home Rule Charter. The Town Manager heads the executive branch and is responsible for the administration of all Town fiscal, prudential, and municipal affairs.

Organization:



(Photo of Town Manager, Paul Bockelman at Cushman Café and Market)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Maintained strong budgetary performance and management of the Town's financial planning and budget as recognized by Standard and Poor's continued bond rating of AA+ with a Stable Outlook.
- Appointed new Department Heads: Finance Director, Police Chief, Fire Chief, Director of Community Responders.
- Addressed and provided progress updates on the goals adopted by Town Council.
- Continued to direct activities to reach the goals as detailed in the Climate Action, Adaptation, and Resilience Plan.
- Facilitated implementation of the Residential Rental Bylaw.
- Advanced construction of new crosswalks, walkways, and roadway improvements utilizing grants whenever possible.
- Finalized plans, funding, and permitting for a new restroom in Kendrick Park near the new playground.
- Broke ground and began construction of the new net-zero energy elementary school building.
- Implemented strategic partnership agreements between the University of Massachusetts and the Town and betwen Amherst

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To develop a long range strategy to ensure the fiscal stability of the Town, schools, and library within the constraints of existing and projected resources.
- To take next steps towards building several of the Capital Investment Projects (new public works building, new fire station, new elementary school, and renovated and expanded library).
- To maintain a commitment to address the Town's infrastructure needs including roads, sidewalks, buildings, water, and sewer.
- To use a lens of Climate Action to prioritize and begin to implement regulatory, fiscal, and other actions to meet energy, sustainability, and resilience goals.
- To address systemic racism in Town government and in the delivery of public safety and other services.
- To undertake targeted management restructuring to improve communication, increase cohesion across departments, and align leadership structures with organizational goals.
- To recruit and retain strong department leaders and support the work of all staff.
- To work with the Commonwealth and local higher education institutions to increase revenue through economic development and remuneration for their impact on Town resources.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To oversee the building of the new Elementary School Building (on the former Fort River Elementary site). **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To break ground on the renovation and expansion of the Jones Library Building. **ONGOING**
- To decide upon a new location for the Central Fire Station and take next steps towards bringing that to fruition. **ONGOING**
- To find a new location for DPW and maintain a safe working environment at the current site. **ONGOING**
- To continue to diversify and work to offer more affordable living options in Amherst. **ONGOING**
- To continue to operate within our fiscal means (not rely on use of reserves) while trying to improve the level of municipal services to Residents. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To work with the Town Council, Finance Committee, and Joint Capital Planning Committee to implement plans for large capital projects and to develop a strategy to finance these projects that will gain the support of the public. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

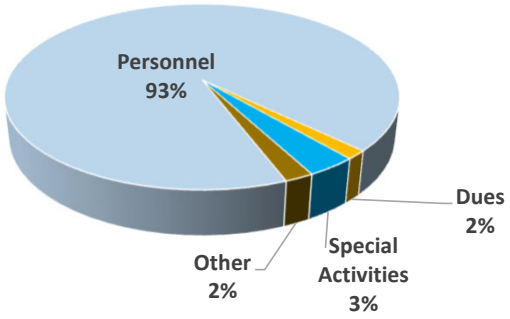
- To achieve the goals established by the Town Council.
- To oversee the building of the new Fort River Elementary School Building.
- To break ground on the renovation and expansion of the Jones Library Building.
- To finalize a new location for the new Fire Station.
- To begin schematic design and finalize a funding plan for a new DPW facility.
- To extend outreach efforts to include a civic academy, Town Hall road show, and other initiatives.
- To begin the license renewal process with Comcast.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

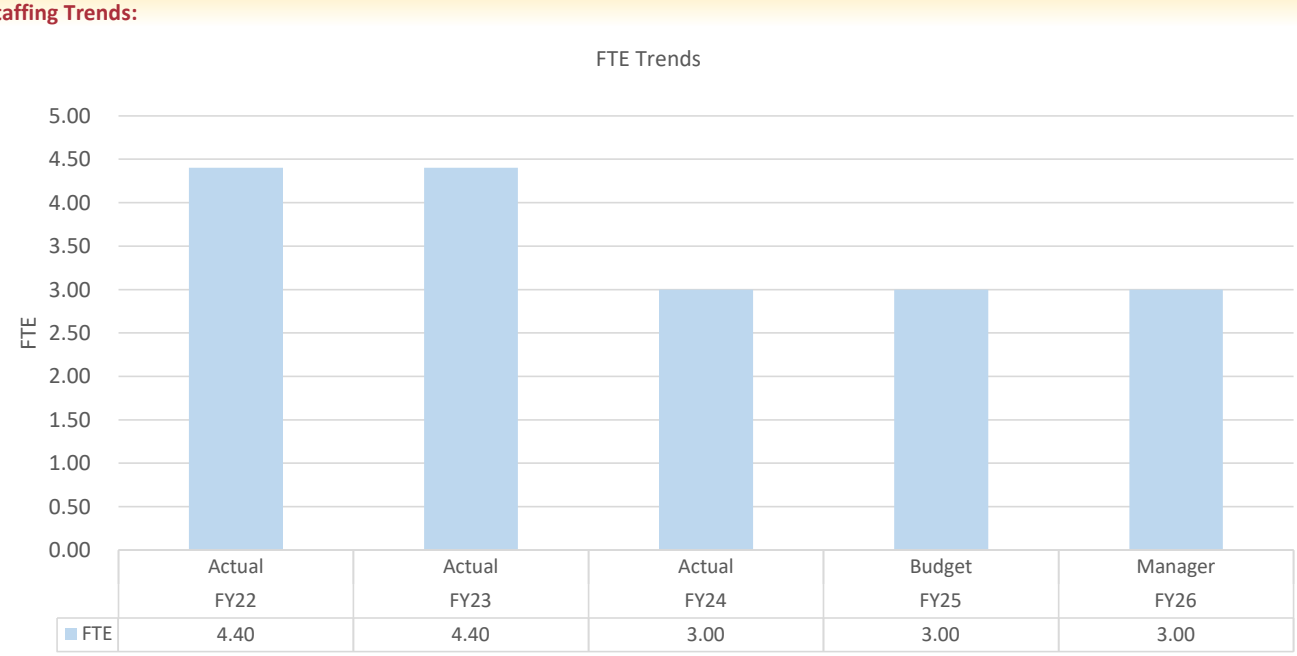
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	351,789	358,106	371,578	396,606	400,709	4,103	1.0%
Operating Expenses	$	39,285	47,172	16,269	30,140	30,140	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	391,074	405,278	387,847	426,746	430,849	4,103	1.0%

Major Components: Personnel Services includes salaries for the Town Manager, Assistant to the Town Manager, Strategic Planning and Legislative Affairs Officer who is shared with the Town Council Department, and the Communications Manager who is shared with the Information Technology Department. Dues include the Town's membership in the Massachusetts Municipal Association which includes the Massachusetts Municipal Councilors Association, and the Town's membership in the Massachusetts Municipal Management Association, International City Management Association, Massachusetts Government Finance Officers Association, and Small Town Administrators of Massachusetts.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services increasing due to projected step increases.



Staffing Trends:

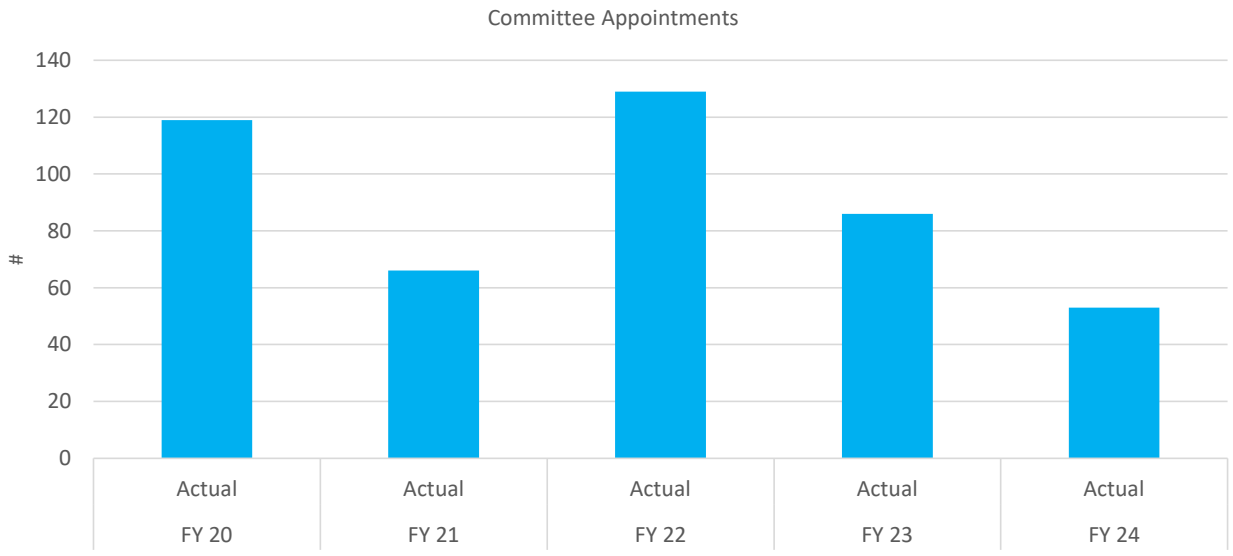


GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN MANAGER'S OFFICE (1124)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Collective Bargaining Agreements/Amendments	6	6	6	6	6
Committee Appointments	119	66	129	86	53
Committees Staffed	7	9	6	6	6
Rental License Agreements	7	7	7	7	7
Town Way Reservations	20	15	39	25	54
Sweetser Park	3	15	9	3	3
Kendrick Park	5	9	7	3	3
Cuppa Joe with Paul	N/A	N/A	8	8	4
Staff District Meetings	10	11	9	10	8
Community Events	N/A	N/A	15	38	28
Town Manager Reports	18	24	22	11	10
Community Activity Forms Received	90	84	183	90	61

Notable Trends:

The Town Manager provides detailed monthly reports to the Town Council. CPOs helped with the implementation of DEI's Building Beloved Community Events. Community Participation Officers continue to collaborate with the Schools, the Recreation Department, and with Town Councilors to bring residents and visitors together for cultural, heritage, and school-related gatherings. These community events reflect the values of the Core Equity work that is happening within the municipal workplace. Inter-departmental work that encourages inclusivity and teamwork across departments will continue to be a core focus for the Town Manager and staff.



For more information, visit the Town Manager's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/77/Town-Manager

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

Function: To assure the continuous, reliable delivery of Town services through effective management of financial resources and courteous, comprehensive service to the public and internal departments. Each department furthers this mission:

Finance: through the development and coordination of policies and processes that identify, evaluate, develop, and facilitate the efficient allocation of resources.

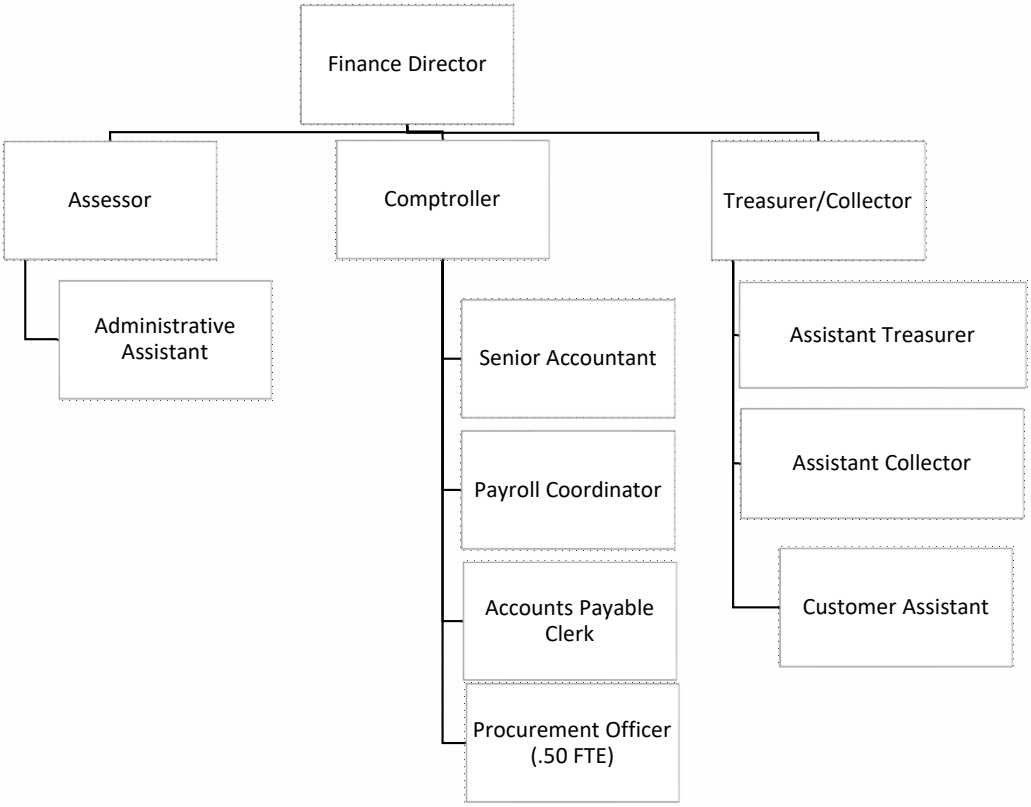
Accounting: through maintenance of appropriate records and financial reports and through monitoring of all financial activity for accountability and legal compliance, including procurement, centralized purchasing, managing general services, property and liability insurance management, and payroll and benefits.

Assessing: through the fair and equitable distribution of property taxes and motor vehicle excise taxes via an open process that makes information available to residents and professionals in a timely and efficient manner.

Collection: through timely, accurate billing and collection of revenue and a central point of services across traditional departmental functions.

Treasury: through effective investment and management of Town funds and the effective use of debt financing where appropriate.

Organization:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Continued to manage the American Rescue Plan Act Funds.
- Supported Jones Library and Fort River Elementary School projects with representation on both building committees.
- Mid-way through an audit of personal property accounts, which will increase revenues.
- Increased investment income greatly by taking advantage of high interest rates and unencumbered capital funds for the second year in a row.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to refine the budget cycle and process under the new form of government.
- To develop staff members to include cross training and organizational efficiency.
- To plan and manage the four building projects (procurements, financings, budgeting).
- To support advocacy that generates more revenue in Town.
- To maximize return on investment of Town funds.
- To manage debt and accelerate payments to reduce debt in anticipation of future borrowings.
- To continuously improve the Town-wide procurement system.
- To support advocacy for legislation focused on obtaining fair financial or in-kind support from tax exempt entities.
- To establish fair values for all non-taxable properties.
- To maintain adequate staffing, and to cross-train and retain employees.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To support successful staff transitions and professional development. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To refine the plan for financing four building projects. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To study the Means Test Senior Tax Relief. **RESCHEDULED**
- To connect the new permit system to real estate appraisal system. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To support successful staff transitions and professional development.
- To refine the plan for financing four building projects.
- To connect the new permit system to real estate appraisal system.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

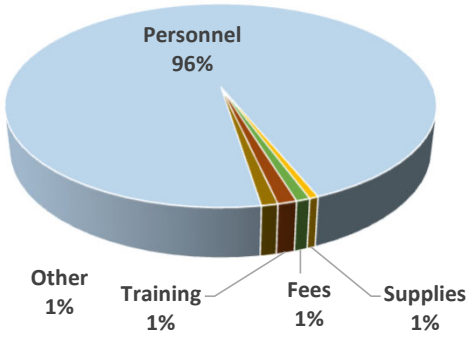
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	1,020,118	981,899	937,623	1,076,310	1,049,925	(26,385)	-2.5%
Operating Expenses	$	101,863	52,855	35,478	40,303	40,303	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	1,121,980	1,034,754	973,101	1,116,613	1,090,228	(26,385)	-2.4%

Major Components:

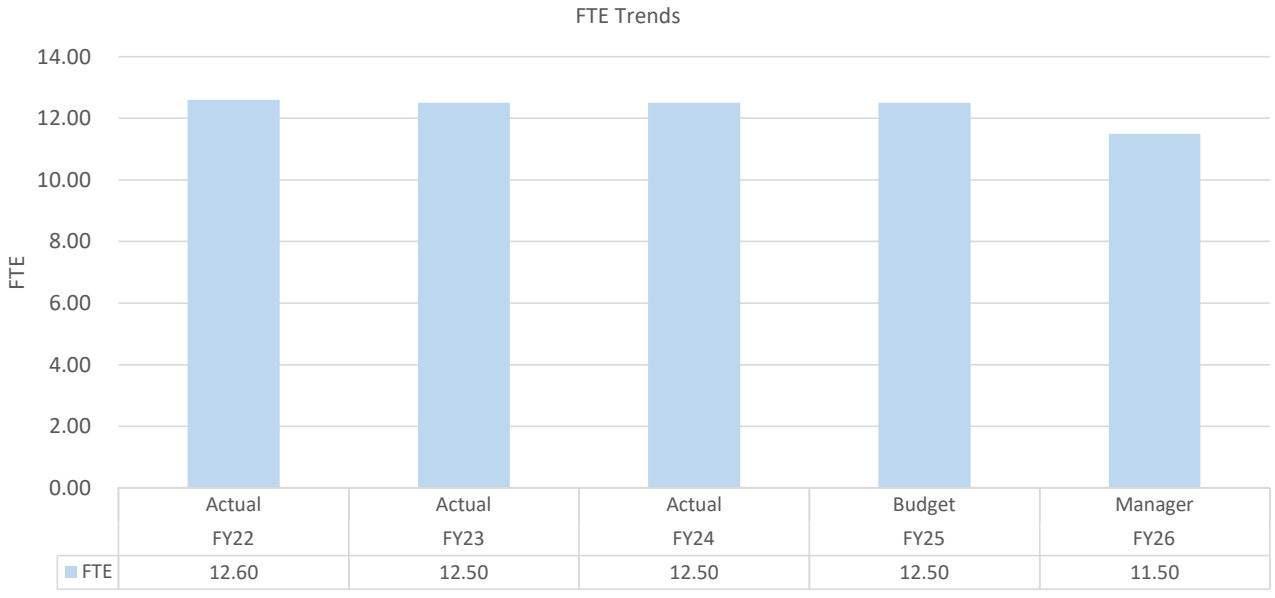
Personnel Services include salaries for a Finance Director, Comptroller, Principal Assessor, Collector/Treasurer, 7 full time Financial positions, and a Procurement Officer shared with the Water, Sewer, and Transportation Funds. Operating expenses include banking fees, dues and subscriptions, bonds, and Registry fees. Also included in operating expenses are printing supplies and other specialized assessing, billing, collection, and accounting forms. Other expenses include costs for training.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services decreased due to freezing one FTE. Step increases for other personnel are included.



Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FINANCE DEPARTMENT (1133, 1134, 1141, & 1146)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Grants Maintained/Monitored	51	58	59	52	48
EFTs processed	1,151	959	1,087	1,162	1,437
Contracts Processed/Maintained/Monitored	87	93	96	82	95
Bids and Proposals Reviewed/Monitored	23	40	49	58	64
Real Estate Property Assessments	7,311	7,345	7,341	7,323	7,307
Site Reviews	100	97	110	500	1,000
Personal Property Assessments	193	188	177	198	189
Abatement Application Reviews					
Real Estate/Personal Property	73	50	31	48	64
Motor Vehicle Excise	1,912	2,344	1,464	442	573
Appeals Granted Real/PP	24	38	21	29	33
Tax Dollars Abated	$ 168,361	$ 127,316	$ 36,176	$ 74,504	$ 63,343
Tax Abated as % of Levy	0.31%	0.22%	0.06%	0.12%	0.09%
Tax Exemptions	$ 113,008	$ 118,319	$ 115,318	$ 104,091	$ 117,804
Exemptions as % of Levy	0.21%	0.21%	0.19%	0.17%	0.18%
Motor Vehicle Excise Collection Rate	88%	89%	93%	93%	94%
Real Estate/Personal Property					
Tax Collection Rate	98%	98%	99%	99%	99%
Water/Sewer Collection Rate	98%	99%	96%	99%	98%
Parking Tickets Collection Rate	77%	80%	80%	72%	70%
Ambulance Bills Collection Rate (One Yr)	67%	64%	71%	71%	70%
Parking Ticket Appeals/Hearings	855	646	688	497	426
Parking Permits Issued	829	543	648	573	570
Tax Liens Processed and Recorded	24	27	46	14	30
Central Service Counter Transactions	17,265	13,819	13,761	14,195	16,302
Online Transactions	16,752	21,210	19,955	20,114	21,897
Tax Liens Redeemed	23	13	34	26	15
Bond Rating (Standard & Poor's)	AA+	AA+	AA+	AA+	AA+

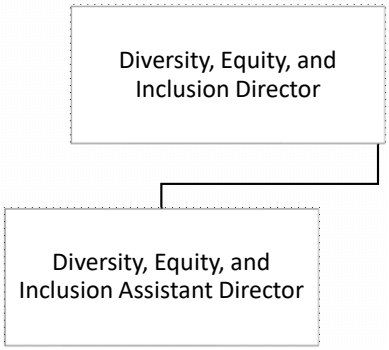
Notable Trends:
The Treasurer/Collector's Office continues to achieve high collection rates particularly in property taxes and water and sewer billing. Online transactions have remained a significant portion of their activity.

For more information, visit the Finance department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/92/Finance

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Function: To support the Town in its goal of embracing diversity and creating an equitable and inclusive environment to live and work. The office supports the work of three standing committees the Community Safety and Social Justice Committee, the Commission for Persons with Disabilities, and the Human Rights Commission.

Organization:



(Photo of community events)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Conducted 12 monthly staff DEI workshops as well as specialized workshops for Town Departments.
- Held two National Day of Racial Healing events, one open to the public the other for staff only.
- Hosted multiple Liberatory Visioning workshops and community meetings.
- Revised delivery of inclusion/cultural events by holding fewer, more inclusive events such as the Global Village Festival.
- Collaborated with the Community Participation Officers in community engagement.
- Established a local DEI 413 connect group.
- Supported the transition from the Disability Access Advisory Committee to the Commission for Persons with Disabilities.
- Supported the Human Rights Commission in establishing immigrant resources for the community.
- Updated DEI website.
- Created a monthly departmental news letter sent to all staff and the community.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To finalize the report and provide a recommendation to establish the Resident Oversight Board.
- To expand youth empowerment programming.
- To promote equity, and inclusion values and incorporate them throughout Town government.
- To work with the Human Resources Department to attract and retain a workforce reflective of the community.
- To develop a strategic plan to ensureTown committees and boards reflect of the community.
- To continue participation in Massachusetts DEI Coalition.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To conduct 6 youth events. **ONGOING**
- To celebrate the 25th Anniversary of the Goodridge Decision with Justice Ireland**.** **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To establish a community based racial healing and reconciliation working group, which will conduct bimonthly racial reconciliation and healing events**.** **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To provide DEI workshops to Town boards, committees and commissions**. ONGOING**
- To establish a closer working relationship with nonprofits, cultural organizations and business organizations. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To create Friends' Group for the DEI**. ONGOING**
- To continue participation in MA DEI Coalition. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To work with the Human Resources Department to improve the Town's Municipal Equality Index rating. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To establish and work with the Law Enforcement Resident Oversight Board. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To expand youth events, including a Youth enterpreneurship program and a Youth 'know our rights' program.
- To provide DEI workshops to Town boards, committees and commissions.
- To establish a closer working relationship with nonprofits, cultural organizations, and business organizations.
- To create Friends' Group for the DEI.
- To establish and work with the Law Enforcement Resident Oversight Board.
- To establish an annual Amherst Global Village Festival.

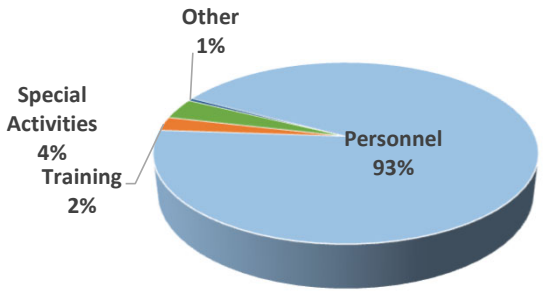
GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	18,222	157,103	182,945	195,242	189,060	(6,182)	-3.2%
Operating Expenses	$	1,700	4,554	12,608	13,500	13,500	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	19,922	161,656	195,552	208,742	202,560	(6,182)	-3.0%

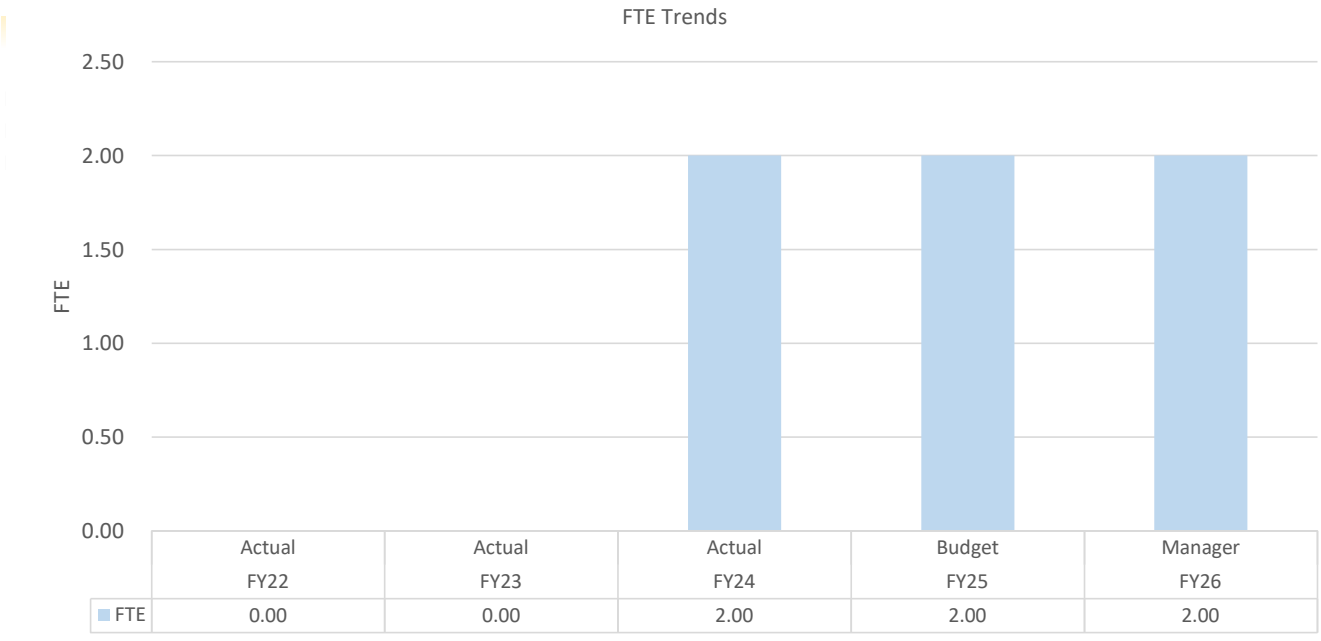
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Director and Assistant Director.

Operating Expenses include: Departmental training, professional development events, special activities for the Human Rights Commission. Other expenses include funds for office supplies and dues & subscriptions.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services decreasing due to staff transitions.



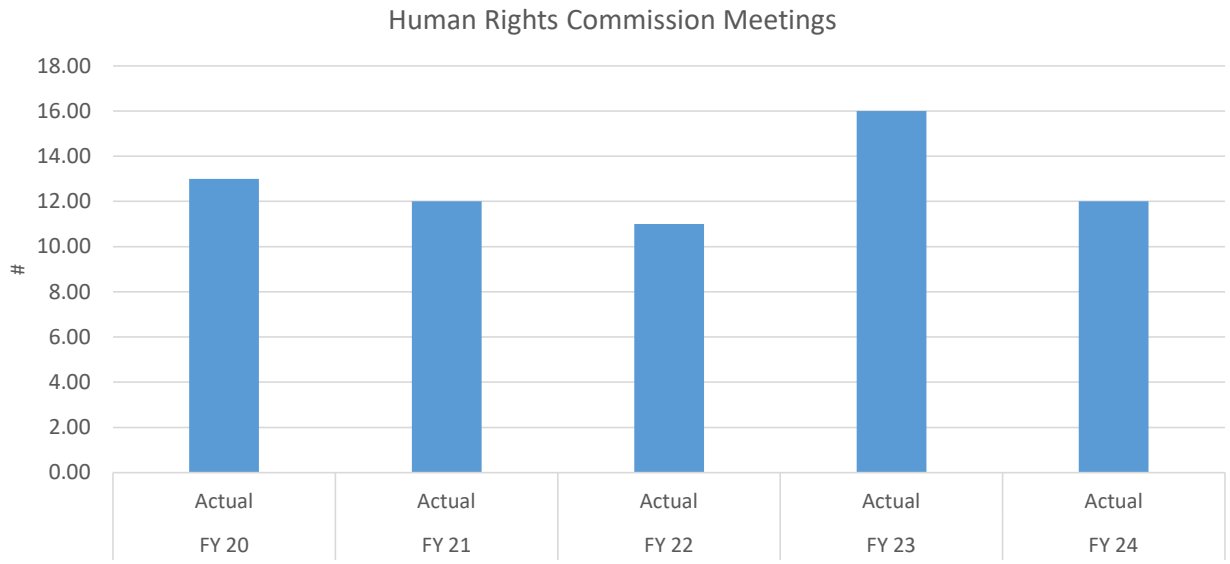
Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION (1150)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Human Rights Commission Meetings	13	12	11	16	12
Human Rights Commission Events			10	16	3
Other Committee/Board Meetings	0	0	36	70	38
Human Rights Complaints	4	2	6	4	6
Staff Development/Training Sessions	0	0	4	10	12
DEI Community Events	0	0	4	4	4

Notable Trends:
The Office of Diversity Equity and Inclusion serves as a liaison to two standing committees, the Disability Access Advisory Committee (now the Commission for Persons with Disabilities) and the Human Rights Commission. Each committee meets monthly with the occasional supplemental meeting. The Human Rights Commission holds an annual planning retreat and in addition sponsors cultural events. The DEI Department and HRC have revised their approach to the hosting of community events. Both groups now support a handful of standalone events and the Amherst Global Village Festival. The DEI Office will host six events on healing and reconciliation. The DEI Department is partnering with local businesses and nonprofits to sponsor these events.

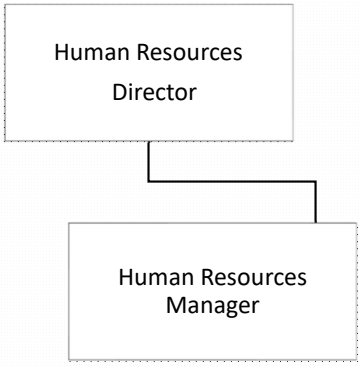


For more information, visit the Diversity, Equity and Inclusion webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3588/Diversity-Equity-Inclusion

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Function: To assist Town management to fairly, consistently, and lawfully create and administer policies and practices that attract, develop, and retain a motivated, diverse, and high-performing workforce.

Organization:



(Photo of HR Director Melissa Loiodice-Walker, right, and HR Manager Serena Harris, left)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Implemented a new non-union salary schedule based upon the results of a reclassification and compensation study.
- Drafted a comprehensive Search and Hiring Procedure to clarify hiring procedures.
- Drafted and implemented a procedure for the search and hiring, onboarding, and termination of seasonal employees.
- Supported the recruitment, hiring, and onboarding of the Police Chief, Finance Director, Director of Community Responders, and Fire Chief.
- Implemented new systems for both the collection and retention of vital employment documentation (*i.e.*, I-9s and CORIs).
- Successfully guided various, long-term IOD, and Worker's Compensation matters to conclusion.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To implement additional Employee Self-Service features.
- To transition to a new Applicant Tracking System platform.
- To draft an informational guide to assist managers in their roles.
- To achieve/maintain a strong and capable Town workforce through increased retention, recruiting, and staff training.
- To work with the Town Manager to incorporate anti-racist training in the onboarding process.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To support the recruitment, hiring, and onboarding of a qualified Fire Chief. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To negotiate and settle Fire Union contract in timely manner (contract expires June 30, 2024). **ONGOING**
- To draft an informational guide to assist managers in their roles. **RESCHEDULED**
- To develop more comprehensive off-boarding procedures in collaboration with IT. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To work with the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion office to expand the pool of diverse qualified candidates, to represent a broad range of races, cultures, and backgrounds, for Town positions. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To implement electronic employee onboarding processes. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To implement a new electronic applicant tracking system. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To finalize and implement Search and Hiring Procedures.
- To negotiate and settle five collective bargaining agreements.
- To implement the recently-revised Personnel Procedures Manual.
- To develop more comprehensive off-boarding procedures in collaboration with IT.
- To vet and implement the Remote Work Policy.
- To work with the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion office to expand the pool of diverse qualified candidates, to represent a broad range of races, cultures, and backgrounds, for Town positions.
- To implement electronic employee onboarding processes.
- To complete the implementation of a new electronic applicant tracking system.

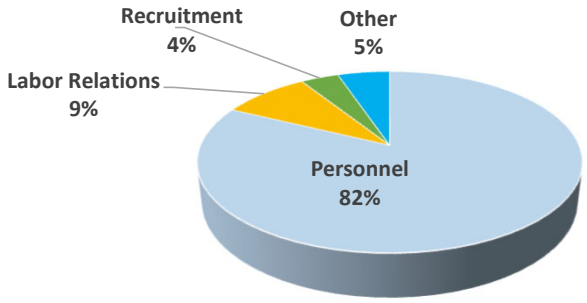
GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	240,656	232,504	237,605	274,727	281,023	6,296	2.3%
Operating Expenses	$	38,905	35,601	57,134	60,830	60,830	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-			-	--
Total Appropriation	$	279,561	268,105	294,739	335,557	341,853	6,296	1.9%

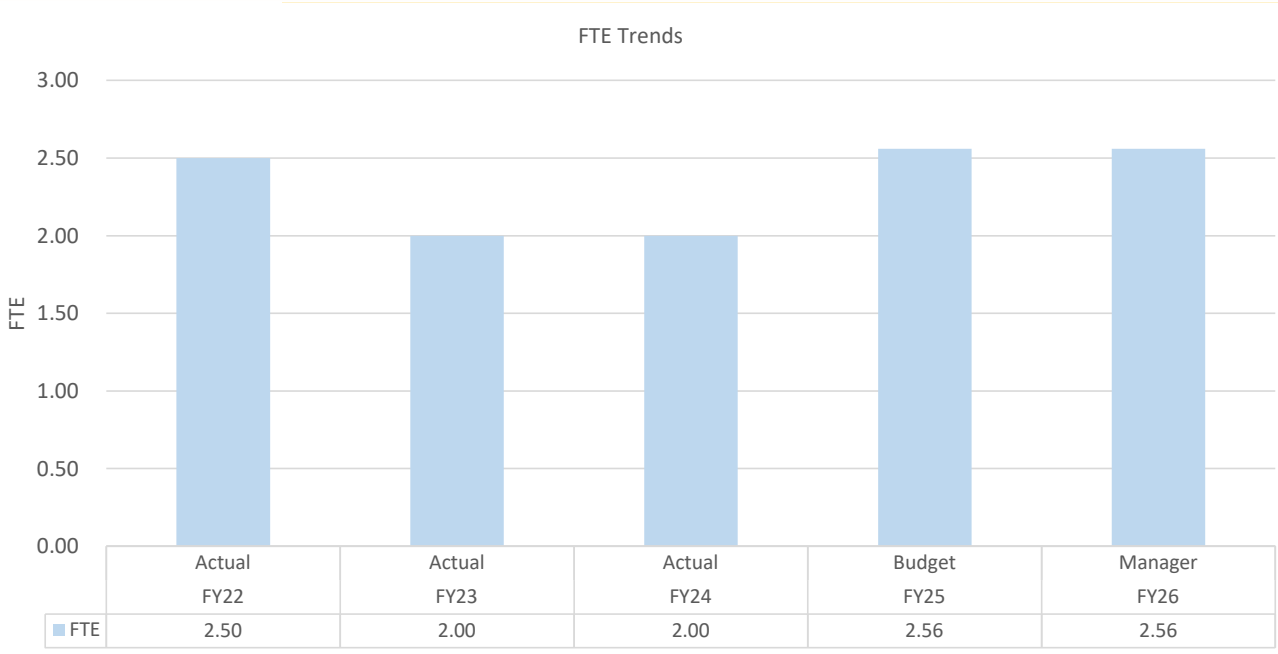
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for a Human Resources Director, Human Resources Manager, and wages for extra help.

Operating Expenses include: Recruitment that provides the funding for newspaper and web advertisements, career fair registrations, exams, and background checks as needed. Labor Relations provide the funding for contract negotiations. Other expenses include funds for training, conferences, and dues & subscriptions.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services includes funding for projected step increases.



Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: HUMAN RESOURCES (1152)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Recruitments and Fully Benefitted Hires	26	16	37	35	32
Personnel Board/Insurance Advisory Comm.	4	5	6	5	7
Collective Bargaining Meetings	11	19	49	15	9
Grievances Resolved	1	0	0	2	2
Staff Development/Training Sessions	6	5	6	6	8

Notable Trends:

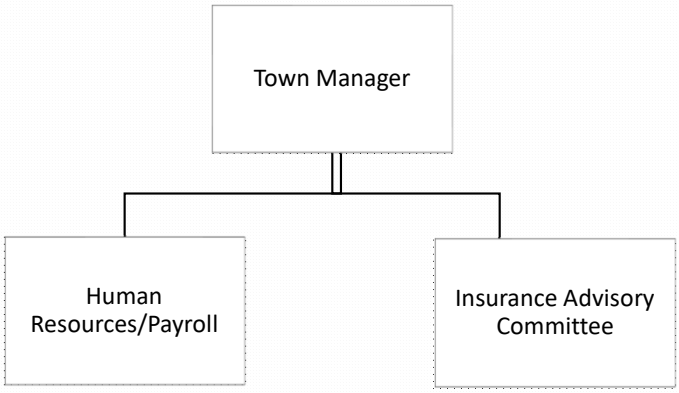
Given the number of Collective Bargaining Meetings recorded in FY22, this figure must also include union negotiations outside of collective bargaining. Subsequent years' numbers include only actual collective bargaining meetings.

For more information, visit the Human Resources webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/648/Human-Resources-Human-Rights

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Function: To administer and manage the full range of benefits provided to current and retired employees of the Town. To provide counsel to employees and retirees, and provide a forum for group discussion and analysis of the variable costs, options, and implications of benefit plan design. To provide quality benefits while seeking ways to reduce or control the cost of those benefits through education, safety awareness, and proactive claims administration.

Organization:



(Photo of Healthy Snacks program delivery)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Continued to provide numerous wellness activities for staff.
- Obtained grants to provide healthy snacks to employees across Town departments and other wellness benefits.
- Worked with the Insurance Advisory Committee and the Town's health insurance provider (MIIA) to implement modifications to the group health insurance plans reducing the overall increase.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To enhance employee communication and education materials and marketing on health insurance and other available benefits.
- To continue to review and monitor the workers compensation and Police/Fire Injured on Duty claims administration policies and practices.
- To review all voluntary benefit plans and vendors.
- To continue to explore tiered health plans and altenative insurance packages in order to lower insurance costs for employees and for the Town.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To review the Worker's Compensation and Injured on Duty coverages. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To review benefits plans to ensure compliance with all applicable regulations. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To explore and identify impacts of the SECURE Act. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To continue to explore tiered health plans and altenative insurance packages in order to lower insurance costs for employees and for the Town. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To make insurance notifications from the Town to retirees easier and more efficient. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To enhance the annual health fair with vendor participation and exhibits to increase employee attendance and experience. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To review the Worker's Comp and Injured on Duty coverages.
- To enhance the annual health fair with vendor participation and exhibits to increase employee attendance and experience.
- To explore tiered health plans and altenative insurance packages in order to lower insurance costs for employees and for the Town.

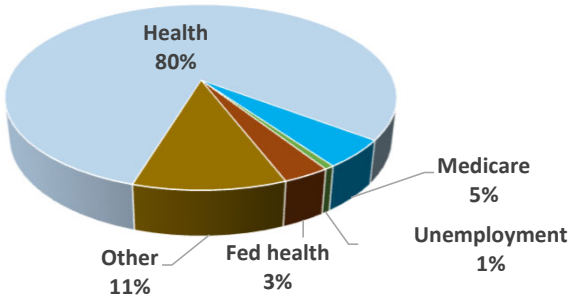
GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	3,370,785	3,722,366	3,925,908	4,536,512	5,556,453	1,019,941	22.5%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-			-	--
Total Appropriation	$	3,370,785	3,722,366	3,925,908	4,536,512	5,556,453	1,019,941	22.5%

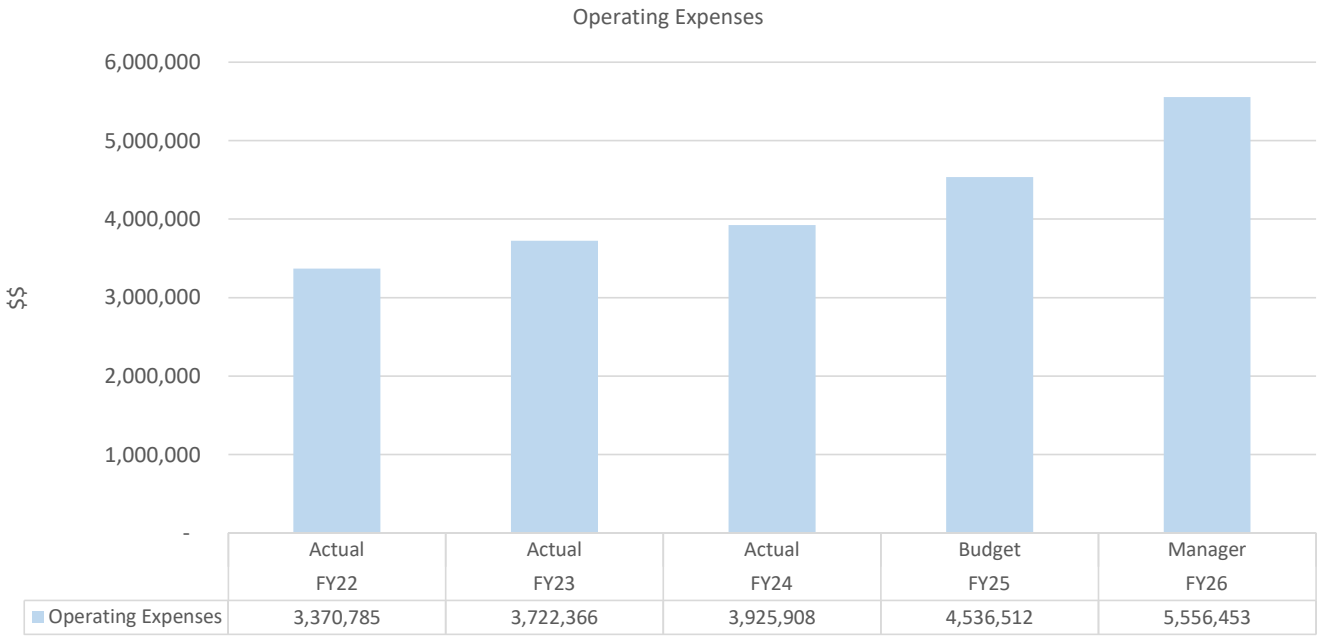
Major Components:
Health insurance is $4,472,298. Medicare is $272,919. Unemployment insurance is $37,644. Federal Health Insurance is $182,083.

Other includes salary reserve, worker's compensation, life insurance, flexible benefits, and police/fire injured-on-duty funding.

Significant Changes:
The large increases for employee health insurance for FY26 are included in this budget line. Five of six collective bargaining agreements are in negotiation for FY26. Funds for estimated contractual settlements are held in this functional area.



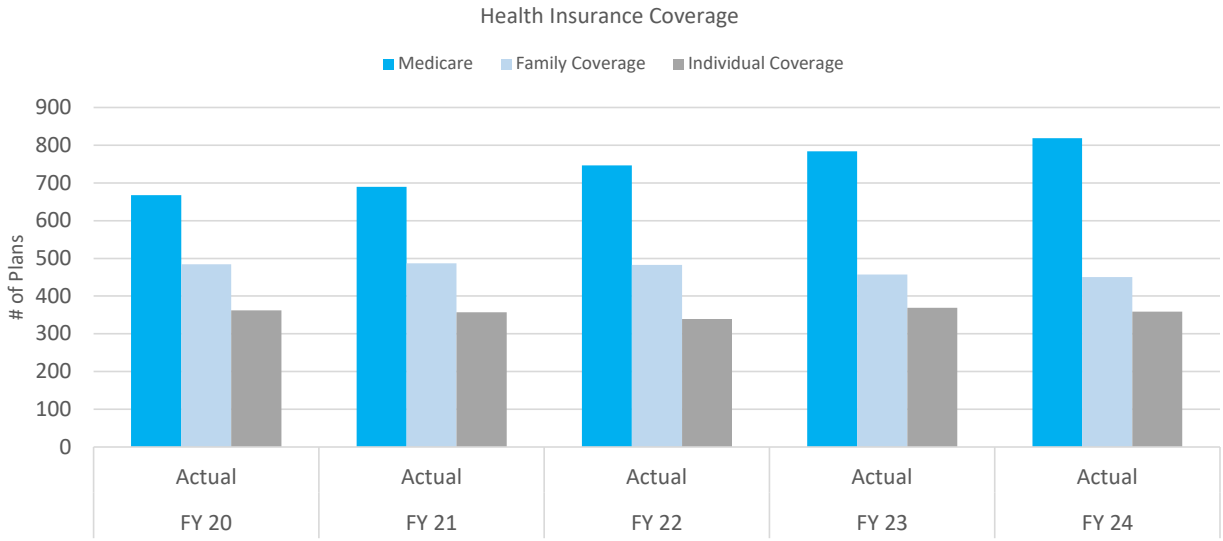
Expenditure Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: EMPLOYEE BENEFITS (1154)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Health Insurance					
Family Coverage	484	487	483	457	450
Individual Coverage	362	357	339	369	359
Medicare	668	690	747	784	819
Life Insurance	1,006	1,173	1,260	1,254	1,263
Unemployment Claims	68	225	32	39	31
Works Comp/Public Safety IOD Claims Medical Only	13	23	16	70	23
Works Comp/Public Safety IOD Claims Lost Time	10	9	9	11	10

Notable Trends:
None.

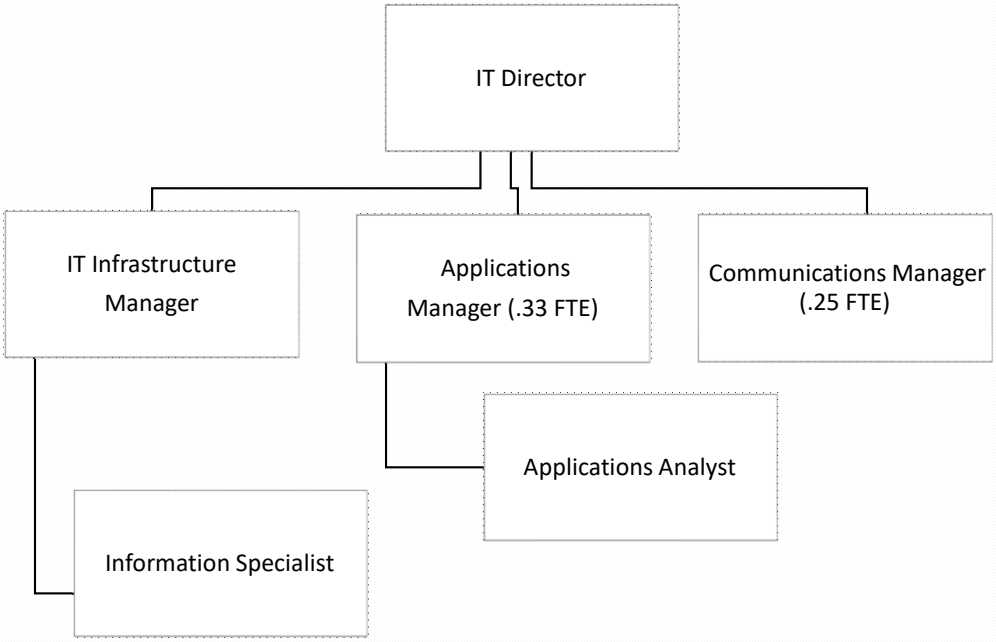


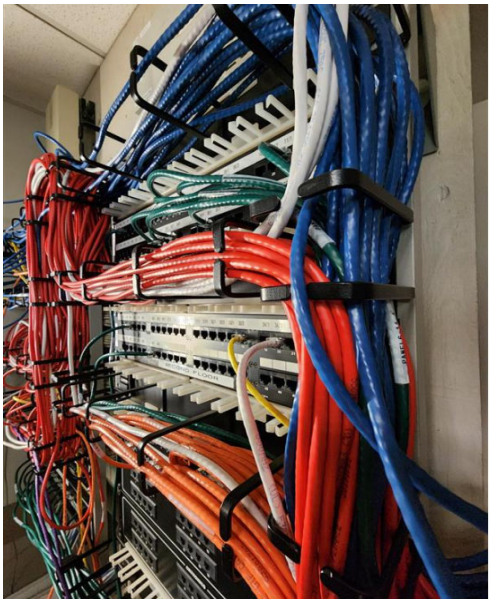
For more information, visit the Employee Benefits webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3526/Employee-Benefits

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

Function: To select, implement, and maintain technology systems to best enhance services delivered by Town departments.

Organization:





(Photo of Town Hall ethernet wiring)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Installed new pirmary server cluster.
- Quickly recovered from network outage caused by software vendor bug.
- Restored fiber infrastructure to the Jones Library and Fire Central Station.
- Continued Cybersecurity training with new State program.
- Ongoing planing to update and enhance our Cybersecurity resilisency.
- Enhanced Fire & EMS wireless mobile connectivity.
- Enhanced public safety radio system for connectivty and backup purposes.
- Upgrade to OpenGov for rental registration application.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To provide technology training to Town staff to better utilize the Town's systems.
- To maintain and improve the Town's cyber security policies and technologies.
- To provide all users with training for cyber security, Munis financial accounting system, Microsoft Teams and Office, and other key applications.
- To provide technology support for public meetings.
- To select and implement a legislative management system.
- To support management of existing software and implementation of new software.
- To manange 24/7/365 IT support with increasing cybersecurity threats and technology events.
- To support new building IT infrastructure and technology needs for new and temporary facilities.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue to make cybersecurity improvements. **ONGOING**
- To replace server and backup infrastructure. **ONGOING**
- To connect fiber and install outdoor WiFi at Recreation sites. **ONGOING**
- To implement new applicant tracking system for Human Resources Department. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

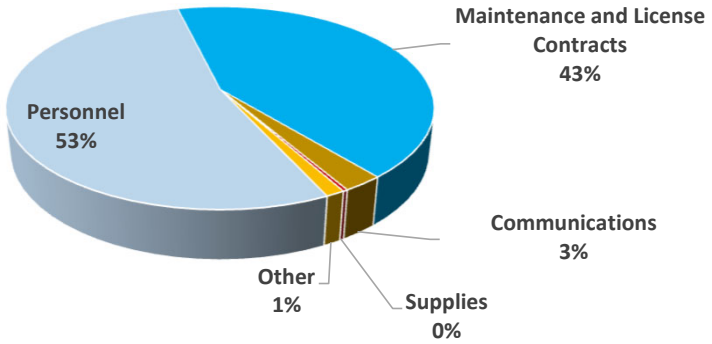
- To continue to make cybersecurity improvements.
- To replace four servers.
- To install equipment and software for backup infrasturcture replacement.
- To connect fiber and install outdoor WiFi at Recreation sites (Mill River pool, Groff park, War Memorial pool).
- To implement new applicant tracking system for Human Resources Department.
- To begin the upgrade to the Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) software for Dispatch.
- To integrate time keeping systems with MUNIS. (Police, Fire, Recreation, Schools)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	393,828	406,179	422,345	451,257	445,759	(5,498)	-1.2%
Operating Expenses	$	379,852	317,920	348,427	393,177	393,177	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	773,679	724,099	770,772	844,434	838,936	(5,498)	-0.7%

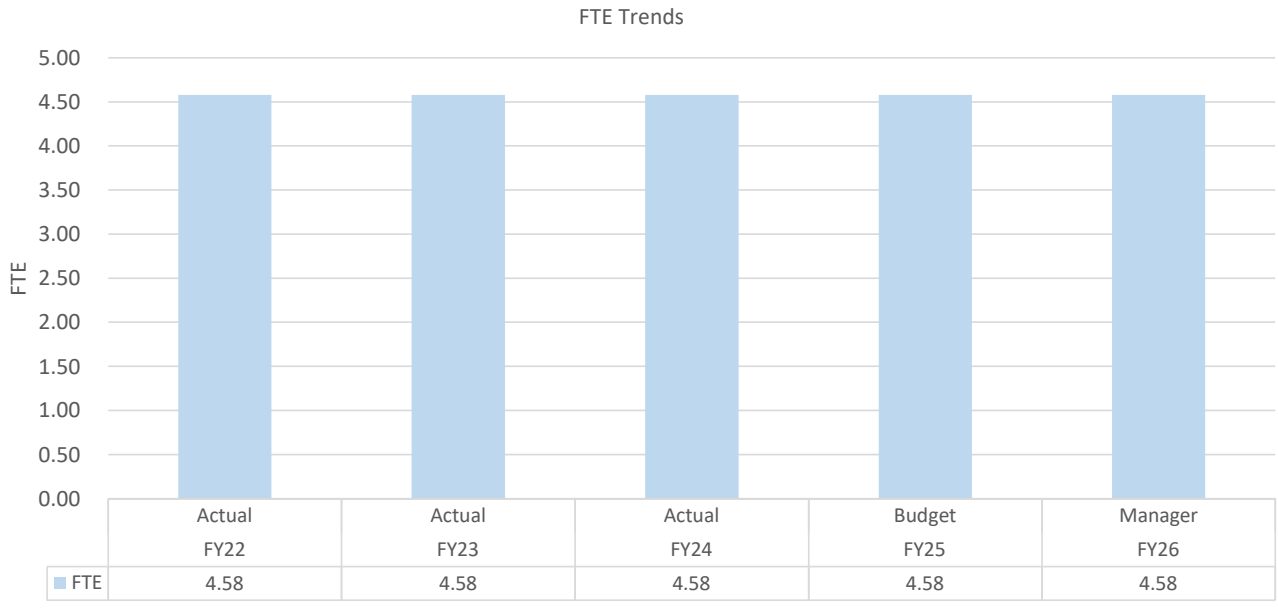
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for the Director, an Infrastructure Manager, .33 of an Applications Manager (shared with the Water and Sewer Funds), an Information Specialist, .25 of the Communications Manager, and an Applications Analyst. Relicensing Agreements, $358,512, provide for the payment of relicense and maintenance agreements on a variety of software and operating systems. All software maintenance costs are part of the Department's budget. Communications includes phone lines and Internet access.

Other expenses include maintenance of equipment, office supplies, and dues/ subscriptions.



Significant Changes:
Personnel Services decreasing due to staff transitions.

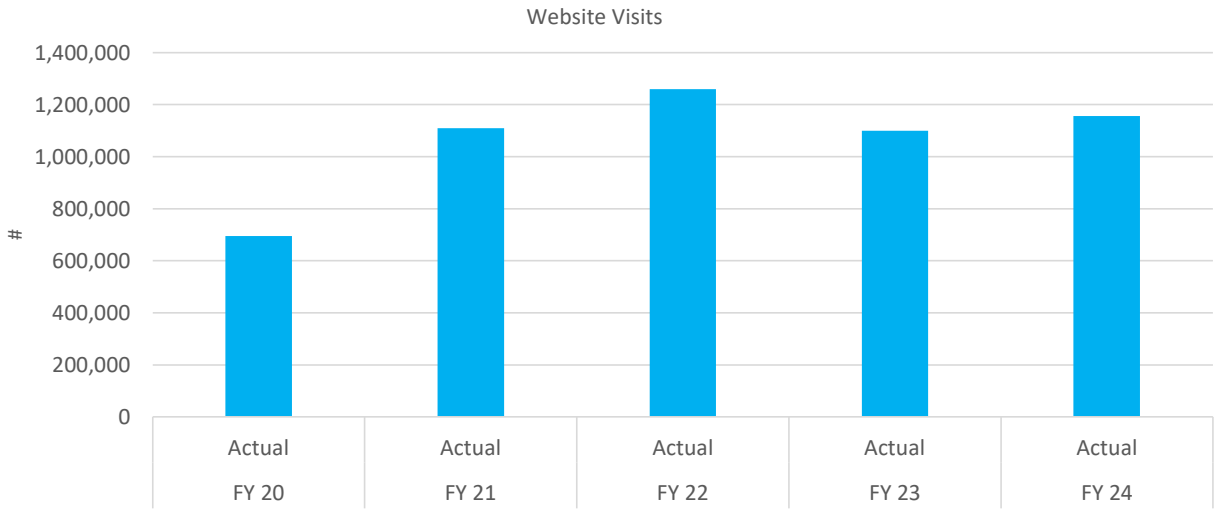
Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (1155)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Buildings Connected to the WAN	18	18	20	20	20
Network User/Group Accounts	1,087	967	1,015	1,031	1,043
Desktop/Notebook Computers	671	674	689	673	440
Virtual Servers	72	74	64	51	33
Printers & Multifunctions	68	69	72	72	71
IP Phones	328	328	251	258	252
Network Database Software Packages	53	54	55	55	55
Websites	12	8	8	8	8
Website Visits	694,477	1,109,022	1,261,046	1,100,000	1,155,977
Amherst YouTube Channel Views	1,751	6,784	10,625	73,360	17,895

Notable Trends:
Website visits continue to grow. Many Town committee meetings are posted on YouTube for public access.

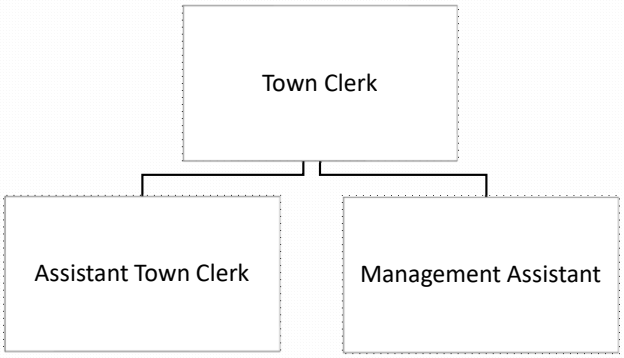


For more information, visit the Information Technology webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/341/Information-Technology

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Function: To work efficiently and effectively to provide the highest level of customer service by properly managing, preserving and providing access to vital and public records. To continue Town-wide compliance with Public Records, Open Meeting, and Conflict of Interest Laws. To perform the duties outlined within the Amherst Home Rule Charter.

Organization:



(Photo of Town Clerk Office)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Assistant Town Clerk completed Year 2 of 3 of the New England Municipal Clerk Institute & Academy.
- Town Clerk attended the International Institute for City/Town Clerks' Annual Conference in Newport, Rhode Island to further knowledge and relay new developments to the office staff.
- Assistant Town Clerk earned the Certified Municipal Clerk designation.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to provide educational opportunities for office staff in all Town Clerk functions.
- To provide trainings for boards, committees and staff members on Conflict of Interest, Open Meeting, and Public Records laws.
- To provide trainings for new staff member liaisons in how to submit a meeting posting for Boards and Committees.
- To manage the number of public record requests - which doubled - more efficiently.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To work with the Community Preservation Act Committee to procure funds to maintain an ongoing schedule for restoration and preservation of historical records. **ONGOING**
- To work with Town Manager's staff and I.T. Dept in determining how to combine board/committee databases. **ONGOING**
- Assistant Town Clerk to attend Year 2 of the New England Municipal Clerk Academy to work towards the CMC designation. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To successfully implement the new MAVRIC (Massachusetts Vital Records Information Collaborative) program by the State Registry of Vital Records and Statistics in April of 2024. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To work with the Community Preservation Act Committee to procure funds to maintain an ongoing schedule for restoration and preservation of historical records.
- To work with Town Manager's staff and I.T. Dept in determining how to combine board/committee databases.
- To have Assistant Town Clerk attend Year 3 of the New England Municipal Clerk Academy.
- To successfully implement the new MAVRIC (Massachusetts Vital Records Information Collaborative) program by the State Registry of Vital Records and Statistics.

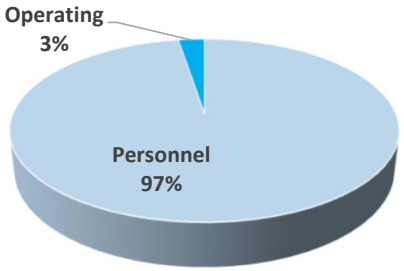
GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	190,834	200,483	209,025	229,744	236,597	6,853	3.0%
Operating Expenses	$	4,837	5,837	5,343	6,260	6,260	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	195,671	206,321	214,368	236,004	242,857	6,853	2.9%

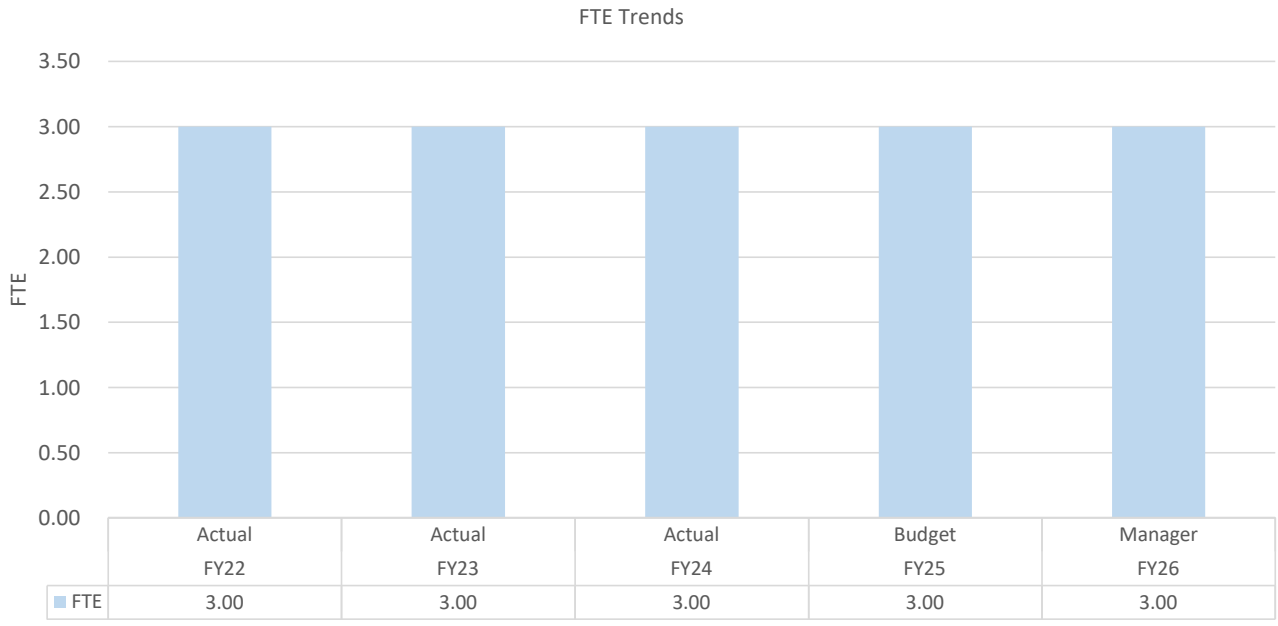
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for the Town Clerk, Assistant Town Clerk, and Management Assistant.

Operating costs include training, dues and subscriptions, communications, and supplies for storage of vital records and dog licensing.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services increasing due to projected step increases.



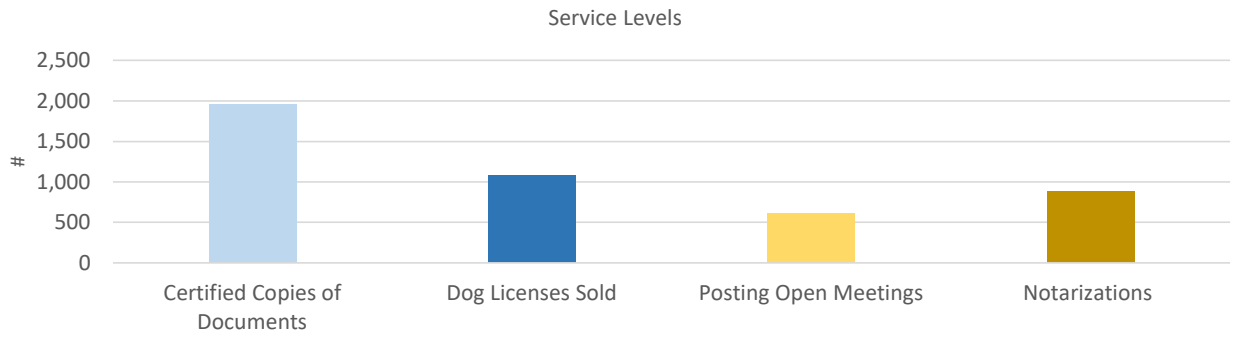
Staffing Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: TOWN CLERK'S OFFICE (1161)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Certified Copies of Documents	2,308	1,723	2,244	2,213	1,961
Marriage Intentions	84	5	69	122	133
Marriage Licenses	85	4	67	119	128
Dog Licenses Sold	880	789	974	1,094	1,087
Poll and Underground Conduits	2	1	0	2	9
Zoning Board of Appeals Applications/ Decisions	33	42	14	16	41
Public Records Requests	84	61	60	57	114
Conflict of Interest Law Compliance	128	518	927	639	365
Street Lists Sold	10	8	37	11	24
Posting Open Meetings	924	718	693	668	615
Planning Board Applications/Decisions	38	22	25	11	24
Business Notices (d/b/a)	108	157	145	109	125
Raffle Permits	9	3	4	4	8
Underground Storage Registrations	20	23	19	13	11
Cemetery Deeds	11	12	10	8	2
Notarizations	511	91	1,260	1,106	886
Passport Applications	34	0	0	0	0
Burial Permits	196	148	177	172	166
Request for Voter Information	9	66	39	140	36
Performance Oath	171	117	180	182	200
Non-certified Copies of Documents	67	33	289	39	160
Vital Records Recorded	370	326	390	470	493
Vital Records: Filing/Amendments	3	8	5	4	10
Passport Photos	167	0	18	27	12
Planning Board filings	14	23	20	11	6
Court case filings	2	7	6	7	7
Resignations from Boards/Committee	24	20	29	13	33
Claims for Damages	60	53	39	12	82

Notable Trends:
Public records requests have doubled from prior years, many of which have focused on information pertaining to the library expansion. Claims for damages also greatly increased from prior years.

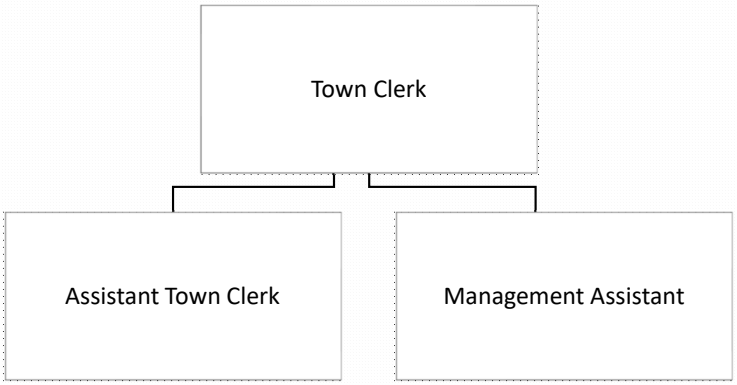


For more information, visit the Town Clerk's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/80/Town-Clerk

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

Function: To register voters, maintain the Voter Registration Information System, and preserve the integrity of elections in accordance with all applicable State and Federal laws.

Organization:



(Photo of a VOTE HERE TODAY sign)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Successful conduct of the September 3, 2024 State Primary and November 5, 2024 State Election.
- Successfully implemented the advance removal and deposit procedure in the management and casting of vote-by-mail ballots. This allowed the polling locations to focus on in-person voters on election day, and not be inundated with the processing of vote-by-mail ballots.
- Town Clerk spoke as guest speaker at a voter information event sponsored by UMass Amherst Women of Color Leadership Network and the League of Women Voters in collaboration with the Center for Justice, Law and Societies, CMass, MassPIRG, Dept. Political Science, School of Public Policy, and GSS in the Fall of 2024.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To work with Town departments and committees on outreach and education for the promotion of ranked-choice voting for municipal elections.
- To continue to hire and train new election workers to ensure adequate staffing at the polls.
- To provide ongoing education for the Board of Registrars members in their legal duties per State law.
- To continue working with the three institutions of higher education through the Resident Life offices, as well as the superintendent's office at the high school on voter outreach.
- To work with major stakeholders to develop effective and viable voter outreach and education programs geared toward the

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To explore options for managing the large volume of mail-in ballots including considering staffing requirements based on increase in demand for mailed ballots, now a permanent option for voting. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To create a Standard Operating Procedure document for each voting location that can be used for the opening and closing of polls which identifies layout, equipment needed, contact information, etc. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To prepare for and facilitate the upcoming September 3, 2024 State Primary and November 5, 2024 State Election. **ACCOMPLISHED**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To prepare for and facilitate the upcoming November 4, 2025 Biennial Town Election.
- To prepare for the transition of the Town Clerk upon her retirement.
- To expand outreach efforts at the University, colleges, and high school to ensure every eligible voter is registered and has access to vote.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

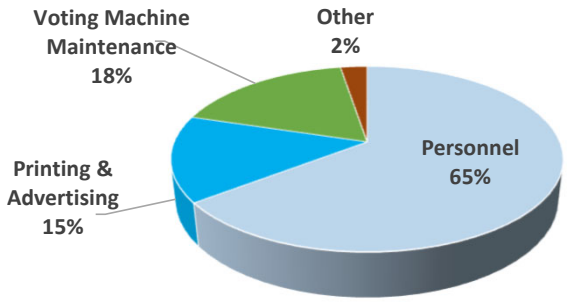
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	18,407	60,036	39,655	43,853	43,853	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	21,980	16,391	21,263	23,975	23,975	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	40,388	76,427	60,918	67,828	67,828	-	--

Major Components:
Personnel Services include stipends for the Board of Registrars and remuneration for Election Workers.

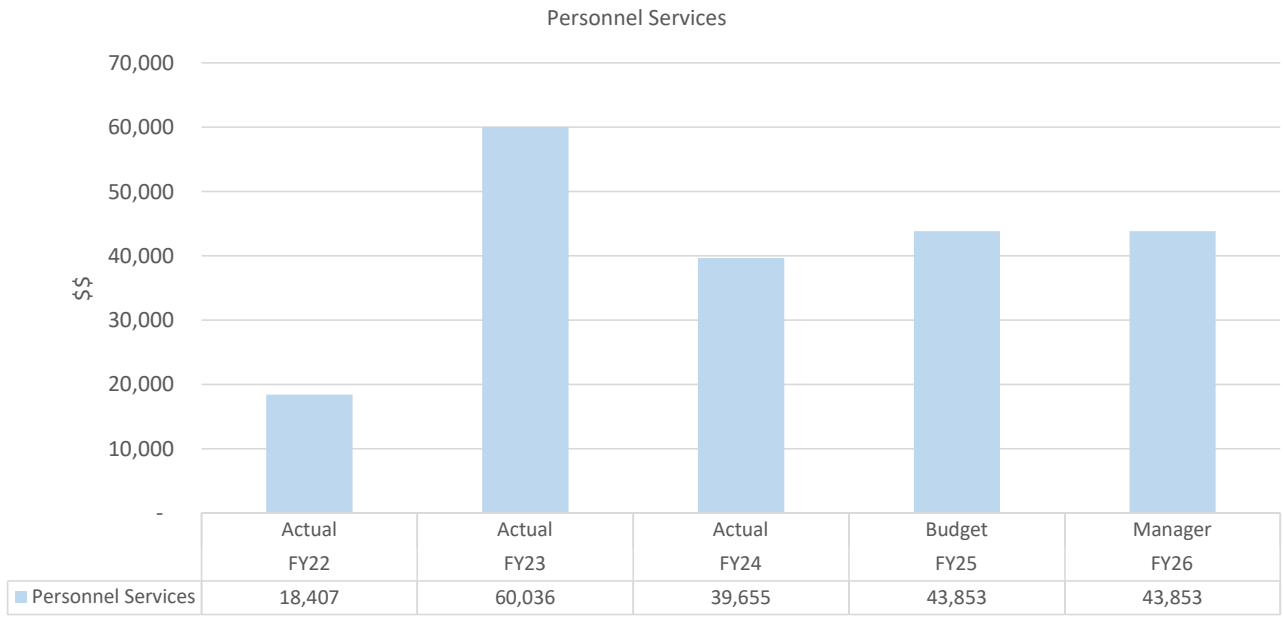
Voting Machine Maintenance includes programming and annual maintenance of voting equipment.

Printing costs include Town election ballots, census mailers, confirmation cards, and annual street list.

Significant Changes:
No changes.



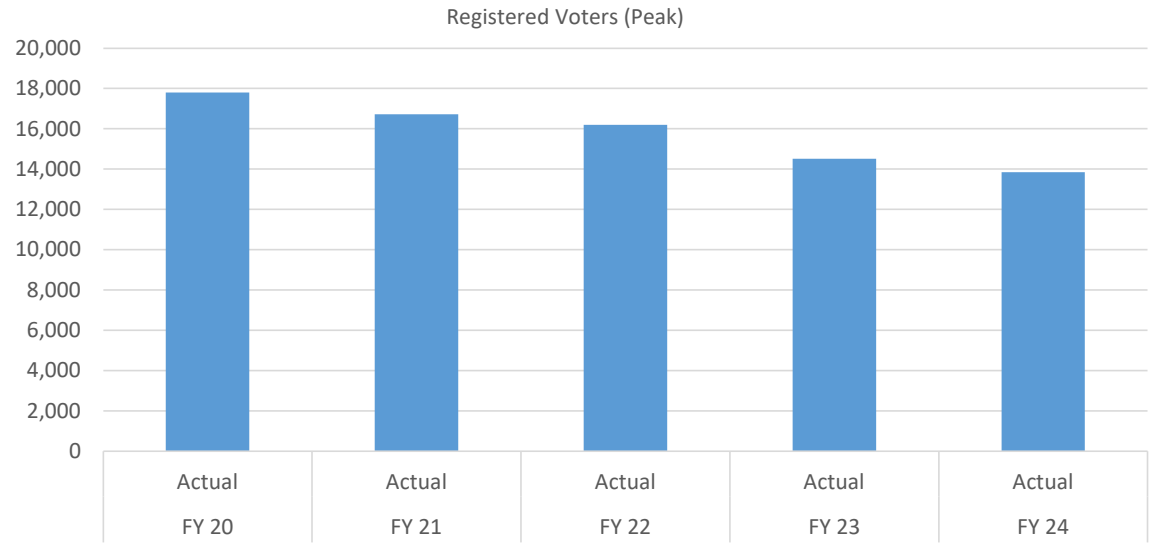
Expenditure Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: ELECTIONS & REGISTRATIONS (1162 & 1163)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Elections	2	2	2	3	2
Election Worker Training Sessions	11	7	4	10	4
Voter Registration Sessions	2	1	2	3	2
Voter Registrations: New, Changes, Deletions	7,723	23,715	9,045	10,085	9,927
Registered Voters (Peak)	17,796	16,721	16,187	14,504	13,844
% Voter Turnout					
Town Elections	13.73%	n/a	31.15%	30.24%	33.55%
Town % By Mail	3.00%	n/a	2.00%	32.00%	38.70%
Presidential Primary	45.75%	n/a	n/a	n/a	28.12%
Presidential % By Mail	5.00%	n/a	n/a	n/a	53.80%
State Primaries	n/a	42.94%	n/a	27.08%	n/a
State Primaries % By Mail	n/a	84.00%	n/a	79.00%	n/a
State Elections (incl. Presidential/Special	n/a	71.89%	n/a	56.26%	n/a
State Elections % By Mail	n/a	57.00%	n/a	46.00%	n/a
Petition/Nomination Signatures	4,504	1,645	5,108	67	8,850
Petition/Nomination Papers	1,660	265	2,141	15	4,159
Annual Street Listing Forms (first mailing)	9,658	10,358	11,000	8,500	8,834
Confirmation Cards (second mailing)	0	4,861	3,884	3,767	3,075

Notable Trends:
There was a heightened interest State-wide in ballot questions and number of candidates appearing on the ballot last election season which resulted in a large increase in the number of petition and nomination forms received for certification by our office.

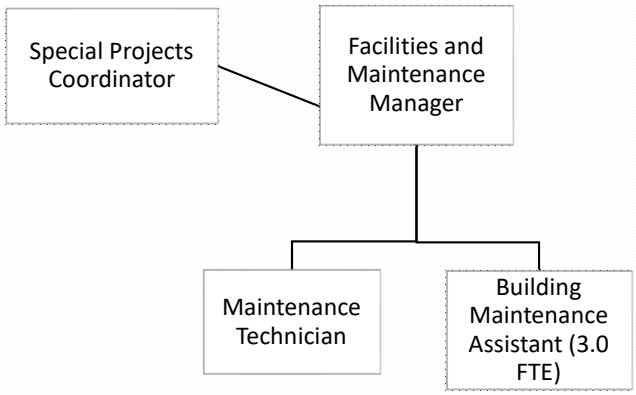


For more information, visit the Board of Registrars webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/472/Board-of-Registrars

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

Function: To maintain a safe, healthy, clean and efficient environment for conducting Town business and other public activities through comprehensive building operations and preventative maintenance programs that also serve to preserve and extend the life of the Town's physical assets.

Organization:



(Photo of newly refinished Town Hall doors)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed the design and renovation of the third floor at Bangs Community Center to house the DEI program.
- Provide in-house OPM (Owner's Project Manager) services for multiple projects.
- Completed the demolition and site restoration of the former VFW building and Hickory Ridge Clubhouse building.
- Major project management: Police Department Roof Replacement and Chiller Replacement; Regional High School Track and Field; new Fort River Elementary School and Jones Library buildings; Bangs Community Center renovations; Kendrick Park Restrooms.
- Minor project management: North and Central Fire Stations lighting upgrades, building envelope repairs, floor replacement; Headhouse Repairs at Boltwood Garage; Eletrical Service at Hickory Ridge Barn; EV charging stations at Police Department and North Fire Station; Multiple buidings: expanded building control access, installed water bottle stations, conducted elevator upgrades for code compliance; Department of Public Works envelope repairs; Hickory Ridge Bridges and Trail work.
- Completed a facilities assessment and energy audit of ten Town buildings to serve as a basis for future capital requests.
- Replaced Facilities Department vehicles with full EV vehicles.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To address deferred maintenance on all buildings.
- To manage impact of increased use of buildings on nights and weekends.
- To continue to work with the Director of Sustainability to apply for Green Community grant funding.
- To achieve watertight roofs on all buildings with a plan for replacement.
- To protect the Town's assets through preventative maintenance and ongoing capital improvements.
- To manage the space needs within the buildings to provide for necessary long-term storage.
- To explore opportunities to increase revenues using Town assets.
- To develop and begin implementing a plan for building improvements that reduces our carbon footprint.
- To continue to schedule and complete previously funded capital projects.
- To address and implement the accessibility initiatives across Town buildings and property, tied to the self-evaluation and accessiblility survey.
- To enhance the safety and security of Town buildings.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To complete the design and installation of the HVAC system at Munson Memorial Building. **ONGOING**
- To enhance the safety and security of Town buildings. **ONGOING**
- To complete the installation of a fire alarm control system at Munson Memorial Library Building. **ONGOING**
- To complete the study and design of the replacement of the boiler at Amherst Childcare Center. **ONGOING**
- To implement energy savings initiatives tied to the audits done by Eversource and consultants. **ONGOING**
- To apply for a grant for ADA improvements on the Munson Memorial Library Building. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To complete an assessment of an additional ten (10) Town buildings. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To develop a strategic plan to address needed roof repair and replacement for Town buildings. **ACCOMPLISHED**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To develop a strategic plan to address needed roof repair and replacement for Town buildings.
- To complete the ADA improvements at the Munson Memorial Library Building.
- To manage the restoration of the slate roofs on Town Hall and Munson Memorial Building.
- To enhance the safety and security of Town buildings.
- To complete the design to replace the HVAC systems at the Munson Memorial Library Building.
- To complete the installation of a fire alarm control system at Munson Memorial Library Building.
- To complete the study and design of the replacement of the boiler at the Amherst Childcare Center.
- To work with the Department of Public Works to address the Traffic and Grounds building energy performance and deferred maintenance.
- To seal the roof at War Memorial Pump house.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	313,145	288,181	315,099	377,515	414,978	37,463	9.9%
Operating Expenses	$	209,910	247,682	243,271	255,600	255,600	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	523,056	535,863	558,369	633,115	670,578	37,463	5.9%

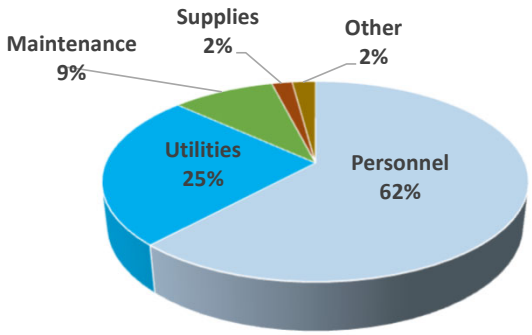
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for a Facilities and Maintenance Manager, a Maintenance Technician, three Building Maintenance Assistants, and the Special Projects Coordinator.

Utilities are for Town Hall, the Bangs Community Center, the Munson Memorial Library building, the North Amherst School, the South Amherst Campus, North Amherst Library, and the East Street School building. Fuel, electricity, water, sewer, and refuse collection are included.

Maintenance includes maintenance and repair of buildings and to routine cleaning and maintenance of building systems, HVAC, and sprinklers occupied by Town departments and those leased to other providers.

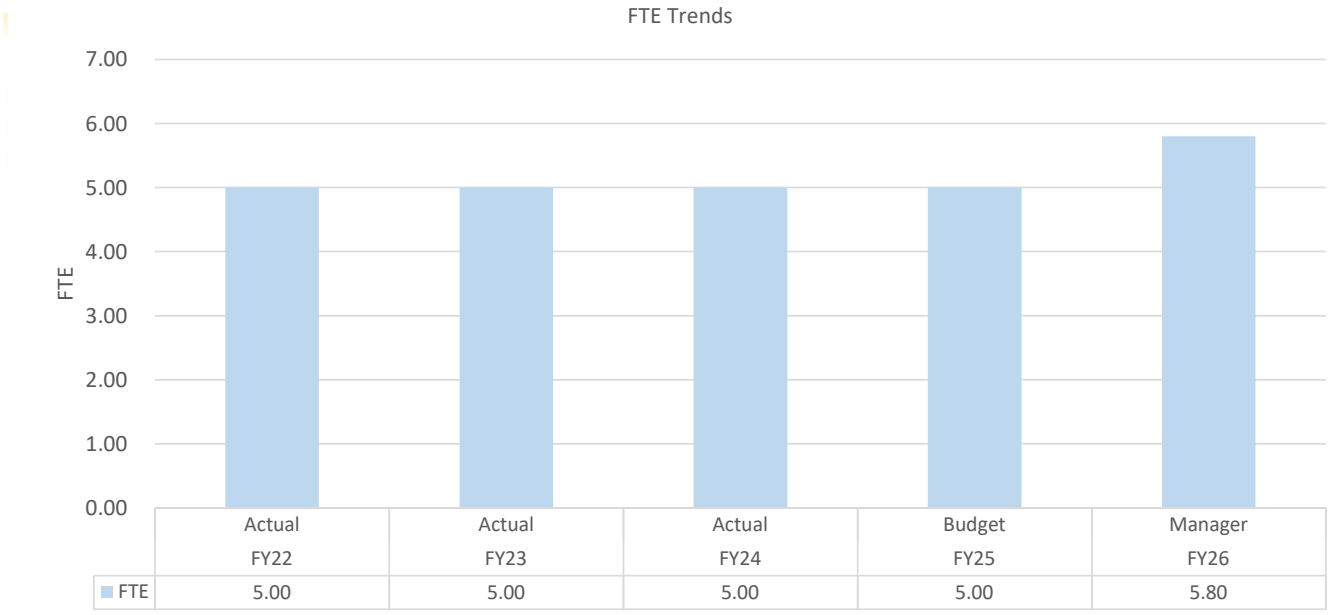
Supplies, includes cleaning and electrical supplies as well as small tools.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to fully funding the Special Projects Coordinator.

Staffing Trends:

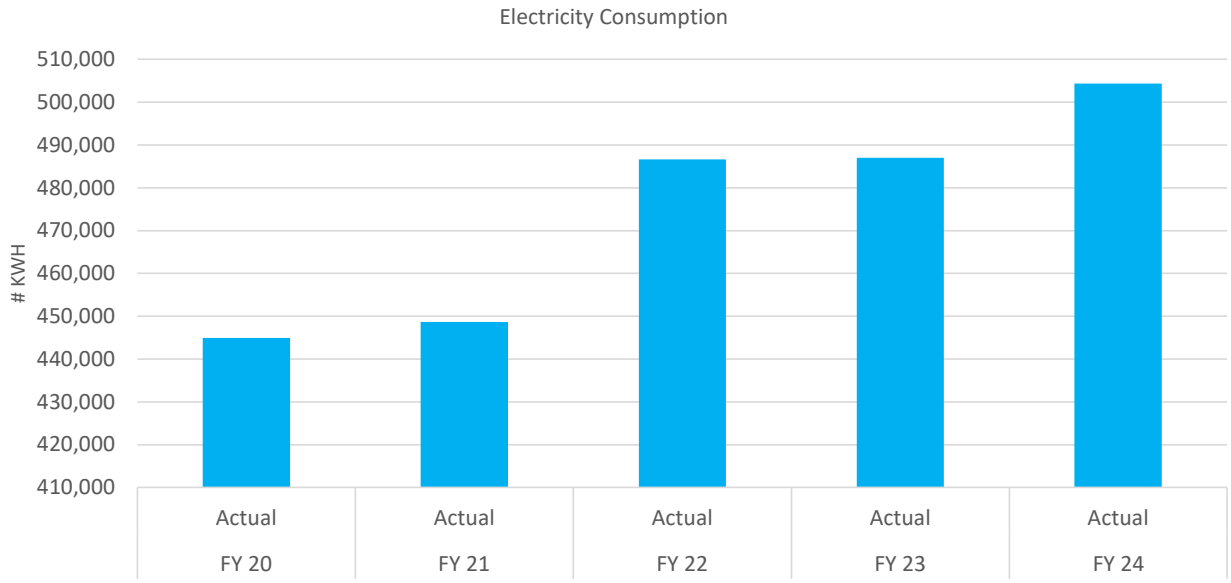


GENERAL GOVERNMENT: FACILITIES MAINTENANCE (1190, 1191, 1192, 1193, 1194, 1195, 1196 & 1197)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Utility Usage*					
Electricity (kWh)	444,970	448,696	486,658	487,006	504,370
Fuel – Gas (cf)	26,495	30,302	29,008	26,682	25,602
Fuel – Oil (gal)	3,931	2,057	2,016	2,168	2,193
Water & Sewer (cf)	59,500	83,600	95,200	52,600	70,000
Square Feet Maintained	101,805	101,805	101,805	104,690	211,000
Facilities Managed	9	9	9	10	14
Automated Computer Systems Monitored	5	5	5	5	7
Building Usage (hrs/wk)	310	310	310	330	785
Maintenance (hrs/wk)	252	252	261.5	261.5	261.5
Meetings Scheduled (includes APD)	5,604	1,238	4,618	4,580	3,429
Rental Contracts	4	4	4	4	4

*(Town Hall, Bangs Community Center, Munson Memorial Library, East Street School, South Amherst Campus, 1200 North Pleasant Street)

Notable Trends:
Facilities department also takes care of other buildings including AFD, Hickory Ridge, DPW building, animal welfare building have been added to service levels for this year. Emergency Responses: Bangs Community Center Elevator, Amherst Childcare Domestic Water Line, East Street School Domestic Water Line.

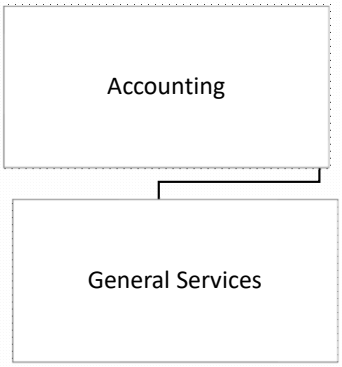


For more information, visit the Facilities webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/358/Facilities

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

Function: To manage the centralized purchasing of services, supplies, and equipment; contracts for maintenance of office equipment; legal services; and property and casualty insurance in order to maximize savings and efficiencies with competitive purchasing. This includes municipal property and casualty insurance, risk management, the annual independent audit, legal services, central telephones, copiers, mailing services, and equipment and central bulk office supplies.

Organization:



(Photo of office equipment managed within this section of the budget)

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Continued to maintain competitive rates on property and casualty insurance for Town, Library, Schools, and Enterprise departments.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to control costs for centralized services.
- To maintain a balance between age of equipment, new acquisition costs, and maintenance costs.
- To conduct a risk assessment and to implement programs that reduce liability insurance cost.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue to look for savings for centralized services for the Town. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To put out a Request for Proposals for FY25 property and casualty insurance. **RESCHEDULED**

Upcoming Objectives:

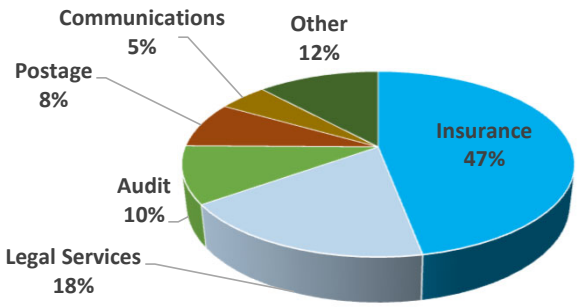
- To continue to look for savings for centralized services for the Town.
- To put out a Request for Proposals for FY27 property and casualty insurance.

GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

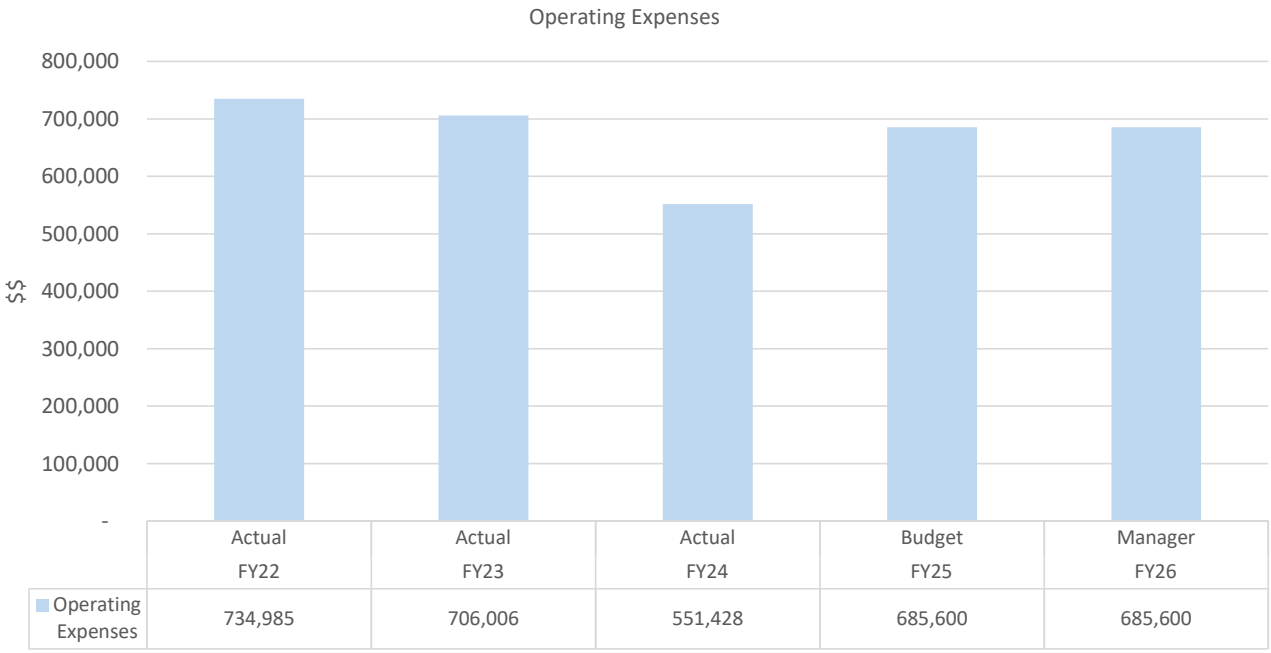
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	734,985	706,006	551,428	685,600	685,600	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	734,985	706,006	551,428	685,600	685,600	-	--

Major Components:
Insurance, $322,100, includes general liability, auto, public official and professional liability, and boiler insurance. Legal Services, $125,000. Postage, $55,000. Communications, $33,000. Supplies, $39,000, include office, copier paper, and miscellaneous supplies for all departments. Audit, $68,500. Equipment rental & maintenance, $28,000, covers contracts, where economical, on photocopiers, computers, printers, fax machines, telephones, etc. Technical Services, $15,000.

Significant Changes:
No changes.



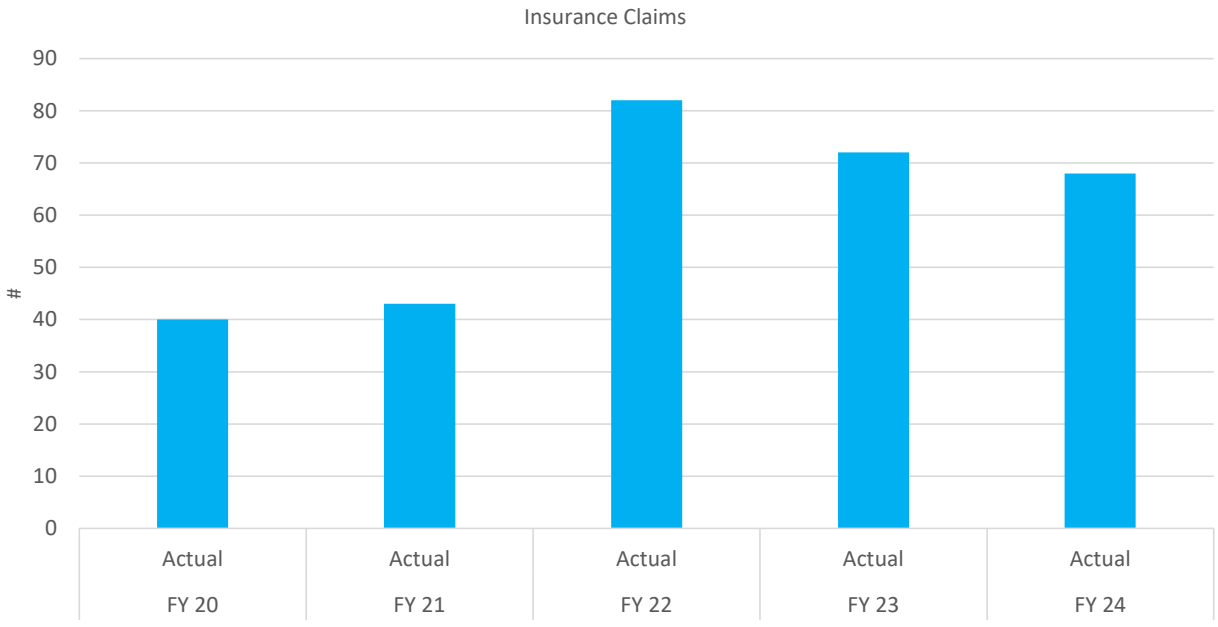
Expenditure Trends:



GENERAL GOVERNMENT: GENERAL SERVICES (1198 & 1199)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Vehicles Insured	229	224	220	225	230
Buildings Insured	62	60	60	63	63
Insurance Claims Processed (Property/Auto)	40	43	82	72	68
Supply Requisitions Filled	199	112	78	86	65

Notable Trends:
None.



PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Function: To operate and maintain a secure, healthy, comfortable, and safe mission-critical facility for all users, twenty-four hours per day, seven days per week, fifty-two weeks per year. The building also serves as the Emergency Operation Center for the Town during emergencies.

Organization:

(Photo of the Police Station)

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed locker room upgrades to include: touchless fixtures, countertop replacement, seating, and other improvements.
- Completed the renovation of the Report Room and Document Station.
- Completed the installation of a new high efficiency air source heat pump cooling system in the server room and telecommunication rooms.
- Completed the installation of bottle fill water stations.
- Completed the installation of a concrete parking pad for APD equipment.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To manage higher use of the building and the directly proportional amount of maintenance work needed. Weekend staffing needs are a challenge for existing staff.
- To implement energy saving initiatives to further the Town's sustainability goals and eliminate the use of fossil fuels consistent with Town Council goals for de-carbonization.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To complete the study and design of roof replacement including the installation of solar panels. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To determine the condition of the chiller and cooling tower, and to develop a plan for replacement or repair. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To implement energy savings initiatives tied to the audits done by Eversource and consultants. **ONGOING**
- To complete the renovation of the Report Room and Document Station. **ACCOMPLISHED**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To implement energy savings initiatives tied to the audits done by Eversource and consultants.
- To complete the replacement of the Chiller system serving the Police Station.
- To complete the design and replacment of the exterior stairs and sidewalks at the rear of building.

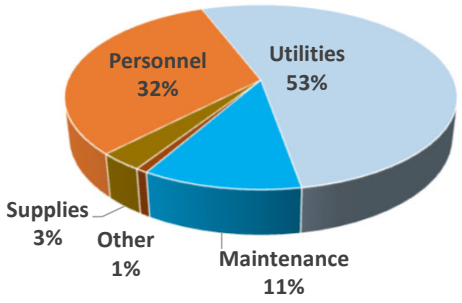
PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	56,343	58,602	63,090	65,941	68,861	2,920	4.4%
Operating Expenses	$	148,068	171,958	139,244	146,755	146,755	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	204,411	230,561	202,335	212,696	215,616	2,920	1.4%

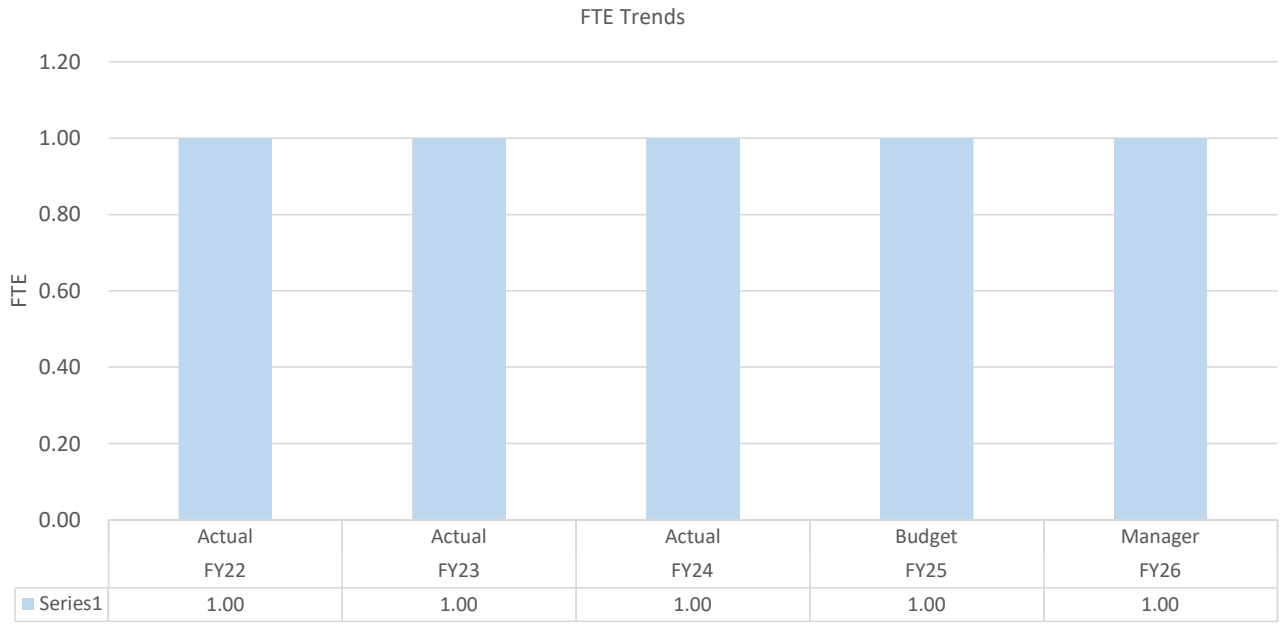
Major Components:
Personnel Services include the salary for a full-time Custodian, a weekend Custodian, and overtime.

Operating Expenses include, Maintenance (contracted services for the elevator, HVAC, security system, building, grounds, and equipment maintenance), Utilities (heating fuel, electricity, water, sewer, and trash removal) Supplies (cleaning supplies and uniforms).

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services increasing due to projected step increases.



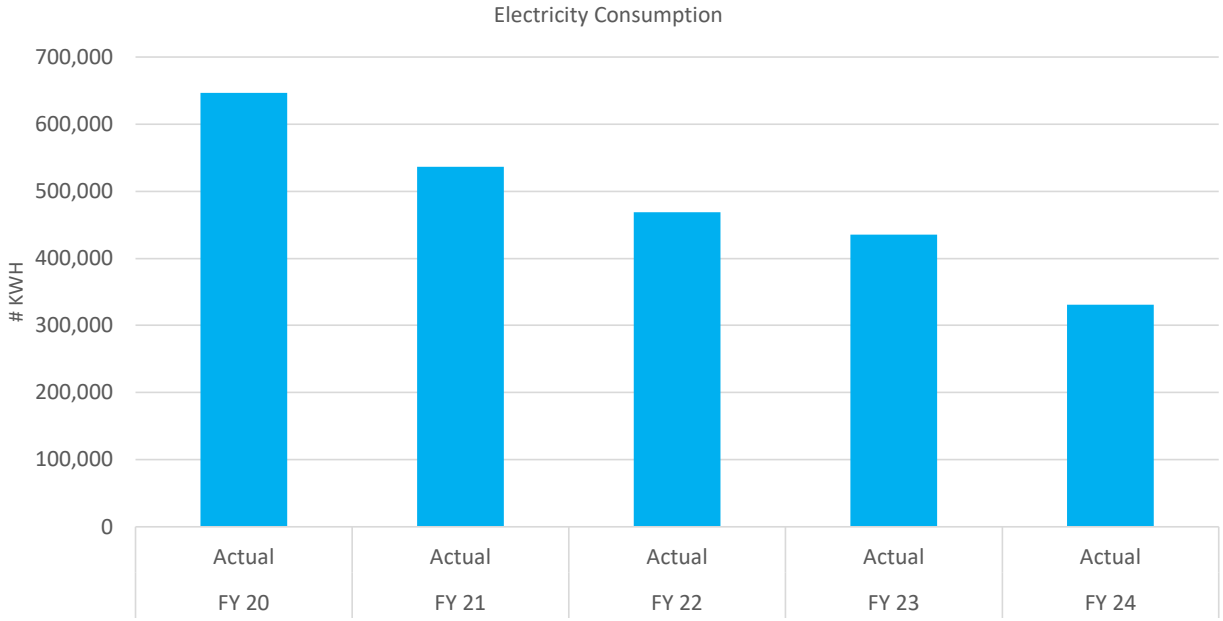
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE FACILITY (2195)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Fuel (Gas) (ccf)	13,932	16,210	16,409	17,420	17,022
Electricity (kWH)	647,040	536,960	468,800	435,680	330,560
Water and Sewer (cu. ft.)	22,800	26,600	25,200	24,600	22,300
Hours of Operation (weekly)	168	168	168	168	168
Usable space (sq. ft.)	24,865	24,865	24,865	24,865	24,865
Meetings Scheduled (Conference)	94	61	64	76	98
Meetings Scheduled (Community)	58	47	90	77	66

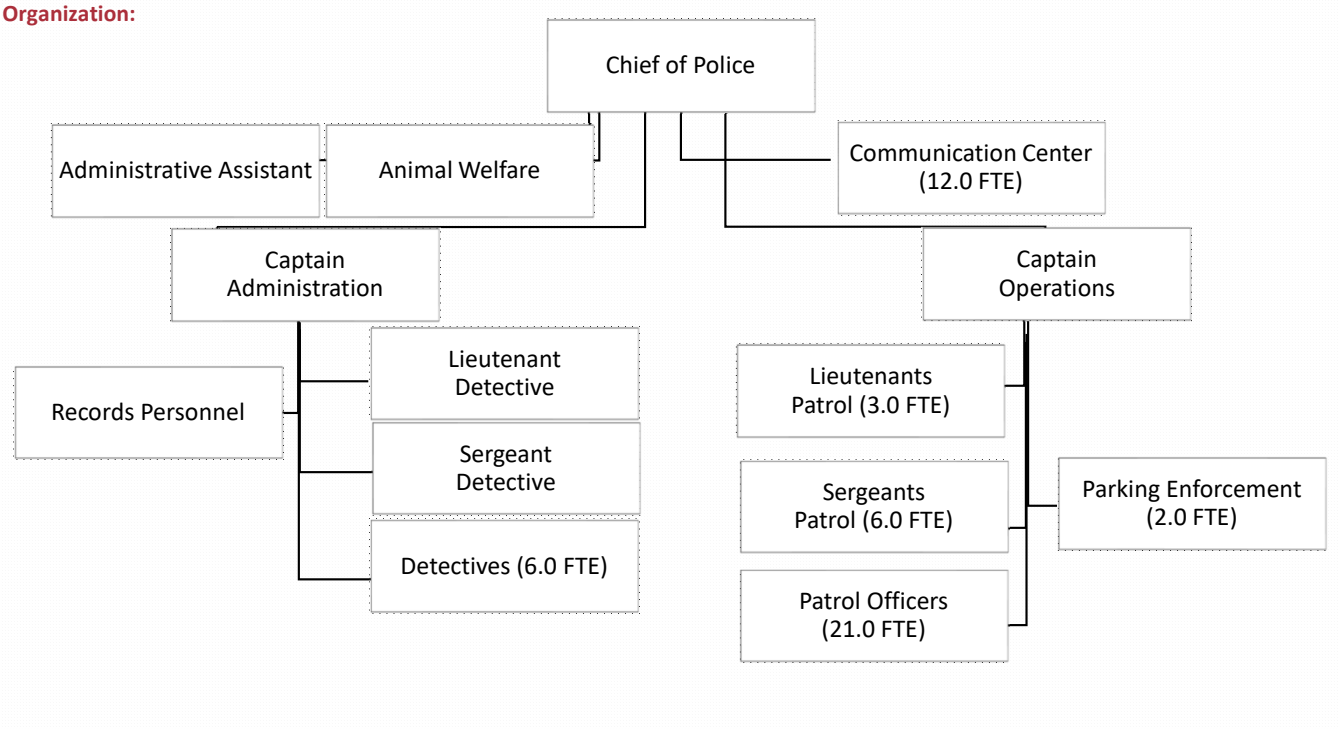
Notable Trends:
None.



PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

Function: The Amherst Police Department (APD) values the dedication and integrity of all members of the Department. APD values the diversity of the Amherst community and is grateful for its support and partnership. APD strives to protect the safety, rights, and property of every person within the Town. APD holds itself to the highest professional and ethical standards

Organization:



(Photo of Amherst Police Officers)

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Department expanded outreach efforts to include a liaison to the LGTBQ+ community.
- Successful recruitment and training plan to fill vacant positions.
- Successfully completed the rigorous three-year assessment required by the Massachusetts Police Accreditation Commission.
- Began implementation of a succession plan for replacing retiring command level officers.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- Continue to adapt to the changing and demanding language as the Massachusetts Peace Officers Standards & Training Commission (POST) commission evolves.
- Provide additional training for new academy level recruits.
- Reimagine and expand our existing community outreach efforts.
- Adapt a more contemporary promotion examination process for first line supervisors.
- Continue to collaborate with the CRESS Department for policy development.
- Reinvent and establish an annual community police academy.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To support the growth and evolution of the CRESS Department. **ONGOING**
- To review and re-shape exisiting policies to meet the updated Massachusetts Police Accreditation Commission standards. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To create a strategic succession plan for existing and anticipated command vacancies. **ACCOMPLISHED**/**ONGOING**
- To continue to meet certification standards established by Massachusetts POST Commission. **ACCOMPLISHED**/**ONGOING**
- To reach 100 % of all Town departments with Alert, Lockdown, Inform, Counter, Evacuate (ALICE) training to provide a safety plan. **ONGOING**
- To work with the Town management to develop new approaches to maintaining community safety. **ONGOING**
- To adjust with the demands of a "New-Norm" in policing while navigating changes with the Police Reform Act. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To develop policies and investigate budget implications of body-worn cameras. **ONGOING**
- To fully staff our sworn personnel to the allotted levels. **ACCOMPLISHED**/**ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To support the growth and evolution of the CRESS Department.
- To create a strategic succession plan for existing and anticipated command vacancies.
- To continue to meet certification standards established by Massachusetts POST Commission.
- To reach 100 % of all Town departments with Alert, Lockdown, Inform, Counter, Evacuate (ALICE) training to provide a safety plan.
- To work with the Town management to develop new approaches to maintaining community safety.
- To develop policies and investigate budget implications of body-worn cameras.
- To fully staff our sworn personnel to the allotted levels.

PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

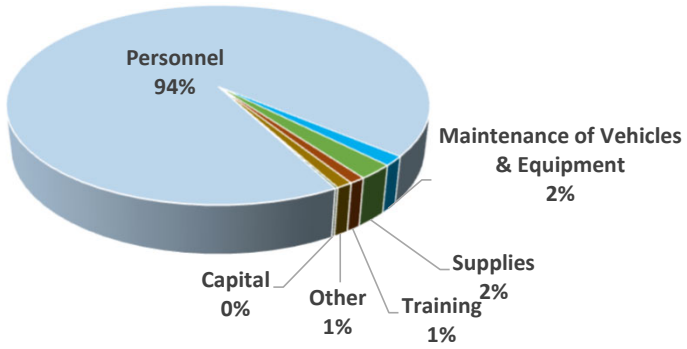
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	4,629,412	4,631,943	4,825,562	5,137,336	4,967,478	(169,858)	-3.3%
Operating Expenses	$	318,595	328,870	306,804	317,250	317,250	-	--
Operating Capital	$	15,852	1,443	1,433	10,300	10,300	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	4,963,860	4,962,257	5,133,799	5,464,886	5,295,028	(169,858)	-3.1%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Chief, 2 Captains, 4 Lieutenants, 6 Detectives, 7 Sergeants, 25 Officers, and 2 Support Staff. Also included are educational incentives and overtime.

Operating Expenses include, Maintenance (vehicles serviced by outside vendor, radio equipment, breathalyzers, etc.), Supplies (gasoline, tires, vehicle supplies, office and computer supplies, and uniforms), Other (dues and subscriptions, meals for prisoners, photography supplies, police physicians, telephones, printing and advertising, towing, etc.).

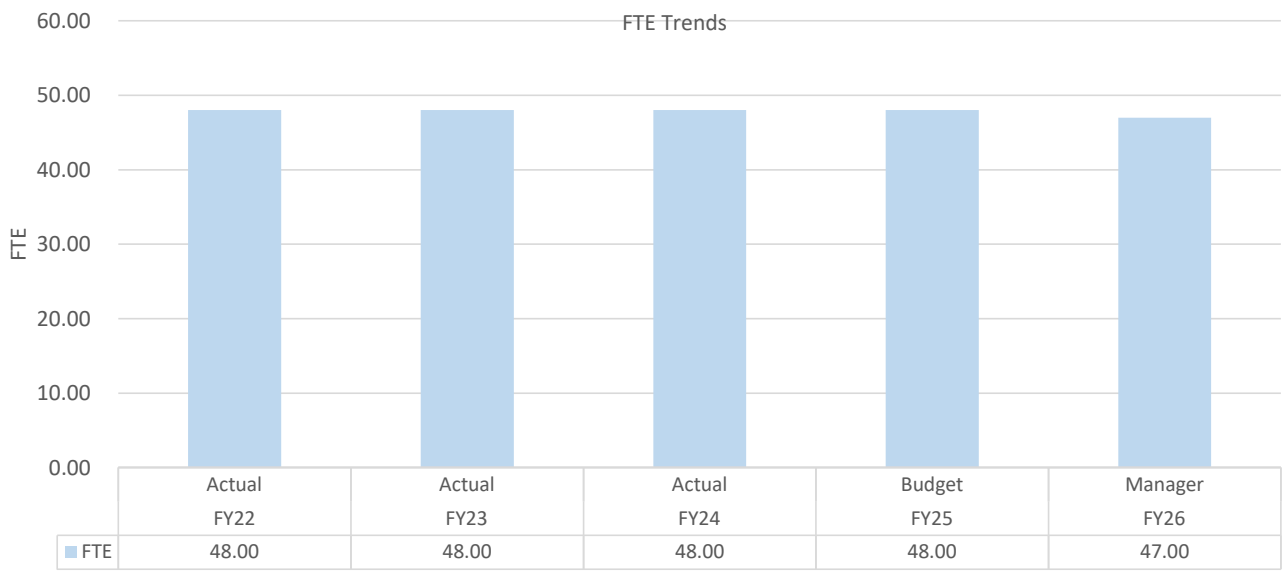
Operating Capital include small equipment,



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services decreasing due to freezing one FTE as well as staff transitions.

Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: POLICE (2210)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Calls for Service	16,632	16,362	16,380	13,920	17,472
Total Officers Responding	21,717	21,420	21,651	18,752	22,521
Arrests, Summons, TBL	672	986	833	554	800
Disorderly Conduct Arrests	44	26	43	19	46
Resisting Arrest	14	8	11	9	15
Assaulting a Police Officer	9	6	14	6	15
Operating Under the Influence Arrests	53	72	145	74	50
Under 21 Alcohol Arrests	81	97	85	11	51
Protective Custody	23	5	2	10	8
Homicide	1	0	0	0	0
Rape	9	13	16	11	14
Sexual Assaults (other)	34	25	36	37	32
Deaths	21	15	31	25	15
Robbery	2	0	1	0	1
Aggravated Assaults	6	8	10	11	17
Assault	25	18	38	19	39
Burglary	37	25	25	29	14
Motor Vehicle Burglary	17	19	14	36	35
Larceny	113	100	136	101	105
Motor Vehicle Thefts	16	11	9	0	4
209A-Restraining Order	290	248	299	247	234
Domestic Violence	212	200	166	188	177
Vandalism	95	80	126	108	62
Missing Person	12	12	11	26	18
Disturbances (Disturb, Fight, Noise)	1,041	1,132	1,082	830	809
Suspicious Activity	963	935	1,100	889	806
Assist Citizen	679	597	723	684	768
Medical Assists	536	216	292	295	588
Assist Fire Department	129	110	112	85	121
Community Outreach	579	451	357	428	619
Mental/Med Assist	351	902	566	776	454
Motor Vehicle Crashes	624	423	633	665	642
Alarms	470	405	441	395	432
Motor Vehicle Violations	1,441	2,446	2,348	2,236	3,188
Nuisance House Violations	2	12	17	4	25
Co-responses with CSO	0	0	0	0	242
Shoplifting	25	14	11	12	22

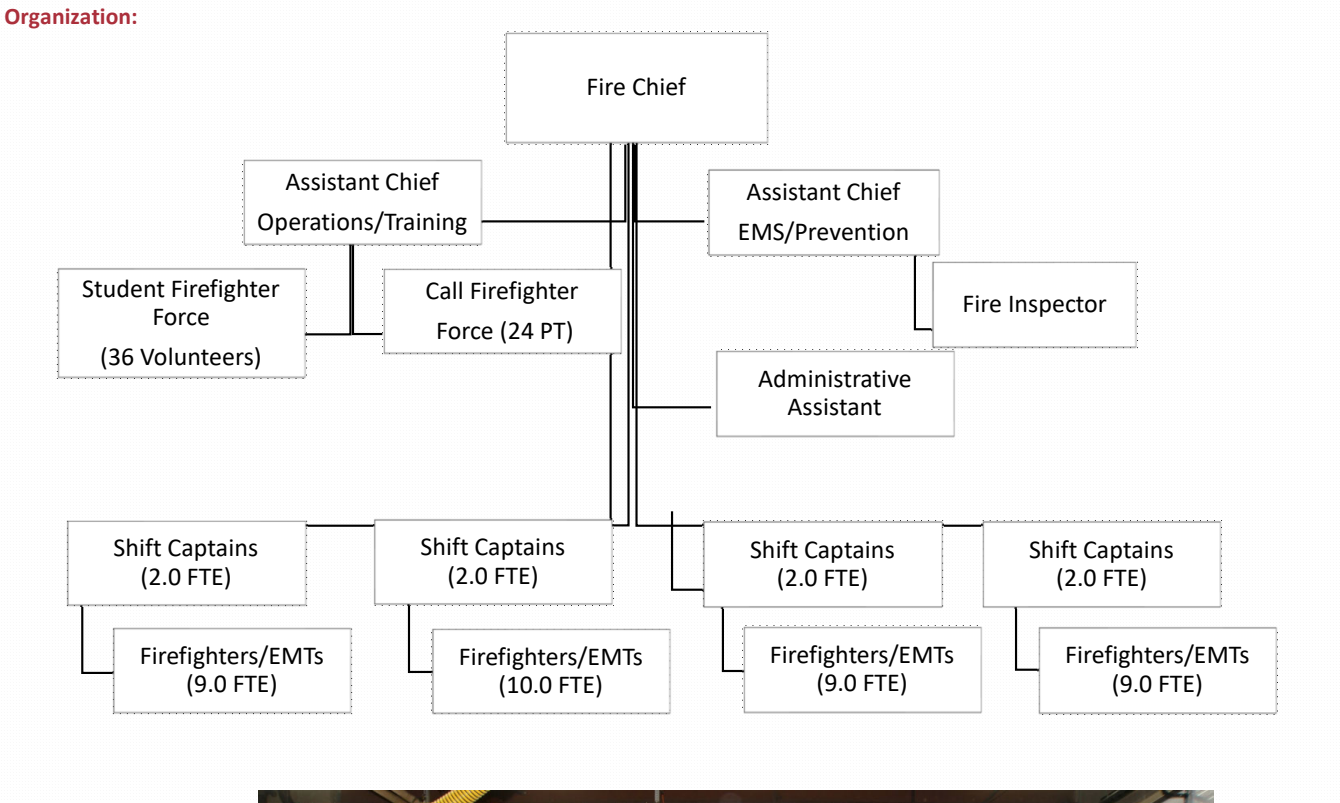
Notable Trends:
Mental/Med Assist calls are on the rise.

For more information, visit the Police Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3558/Police

PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

Function: To enhance the quality of life in the Amherst community by providing quality emergency and support services. The Department strives to be a leader in "All Hazards" preparation, response, mitigation, and recovery. The Department provides the highest level of service as it conducts fire suppression, emergency medical services, rescue services, fire prevention, safety education, hazardous material incident response, and disaster operations.

Organization:



(Photo of Town of Amherst Firefighters)

PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Hired 3 fulltime Firefighter/EMTs who are attending paramedic school. These 3 replace personnel who have retired and to fill open positions.
- Four newer members who obtained their paramedic certification attended and graduated from the Massachusetts Fire Academy Recruit training program.
- Hired and trained three new part-time call Firefighters.
- Received grants to purchase Protective gear for firefighters, to purchase new thermal imaging cameras, to replace fit-testing maching for respirators, and to purchase needed firefighting equipment.
- Particpated in numerous public outreach events including School S.A.F.E. and Senior S.A.F.E programs in the schools and at the Senior Center, Central Station Open House, Town Block Party, 1st Day celebration, and Community Safety Day to share safety information.
- Collaborated with the Regional High School as part of its career days showcasing the Fire/Rescue/EMS career field, as well as career outreach at Greenfield Community College.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain full-time staffing in light of a highly competitive employment environment and shifting demographics.
- To address the dwindling number of part-time Call Force staff and difficulty in recruiting.
- To sustain a vehicle fleet and its maintenance needs given the challenge of longer delivery times for new vehicles, replacement parts, and equipment, combined with escalating costs.
- To continue to support and advocate for the replacement of the Central Fire Station.
- To complete the sustainability and maintenance plan for North Station.
- To determine the viability of Community Paramedicine (CP) and its impact on the way the Town delivers EMS.
- To expand opportunities for non-Public Safety town employees to participate in emergency management training, to include development of plans for operation of Emergency Operations Center, Shelters, and other emergencies.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To fill 3 vacant positions with Firefighter/Paramedics, including four additional new positions which will add one person to each shift. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To fill vacant Call Firefighter positions. **ONGOING**
- To develop a repair and maintenance plan for Central Station. **ONGOING**
- To develop a Town Continuity of Operations Plan. **ONGOING**
- To collaborate and assist with the development and operation of the Community Responders for Equity, Safety and Service (CRESS) Department. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To begin design phase of New Fire Station. **ONGOING**
- To complete an update of the Town Hazard Mitigation Plan. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To fill vacant fulltime positions with Firefighter/Paramedics.
- To fill vacant Call Firefighter positions.
- To complete replacement of radio communications system.
- To place in service the new Ladder-Tower truck with expected delivery in September 2025.
- To update and consolidate department rules and regulations and standard operating procedures.
- To develop a repair and maintenance plan for Central Station.
- To work with the Town Manager and building committee to select a site for new fire station and preliminary design plans.
- To develop a Town Continuity of Operations Plan.
- To complete update of the Town Hazard Mitigation Plan.

PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

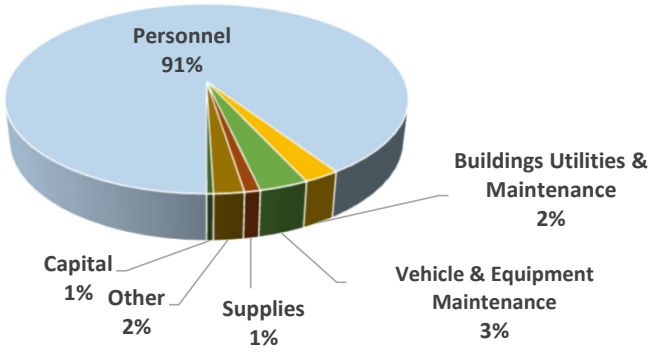
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	4,480,888	4,339,406	4,346,218	4,786,470	5,084,748	298,278	5.9%
Operating Expenses	$	483,428	578,150	567,243	496,020	496,020	-	--
Operating Capital	$	11,555	68,073	18,107	25,590	25,590	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	4,975,871	4,985,628	4,931,567	5,308,080	5,606,358	298,278	5.3%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Chief, 2 Assistant Chiefs, 8 Captains, 38 Firefighters, and one Support Staff. All staff (excluding support staff) are EMTs, 91% of whom are certified as Paramedics. Other costs include overtime, education incentive, and Call Firefighter Force.

Operating Expenses include, Building and Grounds Maintenance some of which is provided by firefighting staff, Utilities (fuel, electricity, water/sewer, etc.), Vehicle and Equipment Maintenance (25 vehicles, communication equipment, emergency medical equipment), Supplies (gas and diesel, medical supplies, and departmental).

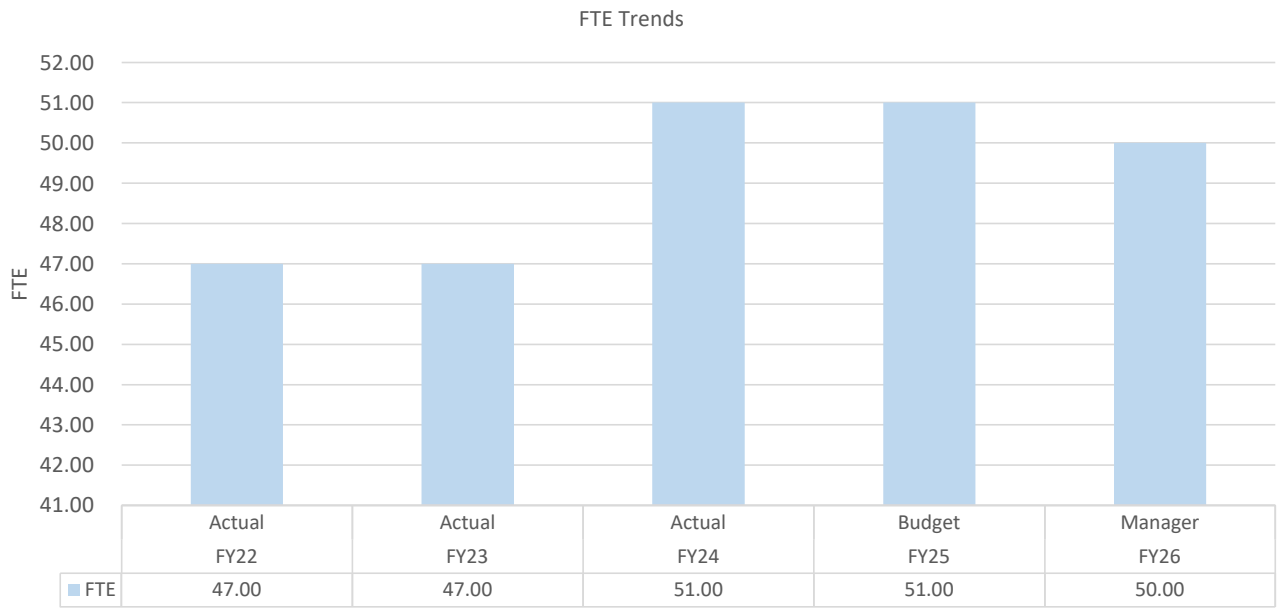
Operating Capital includes small equipment.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected step and cost of living adjustment wage increases. One FTE is being frozen for FY26.

Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: FIRE/EMS (2220)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Total Emergency Responses	5,429	5,116	6,799	6,772	7,345
Fire Responses:					
Total Fire Calls:	1,737	1,852	2,380	2,420	2,652
Fires (all types)	98	83	82	77	58
Rescue (includes MVCs)	523	848	1,163	1,169	1,197
Hazardous Materials	46	31	43	38	38
Hazardous Conditions	48	41	34	35	24
Other Alarms:	206	179	180	214	272
False/Accidental:	816	670	878	887	1,063
Station Coverage Requests					
Permanent Force:	110	99	128	108	125
Call Force:	74	58	88	70	55
Student Force:	61	14	67	60	52
Injuries Due to Fires:	0	0	0	0	2
Fire Deaths:	0	0	0	0	0
Firefighter Injuries:	22	14	15	26	19
Firefighter Lost Time Injuries:	2	5	9	11	14
Ambulance Responses:					
Total EMS Calls:	3,692	3,428	4,423	4,352	4,693
Advanced Life Support (ALS) level:	1,665	1,100 *	2,610	2,738	2,202
Basic Life Support (BLS) level:	884	1,240 *	1,558	1,407	995
Patient Contacts:	3,969	3,111	4,262	4,145	4,436
Patient Contacts; Treat; No Transport:	289	771	1,033	333	1,164
Patients Transported by AFD:	2,549	2,340	3,147	3,143	3,197
Mutual Aid Ambulance into Amherst:	86	52	127	95	141
Mutual Aid Ambulances out of Amherst:	81	97	162	247	195
Fire Mutual Aid into Amherst:	2	0	0	3	2
Fire Mutual Aid out of Amherst:	18	8	20	11	13
Fire Inspections/Prevention:					
Residential Smoke Detectors:	229	341	667	272	257
Misc. Inspections:	570	554	544	632	702
University/Colleges:	187	61	63	87	78
Fire Education:	30	54	62	72	85

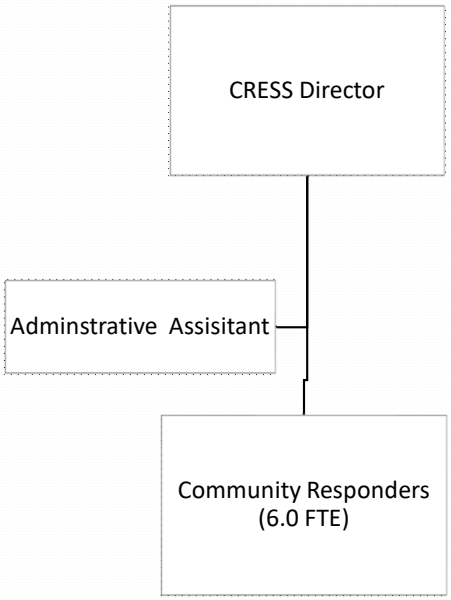
Notable Trends:
Our senior population continues to be the leading demographic in terms of growth, although all types of EMS calls and populations are seeing an increase.

For more information, visit the Fire Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/124/Fire

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Function: The Community Responders for Equity, Safety, and Service (CRESS) Department's mission is to fill service gaps in the Town and to connect people to services and resources. CRESS is an unarmed public safety department that supports the Amherst community. Its work is rooted in trauma-informed and anti-racist frameworks. The Department provides community safety services in situations that do not involve violence or serious crime.

Organization:



(Photo of CRESS Director Camille Theriaque and CRESS Responders)

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Successful continuation of the Department of Public Health (DPH) Equitable Approaches to Public Safety (EAPS) State grant ($450,000).
- Accepted as member of the Council of State Governments (CSG) and Center for Policing Equity (CPE) learning Community for Policing Alternatives "Community and Crisis Response Teams to Improve Responses to Youth".
- Lead staff presented at a national conference.
- Hosted bimonthly "Veteran Community Breakfast for All".
- Continued to increase call volume.
- All CRESS Responders trained in 40-hour Critical Incident Training (CIT).
- 87% of CRESS Response Team trained in 24-hour Youth Critical Incident Training (CIT).
- All members of the CRESS Department are trained as American Red Cross BLS Provider (CPR & AED).
- Started monthly CRESS Newsletter with Department Call Statistics.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To create policies, procedures, and protocols and continue to develop working relationships with community stakeholders (Craig's Doors, Clinical Support Options, Amherst Survival Center, the local colleges and university, Eliot Homeless Services, etc.) and Town departments (Police, Fire, Senior Center, DEI, Public Health, DPW, Recreation, Jones Library, public schools, Town Clerk, Community Participation Officers).
- To host quarterly public forums with Community Stakeholders and Town Residents to uphold contractual obligations.
- To provide on-going professional development training for CRESS Responders including core competencies such as racial justice, motivational interviewing, alternatives to suicide, hearing voices, and trauma-informed care.
- Establish additional call types with our public safety partners: police, fire, and dispatch to become fully operational in Dispatch.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To develop department staffing to include a clinical component.
- To expand dispatch call types to be fully operational in Dispatch.
- To expand connections to local social service organizations and agencies.
- To implement software for data collection (Qualtrics) to capture the qualitative and quantitative impact of the CRESS Department.

Upcoming Objectives:

- To expand department staffing to include administrative support and clinical component. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To expand dispatch call types. **ONGOING**
- To expand connections to local social service organizations and agencies. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To join UMass/Town of Amherst on-call meeting group. **ONGOING**
- To implement software for data collection (Qualtrics) to capture the qualitative and quantitative impact of the CRESS Department. **ONGOING**
- To update and revise CRESS Department website. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To develop a resource guide. **ACCOMPLISHED**

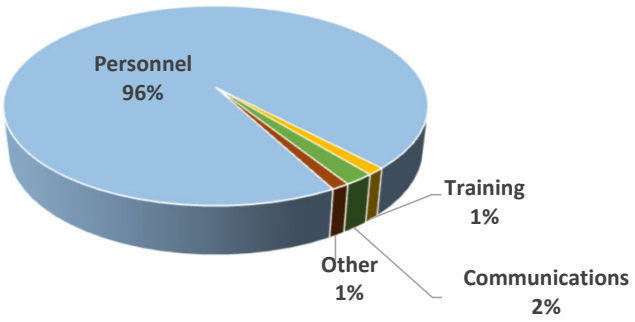
PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	16,069	334,827	429,950	610,015	490,039	(119,976)	-19.7%
Operating Expenses	$	-	10,738	25,314	23,000	23,000	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	16,069	345,565	455,264	633,015	513,039	(119,976)	-19.0%

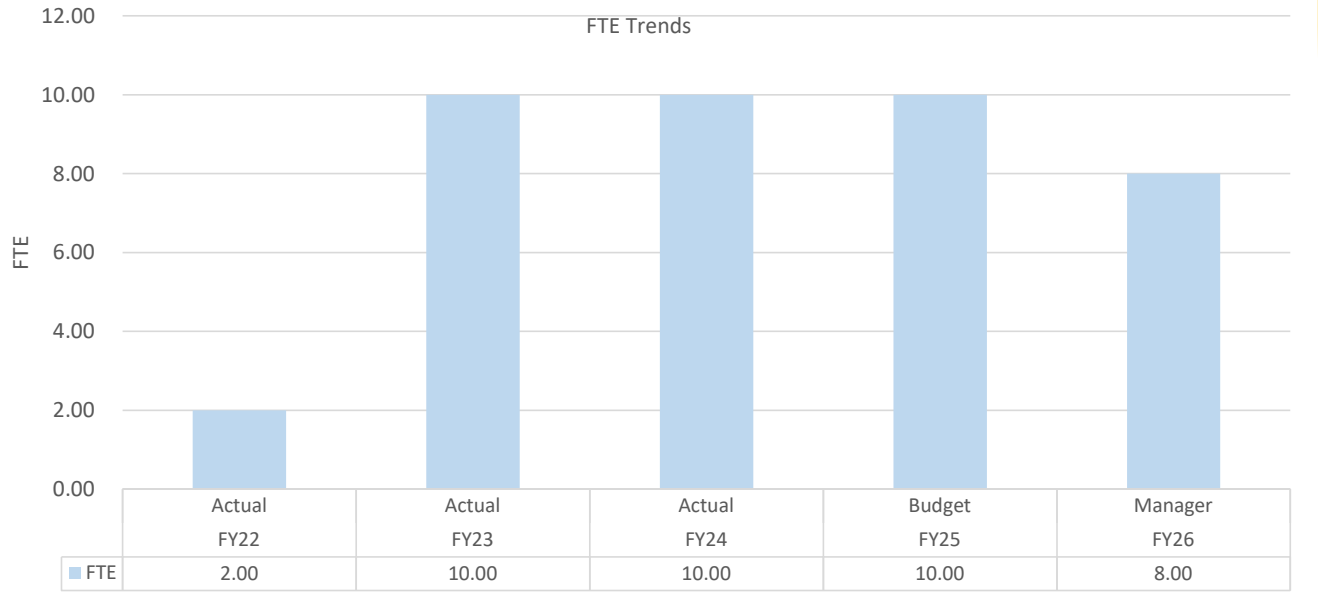
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for one Director, one Administrative Assistant, and six Community Responders.

Operating Expenses include training, office supplies, vehicle maintenance, communications, uniforms, and dues and subscriptions.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services decreases are due to freezing two FTE's.



Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNITY RESPONDERS FOR EQUITY, SAFETY, AND SERVICE (2230)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Total calls for service	0	0	0	199	502
Total Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) calls (began 12/18/23)	0	0	0	25	502
Direct calls for service (bypassed from dispatch)	0	0	0	24	492
Calls for serivce from dispatch	0	0	0	4	10
Community engagement/outreach	0	0	0	10	82
CRESS Follow-Up	0	0	0	1	43
CRESS Wellbeing Check	0	0	0	101	18
CRESS Mental Health	0	0	0	29	4
CRESS Assist Neighbor	0	0	0	5	119
CRESS Assist Business/Agency (includes departments)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	153
CRESS Admin	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	80
CRESS Assist AFD	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	1
CRESS Assist APD	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	1
CRESS Transport	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	1

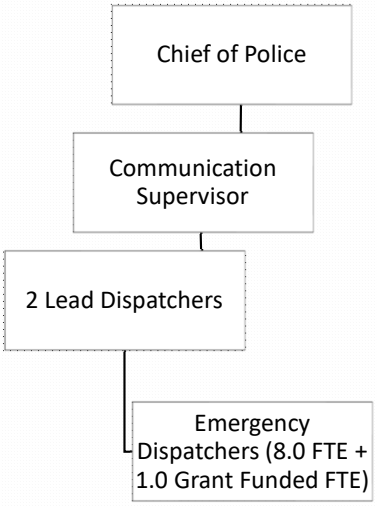
Notable Trends:
Increase in call volume.

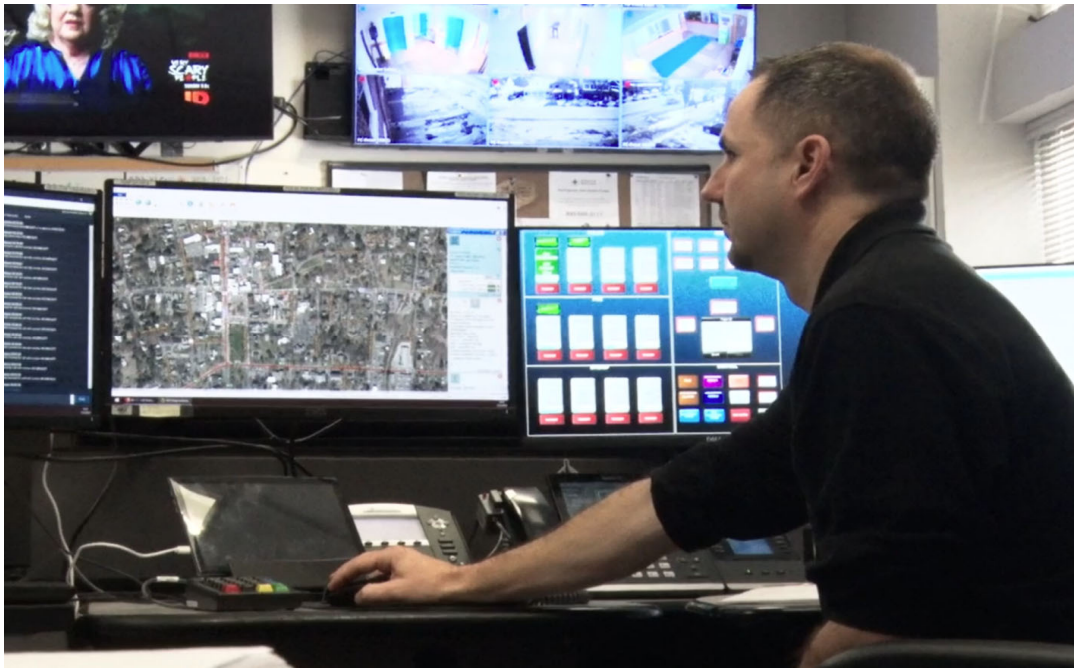
For more information, visit the CRESS Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3655/Community-Responders-for-Equity-Safety-S

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Function: To provide the public with the vital link to emergency services and to provide emergency service professionals who deliver expedient, courteous, and quality service. The Dispatch Center strives for excellence through dedication, training, and teamwork. This expectation of excellence extends beyond the Amherst border to neighbors in Pelham, Leverett, and Shutesbury.

Organization:





(Photo of Amherst Dispatch Center)

PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Received State 911 Support and Incentive Grant which supports funding of one full-time Emergency Dispatcher and supplements the departments overtime budget.
- Received State 911 Support Training Grant to provide mandatory and essential training for Emergency Dispatchers.
- Participated in multiple meetings, internal and external, in regards to the implementation of the CRESS program.
- Recruited, hired, trained, certified two new hires to fill open positions created by retirement and a departures.
- Ensured all staff retained State Certification as emergency dispatchers.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain health and safety standards, while continuing to staff a 24/7 operation.
- To work with the State 911 department to obtain necessary training to maintain certification.
- To maintain mandatory staffing levels while balancing long- and short-term leaves.
- To attract qualified candidates for open telecommunicator positions.
- To continue to upgrade the back-up communications center as new technology becomes available.
- To renovate the Communications Center to address space and ergonomic issues.
- To replace radio console equipment.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To replace current digital voice recorder used to record 911 calls, business line calls, police and fire radio transmissions. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To further integrate The Amherst Community Responders for Equity, Safety and Service into our dispatch policies and procedures. **ONGOING**
- To host State 911 approved and funded trainings. **ONGOING**
- To create further Police radio channel redundancy and to overcome some radio dead spots in Town through push to talk technology. **ONGOING**
- To investigate replacement, refresh, or upgrade of the computer aided dispatch software .**ONGOING**
- To address the need for proper staffing levels to provide coverage for known contractual leaves. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To further integrate the Community Responders for Equity, Safety and Service (CRESS) into our dispatch policies and procedures.
- To host State 911 approved and funded trainings.
- To extend Police radio channel redundancy and to address known radio dead spots in Town through push to talk technology.
- To investigate replacement, refresh, or upgrade of the computer aided dispatch software.
- To address the need for proper staffing levels to provide coverage for contractual leaves.

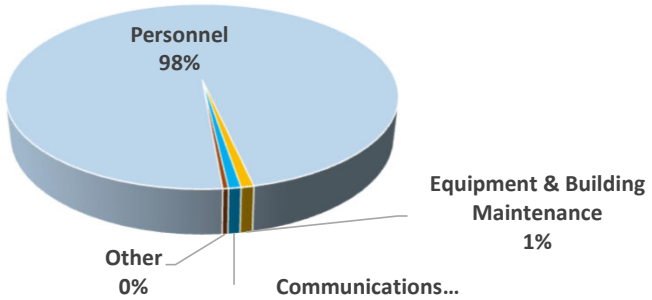
PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	721,696	743,983	778,820	799,791	799,965	174	0.0%
Operating Expenses	$	15,938	16,584	16,107	17,450	17,450	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	737,634	760,567	794,927	817,241	817,415	174	0.0%

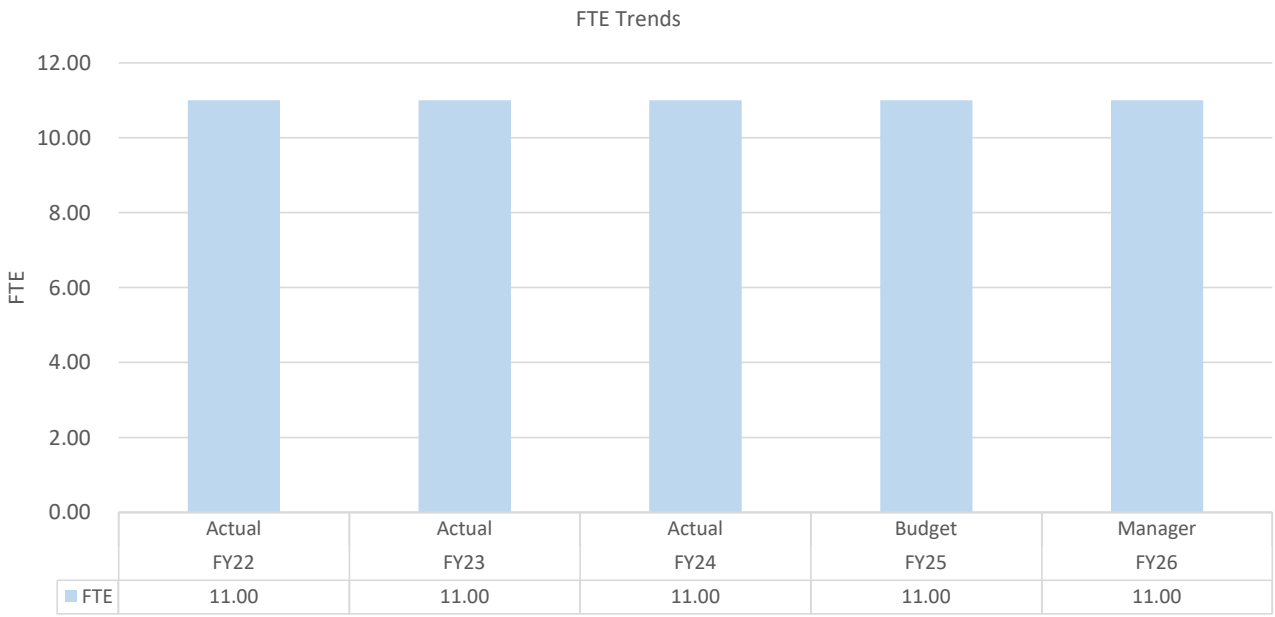
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for 11 full time Emergency Dispatchers and for overtime and holiday pay.

Other costs include maintenance contracts on radio communications equipment, specialized telephone/radio circuits, training, supplies, dues, and subscriptions.

Significant Changes:
None.



Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: COMMUNICATIONS CENTER (2290)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
911/Emergency Calls Received *	5,888	8,698	12,386	11,993	11,866
Business Line Calls	59,423	54,722	59,420	61,325	65,813
Radio Transmissions	134,730	129,353	136,594	132,971	144,640
Calls:					
Police	16,603	16,336	16,380	17,709	17,463
Fire/In Amherst	1,154	1,042	1,174	1,196	1,555
EMS/In Amherst	3,590	3,148	3,956	3,706	3,928
EMS Mutual Aid Management	90	52	138	134	163
Medical Emergencies Requiring:					
Emergency Medical Dispatching	2,964	2,657	3,079	2,837	3,173
Station Coverage	245	173	285	238	232
Animal Control	455	446	478	440	498
CRESS CAD Documentation	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	502
CRESS Calls Dispatched	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	10
CSO CADs	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	242
Other Fire/EMS Service Requests					
Leverett (E)	81	100	108	124	158
Pelham (E)	98	111	118	140	160
Shutesbury (E)	107	77	103	101	80
Mutual Aid (E)	81	98	158	247	187
Mutual Aid (F)	18	8	19	12	13
Out of District Paramedic Intercept	1	15	12	21	20
Regional Hazmat Activations	26	27	N/A	N/A	N/A
CAD Calls Initiated	22,356	21,464	23,217	20,509	24,549
Burning Permits Processed	443	328	453	311	396
Fire Service Inspections	257	436	489	342	269

Notable Trends:

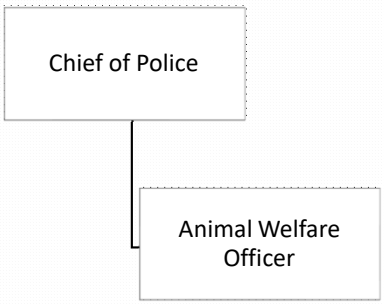
*Data was sourced via State 911 Dept Database that tracks our call volume. 9,443 911 Calls,+29 text to 911 + 2,423 Fire Alarm, Medical & Burglar Alarm Co calling on secondary emergency line.

For more information, visit the Communications Center webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/282/Communications

PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Function: Animal Welfare is committed to protecting the health and safety of the community through the effective control of animals. The Town provides responsible pet care through public education of the leash law, license requirements, and other Town policies relative to the welfare of animals. Animal Welfare strives to find solutions to address disputes with and between dog owners.

Organization:



(Photo of Animal Welfare Officer, Carol Hepburn)

PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Recent Accomplishments:

- The Friends of the Amherst Dog Park now oversee the new Dog Park and perform regular maintenance.
- Investigated twelve dog bite incidents throughout Town.
- A new shed was constructed and placed at the dog shelter.
- Coordinated with the Conservation Department for anticipated increase use of Conservation lands and trails.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- Developed a Memorandum of Agreement with the Town of Hadley for occassional use of the dog shelter.
- Manage the uptick in dead bird investigations due to the transmission of bird flu.
- To continue to educate and enforce the leash law which is a constant issue.
- To achieve 100% compliance with dog licensing.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To work with the Conservation Department to develop dog park oversight. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To develop an internship program. **ONGOING**
- To continue the successful placement rate of 100% for all animals brought to the shelter through adoption, rescue organizations, and by utilizing foster homes. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To work with the Conservation Department to support management of new trails at Hickory Ridge and Robert Frost trails.
- To continue inspections of all barns with farm animals.
- To continue monthly inspections of farm animals per agreement with the MSPCA from a previous investigation.
- To continue the successful placement of 100% for all animals brought to the shelter through adoption, rescue organizations, and by utilizing foster homes.

PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	61,282	62,286	62,657	64,493	64,610	117	0.2%
Operating Expenses	$	5,338	5,809	5,032	7,505	7,505	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	66,620	68,095	67,689	71,998	72,115	117	0.2%

Major Components:

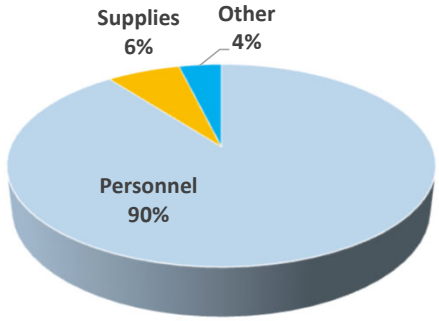
Personnel Services include funding for a full-time Animal Welfare Officer and overtime.

Supplies, provide for gasoline and other vehicle supplies, uniforms, and office supplies.

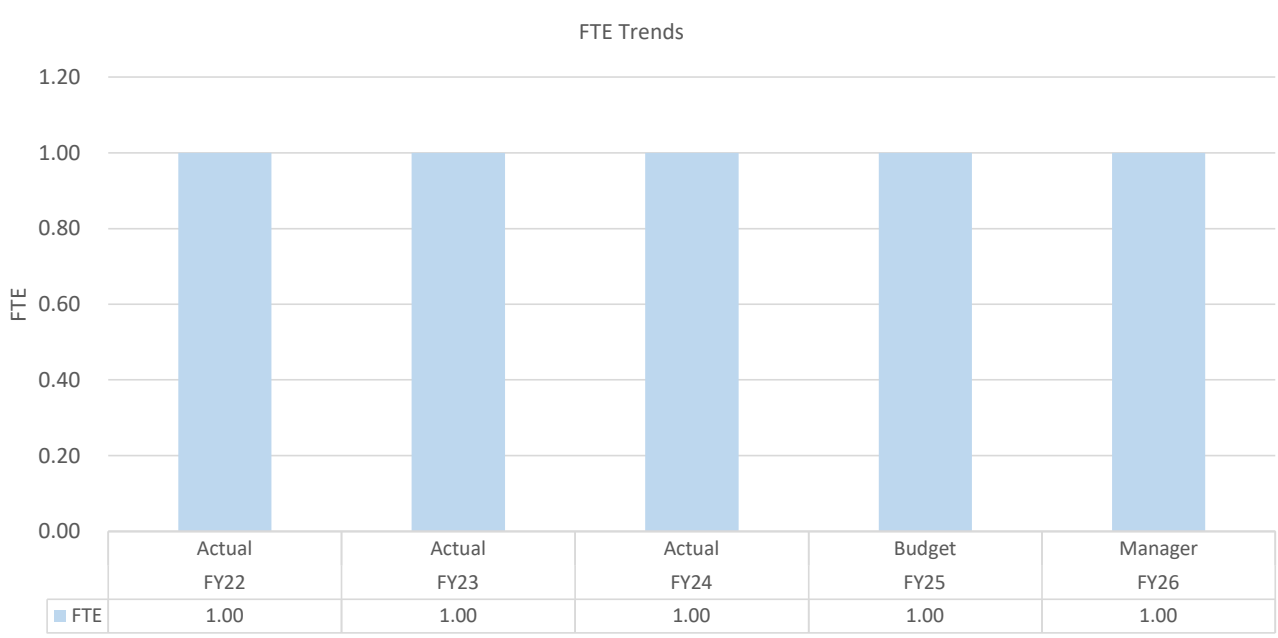
Other expenses include funds for veterinary expenses, vehicle maintenance, telephone, dog food, and other miscellaneous expenses.

Significant Changes:

None.



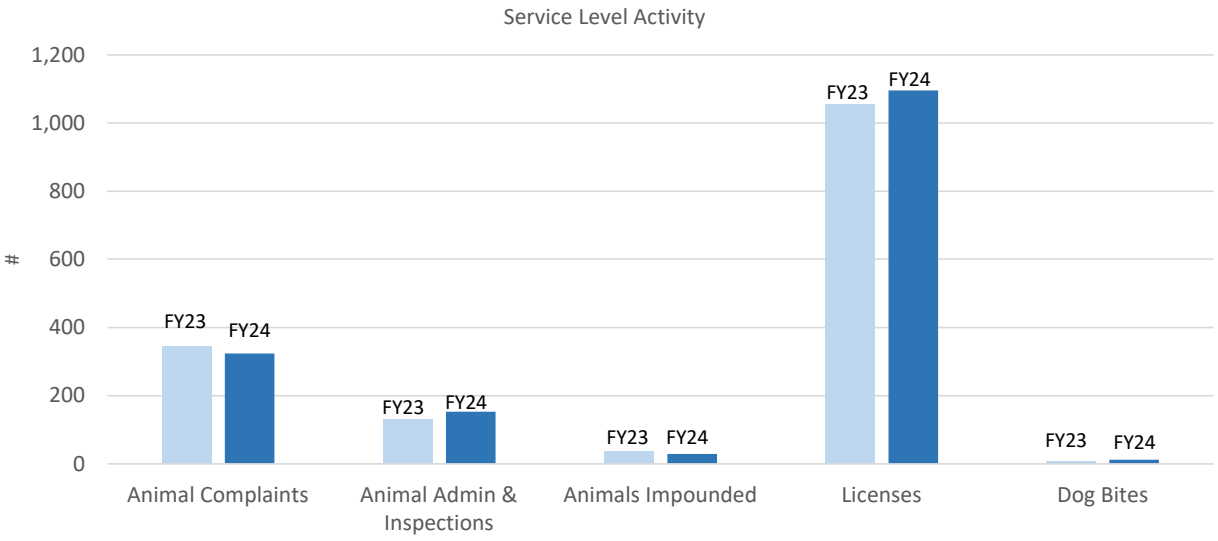
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC SAFETY: ANIMAL WELFARE (2291)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Animal Complaints	379	399	359	345	324
Animal Admin & Inspections	76	67	125	131	153
Animals Impounded	26	18	21	38	29
Licenses	897	1,133	949	1,054	1,096
Dog Bites	14	13	10	9	12

Notable Trends:
None.

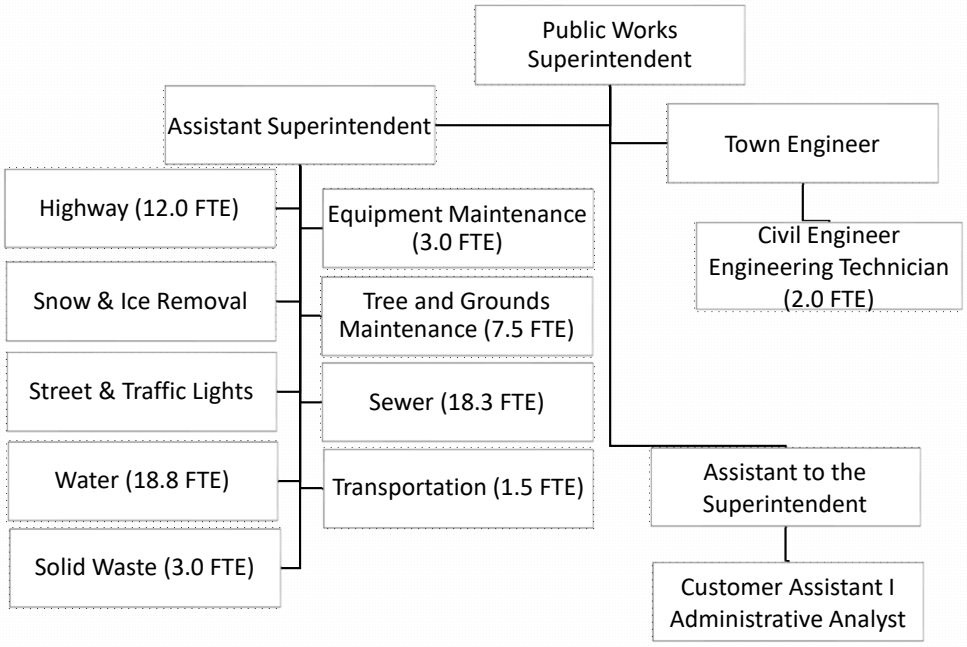


For more information, visit the Animal Welfare webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/279/Animal-Welfare

PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Function: To manage all public works functions and activities in a manner that protects the health and safety of Amherst residents and visitors.

Organization:



(Photo of the revitalized North Common)

PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Obtained new Water Permit.
- Managed the annual paving contract.
- Managed the annual sidewalk and crosswalk repair contract.
- Managed the annual cracksealing contract.
- Received State MVP (Municipal Vulnerability Preparedness) Grant for two culvert replacements.
- Received a significant MassWorks Grant for Amity Street and University Drive intersection improvements.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To recruit and maintain a qualified and capable Public Works staff while managing significant retirement and turnover in the public works field with a shortfall of skilled workers.
- To implement the next phase of the Environmental Protection Agency's Phase II Stormwater program. This will include identifying stormwater outfalls and potential areas of concern.
- To continue to develop and manage numerous Town projects.
- To balance the need to maintain the existing infrastructure with the newly built infrastructure with limited budget.
- To develop work plans with equipment that meet the Town's goal for carbon reduction while maintaining or improving service levels.
- To implement the next phase of the Department of Public Works (DPW) headquarters replacement project as recommended by the feasibility study.
- To develop funding and other strategies to address the need for road repairs.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue construction management of the replacement Centennial Water Treatment Facility. **ONGOING**
- To continue management of the installation of the Gravity Belt Thickener at the Wastewater Treatment Facility. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To continue management of the schematic design phase of the DPW facilities plan including planning for transitioning to alternative locations to facilitate construction of the DPW. **ONGOING**
- To complete the construction of the 2024 Concrete Asphalt Rehabilitation Project (CARP, to include sidewalks on the South Common, a section of Belchertown Road and West Street at the Potwine Lane Intersection. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To complete construction of upgraded sidewalks on North Pleasant Street near Puffton Village. **ONGOING**
- To begin construction of Amity St & University Dr Roundabout. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue construction management of the replacement Centennial Water Treatment Facility.
- To continue management of the schematic design phase of the DPW facilities plan including planning for transitioning to alternative locations to facilitate construction of the DPW.
- To complete the construction of the 2025 Concrete Asphalt Rehabilitation Project (CARP, to include sidewalks on Chestnut Street, North Whitney and North Pleasant St).
- To complete construction of upgraded sidewalks on North Pleasant Street near Puffton Village.
- To begin construction of Amity Street and University Drive intersection improvements.

PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	396,191	396,385	429,124	419,842	429,044	9,202	2.2%
Operating Expenses	$	48,350	47,328	37,306	40,700	40,700	-	--
Operating Capital	$	6,682	1,462	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	451,223	445,175	466,430	460,542	469,744	9,202	2.0%

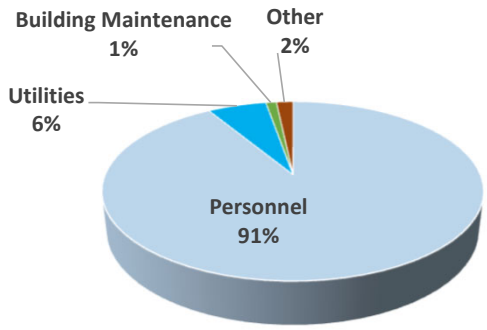
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Superintendent of Public Works, an Administrative Assistant, and 1/3 each of the Assistant Superintendent/Operations Director, a Management Assistant, an Administrative Analyst, an Engineering Technician, the Town Engineer, and the Assistant Town Engineer shared with the Water and Sewer Funds.

Building Maintenance, includes the cost of routine maintenance of the Public Works facility. Custodial and maintenance tasks are performed by staff in other public works budgets.

Utilities, include heating fuel, electricity, and water and sewer.

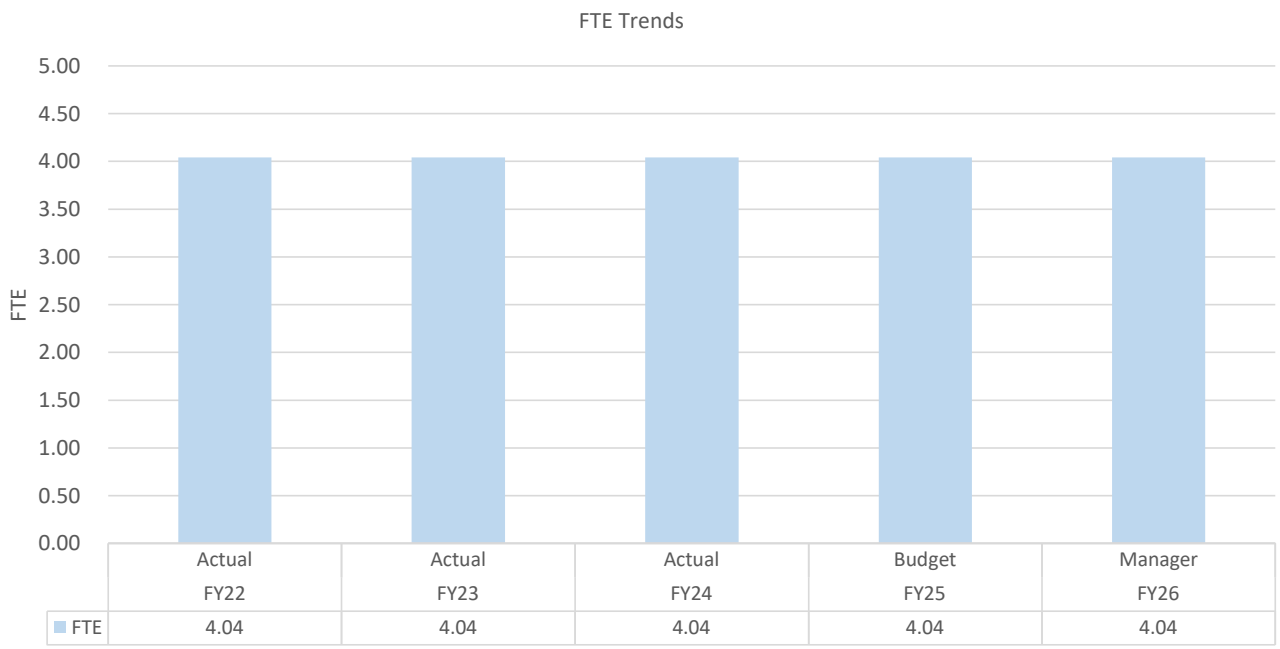
Other expenses include postage, office supplies, dues and subscriptions, etc.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected step increases.

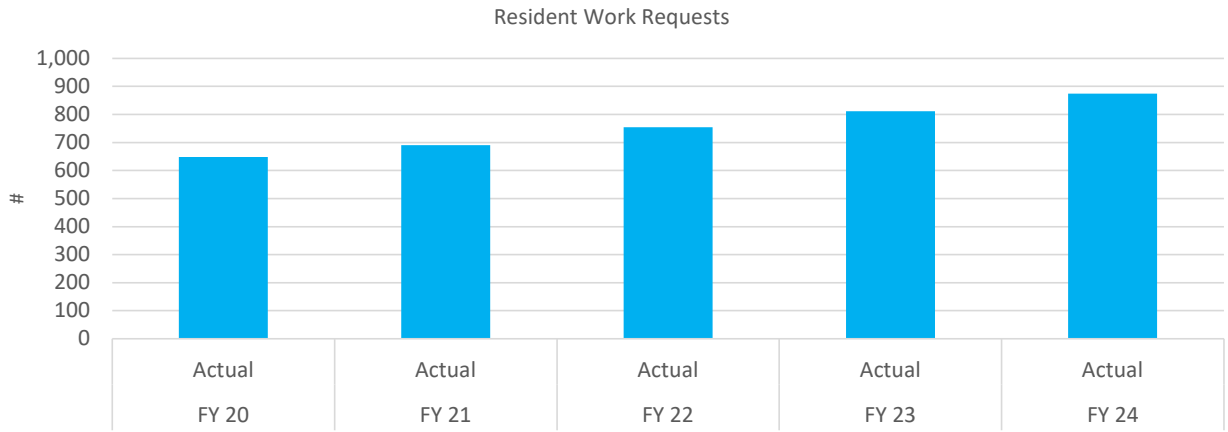
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: PUBLIC WORKS ADMINISTRATION (4410)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Resident Work Requests	648	690	754	811	874
Driveway Permits	43	59	55	36	53
General Excavation Permits	79	81	51	61	65
Sale of Cemetery Lots	10	12	11	7	1
Specifications Prepared	6	6	13	11	15
Refuse Disposal Billing	742	675	623	628	523
Water Permits: New Services & Relays	24	21	13	12	13
Water & Wastewater Reports	240	240	240	240	240
Wastewater Reports to EPA	12	12	12	12	12
Sewer Entrance Permits	27	18	14	13	13
Committees Staffed	3	3	3	3	3
Subdivision (Review and Support to Planning Dept.)					
Engineering Review	0	0	2	0	2
Construction Oversight	3	6	7	4	1
Site Plan Review (private project reviews)	53	35	33	28	32
Project Design:					
In House	29	34	21	18	19
Consultant	10	16	7	4	3
Construction Oversight:					
Contractor Work	6	9	15	10	13
DPW Crews	6	6	6	5	2
Contractor/Consultant	7	6	5	3	4

Notable Trends:
Demands by residents for work requests continues to escalate.

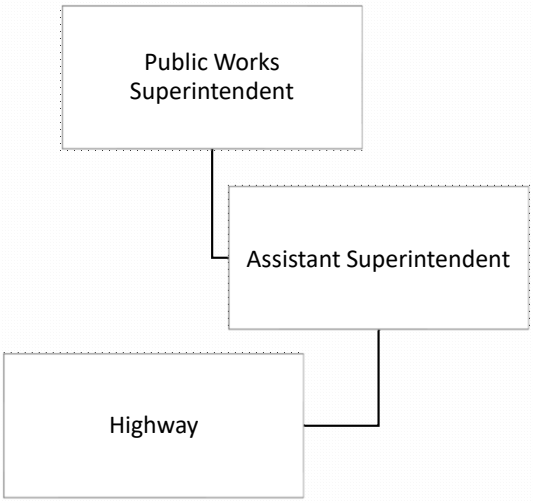


For more information, visit the Department of Public Works webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/149/Public-Works

PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Function: To maintain the highways, streets, and sidewalks of the Town at a safe usable level based on funding and user expectations. To provide support services to the other functional areas of the Department as needed.

Organization:



(Photo of DPW staff filling potholes)

PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Set up and removed parklets for the Business Improvement District (BID).
- Installed the new bridge rails and painted the old bridge rails on the Fort River Bridge on West Street.
- Installed eight new parking kiosk machines.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To effectively maintain roadside vegetation so that it is not an impediment to users of sidewalks, bike lanes, or the travel way.
- To retain current employees while recruiting replacements for current vacancies and provide training to upgrade employee skills.
- To address legacy private roads that need to be maintained by the property owners or properly upgraded and transferred to the public.
- To address, effectively and efficiently, resident work requests in the performance of routine and planned work.
- To examine possible changes to the Division's structure to handle the upcoming storm water permit requirements.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To repave 2 miles of roads, depending on funding available. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To replace Highway bridge railing on West Street. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To repave 1-2 miles of sidewalk. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To provide weekly street sweeping downtown, weather permitting. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To provide support to the various construction projects in Town. **ACCOMPLISHED**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To repave two miles of roads, depending on funding available.
- To repave 1-2 miles of sidewalk.
- To provide weekly street sweeping downtown, weather permitting.
- To provide support to the various construction projects in Town. Specifially the Mill River ADA improvements.

PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	745,900	721,999	820,877	873,155	829,305	(43,850)	-5.0%
Operating Expenses	$	72,290	42,798	57,317	59,611	59,611	-	--
Operating Capital	$	566	-	2,550	7,000	7,000	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	818,756	764,797	880,744	939,766	895,916	(43,850)	-4.7%

Major Components:

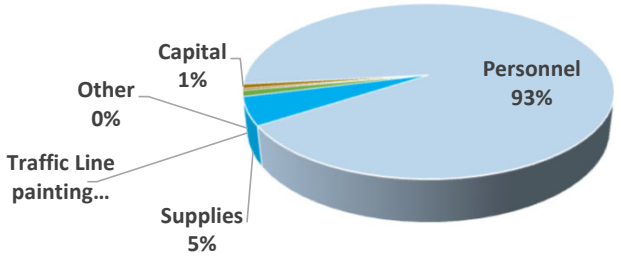
Personnel Services include salaries for a Division Director, 3 Senior Crew Supervisors, 1 Sign Maintenance Worker, 3 Skilled Laborers/Truck Drivers (two shared with the Sewer Fund), and 4 Equipment Operators. Also included is $20,000 for overtime and $10,000 for extra help.

Supplies, include materials for road maintenance: asphalt, concrete, culverts, stone and gravel, signs, and small tools.

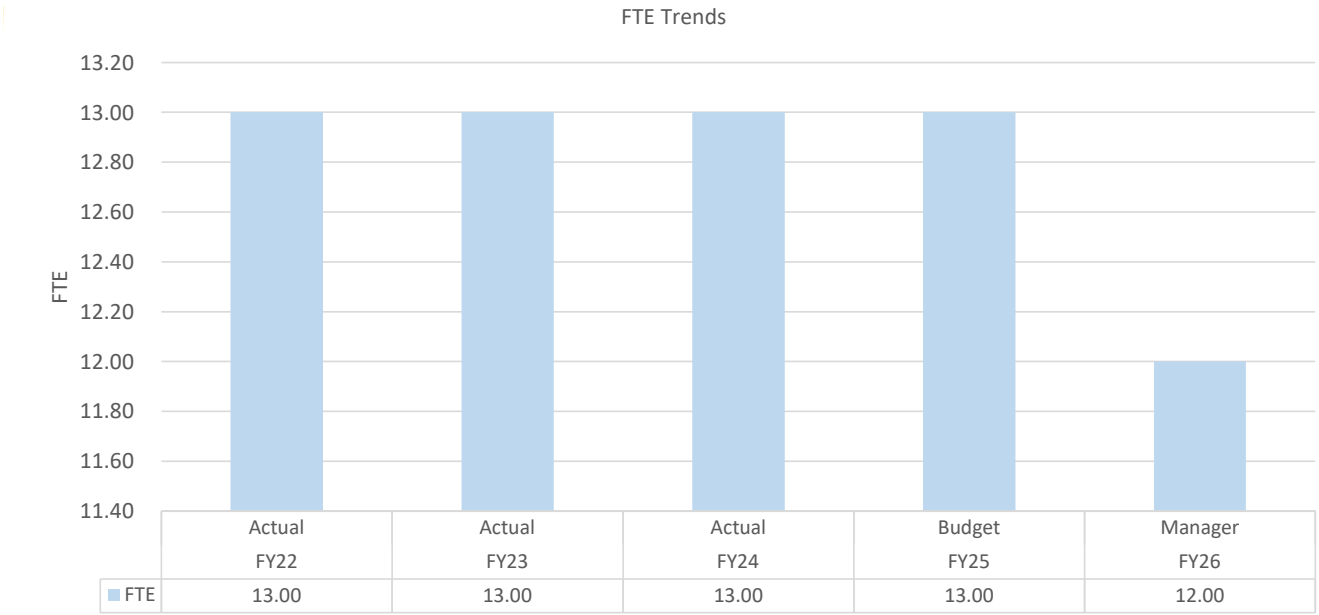
Purchase of services includes $10,000 for traffic line painting.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services are decreasing due to freezing one FTE.



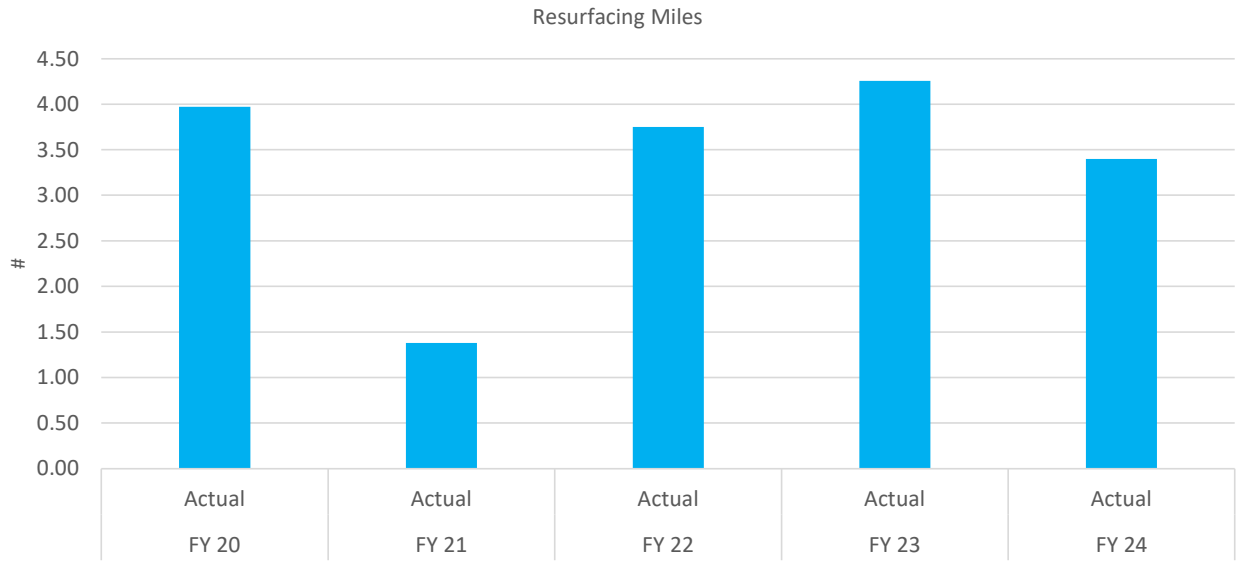
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: HIGHWAY (4422)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Resurfacing (mi)	3.97	1.38	3.75	4.26	3.4
Drainage Pipe Installed (ft)	30	60	250	300	275
Catch Basins Cleaned	89	100	125	100	78
Road Sweeping (mi)	270	270	270	275	275
Drainage Ditch Cleaning (mi)	1	2	2	2	2
Street & Traffic Sign Work Requests	98	115	113	78	69
General Street Maintenance:					
Pothole Patching (tons)	635	580	570	650	600
Street Center Line Painting (ft)	257,640	94,351	76,435	145,185	123,561
Crosswalks Painted	193	193	155	93	108
Road Edge Line Painting (ft)	307,512	6,980	63,488	173,937	158,179
Granite Curbing Repaired or Installed (ft)	80	17,785	0	0	30
Repairs to Sidewalks (linear ft)	2,116	20	400	600	230
New Sidewalk (linear ft)	1,892	700	0	2,200	5,438
Sewer Pipe Installed (ft)	4,600	300	120	150	170
Roadside Mowing (mi)	325	104	325	325	325
Crack Sealing (mi)	4.56	3.25	6.95	6.2	12.74
Shimming (tons)	0	0	0	11	0

Notable Trends:
None.

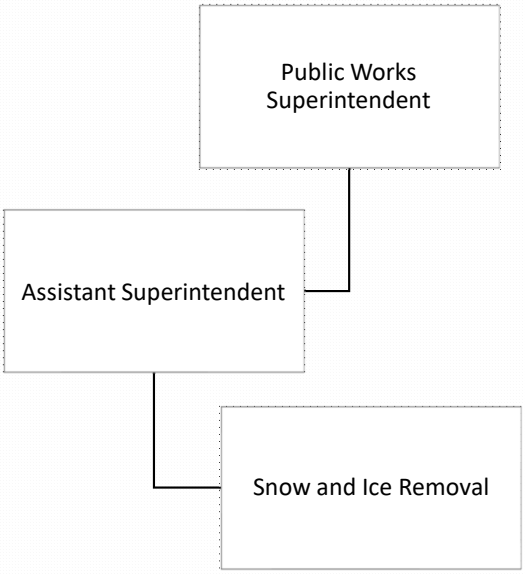


For more information, visit the DPW Highways webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/153/Highways

PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Function: To ensure the safety of motorists and pedestrians using public ways during winter weather. To provide access for emergency vehicles by ensuring that ice and snow operations are performed in a timely fashion.

Organization:



(Photo of dump truck plow)

PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Met winter requirements with current staff.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To provide desired level of snow removal services with a diminishing fleet and the community's desire to move away from carbon-fueled vehicles.
- To communicate progress of snow removal.
- To improve sanding controls to apply product where and when needed.
- To adjust winter operations to meet changing demands in winter services and longer duration storms.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To train and integrate new employees into the Town's snow operations processes**. ONGOING**
- To reduce chemical usage on Town roads. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To train and integrate new employees into the Town's snow operations processes.
- To reduce chemical usage on Town roads.

PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	55,046	43,189	43,133	71,750	71,750	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	194,015	170,819	105,301	203,660	203,660	-	--
Operating Capital	$	14,000	-	2,268	5,000	5,000	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	263,061	214,008	150,703	280,410	280,410	-	--

Major Components:

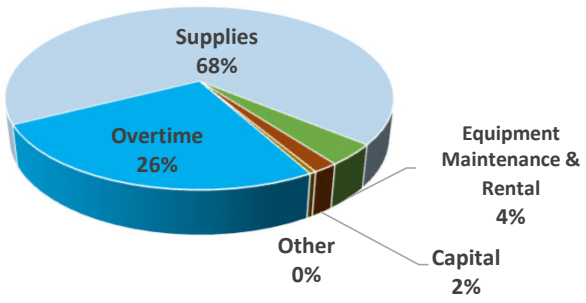
Overtime provides funds for snowplowing. Plowing done during the workday is charged to other Public Works Department budgets. Plowing required beyond the workday, or beyond an employee's 40 hour workweek, is charged to this budget as overtime.

Equipment Maintenance, $7,000, includes the cost of vehicle supplies such as wiper blades, flashers, beacon lights, chains, etc.

Equipment Rental, $3,500, provides funds to rent dump trucks for snow removal.

Supplies, $191,860, include salt, calcium chloride, Ice Ban Magic, sand, gasoline, and diesel.

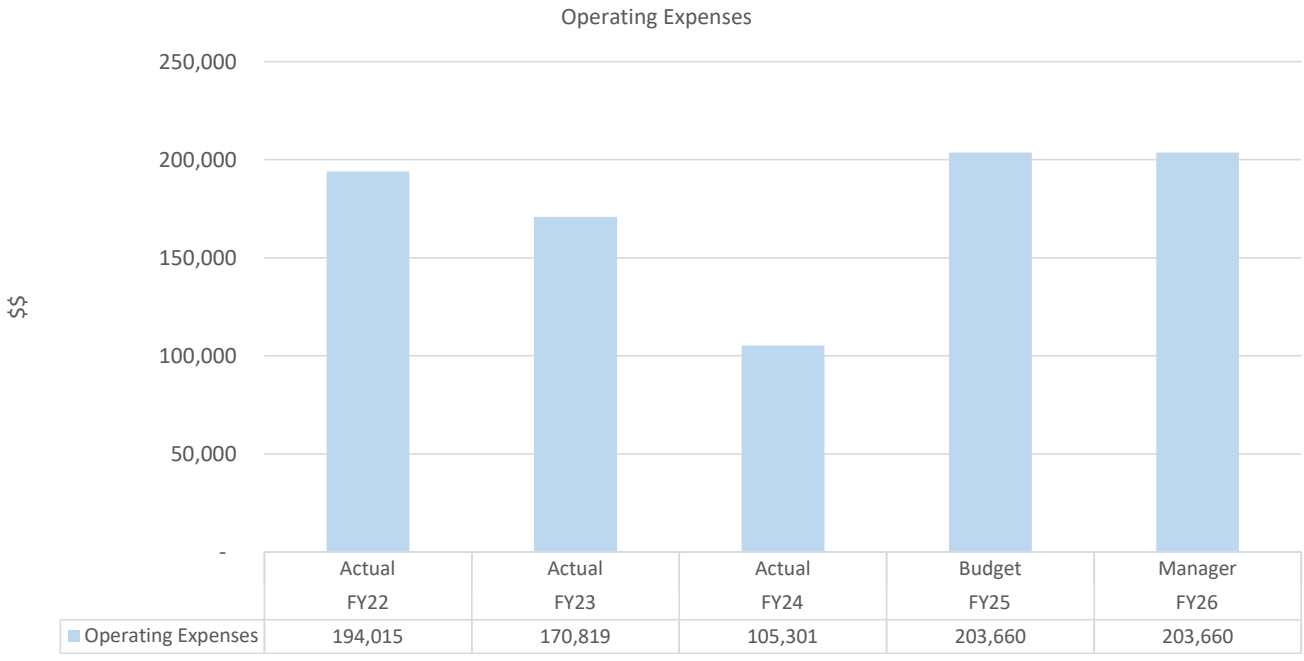
Capital provides for the replacement of a snowplow, part of an annual replacement program.



Significant Changes:

No change.

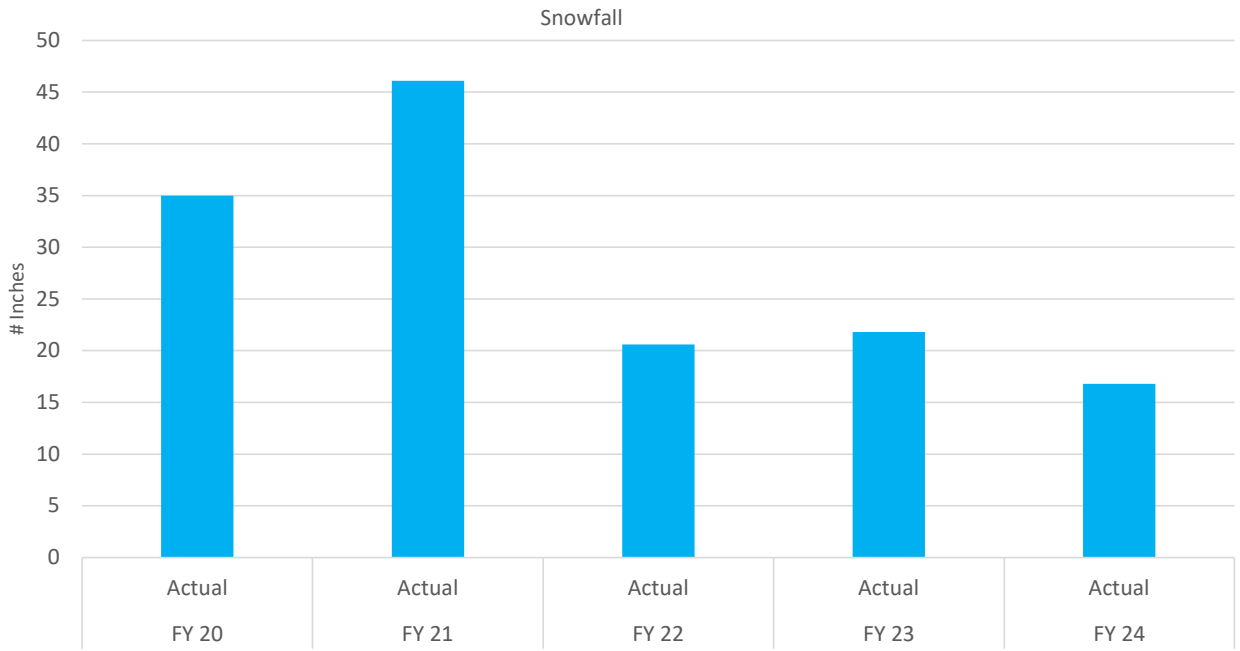
Expenditure Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: SNOW AND ICE REMOVAL (4423)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Lane Miles Plowed	256	256	256	256	256
Sidewalk Miles Plowed	62	62	62	62	62
Snow Storms	11	7	15	12	13
Snow Fall (inches)	35	46.1	20.6	21.8	16.8
Sand Used (tons)	59	40	109	100	75
Salt Used (tons)	2,071	2,500	1,840	1,420	814
Ice Ban Magic (gal)	4,474	2,000	0	2,000	0

Notable Trends:
None.

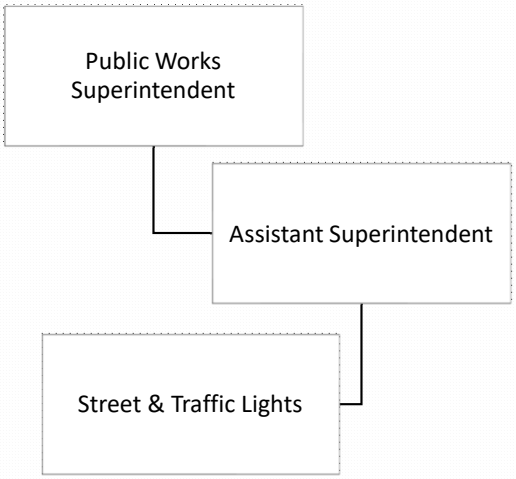


For more information, visit the DPW Snow & Ice webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/165/Snow-Ice

PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

Function: To ensure the safety of those using public ways by maintaining Town owned street lights and pedestrian and traffic signals in operating condition.

Organization:



(Photo of Pomeroy roundabout ribbon cutting)

PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Installed 'NoTraffic' smart intersection systems at Main/ North East Streets and South East St/ College Street.
- Installed and swapped over power to new Waste Water pump station at South East Street pump station #4.
- Installed new underground service at 660 West Street with an 400 Amp service for relocated PVTA Bus stop.
- Completed emergency change variable frequency drive for Well #4 and Well #3.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To quickly and efficiently resolve backlogged SeeClickFix issues and tasks.
- To find and take classes and courses to continue to help minimize and repair PLC and Automation processes that arise.
- To continue to work with Dean Tech Vocational High School in Holyoke and to provide Co-op opportunities to train students in the electrical field.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To enhance power efficiency and upgraded lighting at Mill River Pool/Basketball Court and Groff Park**. ACCOMPLISHED**
- To install lighting at North Pleasant Street upgrades at Kendrick Park. **ONGOING**
- To complete North Common Revitalization project**. ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To install 'NoTraffic' smart intersection systems at the Main Street/Amity Street intersection.
- To remove traffic intersection of Amity Street/University Drive for upcoming roundabout project.
- To install lighting at North Pleasant Street and Kendrick Park.
- To complete installation of lighting for North Common Revitalization project.

PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	25,049	27,144	22,125	29,002	29,872	870	3.0%
Operating Expenses	$	71,712	103,448	113,777	99,650	99,650	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	96,760	130,592	135,902	128,652	129,522	870	0.7%

Major Components:

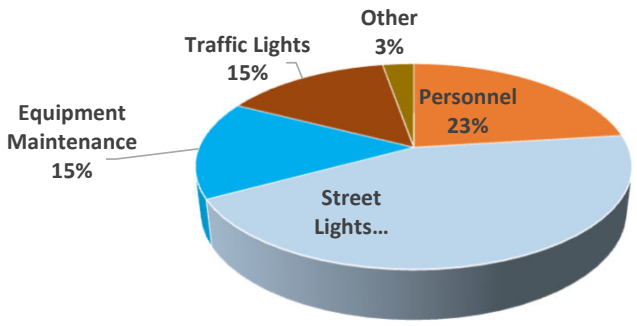
Personnel Services include salaries for 1/3 Division Supervisor shared with the Water and Sewer Funds.

Street lighting budget provides for electricity and maintenance of 1,200+ streetlights.

Traffic lighting budget provides electricity for 12 signalized intersections.

Equipment Maintenance provides the funds for the parts and service necessary to maintain traffic lights.

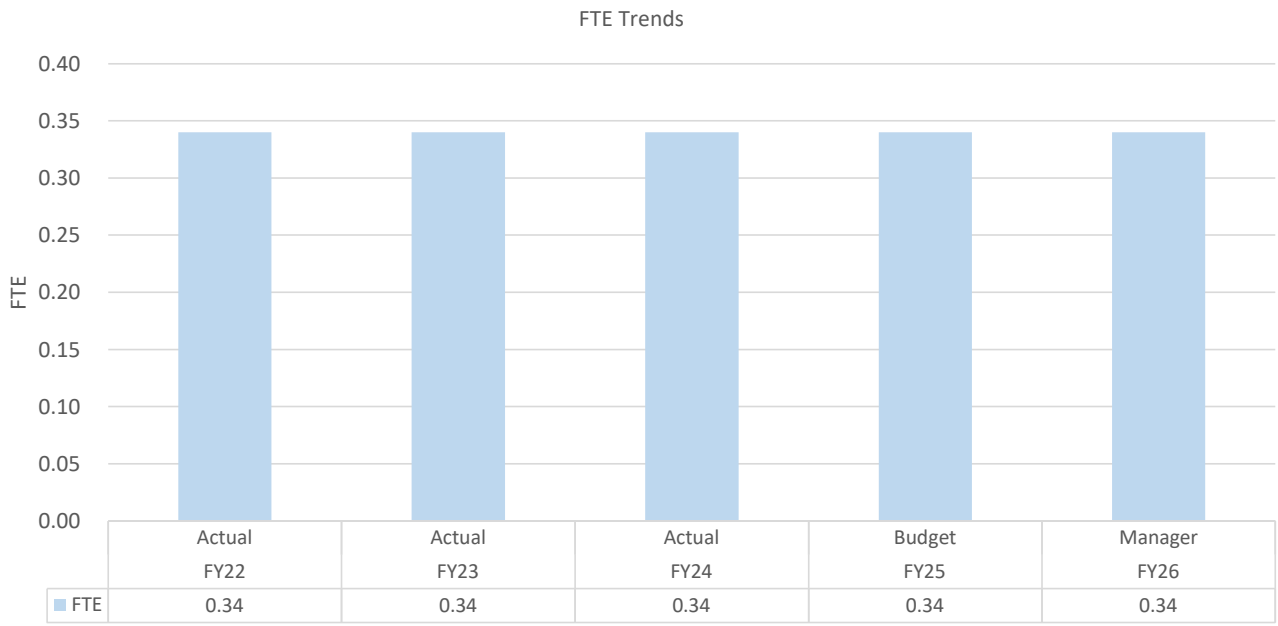
Other includes supplies.



Significant Changes:

None.

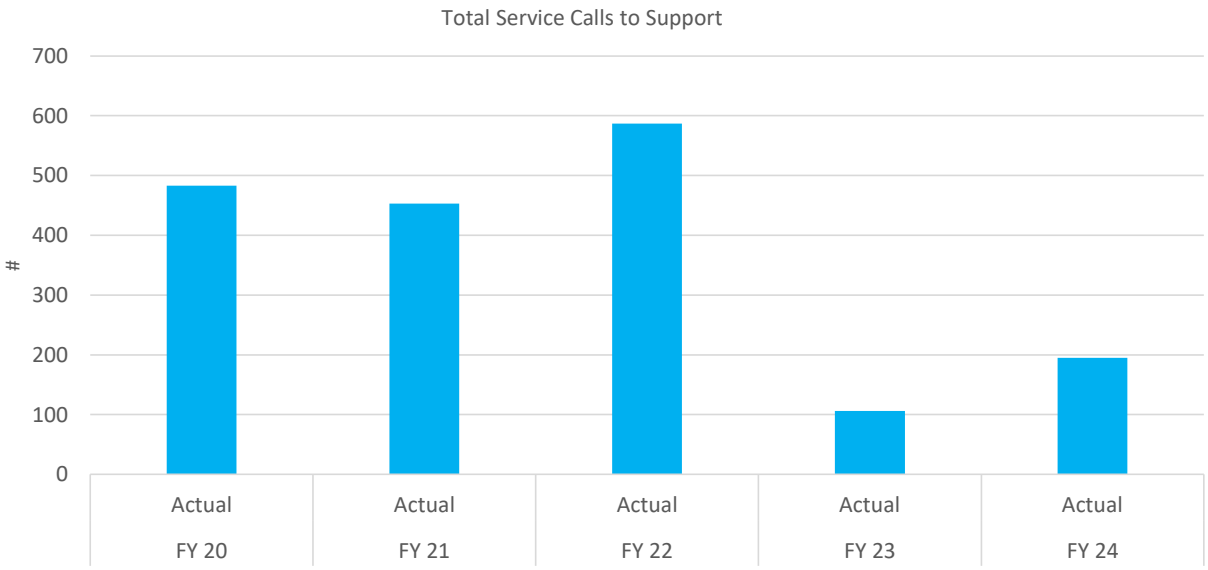
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: STREET & TRAFFIC LIGHTS (4424 & 4425)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Streetlights Maintained	1,198	1,198	1,198	1,198	1,209
School Zone Lights Maintained	5	7	9	9	9
Traffic Lights Maintained	13	13	13	12	12
Traffic Light Knockdowns	6	7	4	1	5
Street Light Trouble Calls	79	191	201	156	105
Service Calls to Support:					
Water Division	87	121	187	15	63
Wastewater Division	230	165	208	30	47
Parking	0	4	0	0	0
Tree & Grounds	40	48	78	10	20
DPW Buildings	63	71	56	25	23
Police and Fire	12	7	12	10	9
Town Hall	36	16	10	2	1
Schools	0	4	20	0	13
Amherst BID	15	12	6	4	15
Bangs Center	0	5	10	10	4

Notable Trends:
None.

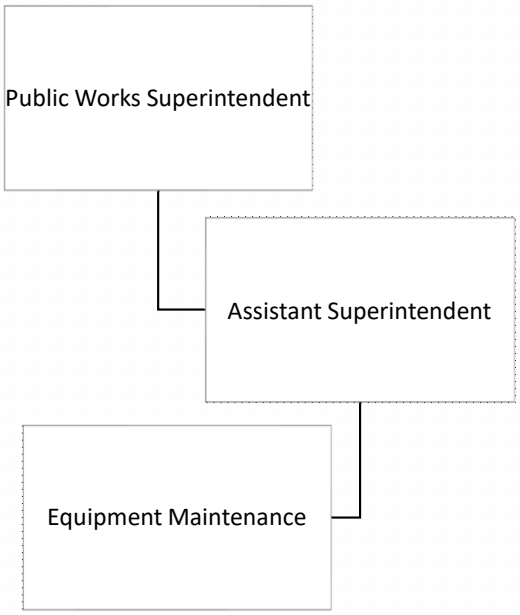


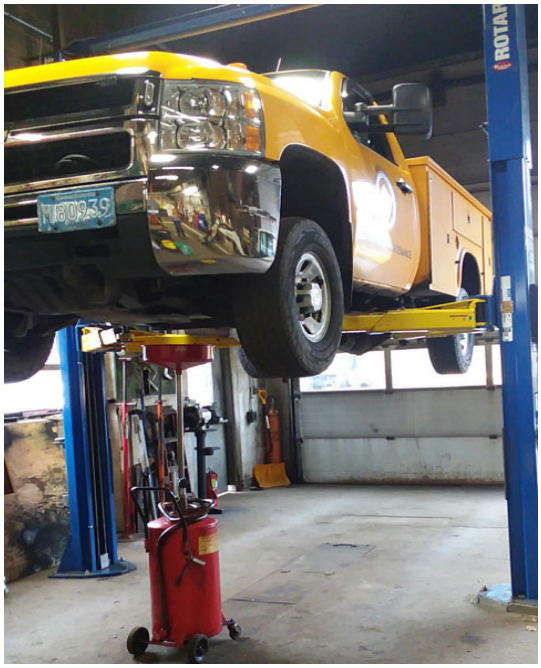
For more information, visit the DPW Street & Traffic Lights webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/1835/Street-and-Traffic-Lights

PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Function: To enable the other divisions to meet their missions by maintaining the Department's fleet of vehicles, construction equipment, and various portable pieces of equipment in excellent operating condition.

Organization:





(Photo of maintenance shop)

PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Upgraded vehicle inspection software.
- Cleared out old inventory of Internation truck parks as last International truck replaced with Freightliner truck.
- Cleared out old inventory of sweeper equipment as new Elgin Crosswinds sweeper is now in full service.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To continue to meet daily vehicle maintenance needs, repair break downs, and perform routine State Inspections on most Town vehicles.
- To evaluate a vehicle maintenance system.
- To maintain the fleet with severe supply chain shortages on parts.
- To continue planning and transition to an electric/hybrid fleet when possible.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To install state of the art ventilation system in the facility. **RESCHEDULED**
- To continue to provide vehicle inspections for Town vehicles. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue to provide vehicle inspections for Town vehicles.
- To repurpose salvaged bucket truck chasis to be used as a dump/flatbed truck.

PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	186,548	194,056	206,835	215,878	218,360	2,482	1.1%
Operating Expenses	$	95,811	127,549	93,182	96,221	96,221	-	--
Operating Capital	$	129	1,336	-	2,500	2,500	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	282,488	322,941	300,017	314,599	317,081	2,482	0.8%

Major Components:

Personnel Services provide for a Supervisor/Mechanic and two Mechanics.

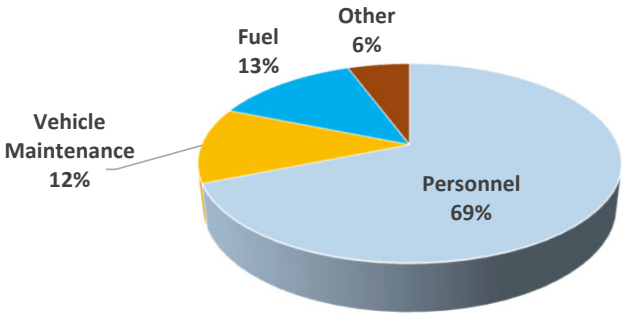
Vehicle maintenance, $39,000, includes funds for vehicle parts and supplies for approximately 53 vehicles.

Fuel includes $41,784 for gas and diesel for all DPW general fund vehicles.

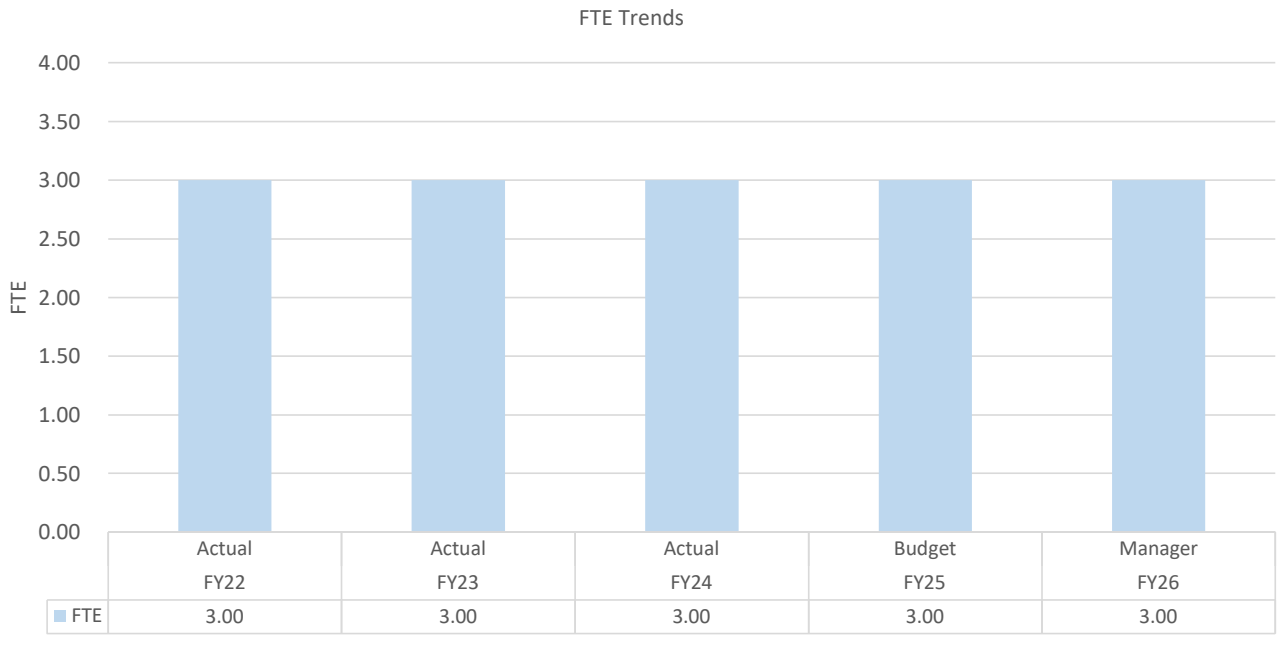
Operating Capital provides funds for small equipment replacement.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected step increases.



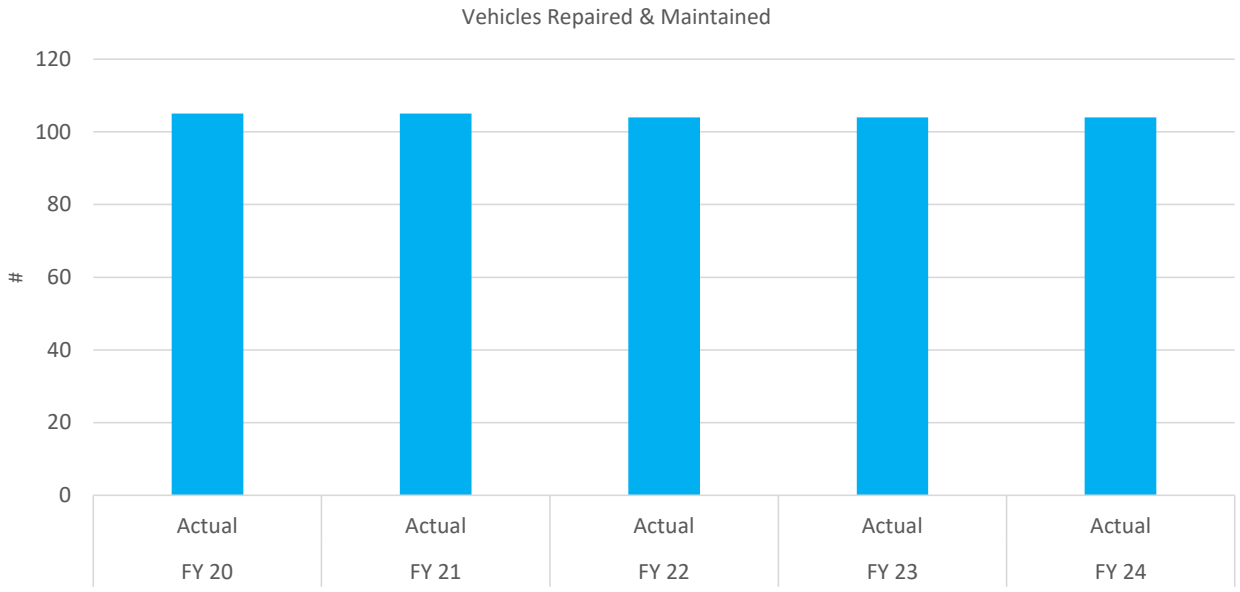
Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE (4428)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Vehicles Repaired & Maintained	105	105	104	104	104
Equipment Repaired & Maintained	180	180	180	180	180
Gasoline Consumption (gal)	30,408	30,535	30,581	25,841	26,701
Oil Supplies (gal)	900	900	875	875	845
Diesel Consumption (gal)	18,361	16,448	18,449	17,448	17,405

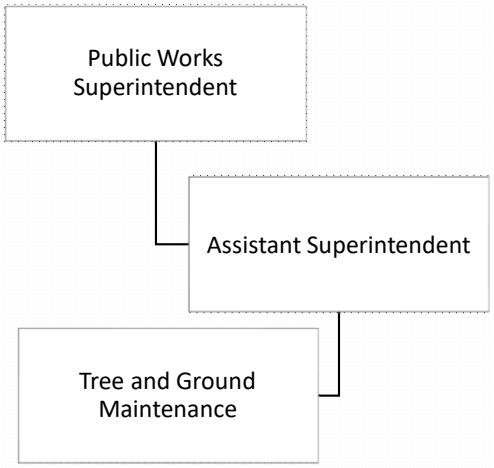
Notable Trends:
None.



PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Function: Enhance the quality of life for residents and the business community by providing an exceptional, diverse, and healthy urban forest, connected by a system of parks, cemeteries, open spaces, and recreational facilities that are safe, accessible, and well maintained.

Organization:



(Photo of Public Shade Tree members planting a red maple tree at the Munson Memorial Library)

PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed Massachusetts Department of Conservation and Development (DCR) Urban Forest Challenge Grant to update the tree inventory and develop a new Urban Forestry Management Plan.
- Planted 97 new public shade trees.
- Coordinated nine 2nd Saturday Tree Planting events for the Public Shade Tree Committee.
- Supported other DPW Divisions, Regional and Elementary Schools, Libraries, Conservation, Recreation, and Facilities.
- Completed filter upgrades to the Groff Park splashpad.
- Completed drainage upgrades for War Memorial Pool.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- Accelerated tree mortality from Maple decline, Emerald Ash Borer infestation and drought has placed unusual demands on existing staff.
- Expectations for service levels for athletic fields, including fields owned by the Regional School District, and park infrastructure is a significant challenge.
- Attracting, training, and retaining employees.
- Managing the rapidly growing wood waste resource and the need to develop a wood bank for wood from public shade trees.
- To evaluate the need for and siting of additional cemetery land.
- To work with Schools and Recreation to develop consolidated grounds maintenance activities.
- To renovate the fountain in Sweetser Park.
- To upgrade the War Memorial pool bathhouse.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To create Foreman position for tree crew. **RESCHEDULED**
- To secure funding for equipment that is carbon neutral to replace existing equipment. **RESCHEDULED**
- To secure funding for equipment that will enable the tree crew to efficiently and safely increase productivity and manage urban wood waste. **RESCHEDULED**
- To automate the filtration system at War memorial Pool and the Groff Spray Park. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To complete Memorandum of Agreement with Schools, Recreation and Department of Public Works for field usage.
- To complete the design for changes/upgrades to War Memorial Pool bath house.
- To complete filtration systems at War Memorial Pool.
- To work with Facilities to address the Traffic and Grounds building energy performance and deferred maintenance.
- To seal the roof at War Memorial Pump house.

PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	464,873	463,473	472,703	509,336	514,926	5,590	1.1%
Operating Expenses	$	120,871	124,387	135,605	119,692	119,692	-	--
Operating Capital	$	620	-	39	1,700	1,700	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	586,364	587,859	608,348	630,728	636,318	5,590	0.9%

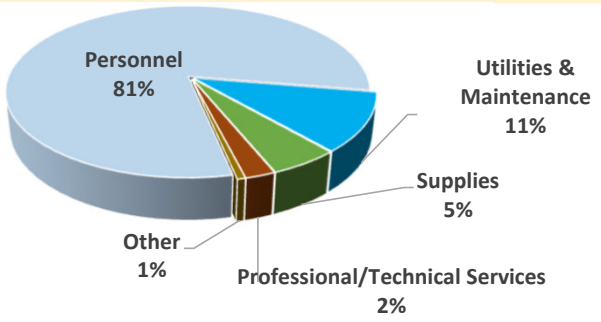
Major Components:

Personnel Services provide salaries for a Division Director, a Crew Supervisor, 3 Maintenance Workers, two Laborers, and a Skilled Laborer/Truck Driver which is shared with the Transportation Fund.

Utilities and Maintenance, $69,774, include funds for lighting parks and commons (electricity for Community Field not included) and providing field, equipment, and building maintenance at picnic areas and other park facilities.

Supplies, $33,310, include funds for fertilizer, gas and diesel fuel, and materials necessary to maintain equipment and clean park facilities.

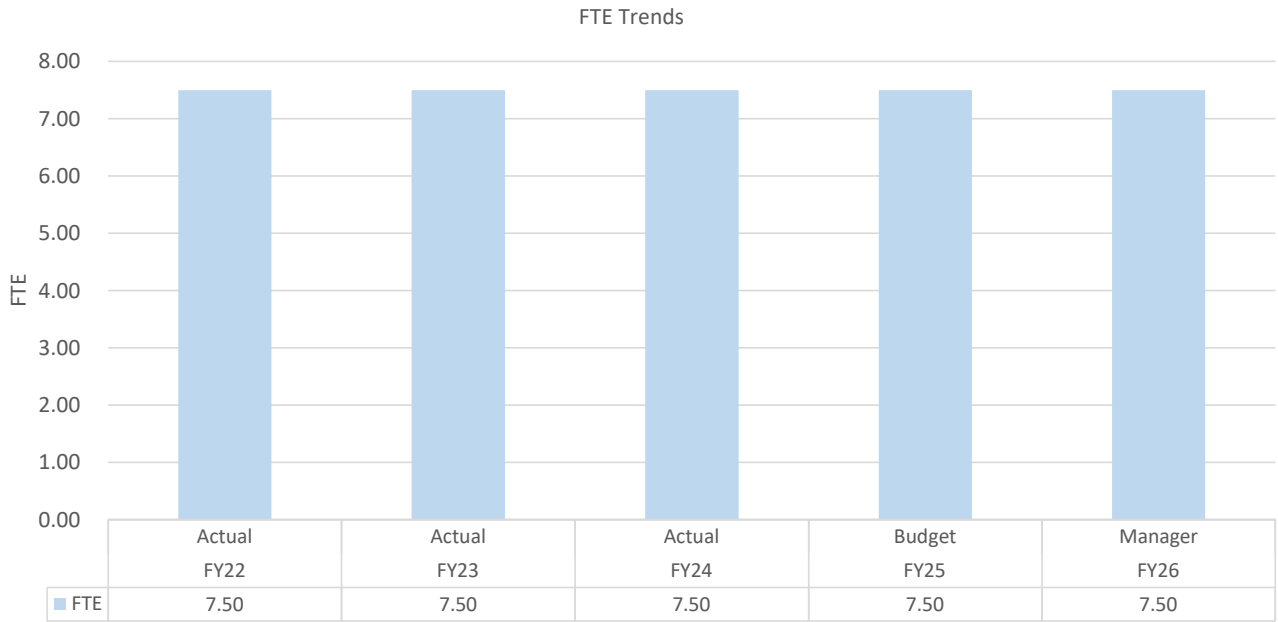
Other provides funds for purchase, replacement or rental of small equipment, uniforms, and training.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected step increases.

Staffing Trends:



PUBLIC WORKS: TREE AND GROUND MAINTENANCE (4490)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Burials	21	15	21	12	20
Grave Stones Repaired	3	4	91	113	4
Sale of Lots	10	8	11	2	1
Mowing: Community Field, Mill River,					
Groff Park, Town Commons and					
all School Areas	42	42	42	42	42
Field Maintenance					
Baseball/Softball Field Maintenance	20	20	20	20	20
Football Fields	6	8	8	8	8
Soccer Fields	10	10	10	10	10
Field Hockey Fields	6	6	6	6	6
Lacrosse Fields	8	8	8	8	8
Swimming Pools (Recreation)	3	3	3	3	3
Wading Pools (Recreation)	1	2	2	2	2
Picnic Areas	3	3	3	3	8
Parks & Commons	18	18	18	18	18
Litter Basket Pickup	6,679	6,679	6,679	6,679	6,679
Tennis Courts	2	2	2	2	2
Basketball Courts	3	3	4	4	4
Building Maintenance	7	7	9	9	9
Youth Soccer Fields	1	1	1	1	1
School Frisbee Fields	3	3	3	3	3
Removal of Public Trees	182	204	223	206	101
Public Shade Trees Planted	110	89	85	87	72
Public Shade Trees Trimmed	345	296	310	290	300
Stump Removal	42	47	52	45	41
Roadside Brush Cleaning (miles)	0.25	0.25	0.35	0.25	0.25
Banners Erected & Removed	19	18	18	25	23

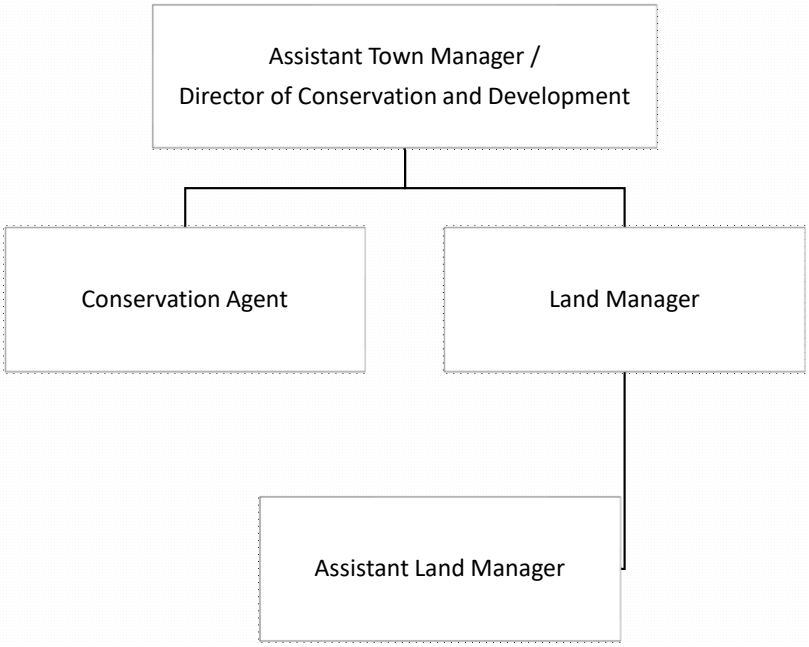
Notable Trends:
None.

For more information, visit the DPW Tree & Grounds webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/1745/Tree-and-Grounds

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

Function: To plan and manage programs and initiatives that protect the natural resources of Amherst, promote a sustainable environment for current and future generations, and ensure a natural environment resilient to the impacts of climate change, while providing staff support to the Conservation Commission and Agricultural Commission on issues related to wetlands, open space, farmland preservation, and climate change. The Assistant Town Manager/Director of Conservation and Development works to coordinate projects between multiple departments and carries out special initiatives as determined by the Town Manager.

Organization:



(Photo of LWCF 60th Anniversary Event)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Coordinated with the Conservation Commission to form a Land Use Sub-Committee to assess and update all policies governing conservation land management in town.
- Secured significant grant to design safety improvements to the dam and dike at Puffer's Pond.
- Developed comprehensive plan for re-use of Hickory Ridge property, including oversight of 26MW solar project, accessible trails and ecological restoration.
- Designed and constructed parking lot improvements at the Fort RIver Farm consevation area and community gardens.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain the level of service that residents demand relative to maintaining 124 miles of trails, the use of Puffer's Pond by thousands of visitors annually, and the management of more than 2,000 acres of Conservation land.
- To expand and enhance access to conservation areas throughout Town with limited staff and funding.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To open multiple ADA trails at Hickory Ridge. **ONGOING**
- To apply for a MA Department of Conservation and Recreation Trails Grant for additional trail access at Hickory Ridge. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To design and build a reroute for a significant portion of the Robert Frost Trail in Lawrence Swamp. **ONGOING**
- To repair and/or replace 3-5 bridges on Conservation land. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To repair all ADA crushed stone trails. **ONGOING**
- To support the update to the open space and recreation plan. **ACCOMPLISHED**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To open multiple trails at Hickory Ridge in the summer of 2025.
- To complete all work related to the Massachusetts Trails Grant at Hickory Ridge.
- To design and build a reroute for a significant portion of the Robert Frost Trail in Lawrence Swamp.
- To repair three ADA trails.
- To construct and open the Tucker Trail in South Amherst.
- To complete the new Land Use Policy for all Conservation Areas.
- To complete design and permitting process for dam and dike improvements at Puffer's Pond.

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	394,860	408,135	423,825	361,083	383,126	22,043	6.1%
Operating Expenses	$	29,211	32,352	33,974	22,079	22,079	-	--
Operating Capital	$	2,593	3,171	2,875	7,000	7,000	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	426,664	443,658	460,674	390,162	412,205	22,043	5.6%

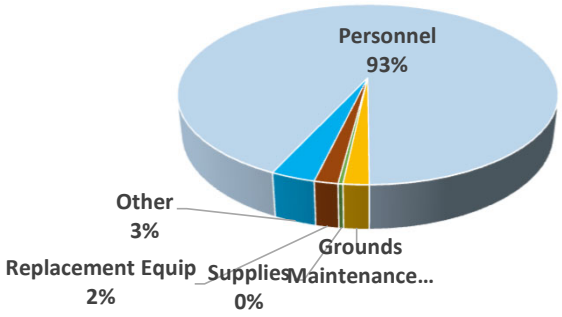
Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Assistant Town Manager/Director of Conservation and Development, a Land Manager, an Assistant Land Manager, and a Conservation Agent.

Grounds maintenance provides funds for materials and supplies such as lumber, gravel, and mulch for more than 2,000 acres of Conservation Land including Puffer's Pond, Larch Hill, Amethyst Brook, and Mt. Pollux and approximately 125 miles of trails.

Supplies include tools and small equipment, gasoline, office and vehicle supplies.

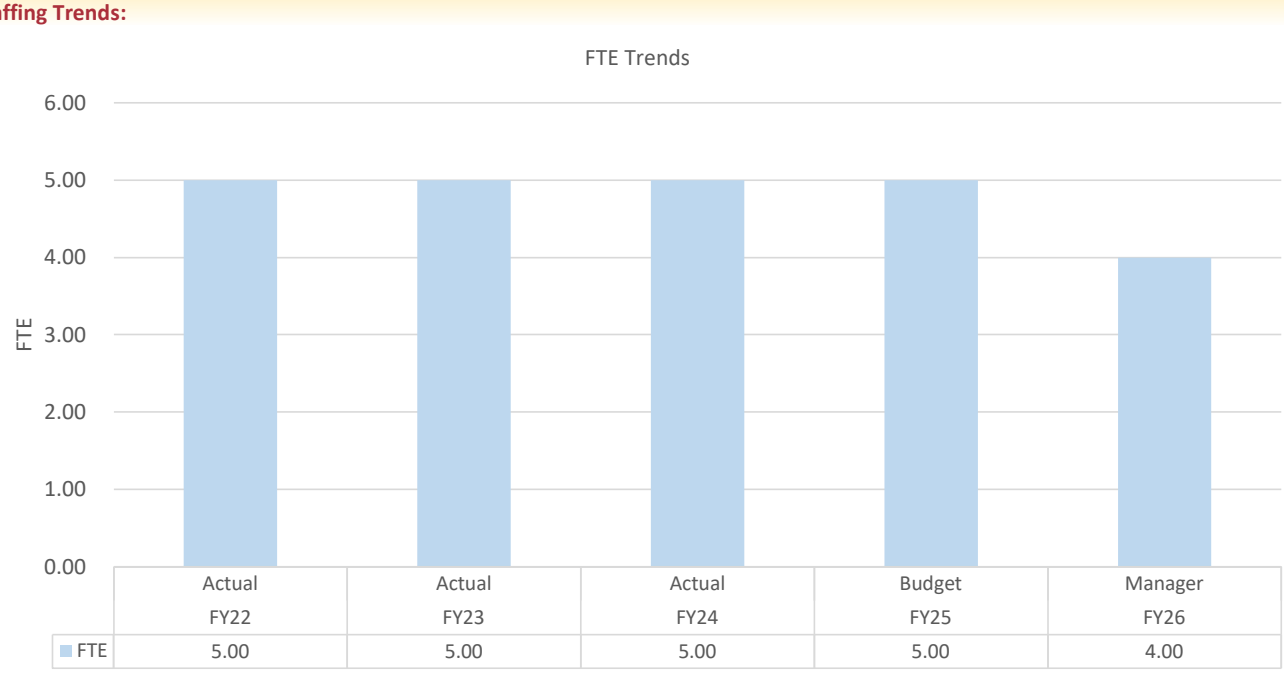
Other includes utilities, uniforms, and other small expenses.



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected step increases and job classifications.

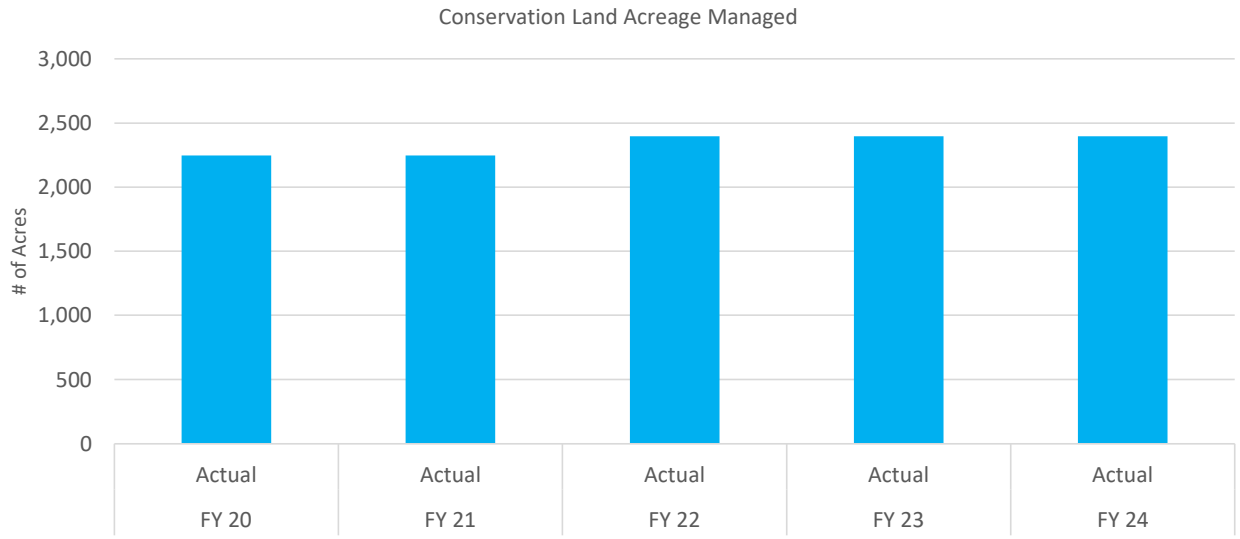
Staffing Trends:



CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: CONSERVATION (5171)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Conservation Land Acreage Managed	2,247	2,247	2,397	2,397	2,397
Trail Miles Maintained	124	124	124	124	124
Accessible Trails Maintained	4	4	4	4	5
Acres Monitored – Agricultural Preservation Restrictions	2,102	2,102	2,102	2,102	2,102
Acres under Conservation Restrictions	202	202	202	202	202
Acres of Farmland Rented Out	45	45	45	45	45
Wetlands Act Notice of Intent and Determinations	32	33	33	31	33
Wetlands Act Major Cases Handled	3	5	6	9	9
Emergency Certifications (wetlands)	11	10	16	15	11
Bridges Built or Replaced	5	12	21	12	8
Volunteers	50	50	75	65	50

Notable Trends:
None.



For more information, visit the Conservation department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/285/Conservation

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Function: To plan and manage programs that promote a sustainable and resilient environment for current and future generations from the impacts of climate change, while providing staff support to the Energy and Climate Action Committee. The Director of Sustainability works to coordinate projects between multiple departments and carries out special sustainability initiatives as determined by the Town Manager.

Organization:

(Photo of Amherst Sustainability Festival)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Completed a fleet vehicle greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions inventory, transition timeline, and report.
- Facilitated the Town's re-launch of the ValleyBike/share program.
- Facilitated and implemented the launch of the Valley Green Energy Community Choice Aggregation Program.
- Completed the selection process for a program administrator for the Town's residential Heat Pump Program.
- Completed installation of two Electric Vehicle DC Fastcharge stations.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To meet the 2050 de-carbonization goals set by the Town Council.
- To collaborate with the Energy and Climate Action Committee (ECAC) and Department Heads on identification, and development, of Climate Action, Adaptation and Resilience Plan (CAARP) implementation strategies.
- To address the intersection of sustainability in municipal and community sectors.
- To maintain the Sustainability Dashboard.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To implement the Valley Green Energy community choice aggregation. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To conduct energy efficiency, weatherization and HVAC conversion building studies in collaboration with the Facilities Manager. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To re-launch the Valleybike program. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To complete a Fleet Vehicle Greenhouse Gas Emissions Inventory. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To launch a communty heat pump program to facilitate the installation of heat pumps for Amherst residents. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To expand our Electric Vehicle DC Fastcharge stations. **ACCOMPLISHED**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue to oversee the Valley Green Energy community choice aggregation.
- To begin implementing energy efficiency, weatherization and HVAC conversions in collaboration with the Facilities Department at the Bangs Community Center, Police Department, Town Hall, and Munson Library.
- To sustain and possibly expand the Valleybike program station network.
- To implement the communty heat pump program to facilitate the installation of heat pumps for Amherst residents.
- To expand the number of Electric Vehicle charging stations throughout Town and at Town owned facilities.
- To continue to support and improve Community Garden infrastructure.
- To become a Climate Leader Community as designated by Massachusetts Department of Energy Resources.

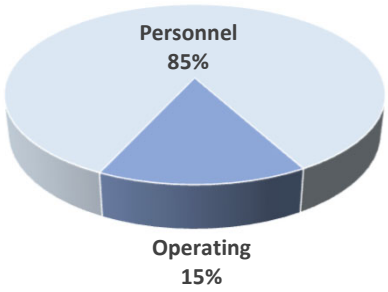
CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	106,047	109,428	3,381	3.2%
Operating Expenses	$	-	-	-	19,340	19,340	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	-	-	125,387	128,768	3,381	2.7%

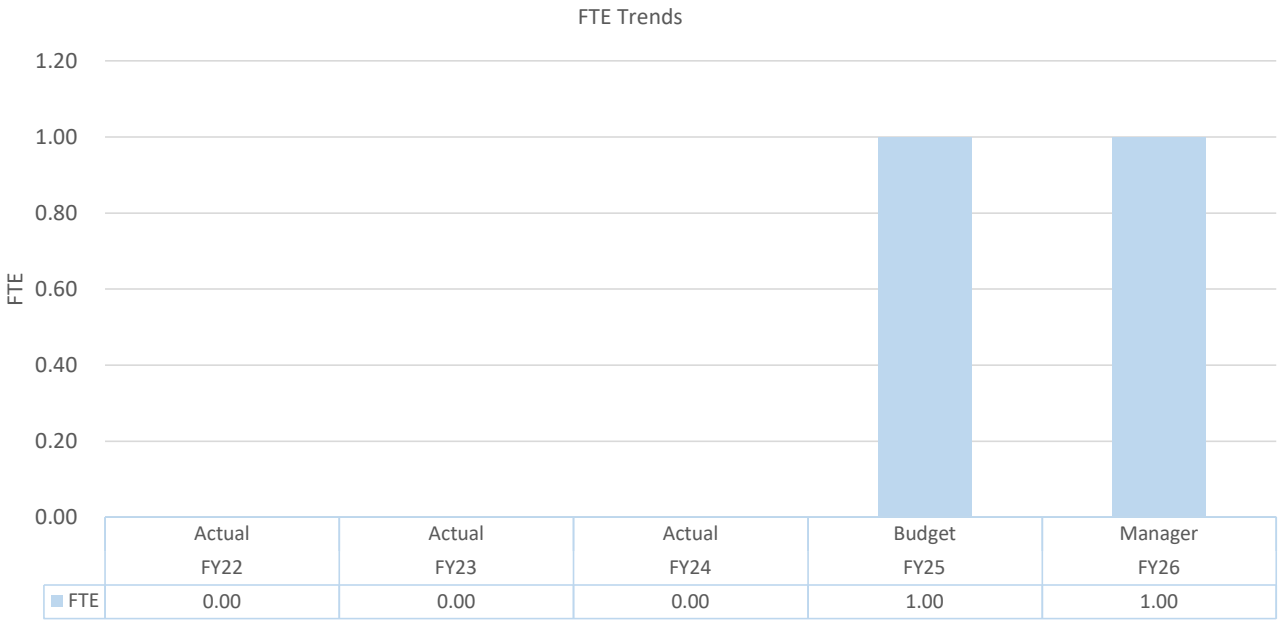
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for the Director of Sustainablitiy.

Operating expenses include training, printing & advertising, supplies, travel and dues and subscriptions.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services increase due to projected step increases.



Staffing Trends:



CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: SUSTAINABILITY (5172)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Studies/special projects managed	n/a	n/a	8	10	9
Grant applications processed /administered	n/a	n/a	5	6	6
Town Board & Committee meetings attended	n/a	n/a	n/a	95	73
Trainings or other project related meetings attended	n/a	n/a	36	82	73
Partnerships/collaborations	n/a	n/a	10	9	9

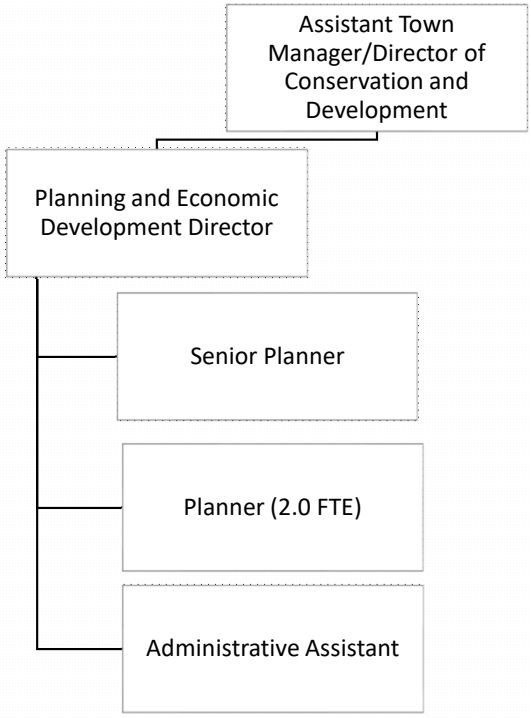
Notable Trends:
New department for FY25, broken out from Conservation.

For more information, visit the Conservation department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/1671/Sustaining-Amherst

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Function: To protect and enhance the environmental, economic, and social quality of life for residents and visitors by creating and implementing appropriate plans and regulations for the preservation of community resources and the orderly, rational, and sustainable development of the Town.

Organization:



(Photo of Downtown Design Standards Workshop)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Developed zoning amendment, "University Drive Overlay District" to increase the housing supply and improve economic opportunities in this area of Town that near the University and Route 9 commercial corridor.
- Completed permitting for affordable housing developers to permit affordable and market rate housing units in the East Amherst Village Center (Belchertown Road and East Street School).
- Completed conceptual design study for combined shelter and permanent supportive housing at the former VFW site.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain the level of service that residents expect and demand such as providing information about proposed projects and proposed zoning amendments, providing mechanisms by which residents' voices can be heard, and encouraging low income and hard-to-reach populations to participate in the public process.
- To respond to the increasing complexity of private development applications and the public permit review process.
- To fully adopt an electronic document management system for all Conservation and Development records.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To work with design consultants, Dodson & Flinker, the public, local businesses, boards, and committees to develop Downtown Design and Streetscape Standards. **ONGOING**
- To develop a zoning amendment, "Housing Overlay Zoning District," for the University Drive area, to increase the housing supply and improve economic opportunities in this area of town that is so close to the university. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To begin to develop a plan and rezoning for the development of East Amherst Village Center, an area of town that is already experiencing growth and change, to increase the housing supply and improve economic opportunities. **ONGOING**
- To work with Wayfinders, affordable housing developers, to shape and permit the project for affordable and market rate housing units in the East Amherst Village Center (Belchertown Road and East Street School). **ACCOMPLISHED**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To develop zoning amendments with a focus on the East Village, downtown, North Amherst, Accessory Dwelling Units (ADU's) and increasing density in existing housing developments.
- To complete the update to the Housing Production Plan (HPP).
- To work with the Fire Department to update to the Hazard Mitigation Plan.
- To begin planning for the update of the Master Plan.
- To explore housing options for the former South Amherst School property.
- To begin to develop a plan and rezoning for the development of East Amherst Village Center to increase housing supply and expand economic opportunities.
- To work with design consultants, the public, local businesses, boards, and committees to develop Downtown Design and Streetscape Standards.

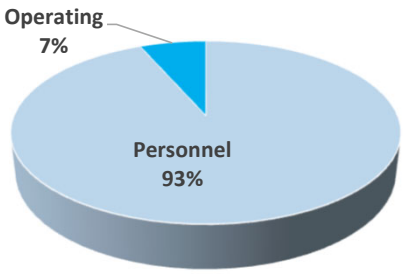
CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	344,708	332,504	341,996	395,438	398,061	2,623	0.7%
Operating Expenses	$	23,178	27,135	31,555	27,925	27,925	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	367,886	359,639	373,551	423,363	425,986	2,623	0.6%

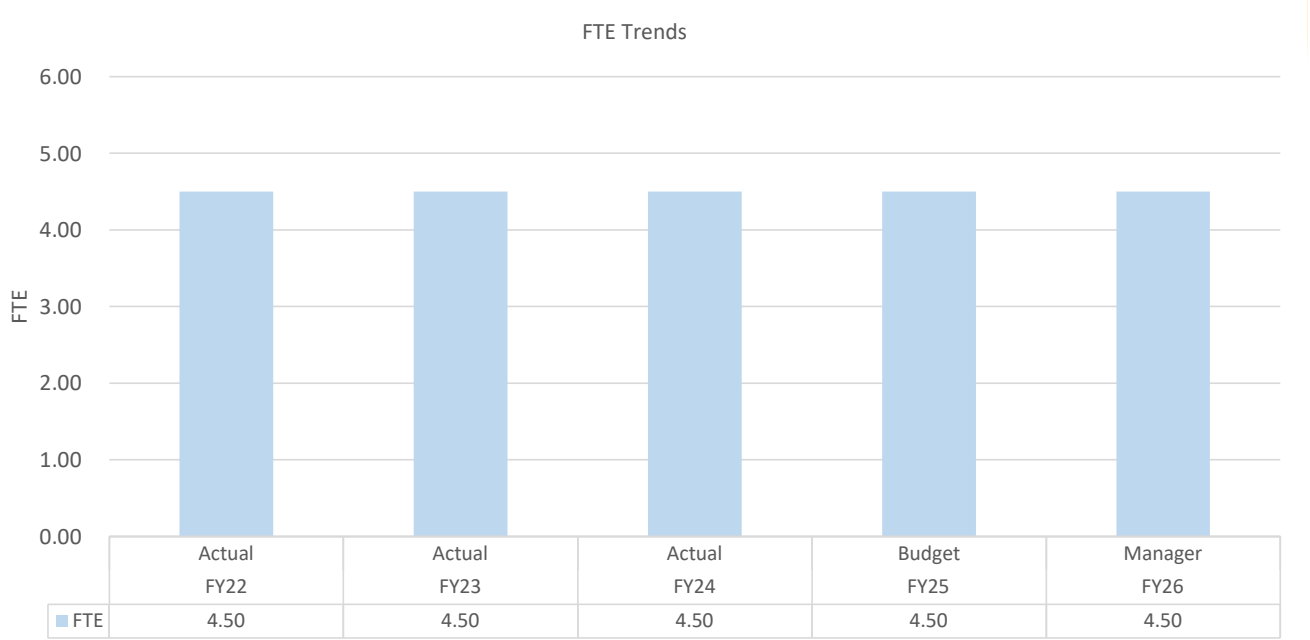
Major Components:
Personnel Services includes salaries for a Planning Director, a Senior Planner, two Planners (one of them is 50% funded with CDBG), and a Permit Administrator.

Operating costs include public hearing legal ads, professional development and travel, materials associated with mapping, computers, printers/copiers, and other departmental supplies.

Significant Changes:
None.



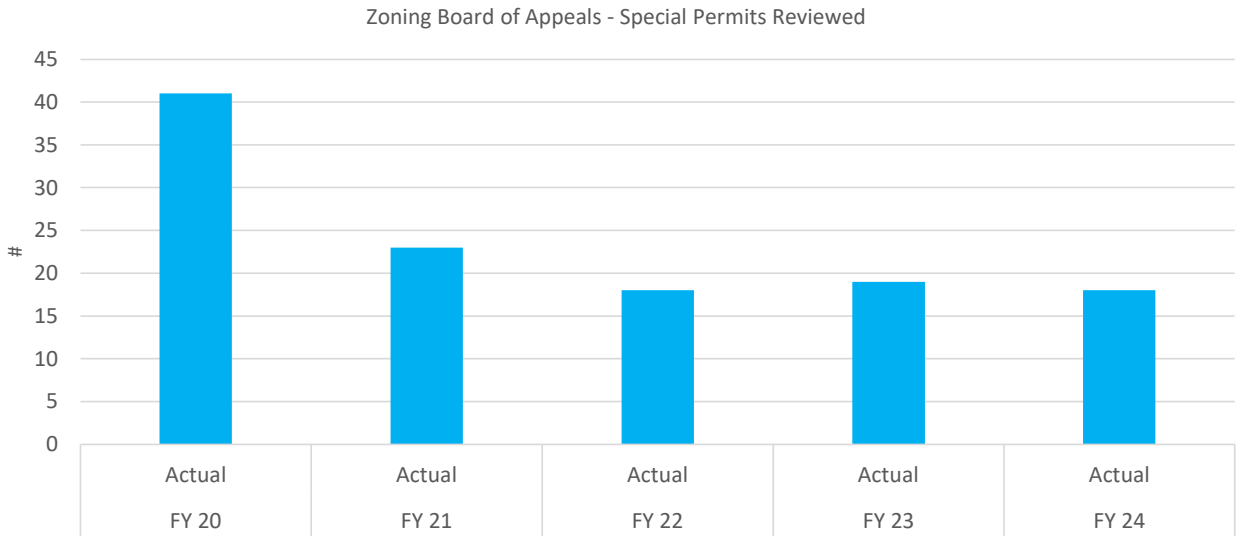
Staffing Trends:



CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: PLANNING (5177)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Zoning/Subdivision/Regulation Amendments Worked On	2	11	13	4	3
ANR/Subdivision Plans Reviewed & Processed	18	10	14	9	8
Planning Board Special Permits	5	3	5	4	5
ZBA Special Permits Reviewed	41	23	18	19	18
Design Review Board Reviews	11	24	21	23	17
Demolition Delay Applications	10	14	11	12	6
Other Development Applications Processed (Local Historic District)	24	11	6	14	20
Planning Board Site Plan Reviews	11	12	15	8	11
Grant or Other Non-Town Funding Project Applications Processed/Administered	8	8	8	8	5
Contracts Administered	10	15	12	10	7
Special Planning Studies/Projects	16	16	9	12	5
Review of Other Projects	3	2	2	1	4
Committees/Boards Assisted	15	11	11	10	13
Committee & Board Meetings	127	244	302	170	236

Notable Trends:
Committee/board meetings & ZBA permits were down in FY23 due to zoning amendments that had been adopted allowing Accessory Dwelling Units by right & some Food & Drink Establishments by right, eliminating the need for ZBA Special Permits & public hearings.

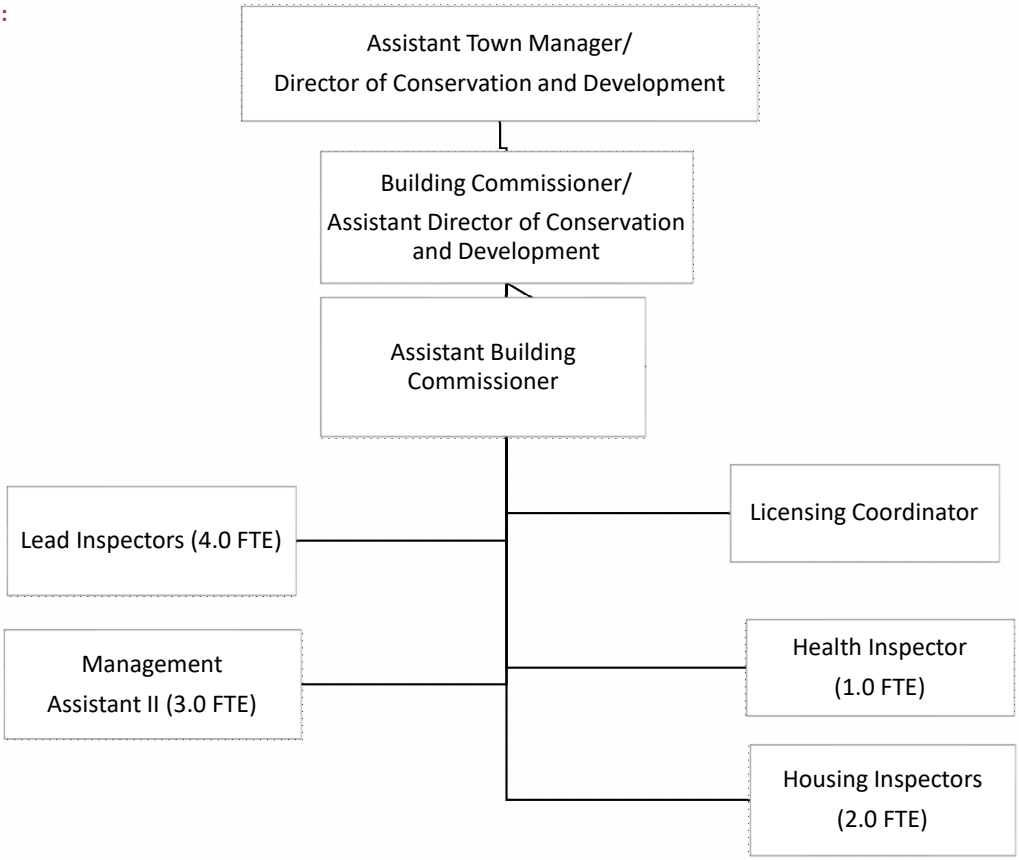


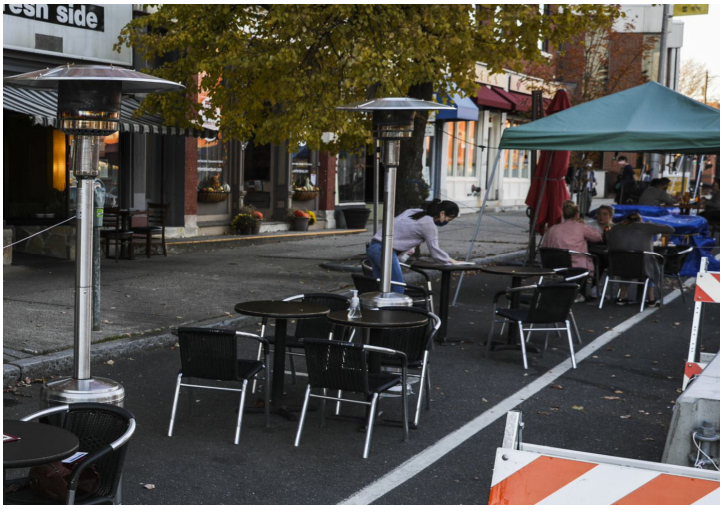
For more information, visit the Planning department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/651/Planning-Zoning

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Function: To ensure the public health, safety, and welfare of the inhabitants of the Town by administering the General Laws and Regulations of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts and Town of Amherst Bylaws as they relate to land use and to the construction and occupancy of buildings and structures.

Organization:





(Photo of outdoor dining)

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Development of enhanced Residential Rental Permitting Program.
- Updated Food Truck Regulations.
- Assisted with many special projects including Bang's Community Center Renovation, conceptual planning for permanent shelter and housing, facilities conditions study, building scanning, and Hickory Ridge trails parking area.
- Activated North Amherst Library community space.
- Scanned all Zoning Board of Appeals historical documents, permits, and decisions to enable Town staff and the public to electronically search for and view records associated with a property.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To proactively enforce improved compliance at residential rental properties.
- To implement an electronic document management system established for all Conservation and Development records.
- To improve the Inspection Services website to expand information and resources.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To assist the Town Council Community Resources Committee with development of updated Rental Regulations and Property Nuisance Bylaw. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To develop online reporting for sidewalk obstruction response recently assigned to Inspection Servcies. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To explore having Inspection Services assist with building space reservation and use. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To transition from complaint only to inspection program related to residential rental properties. **ONGOING**
- To transition to new State codes relative to energy compliance, general building code, and health codes. **ONGOING**
- To work with the Board of License Commissioners to amend Rental Regulations and other regulations. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To launch the Residential Rental Inspection Program.
- To transition fully from a complaint-only to a proactive inspection program for residential rental properties.
- To continue to provide public education about codes, regulations, and permitting procedures.

CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	811,880	823,292	831,798	1,017,117	1,092,061	74,944	7.4%
Operating Expenses	$	20,346	21,095	19,598	29,495	29,495	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	832,226	844,386	851,396	1,046,612	1,121,556	74,944	7.2%

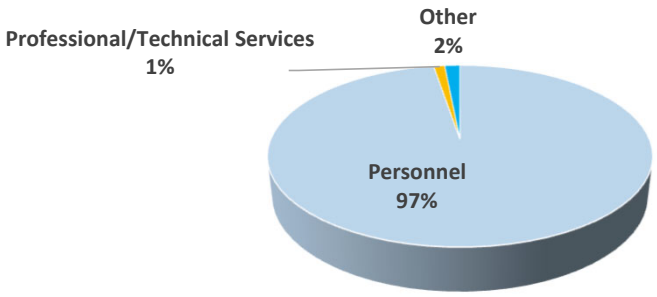
Major Components:

Personnel Services provide funds for the Building Commissioner, Assistant Building Commissioner, 3 Lead Inspectors, 1 Building Inspectors, 1 Health Inspectors, a licensing coordinator, 3 Management Assistants, 2 Housing Inspectors, and part-time or substitute Plumbing, Electrical, and Gas Inspectors.

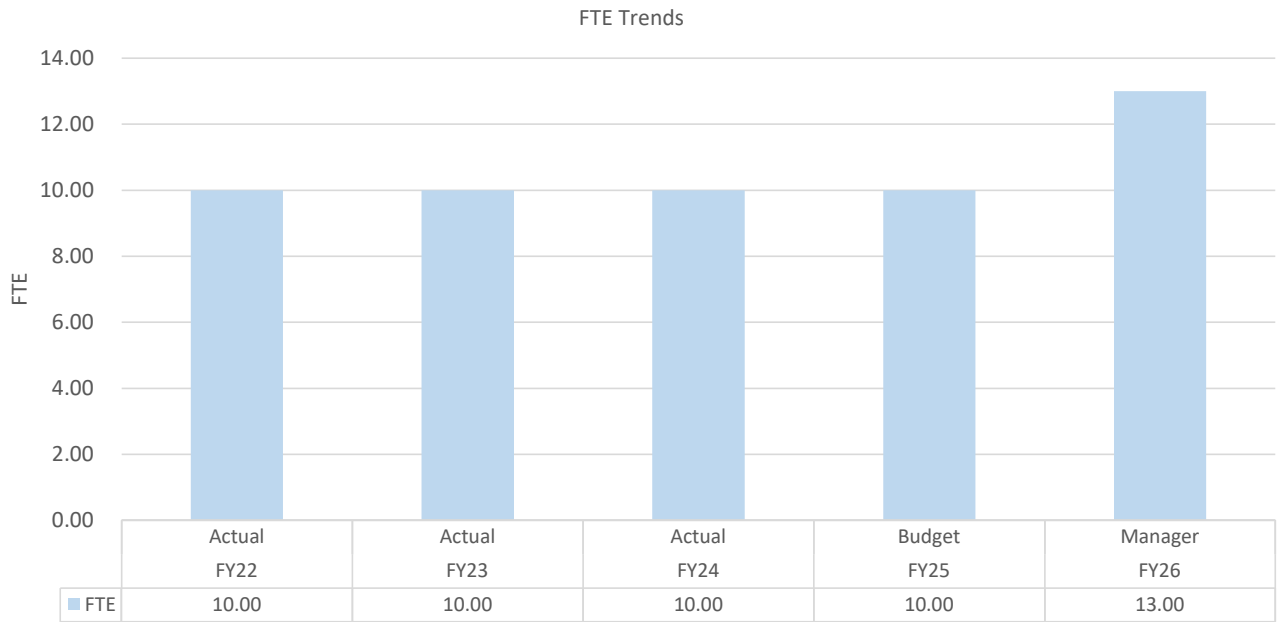
Professional/Technical Services provides the funds for the regional sealer of weights and measures program.

Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increase due to projected step increases as well as the additional staff to begin the new rental registration program and job classifications.



Staffing Trends:



CONSERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT: INSPECTION SERVICES (5241)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
PERMITS ISSUED:					
Building Permits	838	888	1,107	1,288	1,388
Electrical Permits	839	751	998	1,158	1,142
Gas Permits	193	168	205	183	201
Plumbing Permits	335	251	301	345	384
Mechanical	20	13	2	7	46
Demolition Permits	22	24	18	18	13
Certificates of Inspection	202	106	85	68	205
Certificates of Occupancy	45	31	34	32	17
Total Permits	2,494	2,232	2,750	3,099	3,396
INSPECTIONS					
Building	1,056	811	1,994	2,469	1,793
Electrical	1,195	501	1,138	1,837	1,762
Gas	125	107	327	289	209
Plumbing	208	204	540	592	389
Total Building Inspections	2,584	1,623	3,999	5,187	4,114
Business Licenses	297	172	270	234	240
Health Permits/Licenses	324	218	363	279	337
Health Inspections	360	441	446	505	565
Rental Permits	1,212	1,380	1,369	1,223	1,227
COMPLAINTS AND VIOLATIONS					
Zoning	96	15	15	12	19
Code	144	45	251	112	185
WEIGHTS AND MEASURES					
Inspections	27	24	31	29	28

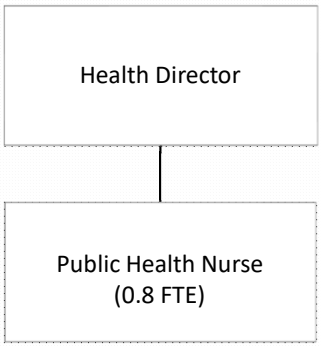
Notable Trends:
Steady increase in permits.

For more information, visit the Inspection Services webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/231/Inspection-Services

COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Function: To promote the health and well-being of the Amherst community and eliminate health inequities. The work of the Health Department is organized into five major service areas: Access to Health Care; Infectious Disease Control; Disease Prevention and Health Promotion; Health Policy; and Emergency Preparedness.

Organization:



(Photo of Public Health Director Malin and Town Manager Bockelman at Cuppa Joe)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Distributed approx 9,000 free COVID tests to community-based organizations, low-income apartment complexes and the general public.
- Held five COVID/flu vaccine clinics and provided vaccines to homebound residents.
- Collaborated with Craig's Doors to offer Hepatitis A vaccine to their guests.
- Hosted the second annual health fair and vaccine event for the Native American community on the Town Common.
- Continued wastewater surveillance testing for COVID in cooperation with the Department of Public Works.
- Provided childhood immunizations to students enrolling in ARPS through the Vaccines for Children program and connected their families to resources and supports.
- Expanded sharps disposal program to include free services for Amherst, Pelham and Shutesbury residents.
- Conducted ongoing mosquito surveillance and became part of pilot larval mitigation program.
- Launched "Kindness Campaign" and mental health workshop series in collaboration with the Recreation Department to highlight the link between kindness and mental wellness in the community.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To sustain a workforce that meets the needs of the Town in light of the shifting public health landscape.
- To continue to incorporate health equity and anti-racist principles into the work of the Department, with attention to the social determinants of health.
- To collaborate with Town departments and regional coalitions on emergency preparedness planning that addresses new challenges posed by climate change and other factors.
- To collaborate with CRESS and other departments to build Town capacity to respond to the shifting demographics of the community, the arrival of migrant families, and the needs of the unhoused.
- To ensure members of our community have access to vaccines and to accurate information about vaccine safety.
- To continue shared service programming through the Public Health Excellence grant.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To develop a strategic program plan for the Public Health Department based on the Community Health Needs Assessment. **ONGOING**
- To continue shared service programming - such as vaccine clinics and health education and promotion activities, including CPR and other trainings - through the Public Health Excellence grant. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To conduct a community needs assessment about the impact of the opioid crisis and develop a multi-year plan to spend the opioid funds. **ONGOING**
- To collaborate with other Town Departments to assess resources for people experiencing mental health and substance use challenges and develop programming to address identified needs. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To collaborate with community-based organizations to implement harm reduction efforts, including expanded sharps disposal programs and narcan distribution and training. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To make improvements to the Public Health website so that the site is more engaging and accessible to the public. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To reinstate the Human Services Network meetings for local human service organizations.
- To assess community need for strategies and programs to reduce opioid overdose and implement harm reduction efforts.
- To sustain wastewater surveillance for infectious disease and potentially expand the scope to include more organisms.
- To promote vaccine safety and efficacy and provide resources to faciliate access to vaccines for our community.
- In host an intergenerational Wellness Learning Community and offer other public health programming such as drop-in blood pressure clinics.

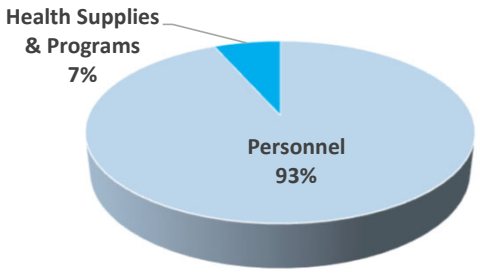
COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	117,175	165,187	156,817	204,098	209,621	5,523	2.7%
Operating Expenses	$	2,341	6,404	10,922	14,803	14,803	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	119,517	171,591	167,739	218,901	224,424	5,523	2.5%

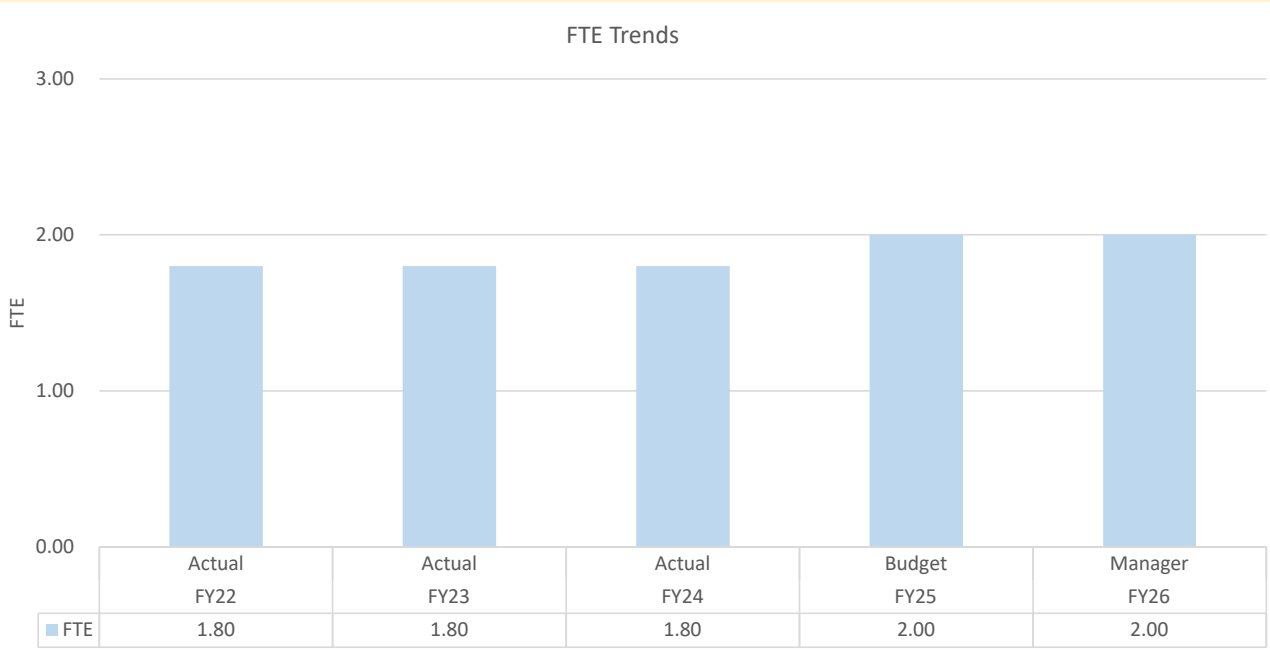
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for a Health Director and a Public Health Nurse. Part time administrative help is also included.

Health Supplies and Programs includes printing and advertising, dues and subscriptions, and for materials necessary to conduct health programs and clinics.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services increase due to projected step increases.



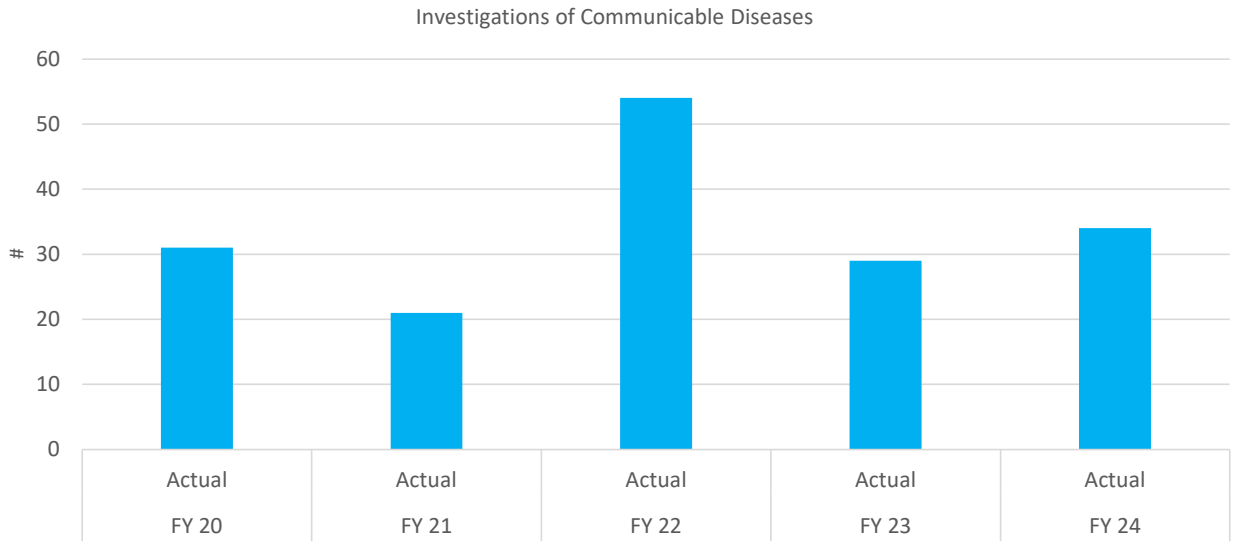
Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: PUBLIC HEALTH (6510)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Community Health Planning /Promotion					
Sponsor Local/Regional Educational Programs	0	1	1	2	6
Grants Applied For	0	0	0	0	2
Grants Administered	1	1	1	1	0
Vaccinations					
Influenza	55	55	60	32	115
COVID-19	0	17,290	550	1,409	158
Childhood Vaccines	0	0	0	48	142
Children Immunized	0	0	0	20	66
Investigation of Communicable Diseases					
COVID-19 Cases	100	2,658	6,882	987	327
Infectious Disease Cases (Not Tuberculosis or COVID-19)	110	26	108	247	127
Tuberculosis Screening/Prevention	31	21	54	29	34
Total	241	2,705	7,044	1,263	488
Tobacco Compliance Checks	60	60	76	54	56

Notable Trends:
COVID case numbers continue to be lower than in past years due to the current practice of using at-home antigen tests, with results not being reported to DPH. COVID vaccine numbers are also lower since the COVID vaccine was commercialized in 2023, meaning that municipalities no longer receive large quantities of free vaccine from the State and most consumers are being directed to get their vaccines through their health care provider or at local pharmacies.

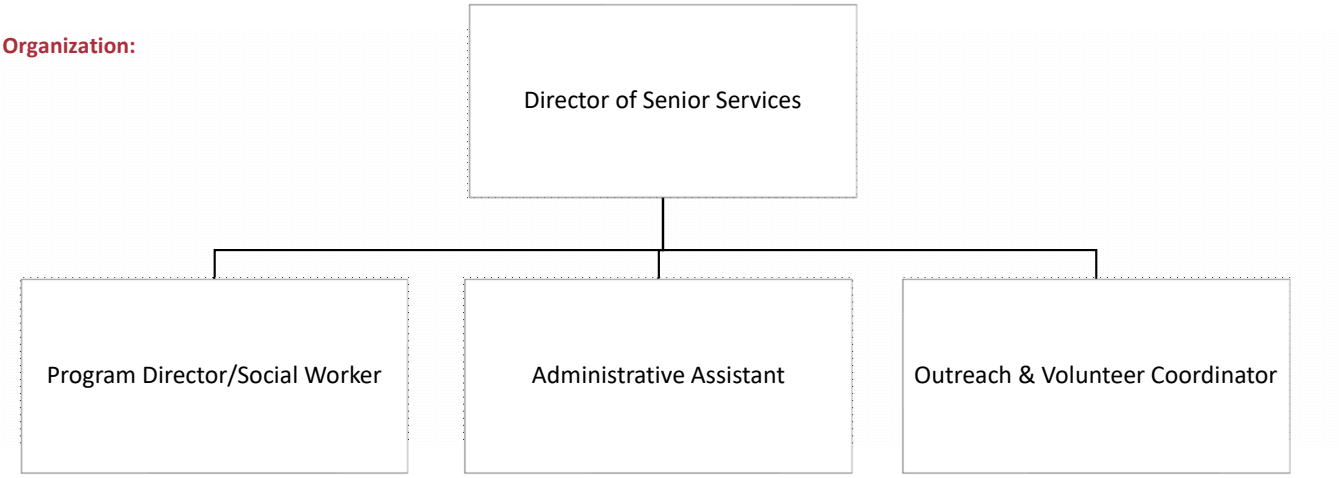


For more information, visit the Public Health Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/65/Health

COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Function: To welcome and serve the needs of the many diverse populations of older adults in Amherst and those who support them. To optimize the quality of life for older adults; empower them to remain independent; promote physical, mental and emotional well-being; and encourage participation in community life. To provide services, programs, and advocacy that value older people as important assets in the community.

Organization:



(Photo of new mural painted by Amherst College student volunteers)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Resumption of food distribution program, Wednesday Markets.
- Outreach session at Clark House and Ann Whalen with Volunteer & Outreach Coordinator and Social Services Coordinator.
- Resumption of student intern program with participation from Amherst College.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To develop space for an exercise gym to strengthen resilience and reduce isolation.
- To navigate the challanges of enhancing programming through grants and the Friends of the Senior Center funding.
- To increase BIPOC leadership, recruitment, outreach, and services.
- To explore options for creation of a new or updated Senior Center.
- To improve Senior Center security.
- To fully staff and support the Silver Shuttle Ridership program.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To increase average daily attendance by 10%. **ONGOING**
- To recruit student groups for volunteer opportunities and intergenerational programming. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To obtain Dementia-Friendly designation for the Town. **ONGOING**
- To increase social service programming. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To increase Silver Shuttle ridership by 15%. **ONGOING**
- To increase volunteer recruitment to match FY22 levels. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To increase average daily attendance by 10%.
- To obtain Dementia-Friendly designation for the Town.
- To increase volunteer recruitment to match FY22 levels.
- To recruit new partners/vendors for Wednesday Market.
- To examine operational efficiencies and development improvements for file storage and communication.
- To make the Senior Center an exciting, welcoming hub for seniors.

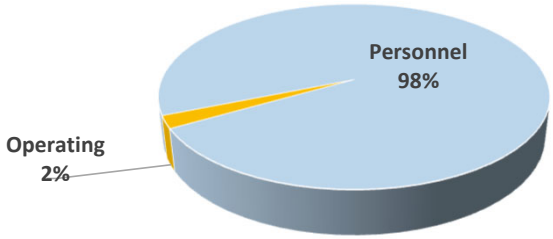
COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	191,433	194,207	221,627	239,990	245,351	5,361	2.2%
Operating Expenses	$	1,459	2,776	2,300	5,473	5,473	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	192,892	196,983	223,927	245,463	250,824	5,361	2.2%

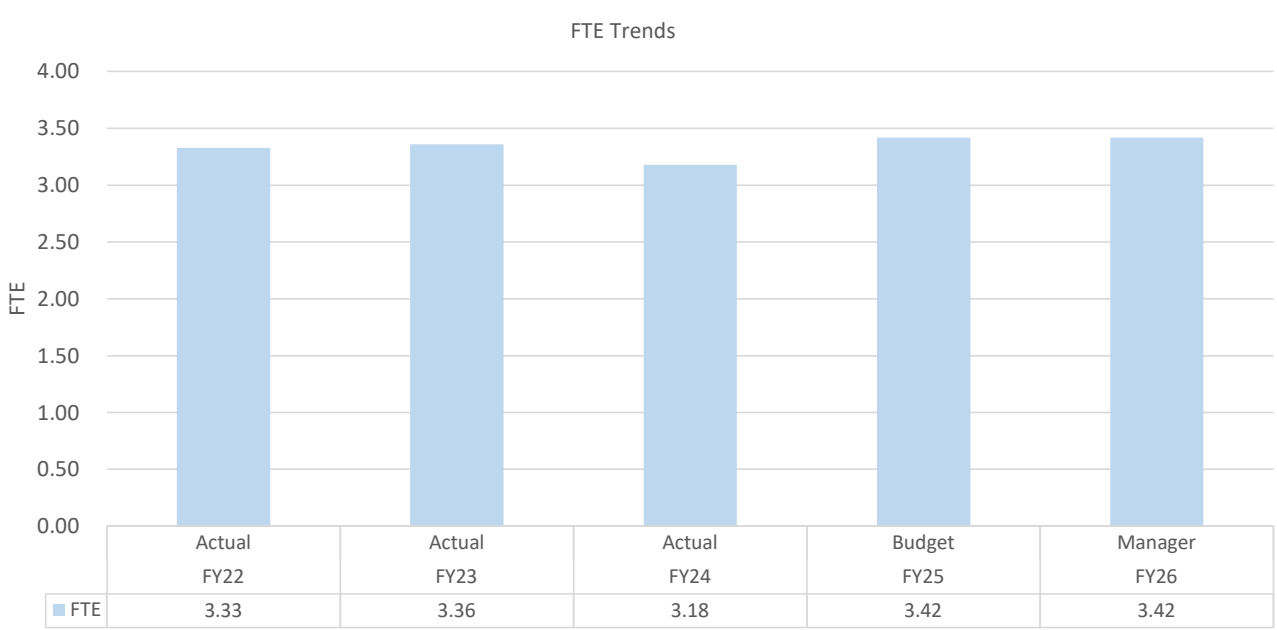
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for the Director of Senior Services, a Program Director/Social Worker, an Administrative Assistant, and an Outreach & Volunteer Coordinator. State funding offsets $40,000.

The Friends of the Amherst Senior Center, a non-profit organization, provides funding to cover many additional operating expenses.

Significant Changes:
Personnel Services increase due to projected step increases.



Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: SENIOR CENTER (6541)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Average daily attendance *	125	130	105	110	100
Nutrition					
Congregate & To-Go Meals Served	6,399	6,501	8,369	9,568	7,760
Home Delivered Dinner or Baby Berk Truck Lunch - UMass	5,080	2,500	0	0	0
Home Delivered Hot Lunch - Highland Valley Elder Services	6,801	6,922	11,918	13,352	20,384
Support Services					
AARP Tax Preparation	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	191
Newsletters Mailed (6x/year)	22,000	22,000	21,600	21,600	800
Case Management/Information Referral/Advocacy	7,342	8,500	6,329	5,981	5,642
Health Benefits Counseling (SHINE) Visits/Client	203/178	152/123	231/204	254/217	234/212
Legal Assistance Referrals (to Western Mass. Legal Services)	31	20	4	165	88
Tax Work-Off Program Participants	28	27	20	16	15
Medical Ride Program	89	0	0	0	0
Medical Equipment Loans	156	65	113	188	230
Recreation/Education/Health Programs (participants)					
Silver Shuttle Riders/ Rides	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	54/844
Cultural Events (Classes, Seminars, Concerts)	742	1,768	2,115	2,331	1,971
Exercise/Recreation	1,166	4,361	4,160	6,239	4,051
Health Screenings and Clinics (Nursing Center, Foot Assessment & BP clinics)	1,042	1,008	495	510	597
SC Nursing Center Visits	300	1,160	0	0	0
Volunteer Overview					
Total volunteers	260	130	80	47	42
Total # of Volunteer hours	15,732	7,351	1,932	3,451	2,889

* FY20 prior to pandemic/ 0 after

Notable Trends:

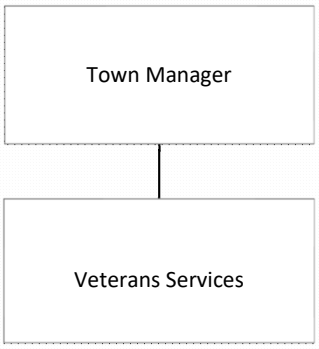
The newsletter is now distributed primarily online and through email instead of bulk mail. Highland Valley Elder Services now distributes meals for the Senior Center. The Senior Services Department has resumed the Wednesday Market which offers hundreds of pounds of fruits, vegetables, sweets, bread, and more courtesy of Whole Foods Market.

For more information, visit the Senior Center's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/269/Senior-Services

COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Function: To aid, support, and advocate for the veterans of our community and/or their dependents by identifying benefits on the local, state, and Federal level and providing financial, fuel, and medical assistance to veterans and/or their dependents who are eligible under M.G.L. Ch. 115. Amherst is a member of the Central Hampshire Veteran Services district with its headquarters located in Northampton. The district currently includes 11 communities: Amherst, Northampton, Pelham, Hadley, Williamsburg, Goshen, Cummington, Chesterfield, Worthington, Middlefield, and Chester.

Organization:



(Photo of Veterans Day Ceremony)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Recent Accomplishments:

- The district has expanded to include Huntington, Hatfield, and Granby.
- Worked with Craig's Doors, VA homeless program, SOLDIER ON SSVF program, and the CRESS team working with veterans struggling with mental health issues causing evictions and homelessness or risk of homelessness. Continued to work with Western Mass. Housing Court to assist and prevent evictions.
- Continued to exercise an in-person Memorial Day procession with a ceremony of remembrance to honor those military members from Amherst.
- Developed and facilitaded a program titled "Know It Before You Need It" designed to educate elderly veterans and their caregivers about relevant benefits and services as they age.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To find new and innovative methods of outreach to ensure all who need assistance receive it.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To research, plan, and implement a training event to improve the lives of military and veteran family members with a goal to reach health care and behavioral health providers, first responders, law enforcement personnel, veteran organizations, veteran services representatives, guidance counselors and educators, pastoral care and clergy, and all others who connect with family members or who interact with military and Veteran communities to improve their lives and well-being. **ONGOING**
- To enhance the Memorial Day ceremony by honoring family members of Amherst veterans who have passed away during their service or later due to wounds or disease incurred during military service and awarding two medals for this recognition: the medal of Liberty and the medal of Fidelity. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To participate in a state-funded trial project of the "Just Ask" campaign that was designed and will be implemented by the Western Massachusetts Veteran Outreach Project. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To propose to rearrange the current structure of the organization to realign resources to allow for four full-time staff in accordance as approved by the Executive of Veterans Services.
- To plan two educational events around specific topics that are regarded as newly emerging or difficult to manage. Eg. moral injury, spouse/child transitional care including creating training videos for ongoing education.
- To create of a Veterans' Commemoration Committee to honor and recognize the service and sacrifices of veterans in the community through organized commemorations, educatiuonal initiatives, and community engagement.
- To establish Amherst as a "Purple Heart Community".

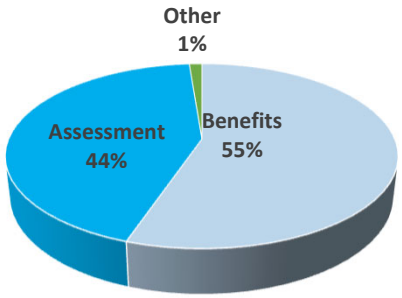
COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	257,514	276,662	251,411	277,878	271,609	(6,269)	-2.3%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	257,514	276,662	251,411	277,878	271,609	(6,269)	-2.3%

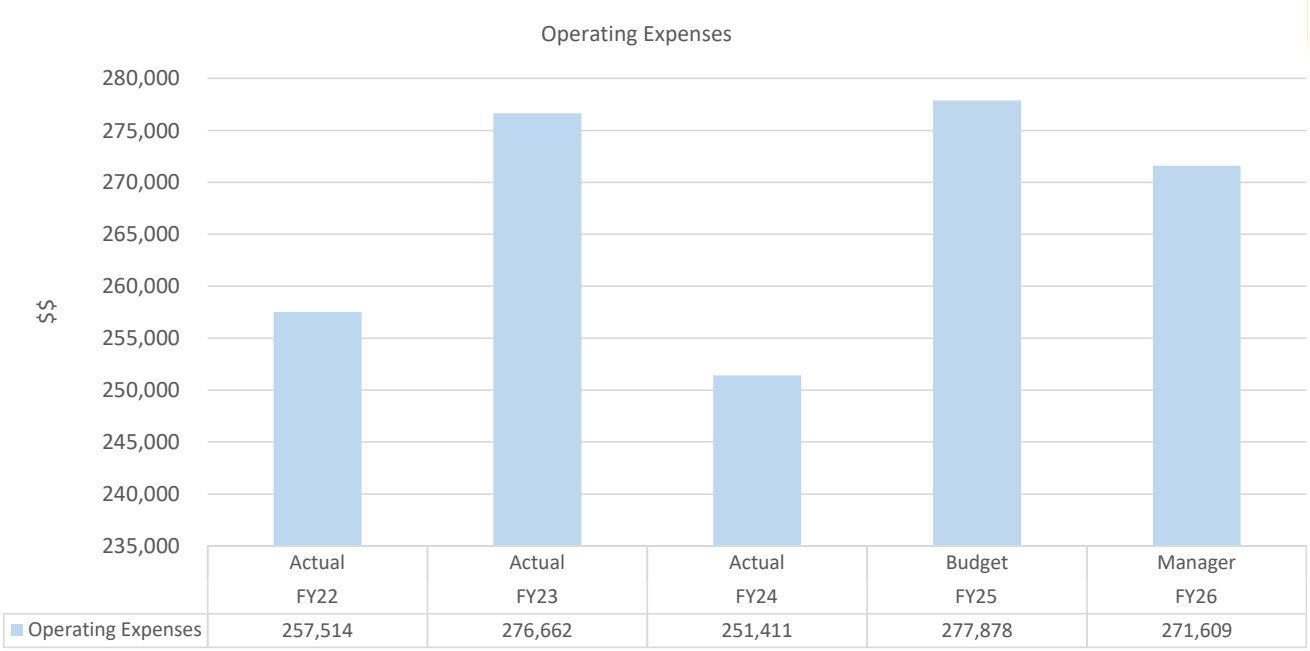
Major Components:
Assessment paid to the Central Hampshire Veterans' Services district.

Benefits include funds for cash, rental, and medical assistance for qualifying veterans.

Significant Changes:
None.



Expenditure Trends:

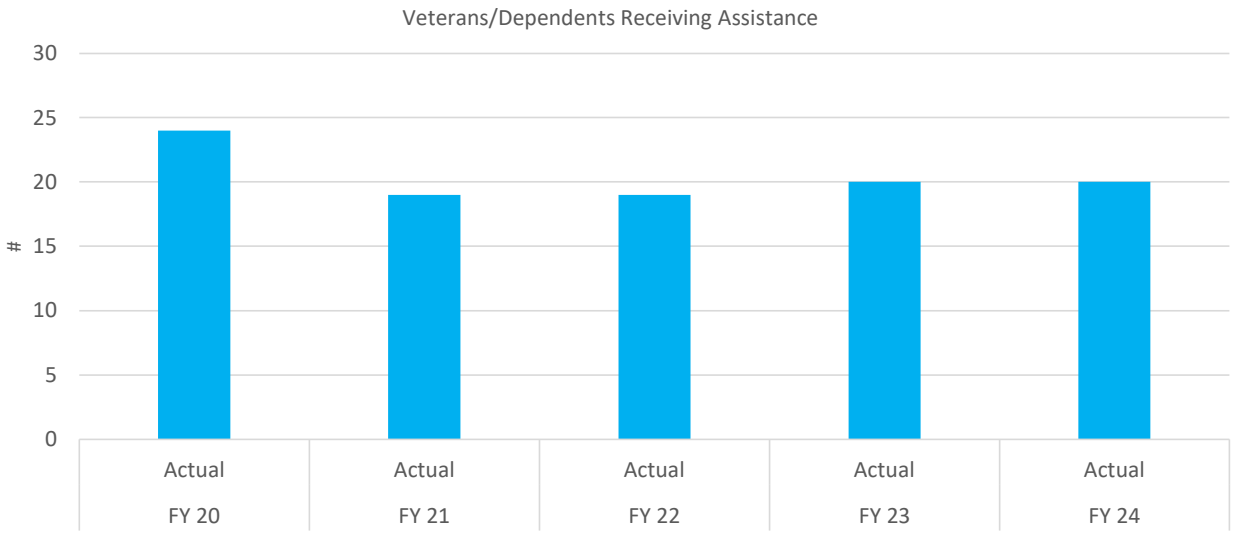


COMMUNITY SERVICES: VETERANS' SERVICES (6543)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Veterans/Dependents Receiving Assistance	24	19	19	20	20
Veterans/Dependents Assisted with VA Claims	26	23	26	30	28
Benefits Paid Out	$ 147,683	$ 130,013	$ 137,954	$ 166,129	$ 137,919
75% State Reimbursement	$ 95,001	$ 98,368	$ 103,465	$ 120,950	$ 103,439

(reimbursements are one full year behind)

Notable Trends:
None.

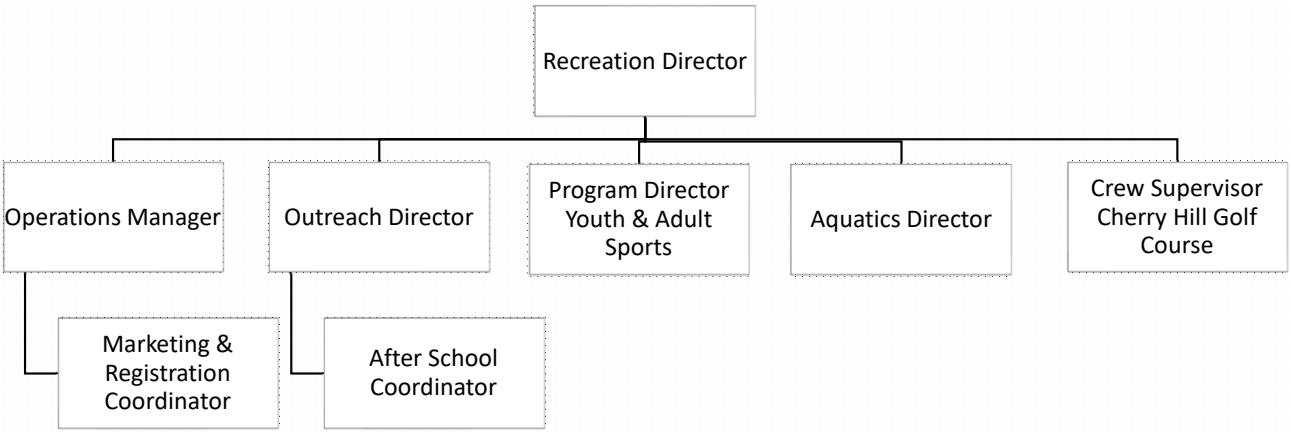


For more information, visit the Veterans Services webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/435/Veterans-Services

COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Function: To enrich the quality of life for all members of the community by providing the highest level of recreational opportunities.

Organization:



(Photo of Morning Movement Program)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Received the 2025 MRPA Regional Community Impact of the Year Award for committed work in inclusive programming.
- Partnered with the ARPS Family Center to continue the dynamic Morning Movement and Mentoring Program (MMMP) for middle school students.
- Introduced a Summer Men's Basketball League pilot and all-season Sandlot Pickleball programming as popular adult offerings.
- Hosted a series of popular community engagement activities in Outreach: "Salsa in the Park," "Pop-up in the Park", Halloween Spooktacular, Luminaria on the Town Common, and Winterfest events.
- Increased presence at partnered community events: Amherst Block Party, First Night- Back to School, Healthy Living Community Festival, Merry Maple, and various cultural celebrations with DEI
- Partnered with Amherst Police to introduce the RISE program to select middle school students in a workshop series building community, identity, and responsibility from a DEI perspective.
- Successfully executed the Town of Amherst Halloween, Winterfest, and Independence Day events- enjoyed by thousands of spectators/participants.
- Continued to manage athletic feeder programs in partnership with the school department

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To simplify and improve processes for Financial Assistance Program.
- To advance in pursuit of permanent playing options for pickleball.
- To continue to address community objectives and recommendations as a result of feedback from 2024 Community Survey.
- To continue a process of re-branding Amherst Recreation.
- To effectively manage new responsibilities of athletic feeder programs.
- To take inventory and evaluate existing programs offered and review fee schedules.
- To continue to provide high quality recreational programming while ensuring the community's health and safety.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To evaluate/expand new Outreach Initiatives within the community (MMMP, Sensory Inclusion, Mental Health Initiative w/ Health Department, Kestrel/Hitchcock Center Partnership). **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To evaluate/expand existing sports Feeder Programs**.** **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To build new community support partnerships (with Amherst Police, DEI, School Department). **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To explore possibilities of Inclusion Sports and Special Olympics programming. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To utilize ARPA funds to improve programming. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To simplify and improve processes for Financial Assistance Program. **ONGOING**
- To proceed with plans forward for Pickleball in Amherst. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

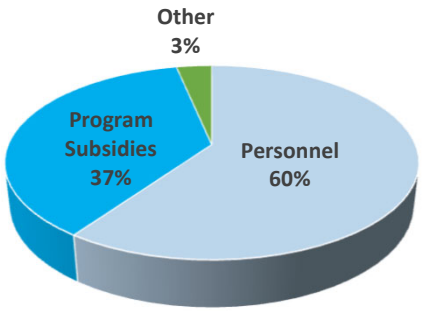
- To advance in pursuit of permanent playing options for pickleball.
- To simplify and improve processes for Financial Assistance Program.
- To rebuild enrollment numbers in Youth Sports
- To pilot a successful Youth Entrepreneurship Program
- To evaluate/secure the long-term viability of MMMP and RISE as youth programming initiatives

COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	298,010	273,104	335,437	346,387	335,111	(11,276)	-3.3%
Operating Expenses	$	133,437	127,635	71,632	225,816	225,816	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	431,447	400,739	407,069	572,203	560,927	(11,276)	-2.0%

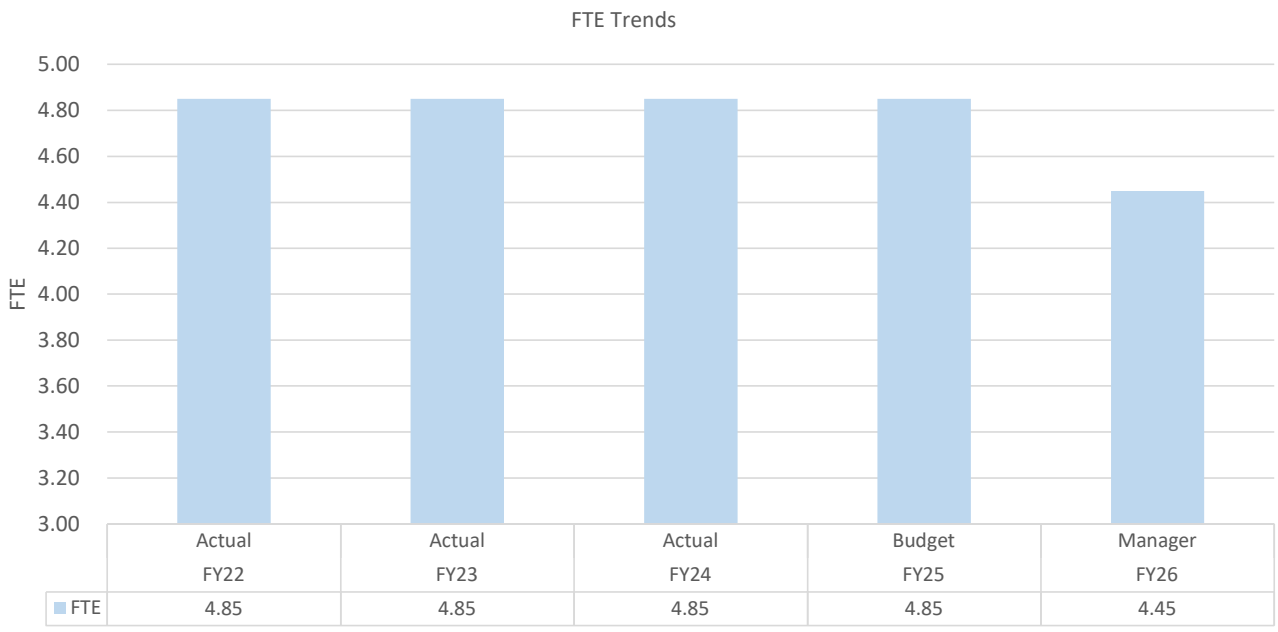
Major Components:
Personnel Services include salaries for the Director (shared 70/20/10% with the Pools and Cherry Hill Golf Course), a full time Program Director (shared 90/10% with Cherry Hill Golf Course), an Outreach Director, the Operations Manager (shared 92.5/7.5% with the Pools), and two Customer Assistants (one shared 92.5/7.5% with the Pools and one part-time). The Director also oversees Cherry Hill, After School, and Revolving Fund activities.

Program Subsidies provide tuition assistance to low-income families.



Significant Changes:
Personnel Services decrease due to freezing .4 FTE.

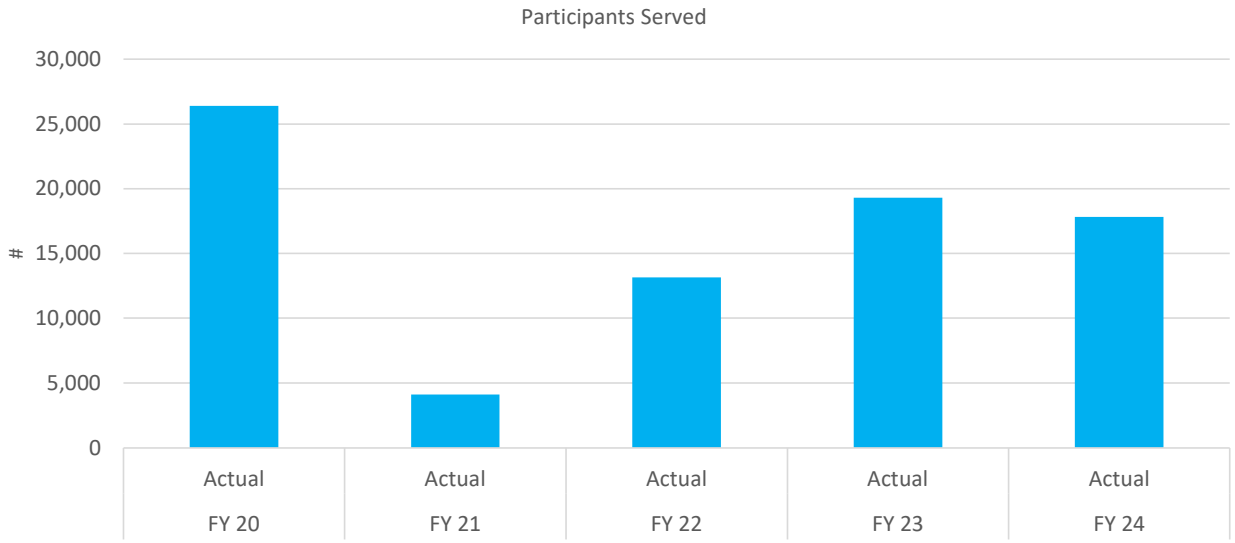
Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: RECREATION (6630)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Youth Programs Run	139	34	212	206	233
Adult Programs Run	23	11	17	18	23
Participants Served	26,398	4,114	13,147	19,303	17,820
Total Registrants	1,428	1,529	2,897	2,742	3,520
Total Community Events Attendees	24,970	2,585	10,250	14,070	14,200
Youth Sports Coaches Trained	70	12	90	80	82
Coaches Training Sessions Offered	4	1	1	1	1
Community Theater Tickets Processed	4,544	0	0	4,280	3,627
Fee Subsidy Families Served	268	103	236	228	239
Fee Subsidy Individuals Served	615	1,494	987	915	1,057
Recreation Commission Meetings	8	12	9	9	10
Program Volunteers Utilized	589	209	180	200	200
Estimated Volunteer Hours	14,725	12,508	5,760	6,520	6,231
Committees Staffed	8	3	4	2	2
Partnerships/Collaborations	16	7	12	12	14

Notable Trends:
None.

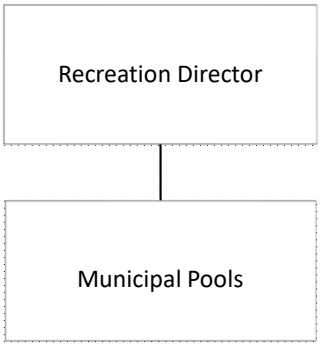


For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3564/Recreation-Department

COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

Function: To provide high quality aquatics programs and experiences that are safe, fun and affordable, and that promote water safety and the enjoyment of swimming as a life-long recreational pursuit.

Organization:



(Photo of outdoor municipal pool)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Increased participation with Recreational Swim Team - Amherst United.
- Improved operations of outdoor aquatics programs and facility management.
- Promoted adult community Masters Swimming Program for training access.
- Outreach with Amherst Survival Center, School Department to provide free access passes to pools.
- Built relationships with Hampshire College and the adult swim population, addressing community interests through Masters, Lap Swim scheduling.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To make progress in the goal of ensuring that every Amherst child learn how to swim regardless of ability to pay.
- To manage the increasing seasonal demands of the pools.
- To offer special attention to 1-1 formats for children with special needs learning to swim.
- To equitably manage scheduling difficulties with an increasing popularity of highlighted programs in finite space.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To create and implement a "learn to swim" program that is FREE of cost for NON-Swimmers only as an initiative to prevent drowning. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To install new POS (Point of Sale) for outdoor pool payment of fees. **ACCOMPLISHED**

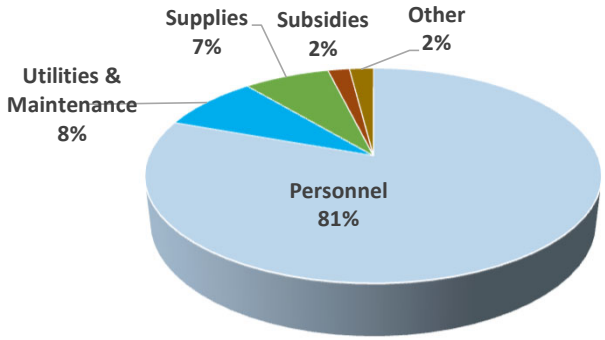
Upcoming Objectives:

- To accommodate the increasing demands of successful aquatics offerings: Adaptive Aquatics, Masters Swimming and Amherst United
- To secure the resources necessary to commit to these expanding programs in the present and future.
- To provide more creative ways of engaging the community in Amherst Recreation Outreach initiatives
- To make progress to meet the goal of ensuring that every Amherst child learn how to swim regardless of ability to pay.

COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

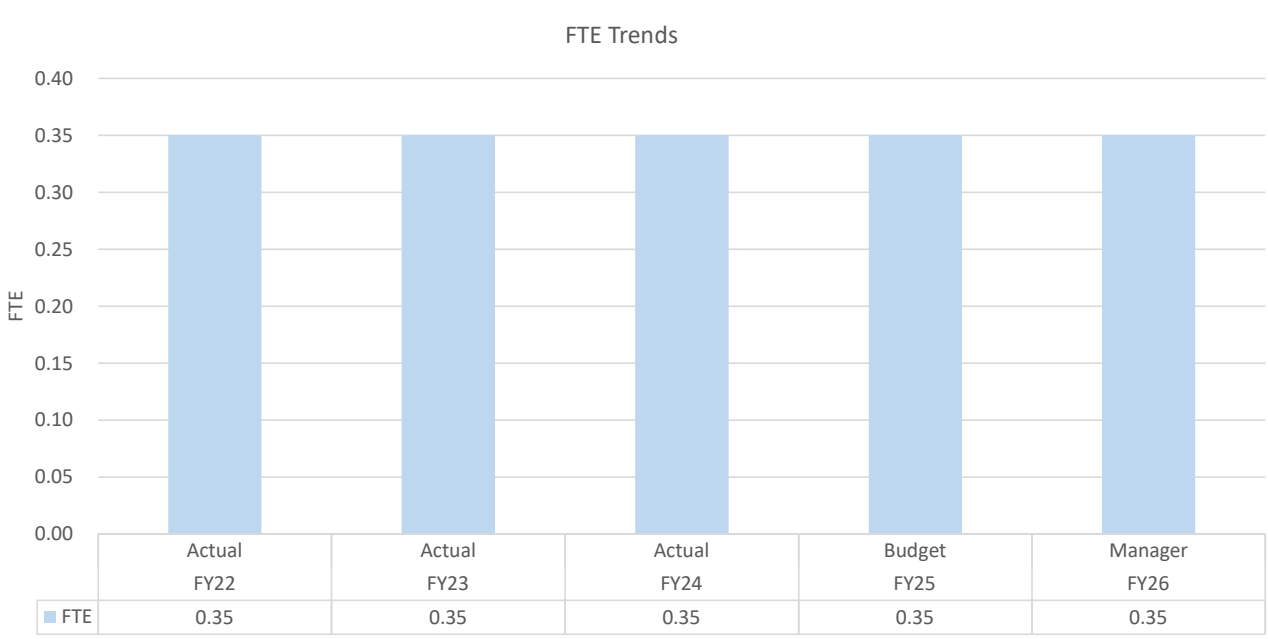
Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	131,120	167,183	142,698	175,972	176,643	671	0.4%
Operating Expenses	$	43,695	39,520	40,131	42,800	42,800	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	174,815	206,703	182,830	218,772	219,443	671	0.3%

Major Components:
Personnel Services include the Director's salary (shared 20/70/10% with the Recreation and Cherry Hill Golf Course), the Operations Manager and a Customer Assistant are shared (7.5/92.5%) with Recreation, and part-time non-benefited lifeguards and instructors. Operating Expenses include Utilities & Maintenance (electricity, fuel, water/sewer etc.), Supplies (chemicals, cleaning and other departmental supplies, as well as state-mandated uniforms), Subsidies that provide financial assistance to low income families, Other (training, credit card fees, inspections, communications and small tools and equipment).



Significant Changes:
None.

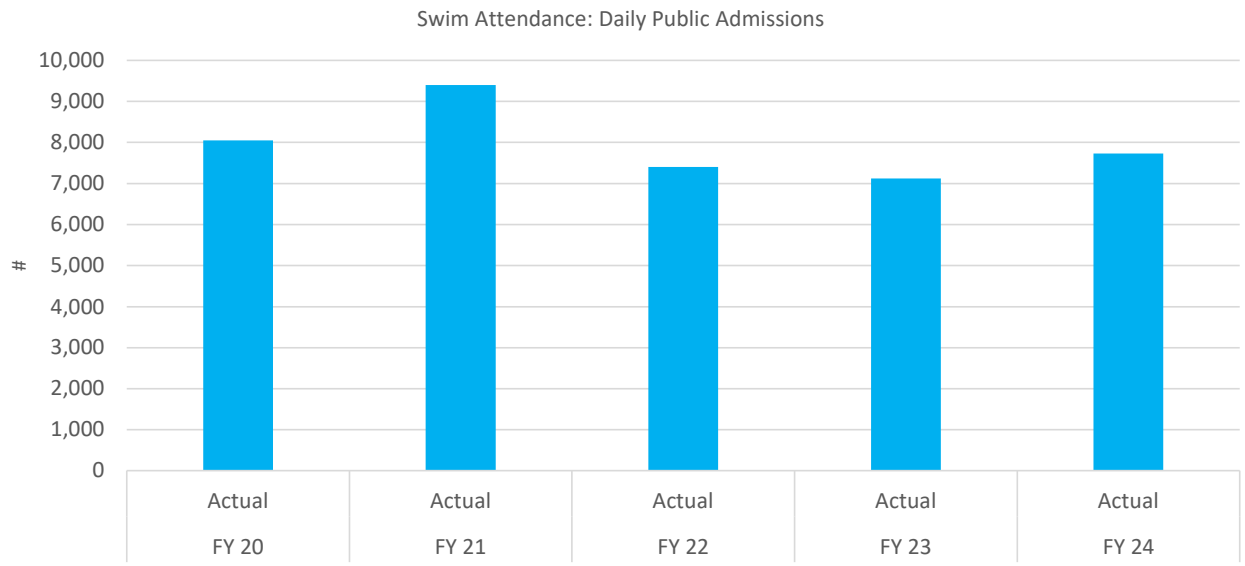
Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: MUNICIPAL POOLS (6633)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Number of Operating Days					
War Memorial	65	77	49	50	50
Mill River	92	77	66	65	65
Pool Memberships Sold					
Full Summer Memberships	150	125	129	120	112
Half Summer Memberships	51	88	42	163	102
Total Memberships Sold	201	213	171	283	214
Swim Attendance					
Daily Public Admissions	8,054	9,400	7,406	7,120	7,728
Camp Admissions	0	0	2,720	1,950	2,036
Total Admissions	8,054	9,400	10,126	9,070	9,764
Average Daily Attendance	124	122	176	140	170
(based on 65 days)					
Swim Lessons					
Public Swim Lessons Participants	0	61	448	461	678
Camp Swim Lessons Participants	0	0	456	515	575
Total Swim Lessons Attendees Participants Taught	0	61	904	976	1,253
Free Passes Provided to Social Service Agencies	625	500	800	700	700

Notable Trends:
None.

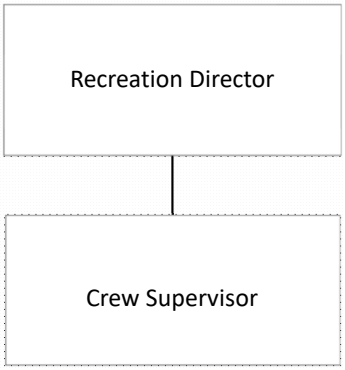


For more information, visit the Pools webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/370/Pools

COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6660)

Function: To provide a high quality and affordable golf experience for residents of the Town and the surrounding area as well as other year round recreational experiences for the community such as skiing, hiking, sledding, and special events.

Organization:



(Photo of Cherry Hill golf course)

COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6660)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Designed and introduced an 18 hole Disc Golf course for drop-in public play
- Hosted an increased number of Men's and Women's League participants
- Continued to increase the number of Student Golfers by offering affordable memberships.
- Maintained trails and actively supported a range of winter activities such as hiking and running.
- Offered access to tournament organizers to run community-organized events.
- Actively assessed course user fees, including membership rates, schedule to reflect cost of service provided.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To manage the new presence of Disc Golf opportunities without sacrificing any of the safe, high quality golfing experience.
- To prepare for infrastructural challenges in an environmentally To generate revenue on the course during the offseason.
- To continue to expand recreational programming opportunities on the course to attract diverse participation.
- To create new generations of users with vested interest in the course- its programs and its long term health.
- To provide resources to meet infrastructure needs to keep the course operational.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To expand on Family Day features to bring in parent-child groupings, introducing Cherry Hill to families and new generations. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To examine the structural and financial long-term viability of the course under the existing budget. **ONGOING**
- To work in active partnership with other town staff, North Amherst community members and business leaders, and Cherry Hill members to develop the clubhouse and increase its revenue-raising potential. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To examine the structural and financial long-term viability of the course under the existing budget.
- To work in active partnership with other town staff, North Amherst community members and business leaders, and Cherry Hill members to develop the clubhouse and increase its revenue-raising potential.
- To introduce Disc Golf programming as an offseason supplement to golf revenue.
- To expand membership, increase versatility, and continue to raise revenue.

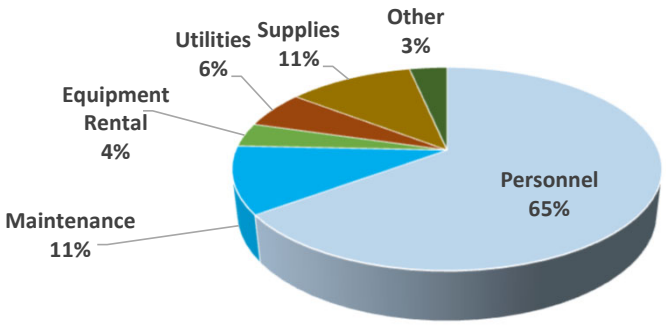
COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6660)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	132,936	146,568	152,408	151,499	154,670	3,171	2.1%
Operating Expenses	$	111,423	96,342	102,619	83,424	83,424	-	--
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	244,359	242,911	255,027	234,923	238,094	3,171	1.3%

Major Components:

Personnel Services include the salary for the Director (shared 10/70/20% with the Recreation and Pools), a Program Director (shared 10/90% with Recreation), a Crew Supervisor and wages for part-time non-benefited help to operate the clubhouse and maintain the grounds.

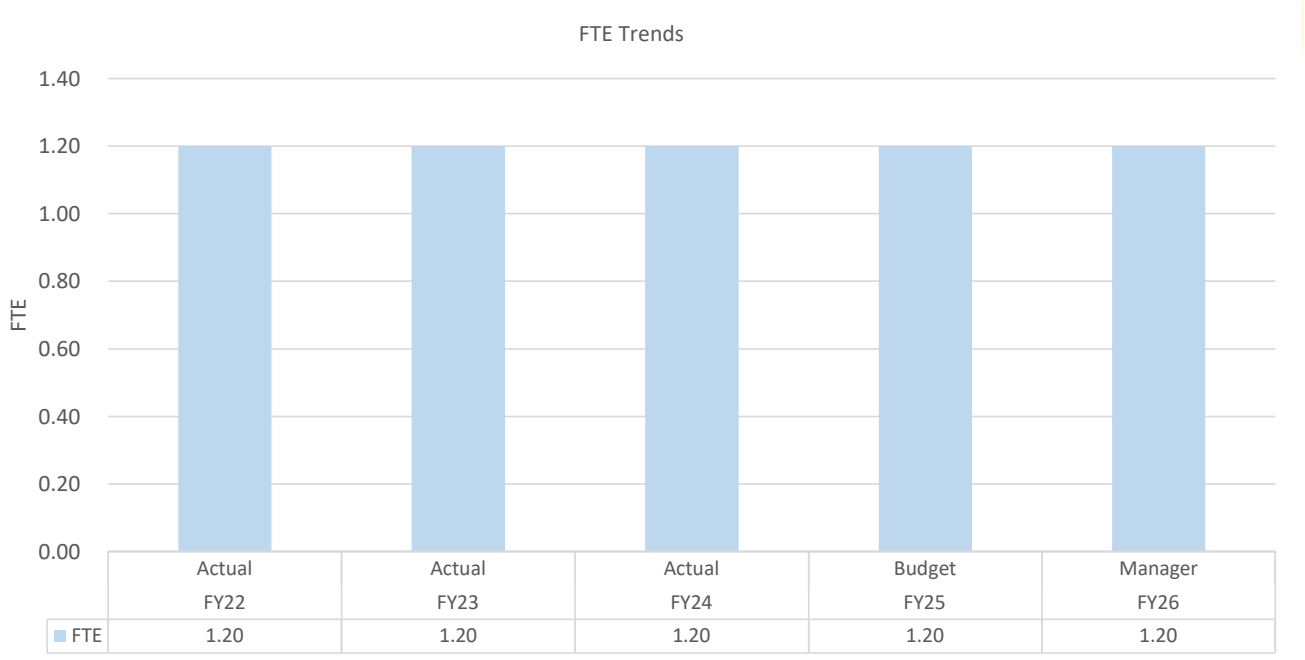
Operating Expenses include Maintenance (repairs to buildings, grounds, vehicles and equipment), Equipment Rental (lease of golf carts), Supplies (fertilizers, insecticides, grounds keeping, office, and equipment supplies), Utilities (fuel, electricity, water/sewer etc.), Other (banking fees, printing & advertising, communications, dues and subscriptions, etc.).



Significant Changes:

Personnel Services increasing due to projected step increases.

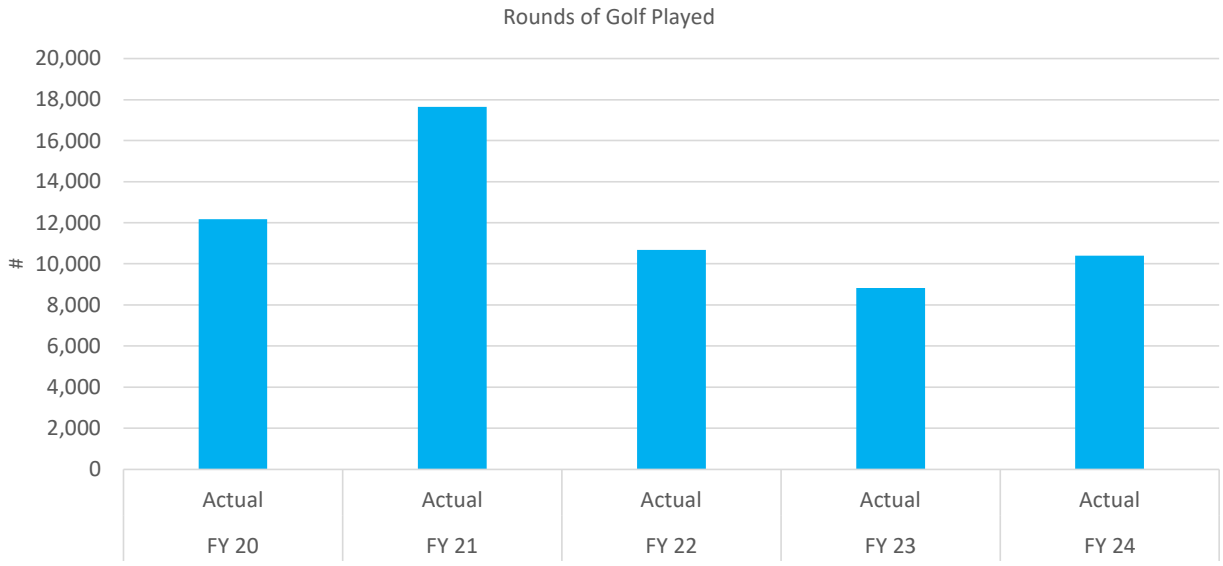
Staffing Trends:



COMMUNITY SERVICES: GOLF COURSE (6660)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Rounds of Golf Played	12,174	17,659	10,684	8,829	10,403
By Members	5,175	6,935	3,973	3,895	4,108
By General Public	6,999	10,724	6,711	4,934	6,295
Operating Days	208	191	198	189	200
Average Daily Rounds Played	59	92	54	47	52
Memberships Sold	83	78	65	84	94
Partial Memberships Sold	0	0	0	0	0
Clinic Participants	0	18	0	4	0
League Participants	0	27	33	21	50
Nordic Skiers (ARHS)	45	40	40	40	40

Notable Trends:
None.

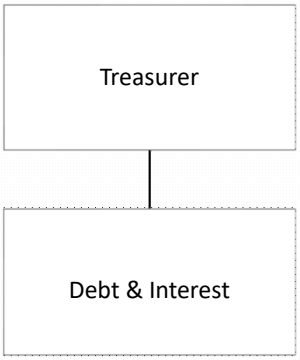


For more information, visit the Golf Course's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/373/Cherry-Hill-Golf-Course

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7701)

Function: To manage debt effectively to meet the needs of the Town and minimize debt service costs.

Organization:



(Photo of Hickory Ridge)

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7701)

Recent Accomplishments:

- Issue new long-term debt for the Fort River Elementary School construction project.
- Completed annual renewal of short-term financings.
- Completed Continuing Disclosure Report.
- Completed a Standard and Poors rateing review.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To prepare and secure financing for the Town's four municipal buildings.
- To plan for uncertain interest rates and their impact in our ability to fund major capital improvements.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To support the Town Manager and Town Council in preparing funding schedules for the four building projects. **ONGOING**
- To complete annual renewal of existing short term debt and issuance of new debt to support projects in the capital plan. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To support the Town Manager and Town Council in preparing funding schedules for the four buildings projects.
- To complete the annual renewal of existing short term debt and issuance of new debt to support projects in the capital program.

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7701)

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Operating Expenses	$	1,256,631	1,221,919	1,187,750	3,627,999	4,189,543	561,544	15.5%
Operating Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	1,256,631	1,221,919	1,187,750	3,627,999	4,189,543	561,544	15.5%

Major Components:

	Principal	Interest	Total
AMAHT Belchertown Road CPA	55,000	19,250	74,250
Kendrick Park CPA	35,000	1,050	36,050
Valley CDC - SRO Studio Apts CPA	50,000	16,250	66,250
Elementary School Project-Part 1 of 3	205,000	485,350	690,350
Elementary School Project-Part 2 of 3	240,000	613,454	853,454
Elementary School Project-Part 3 of 3	200,000	381,839	581,839
Regional School District Debt Assessment		485,000	485,000
I - Net Loop (PEG $450K)	60,000	8,850	68,850
Public Works Street Sweeper	60,000	8,300	68,300
School Feasibility Study	70,000	27,500	97,500
Interest on Temporary Debt	-	123,255	123,255
Jones Library General Construction	-	85,495	85,495
Police Facility Chiller 1 of 2	370,000	12,950	382,950
Police Facility Chiller 2 of 2	540,000	36,000	576,000
Total	1,885,000	2,304,543	4,189,543

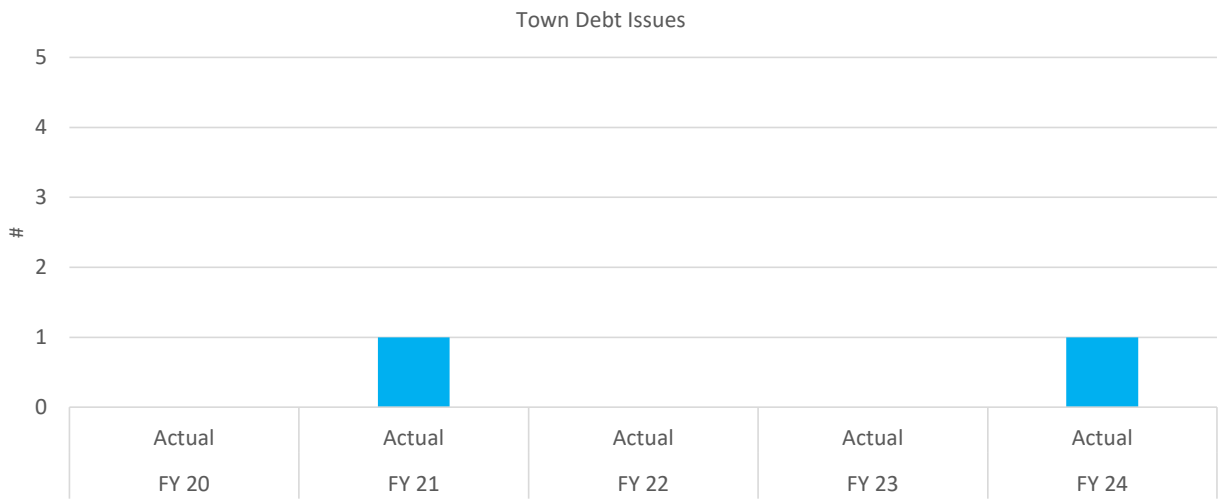
Significant Changes:

Debt is increasing in FY26 due to the Elementary School project moving forward and many other projects making progress.

DEBT SERVICES: DEBT & INTEREST (7701)

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Number of New Issues					
School Debt	0	0	0	0	0
Town Debt	0	1	0	0	1
Library Debt	0	0	0	0	0

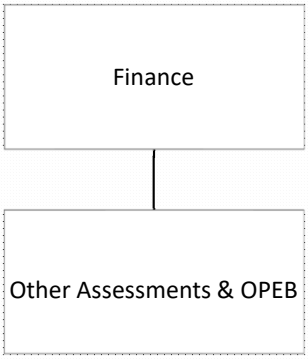
Notable Trends:
None.

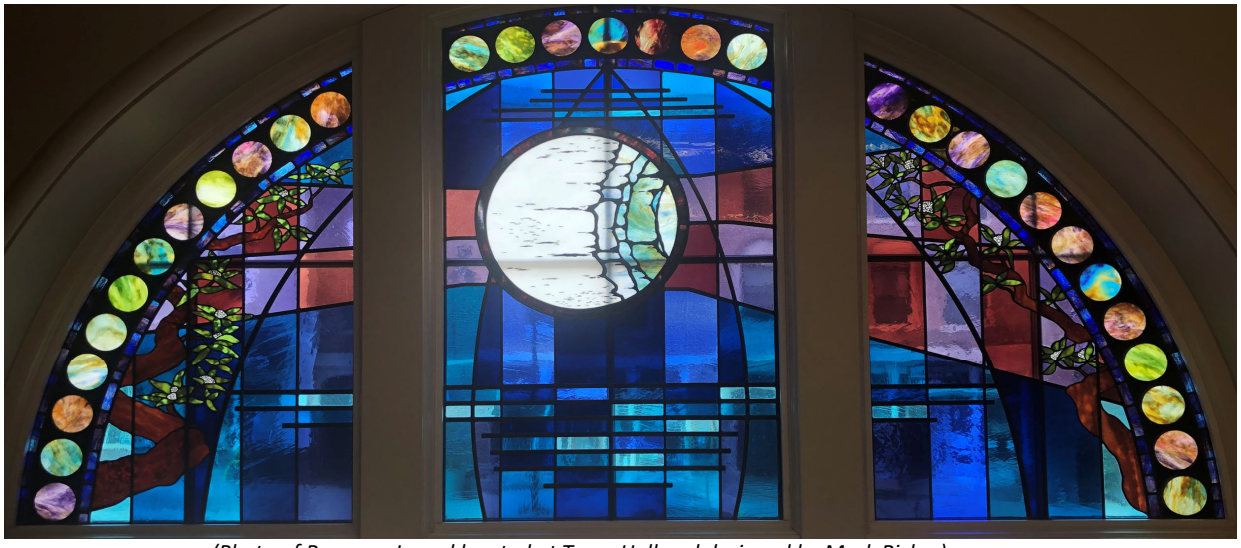


OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Function: To pay for charges assessed by other governmental entities and to provide funding for Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB), i.e. health insurance and other non-pension benefits for retirees.

Organization:





(Photo of Pangean Laurel located at Town Hall and designed by Mark Ricker)

OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Recent Accomplishments:

- Updated OPEB actuarial study.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To fully fund the annual obligation to meet future OPEB liabilities.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue annual funding of the OPEB liability**. ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To evaluate the efficiency and effectiveness of the services provided to the Town by other agencies. **ONGOING**

Upcoming Objectives:

- To continue annual funding of the OPEB liability**.**

OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Budget:		FY22 Actual	FY23 Actual	FY24 Actual	FY25 Budget	FY26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	% Change
Personnel Services	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Assessments	$	9,835,786	10,279,609	11,029,099	11,050,536	11,644,303	593,767	5.4%
OPEB Contributions	$	750,000	500,000	550,000	600,000	600,000	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	10,585,786	10,779,609	11,579,099	11,650,536	12,244,303	593,767	5.1%

Major Components:								
State Assessments								
Air Pollution Districts	$	9,544	9,520	9,722	10,098	10,415	317	3.1%
RMV Non Renewal Surcharge	$	23,942	30,180	30,180	24,500	20,900	(3,600)	-14.7%
Regional Transit (PVTA)	$	1,134,115	1,290,121	1,391,239	1,346,567	1,458,048	111,481	8.3%
Special Education	$	0	0	0	0	22,284	22,284	--
School Choice Tuition	$	342,832	361,311	384,626	384,756	405,081	20,325	5.3%
Charter School Tuition	$	1,735,869	1,658,685	1,705,555	1,686,273	1,942,640	256,367	15.2%
County Regional Lockup	$	0	0	0	0	0	-	--
PVPC	$	6,572	6,993	7,168	7,348	7,532	184	2.5%
Retirement Assessment	$	6,582,912	6,922,799	7,500,609	7,590,994	7,777,403	186,409	2.5%
Total Appropriations	$	9,835,786	10,279,609	11,029,099	11,050,536	11,644,303	593,767	5.4%

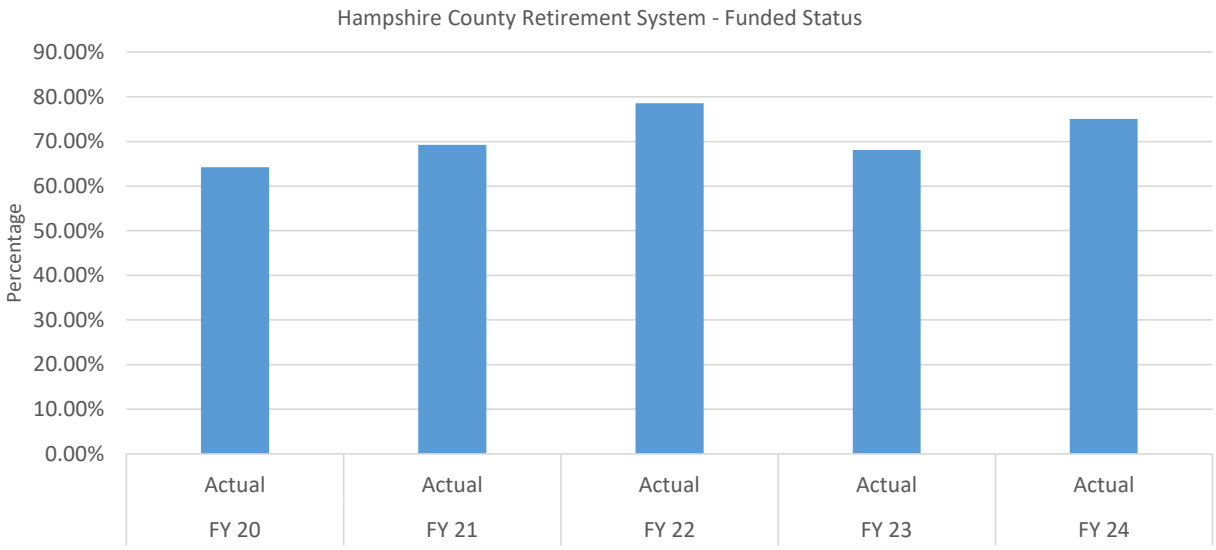
Significant Changes:

Assessment changes are due to changes in the Cherry Sheet estimates from the State. The retirement assessment for FY26 had a very minimal increase due to many vacancies in Town position at the time the data was collected. We expect the trend to return to the normal of 6-8% increases in the coming years.

OTHER ASSESSMENTS & OPEB

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Percent of Pension System	26.72%	26.26%	26.16%	25.56%	25.79%
Funded Status (Percentage)					
Hampshire County Retirement System	64.25%	69.30%	78.55%	68.10%	75.10%
Other Post Employment Benefits	9.70%	11.80%	12.22%	13.13%	17.74%

Notable Trends:
The retirement system approached 80% funding in FY22 due to a strong economy. This performance has declined due to market volatility. Nevertheless, the Hampshire County Retirement System is on track for full funding in the early 2030s.



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Enterprise Fund Summary & Detail

Overview

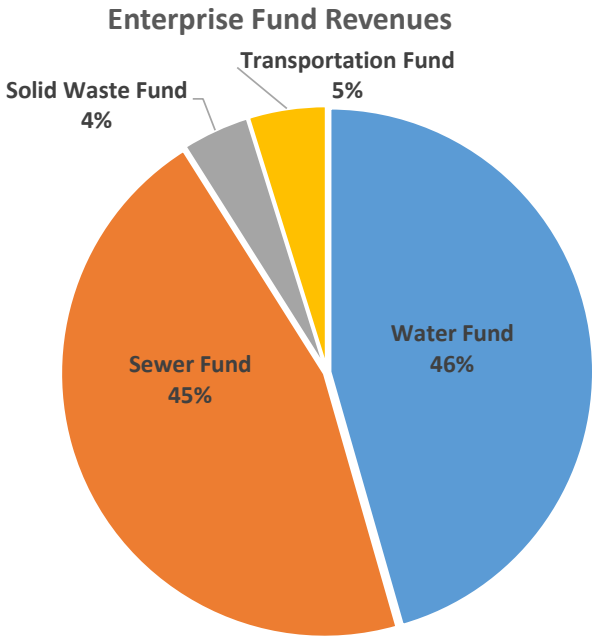
The following section provides a summary and additional details about the Enterprise Fund budgets including revenue and expenditure data.

ENTERPRISE FUND SUMMARY

Revenues:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Water Fund	$	4,683,080	5,283,350	5,365,159	5,722,500	7,002,500	1,280,000	22.4%
Sewer Fund	$	5,079,793	5,452,103	5,621,273	6,710,675	6,986,725	276,050	4.1%
Solid Waste Fund	$	613,486	717,632	626,188	607,447	640,119	32,672	5.4%
Transportation Fund	$	681,400	721,022	890,872	875,023	738,984	(136,039)	-15.5%
Total Revenues	$	11,057,758	12,174,106	12,503,491	13,915,645	15,368,328	1,452,683	10.4%
Expenditures:								
Water Fund	$	4,822,318	5,144,209	5,175,715	5,722,500	7,002,500	1,280,000	22.4%
Sewer Fund	$	4,754,834	5,005,545	5,728,212	6,710,675	6,986,725	276,050	4.1%
Solid Waste Fund	$	507,280	528,153	620,042	607,447	640,119	32,672	5.4%
Transportation Fund	$	602,865	648,184	628,172	875,023	738,984	(136,039)	-15.5%
Total Expenditures	$	10,687,296	11,326,091	12,152,142	13,915,645	15,368,328	1,452,683	10.4%
Fund Gain/(Loss)	$	370,462	848,015	351,350	-	-	-	--

Significant Changes:

Enterprise Fund revenues are increasing due to increases in service fees. Water and Sewer rates are increasing 22.86% and 18.8% respectively. Water Fund cost drivers are capital, debt, aging infrastructure, and increased costs. Sewer Fund are sludge removal related to fuel costs, general increased costs, capital, and debt associated with infrastructure improvements. Updated revenues from the solar array and cell towers are reflected in the Solid Waste budget, while tipping fees and monitoring expenses are increasing. Transportation costs are decreasing due to reductions in capital expenses this fiscal year.



ENTERPRISE FUND SUMMARY

Enterprise Fund Overview:

An enterprise fund is a separate accounting and financial reporting mechanism used to manage municipal services for which a fee is charged in exchange for goods or services. The Town has four Enterprise Funds: Water, Sewer, Solid Waste, and Transportation.

Water Enterprise Fund: This fund manages all of the costs associated with providing water to the Town. This includes costs to manage the Town's water sources, costs to make sure the water is safe to drink, and costs to get water to each household or property. In exchange for these services, the Town bills users based on their water consumption.

Sewer Enterprise Fund: This fund manages all of the costs associated with disposing of sewer related waste. This includes costs to manage the infrastructure that brings sewage from properties to the sewer treatment facility, costs to treat the sewage and prepare it for disposal, and the costs to actually dispose of it. In exchange for these services, the Town bills users based on their sewage discharge.

Solid Waste Enterprise Fund: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's solid waste. This includes costs to collect solid waste, costs to manage the Town's landfill, and costs to dispose of solid waste. In exchange for these services, the Town bills users based on the service provided.

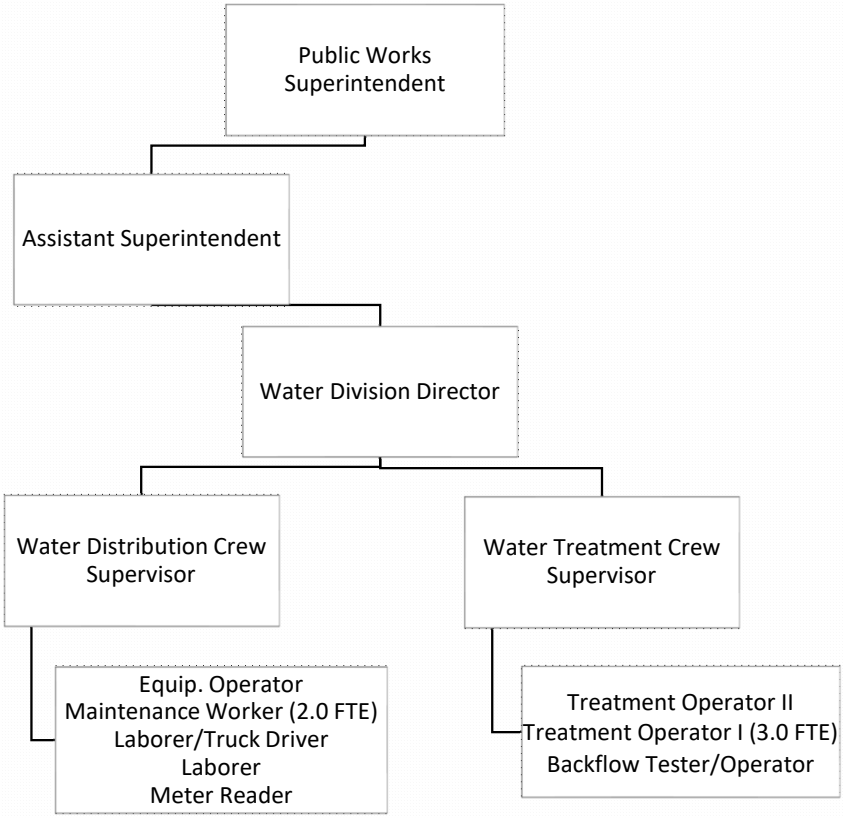
Transportation Enterprise Fund: This fund manages costs associated with Town related transportation services. This includes costs for public transportation, costs to maintain parking lots, and costs to enforce parking regulations. In exchange for these services, the Town collects parking fees and a variety of other revenue sources related to transportation.

Photo of topping off ceremony for the Centennial Water Treatment Plant

WATER FUND

Function: To develop, treat, and distribute a sufficient supply of high quality water to meet the needs of Amherst residents, businesses, and institutions through a user fee based revenue system.

Organization:



(Photo of first of its kind solar-powered groundwater treatment system)

WATER FUND

Recent Accomplishments:

- Assisted with the water main replacement on Grove Street, Harvard Street, and Canton Avenue.
- Completed water service line inventory.
- Replaced pump at Well #2.
- Repaired and restarted the raw water pump station for the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain Water Division staff at the current level and retain employees.
- To continue managing the replacement of the Centennial Water Treatment Facility.
- To design and replace valves and screens at the Atkins Reservoir screen house.
- To replace/repair roof at the Atkins Water Treatment Facility.
- To replace water lines on South Valley Road and Jones Road.
- To create a more efficient system to read, replace, and fix problematic water meters.
- To install a new backup generator for Wells #1 & #2.
- To replace large capacity meters and vaults.
- To replace of all 4” water mains.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To manage the replacement of the Centennial Water Treatment Facility upgrades. **ONGOING**
- To continue the process of replacing large capacity meters and vaults. **ONGOING**
- To continue to replace and upgrade all water meters in system to radio read units. **ONGOING**
- To replace the boards and framing at Hills Reservoir. **RESCHEDULED**
- To pave the driveway at Baby Carriage Brook WTP. **RESCHEDULED**
- To loop water line feeding WWTP to UMASS line stub to assure a better supply to WWTP. **RESCHEDULED**

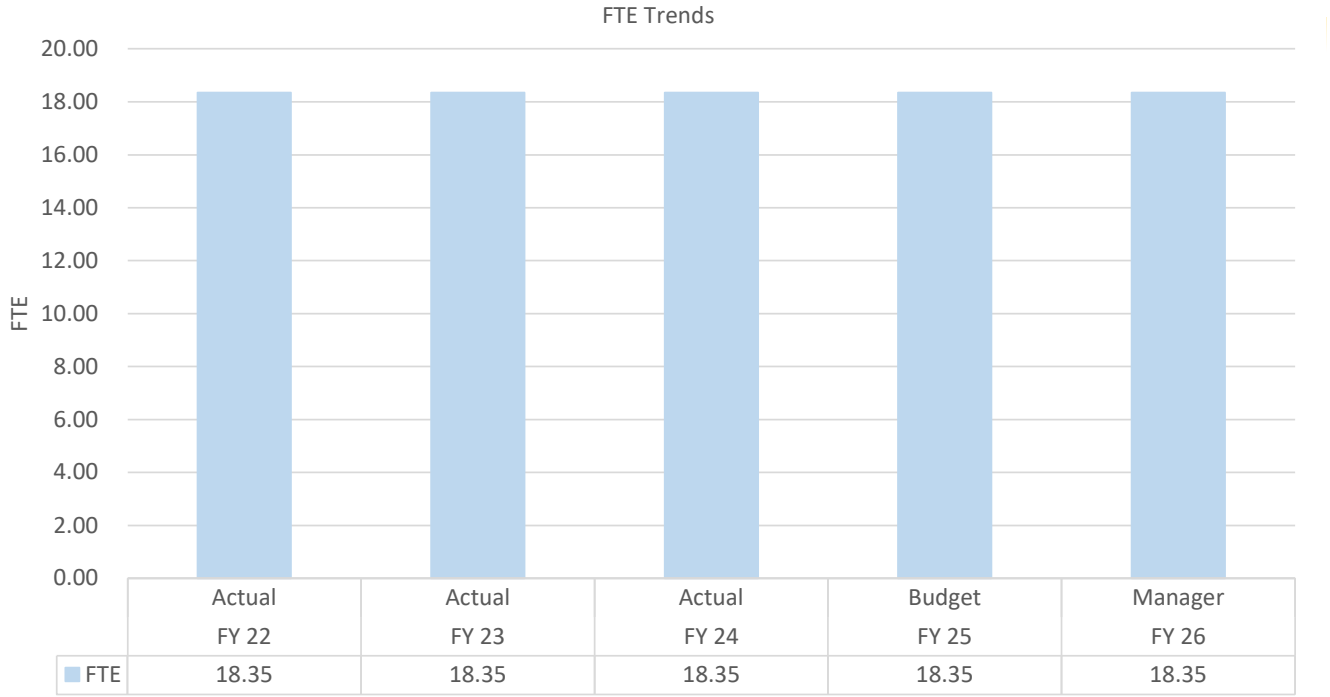
Upcoming Objectives:

- To implement the new water use restrictions based on requirement established by the State.
- To manage the replacement of the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility upgrades.
- To continue the process of replacing large capacity meters and vaults.
- To continue to replace and upgrade all water meters to radio-read units.
- To replace the boards and framing at Hills Reservoir.
- To pave the driveway at the Baby Carriage Brook Water Treatment Facility.
- To loop water line feeding the Town's Wastewater Treatment Facility to the line serving the Univerisity to assure a better supply to the Wastewater Treatment Facility.

WATER FUND

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	4,395,126	4,943,241	4,861,267	5,512,500	6,772,500	1,260,000	22.9%
Interest and Late Fees	$	32,942	93,515	109,158	40,000	40,000	-	--
Other	$	255,012	246,594	394,733	170,000	190,000	20,000	11.8%
Subtotal Revenues	$	4,683,080	5,283,350	5,365,159	5,722,500	7,002,500	1,280,000	22.4%
Returned Capital	$	-	-	59,178	-	-	-	--
Retaining Earnings	$	-	-	108,700	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	4,683,080	5,283,350	5,533,037	5,722,500	7,002,500	1,280,000	22.4%
Operating Budget	$	3,436,662	3,593,334	3,518,650	3,810,035	4,017,662	207,627	5.4%
Debt Service	$	547,551	545,627	626,850	957,145	1,394,904	437,759	45.7%
Capital Program	$	315,000	465,000	505,632	415,000	1,000,000	585,000	141.0%
Total Appropriation	$	4,299,213	4,603,961	4,651,132	5,182,180	6,412,566	1,230,386	23.7%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	523,105	540,248	524,583	540,320	589,934	49,614	9.2%
Total Expenditures	$	4,822,318	5,144,209	5,175,715	5,722,500	7,002,500	1,280,000	22.4%

Staffing Trends:

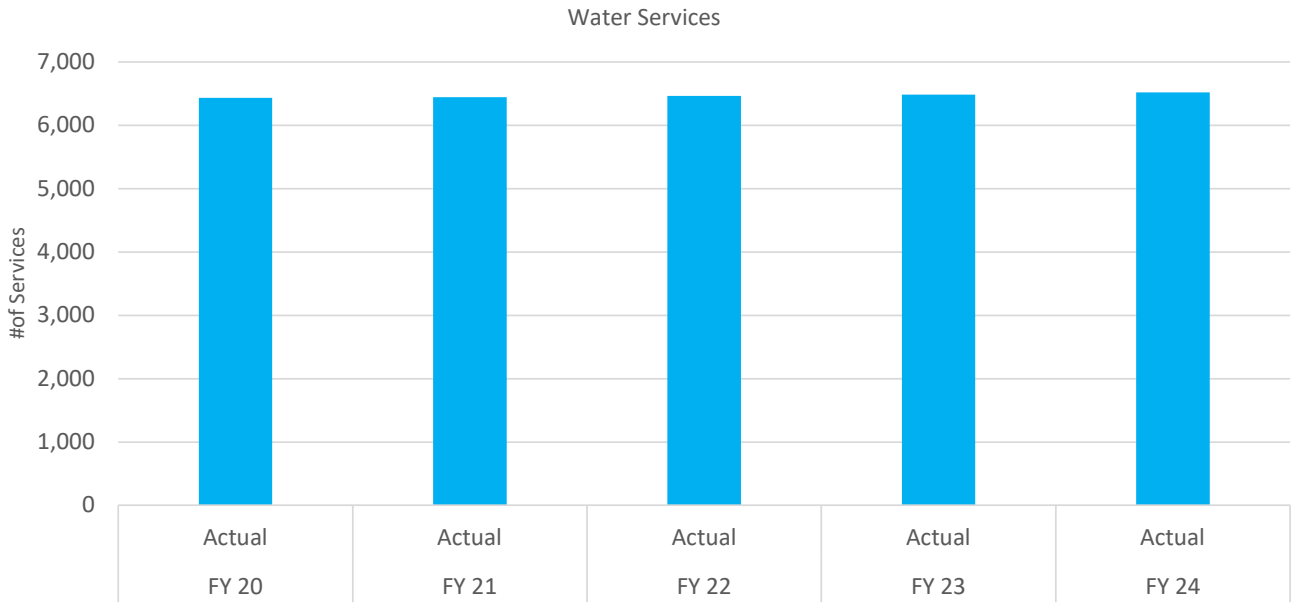


WATER FUND

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
New Water Services Installed	22	14	20	18	35
Water Service Relays	11	6	4	10	9
Water Services	6,434	6,448	6,468	6,486	6,521
Water Metered					
& Produced (billion gallons)	0.92	0.80	0.89	0.93	0.91
Positive Coliform Bacteria Samples	2	0	7	4	0
Meters Installed	225	268	353	290	203
Hydrants in Service	1,146	1,148	1,166	1,168	1,170
Frozen Water Services	0	0	3	0	0
Hydrants Repaired	55	72	57	65	60
Water Mains Flushed (mi)	114	114	116	116	116
Water Main Breaks Repaired	6	2	4	5	6
Meters Read by Radio	60%	60%	68%	71%	75%
Debt Issues					
Issues Outstanding	3	3	3	3	4
New Issues	0	2	0	0	1
Capital Projects					
Departmental Equipment	1	0	1	1	1
Existing Facilities	1	2	2	4	3
New Facilities	0	1	0	0	0

Notable Trends:

The percentage of meters read by radio continues to increase. This method is more efficient and reliable than manual reads.



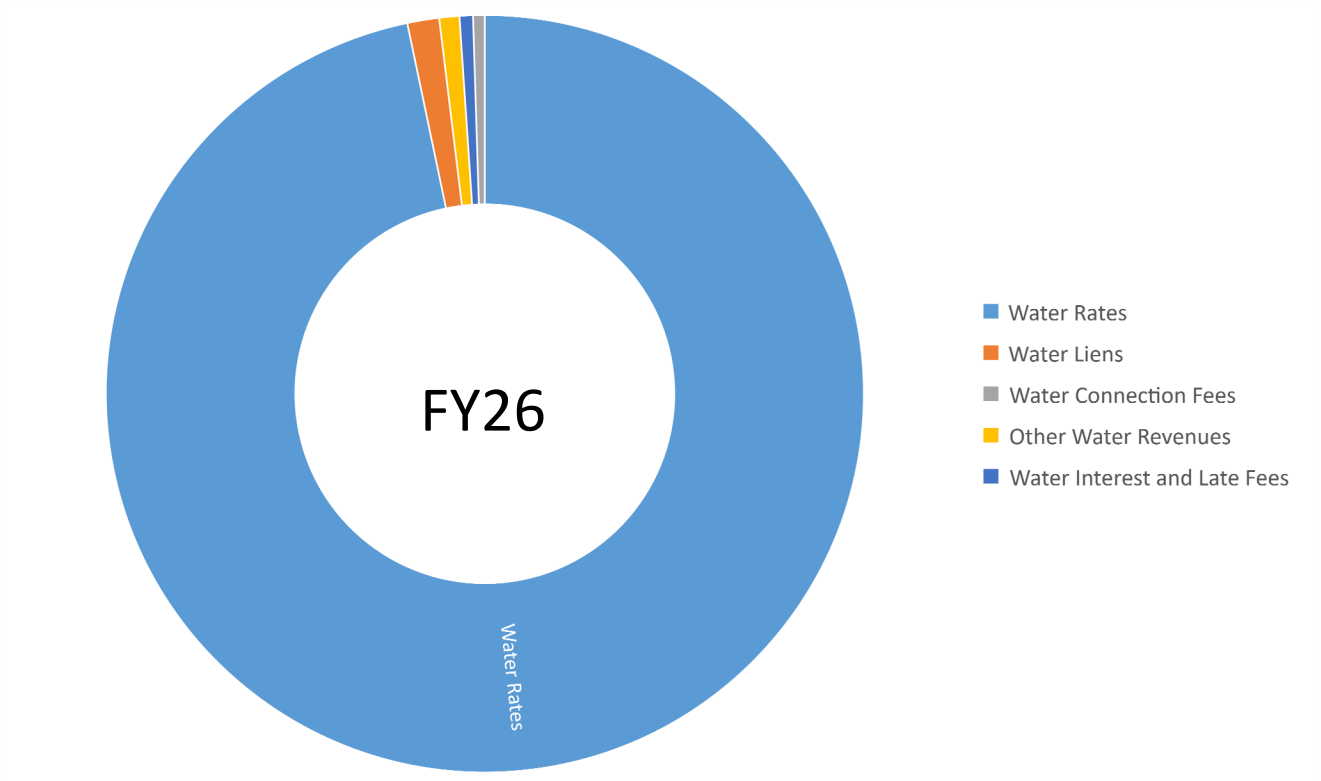
For more information, visit the Water Department's webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/179/Water

WATER FUND

Revenue Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Water Rates	$	4,395,126	4,943,241	4,861,267	5,512,500	6,772,500	1,260,000	22.9%
Water Liens	$	146,885	112,718	124,101	75,000	95,000	20,000	26.7%
Water Connection Fees	$	37,600	32,300	27,400	35,000	35,000	-	--
Other Water Revenues	$	70,528	101,575	243,232	60,000	60,000	-	--
Water Interest and Late Fees	$	32,942	93,515	109,158	40,000	40,000	-	--
Total Revenues	$	4,683,080	5,283,350	5,365,159	5,722,500	7,002,500	1,280,000	22.4%

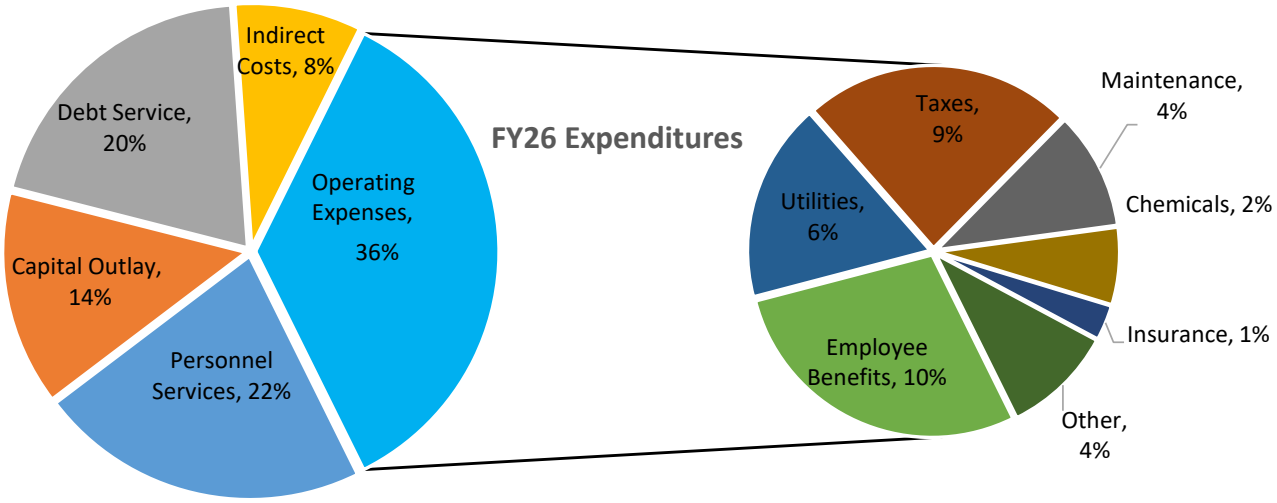
Significant Changes:

Water rate revenue is projected to increase by 22.9% due to a recommended increase in the water rate. For FY26, the proposed rate will increase from $5.25 to $6.45 per hundred cubic feet. Rates are expected to continue rising in the coming years to fund the debt of the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility and to make necessary updates to the Town's aging water infrastructure. One of the Town's most important responsibilities is to provide an adequate supply of safe, potable water for its residents, and the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility will help ensure that this continues well into the future.



WATER FUND

Expenditure Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	1,189,847	1,207,462	1,210,392	1,379,837	1,540,888	161,051	11.7%
Operating Expenses	$	2,246,815	2,385,872	2,308,258	2,430,198	2,476,774	46,576	1.9%
Capital Outlay	$	315,000	465,000	505,632	415,000	1,000,000	585,000	141.0%
Debt Service	$	547,551	545,627	626,850	957,145	1,394,904	437,759	45.7%
Indirect Costs	$	523,105	540,248	524,583	540,320	589,934	49,614	9.2%
Total Expenditures	$	4,822,318	5,144,209	5,175,715	5,722,500	7,002,500	1,280,000	22.4%



Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Assistant Superintendent (shared with the Sewer Fund and the General Fund), one Division Director, two Division Supervisors, three Water Treatment Operators, one Skilled Laborer, one Laborer, one Maintenance Worker, one Meter Reader, one Backflow Tester, one Backflow/Meter Specialist, and an Equipment Operator. The Town Engineer, the Civil Engineer, a Division Supervisor, a Clerk, an Administrative Analyst, an Applications Manager, and an Engineer Technician are shared with the General Fund and Sewer Fund. A Utility Technician, an Environmental Scientist, and an Electrician are shared with the Sewer Fund. The Procurement Officer is shared with the General Fund, Sewer Fund and Transportation Fund. Also included is $70,000 for overtime. $699,298 is budgeted for health, retirement, life insurance, and other benefits, including a payment of $79,000 into the OPEB Trust Fund.

WATER FUND

Capital Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$	40,000	55,000	55,000	55,000	-	(55,000)	-100.0%
Existing Facilities	$	275,000	410,000	341,932	360,000	1,000,000	640,000	177.8%
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-		-	--
Total Appropriation	$	315,000	465,000	396,932	415,000	1,000,000	585,000	141.0%

Significant Changes:
Existing Facilities expense is increasing due to aging infrastructure. Planned vehicle purchase removed.

Major Components:
Includes, $800,000 for water system improvements, and $200,000 for water treatment system improvements.

(Photo of solar powered groundwater treatment system)

WATER FUND

Debt Service:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	422,000	425,000	475,000	685,000	1,007,253	322,253	47.0%
Interest	$	125,551	120,627	151,850	272,145	387,651	115,506	42.4%
Total Appropriation	$	547,551	545,627	626,850	957,145	1,394,904	437,759	45.7%

Significant Changes:

Debt service costs to rise through completion of construction on the new Centennial Water Treatment Facility and other capital needs.

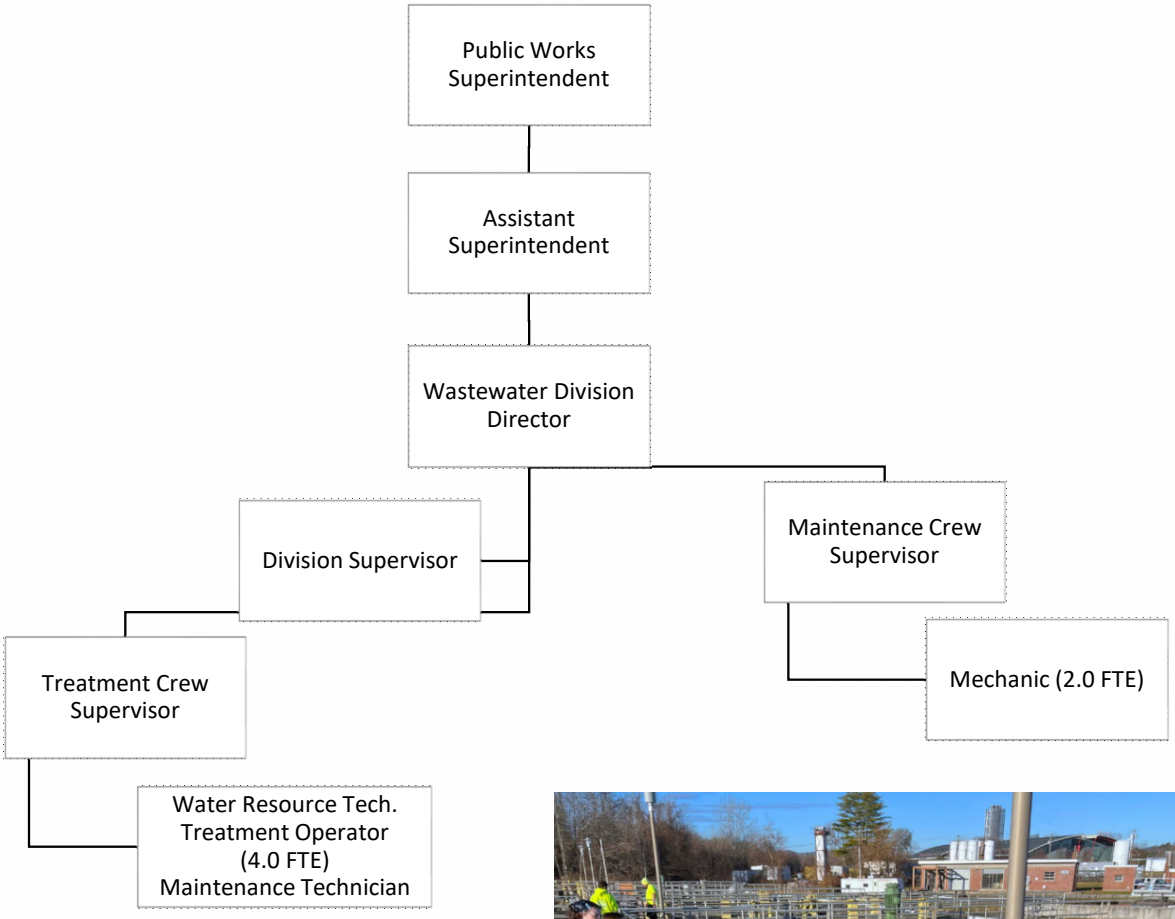
Major Components:

	Principal	Interest
Centennial Water Treatment Facility	$200,000	$34,850
Pine Street Extension	50,000	15,750
Water Meter Radios	75,000	6,450
Centennial Treatment Facility Engineering	65,000	10,700
Centennial Treatment Facility Construction	300,000	48,000
Northampton Road Water Main	55,000	46,662
Well # 4 Replace/Repair	35,000	5,250
SRF-loans Clean Water Trust -24	227,253	157,311
Short Term Interest		62,678
Total	$1,007,253	$387,651

SEWER FUND

Function: To provide an environmentally safe system for collection, treatment, and disposal of sewage and to do so through a user-fee-based revenue system.

Organization:



(Photo of Chief Operator/Division Director Brace giving a tour of the of the Wastewater Treatment Plant)

SEWER FUND

Recent Accomplishments:

- Substantial completion of new Gravity Belt Thickener.
- Continued to provide bacteria testing for Puffers Pond and Fort River.
- Continued to investigate fats, oils, and grease options in other communities to improve Town programs.
- Repaired damage from vandalism at the Wastewater Treatment Facility classroom and lab.
- Replaced the Wastewater Treatment Facility water strainer.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To manage an aging facility.
- To continue rebuilding of the institutional knowledge of the wastewater collection and treatment systems.
- To reduce inflow and infiltration at the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- To acquire parts and supplies that are difficult to source and have long lead times.
- To develop a fee structure for re-use water and effluent.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To continue oversight of the gravity belt thickener installation. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To slipline several sewer lines in Town to restore structural integrity and stop water infiltration. **ACCOMPLISHED/ONGOING**
- To complete the installation of the South East Street pump station #4. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To replace three large effluent valves at the Wastewater Treatment Facility. **ONGOING**
- To replace the plant water strainer at the Wastewater Treatment Facility. **ACCOMPLISHED**

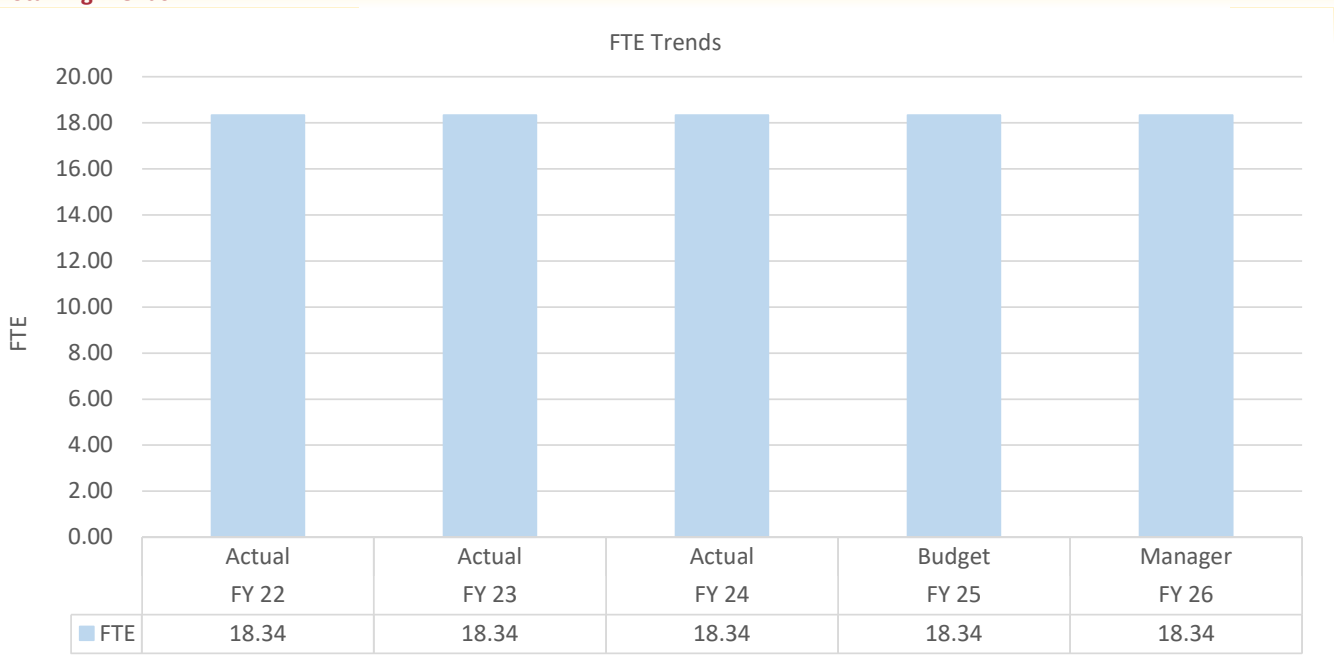
Upcoming Objectives:

- To complete replacment of three large effluent valves at the Wastewater Treatment Facility.
- To begin a comprehensive Wastewater Treatment Facility study.
- To complete pH study of the wastewater treatment processes.
- To begin chlorine system study and analysis.
- To slipline several sewer lines in Town to restore structural integrity and stop water infiltration.

SEWER FUND

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	4,296,541	5,019,362	4,722,926	5,589,675	6,640,725	1,051,050	18.8%
Interest and Late Fees	$	31,770	129,286	181,075	30,000	80,000	50,000	166.7%
Other	$	516,777	303,455	213,530	266,000	266,000	-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	4,845,088	5,452,103	5,117,531	5,885,675	6,986,725	1,101,050	18.7%
Returned Capital	$	-	-	3,742	-	-	-	--
Other Financing Sources	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Retained Earnings	$	234,705	-	500,000	825,000	-	(825,000)	-100.0%
Total Revenues	$	5,079,793	5,452,103	5,621,273	6,710,675	6,986,725	276,050	4.1%
Operating Budget	$	3,760,071	3,740,591	3,872,662	4,247,092	4,672,092	425,000	10.0%
Debt Service	$	604,678	652,220	919,924	1,005,938	1,150,623	144,685	14.4%
Capital Program	$	110,000	293,620	735,000	1,045,000	710,000	(335,000)	-32.1%
Total Appropriation	$	4,474,749	4,686,431	5,527,586	6,298,030	6,532,715	234,685	3.7%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	280,085	319,114	200,626	412,645	454,010	41,365	10.0%
Total Expenditures	$	4,754,834	5,005,545	5,728,212	6,710,675	6,986,725	276,050	4.1%

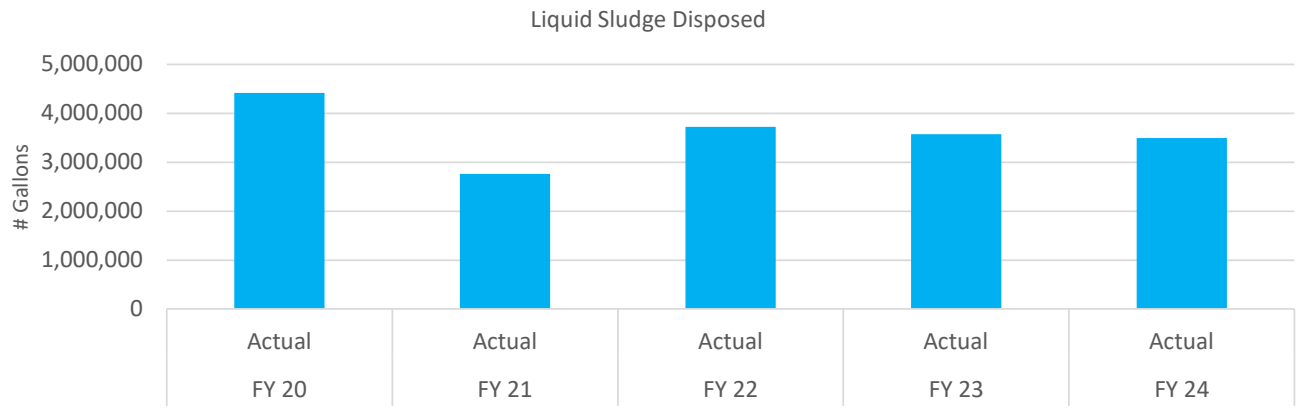
Staffing Trends:



SEWER FUND

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Sanitary Sewer Complaints	36	39	36	36	35
Sewer Main Stoppages	23	12	12	16	18
Sewer Main Flushing (mi)	22	15.41	23	19	1
Sewer Mains Treated for Roots (linear ft)	3,259	7,183	5,289	5,223	5,223
Sewer Maintained (miles)	123	123	123	123	123
T.V.'d Sections of Problem Sewers (linear ft)	35,344	34,862	13,595	5,831	1,000
Sewer Rehabilitated (ft)	0	0	0	3	0
Sewer Replaced (ft)	100	10	80	231	400
Flow Totals (billion gals)	1.27	1.21	1.50	1.41	1.5
Chlorine (lbs)	9,648	10,348	18,548	11,555	10,000
Polymer (lbs)	2,547	1,855	2,925	2,935	3,000
Tests Achieving EPA Standards:					
Main Plant	99.50%	99.21%	99.53%	99.25%	90.00%
Pumping Stations Operated	22	22	22	22	22
Grit & Screenings Deposited at Sanitary					
Landfill (cu.yd.)	36	45	72	63	54
Septic Waste Delivered to Plant (loads)	349	425	488	347	350
Liquid Sludge Disposed (gal)	4,420,600	2,762,200	3,724,500	3,573,600	3,500,000
Dry Sludge Produced (tons)	847	723	904	933	900
Debt Issues					
Issues Outstanding	3	3	3	3	4
New Issues	1	1	0	0	1
Capital Projects					
Departmental Equipment	2	0	0	2	0
Existing Facilities	2	2	3	2	4
New Facilities	0	0	0	0	0

Notable Trends:
FY24 levels are estimates at this time. Due to staffing levels we are unable to perform some preventative maintenance.



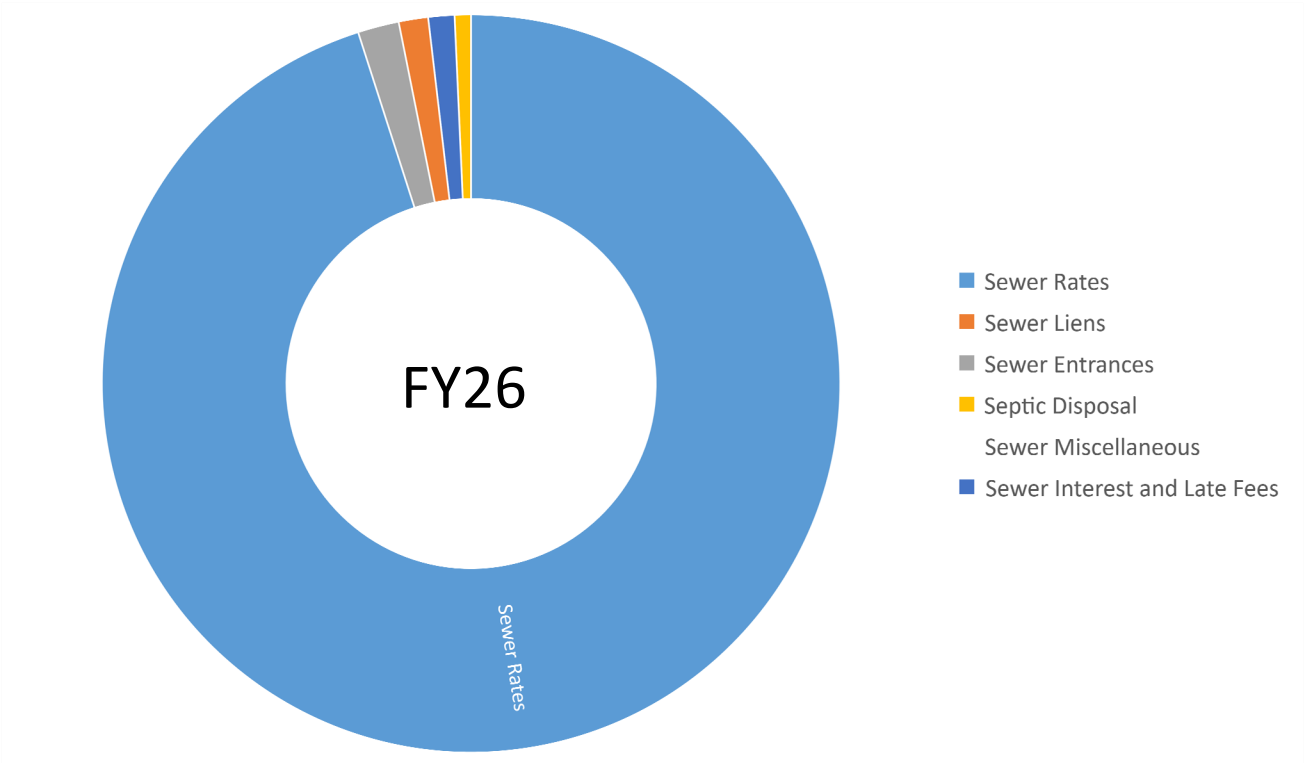
https://www.amherstma.gov/166/Wastewater

SEWER FUND

Revenue Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Sewer Rates	$	4,296,541	5,019,362	4,722,926	5,589,675	6,640,725	1,051,050	18.8%
Sewer Liens	$	133,944	102,886	108,348	90,000	90,000	-	--
Sewer Entrances	$	296,489	121,227	37,225	126,000	126,000	-	--
Septic Disposal	$	78,150	62,400	53,850	50,000	50,000	-	--
Sewer Miscellaneous	$	8,195	16,943	14,107	0	0	-	--
Sewer Interest and Late Fees	$	31,770	129,286	181,075	30,000	80,000	50,000	166.7%
Total Revenues	$	4,845,088	5,452,103	5,117,531	5,885,675	6,986,725	1,101,050	18.7%

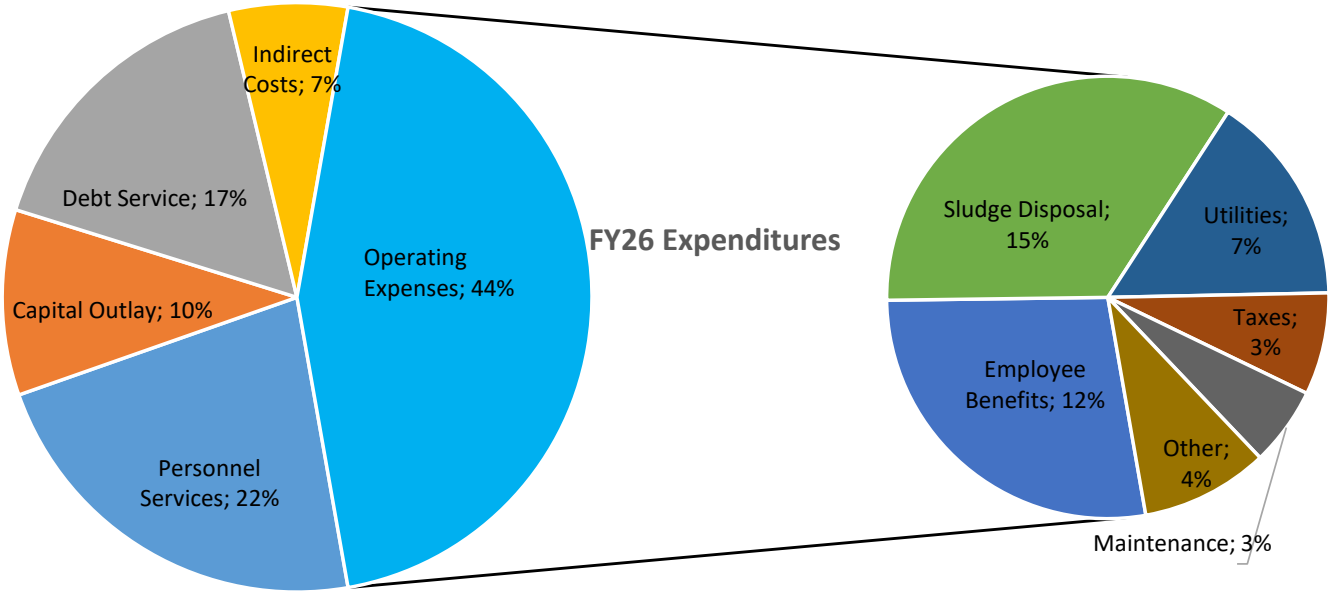
Significant Changes:

Sewer revenue is projected to increase by 18.7% due to an increase in the sewer rate. For FY26, the rate is projected to increase from $5.85 per hundred cubic feet to $6.95 per hundred cubic feet. Rates are projected to continue to increase in the coming years to pay for infrastructure projects.



SEWER FUND

Expenditure Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	1,222,918	1,207,015	1,284,458	1,330,564	1,565,324	234,760	17.6%
Operating Expenses	$	2,537,153	2,533,576	2,588,204	2,916,528	3,106,768	190,240	6.5%
Capital Outlay	$	110,000	293,620	735,000	1,045,000	710,000	(335,000)	-32.1%
Debt Service	$	604,678	652,220	919,924	1,005,938	1,150,623	144,685	14.4%
Indirect Costs	$	280,085	319,114	200,626	412,645	454,010	41,365	10.0%
Total Expenditures	$	4,754,834	5,005,545	5,728,212	6,710,675	6,986,725	276,050	4.1%



Significant Changes:

Major Components:

Personnel Services include salaries for the Assistant Superintendent (shared with the Water Fund and the General Fund), a Division Director, two Supervisors, a Water Resources Technician, four Treatment Operators, three Mechanics, a Laborer and a Maintenance Worker. Engineering division staff, a Division Supervisor, an Office Manager, an Administrative Analyst, and an Applications Manager, are shared with the General Fund and the Water Fund. A Utility Technician, an Environmental Scientist, and an Electrician are shared with the Water Fund. The Procurement Officer is shared with the General Fund, Water Fund, and Transportation Fund. Also included is $42,800 for overtime. $856,123 is budgeted for health, retirement, life insurance, and other benefits, including a payment of $150,000 into the OPEB Trust Fund.

SEWER FUND

Capital Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$	-	60,000	-	60,000	-	(60,000)	-100.0%
Existing Facilities	$	-	233,620	235,000	985,000	710,000	(275,000)	-27.9%
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	293,620	235,000	1,045,000	710,000	(335,000)	-32.1%

Significant Changes:
Planned vehicle purchase removed.

Major Components:
Includes $10,000 for facilities improvements, $400,000 for collection system improvements, and $300,000 for treatment system improvements.

(Photo of Wastewater Treatment Plant today)

SEWER FUND

Debt Service:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	454,600	494,600	762,928	505,000	855,000	350,000	69.3%
Interest	$	150,078	157,620	156,996	184,938	250,649	65,711	35.5%
Total Appropriation	$	604,678	652,220	919,924	689,938	1,105,649	415,711	60.3%

Significant Changes:

Debt Service costs begin to rise as the replacement of wastewater infrastructure ramps up.

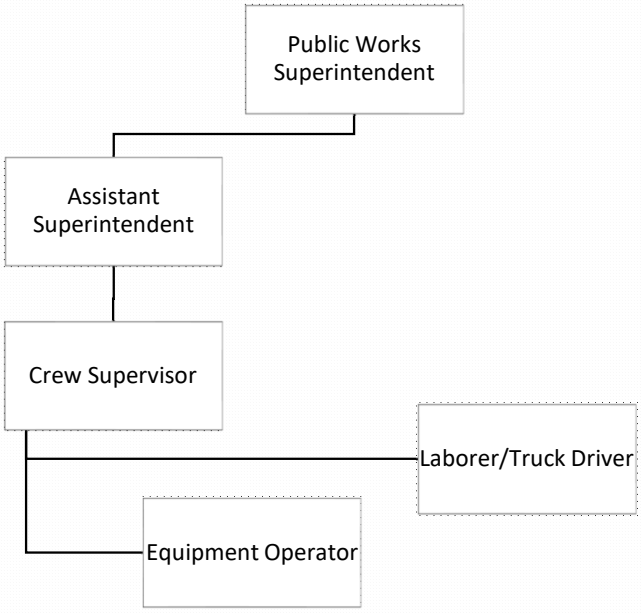
Major Components:

	Principal	Interest
Harkness Sewer Construction	200,000	34,875
Pine Street Extension	50,000	15,750
Amherst Woods Improvements	185,000	38,850
Gravity Belt Thickener - Engineering	70,000	32,534
Replace Gravity Belt Thickener	250,000	116,640
South East Street Sewer Pump Station #4	100,000	12,000
Short Term Interest expense		44,974
Total	$855,000	$295,623

SOLID WASTE

Function: To provide for the environmentally safe disposal of solid waste and to develop and promote programs that are viable alternatives to landfilling, all to be funded through a user-fee-based revenue system.

Organization:



(Photo of volunteers at Rubbish Roundup)

SOLID WASTE

Recent Accomplishments:

- Crack sealed parking area at the Transfer Station.
- Reduced old granite curbing stockpile.
- Reclaimed Asphalt, Brick, and Concrete (ABC) waste for reuse.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To achieve long term financial sustainability.
- To replace the loader with a backhoe capable of handling all Division needs.
- To convert the electronics shed into a multi-function building.
- To repair the floor and drainage in the scrap metal staging area.
- To repair the concrete floor of the roll-off pit.
- To install insulated doors on the vehicle garage.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To repair concrete curbing. **ONGOING**
- To paint/weatherproof wooden structures. **ONGOING**
- To begin replacing or repairing monitoring wells. **ONGOING**
- To expand outreach for trash and recycling programs. **ONGOING**
- To replace the Transfer Station scale. **ONGOING**
- To support the exploration of a waste hauler bylaw. **ACCOMPLISHED**

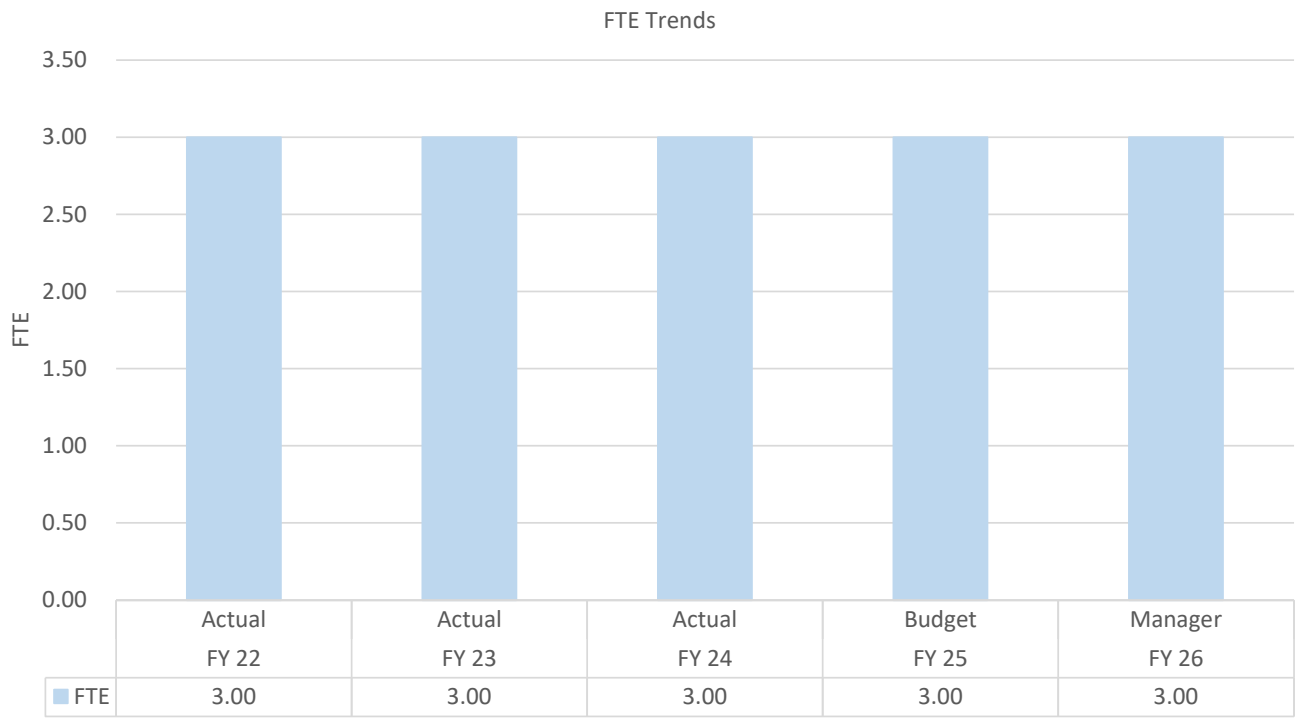
Upcoming Objectives:

- To repair concrete curbing.
- To paint/weatherproof wooden structures at the Transfer Station.
- To begin replacing or repairing monitoring wells.
- To expand outreach for trash and recycling programs.
- To replace the Transfer Station scale.
- To support development of the waste hauler bylaw.

SOLID WASTE

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	503,866	472,719	473,467	442,447	486,119	43,672	9.9%
Interest Earnings	$	670	13,520	23,553	2,000	16,000	14,000	700.0%
Other	$	74,419	206,393	85,011	88,000	138,000	50,000	56.8%
Subtotal Revenues	$	578,956	692,632	582,030	532,447	640,119	107,672	20.2%
Returned Capital	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Retained Earnings	$	34,530	25,000	44,158	75,000	-	(75,000)	-100.0%
Total Revenues	$	613,486	717,632	626,188	607,447	640,119	32,672	5.4%
Operating Budget	$	507,280	528,153	550,042	607,447	640,119	32,672	5.4%
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Capital Program	$	-	-	70,000	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	507,280	528,153	620,042	607,447	640,119	32,672	5.4%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	-	-	-	-		-	--
Total Expenditures	$	507,280	528,153	620,042	607,447	640,119	32,672	5.4%

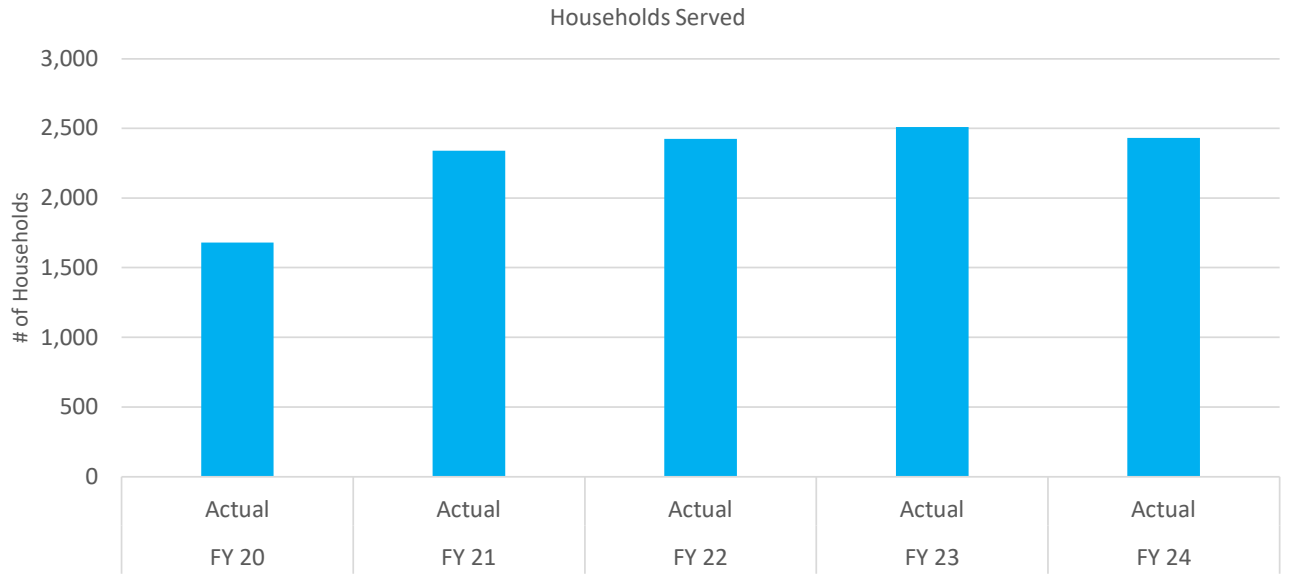
Staffing Trends:



SOLID WASTE

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Households Served (stickers sold)	1,681	2,340	2,423	2,510	2,431
Commercial Businesses Served	154	164	142	140	129
Solid Waste Received & Transferred (tons)	156	187	208	170	189
Construction & Demo (tons)	1,043	1,037	1,157	1,097	1,078
Recycling Paper (tons)	318	295	283	292	257
Mixed Glass, Cans and Plastic	144	127	113	94	107
Metal	137	64	197	119	169
Oil (gal)	900	950	500	950	1,250
Household Hazardous Waste (gal)	1,800	1,650	1,475	2,400	2,710
Tires (tons)	5.4	2.5	3	3	3.2
Compost Bins Sold	28	9	0	2	24
Electronics (tons)	16.4	23.6	15	13	11.2
Leaves (tons)	81	132	157	139	179
Fluorescent Bulbs (each)	2,072	1,482	1,767	1,607	1,828
Appliances with Freon (each)	321	376	360	312	379

Notable Trends:
Most categories had increased numbers for FY24.



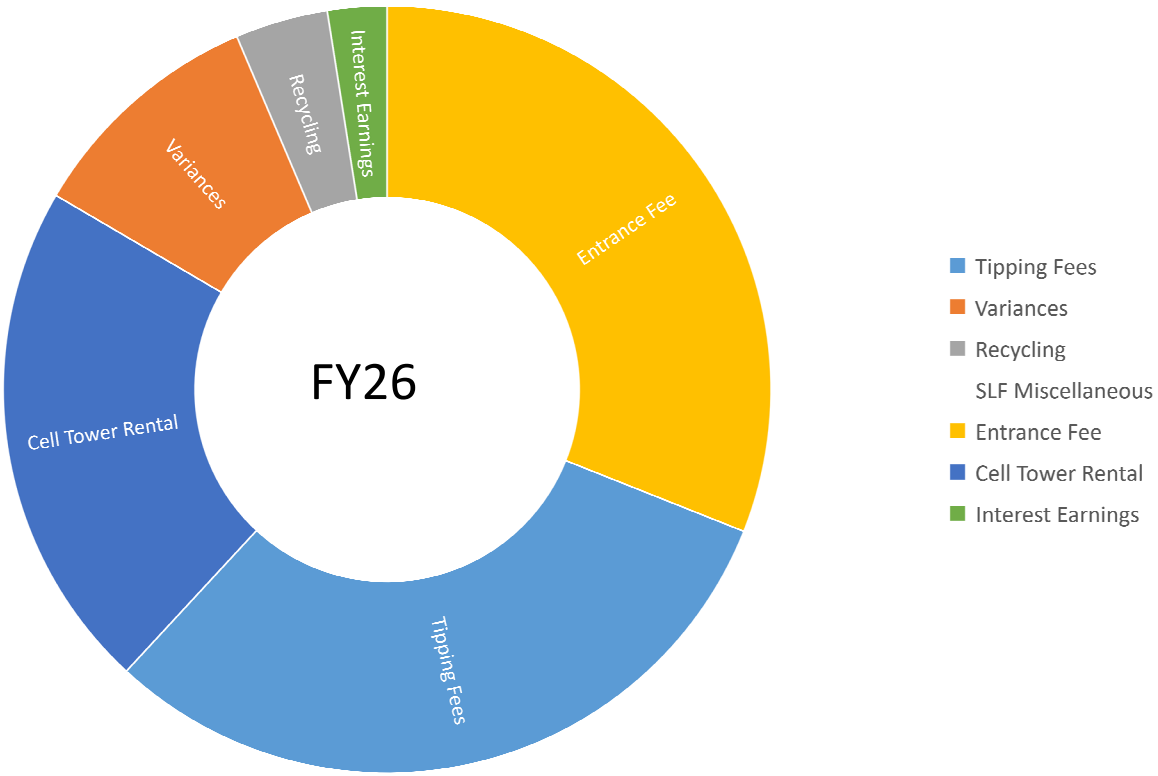
For more information, visit the Solid Waste webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/157/Recycling---Solid-Waste

SOLID WASTE

Revenue Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Tipping Fees	$	195,670	165,028	156,118	181,447	197,519	16,072	8.9%
Variances	$	65,795	64,923	65,390	65,000	65,000	-	--
Recycling	$	61,371	26,271	36,509	15,000	25,000	10,000	66.7%
SLF Miscellaneous	$	0	0	0	0	0	-	--
Entrance Fee	$	181,030	216,497	215,450	181,000	198,600	17,600	9.7%
Cell Tower Rental	$	74,419	206,393	85,011	88,000	138,000	50,000	56.8%
Interest Earnings	$	670	13,520	23,553	2,000	16,000	14,000	700.0%
Total Revenues	$	578,956	692,632	582,030	532,447	640,119	107,672	20.2%

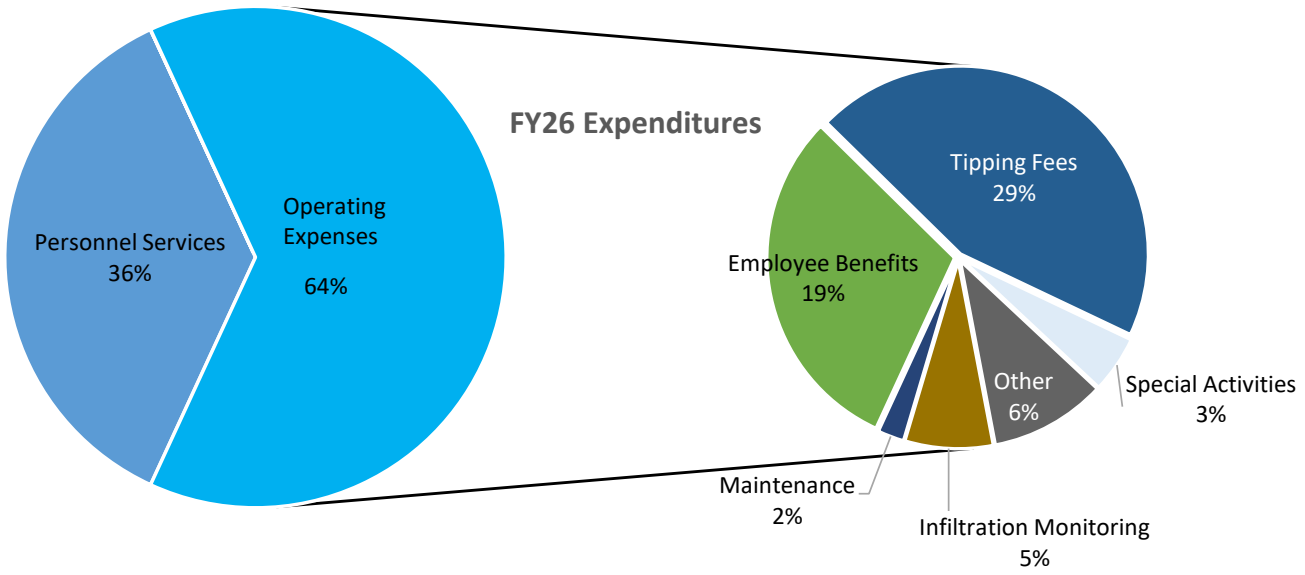
Significant Changes:

Updated revenues from the solar array installed on the north landfill are reflected in the Miscellaneous category above. This revenue source that will boost the financial sustainability of the Solid Waste Fund. Some user fees will be increased to keep up with budget demands.



SOLID WASTE

Expenditure Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	189,364	202,297	214,772	225,947	232,001	6,054	2.7%
Operating Expenses	$	317,916	325,857	335,270	381,500	408,118	26,618	7.0%
Capital Outlay	$	-	-	70,000	-	-	-	--
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Indirect Costs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	507,280	528,153	620,042	607,447	640,119	32,672	5.4%



Significant Changes:
None.

Major Components:
Personnel Services include a Crew Supervisor, one Equipment Operator, and one Laborer/Truck Driver and extra help at the landfill.

$124,328 is budgeted for health, retirement, life insurance, and other employee benefits.

Maintenance, $9,300, includes funds to repair buildings and equipment.

Infiltration Monitoring, $31,000, includes funds for testing soil and gases emitted from the landfills, as well as PFAS.

Other includes $10,000 for diesel fuel, $13,770 for utilities, and smaller amounts for tools and equipment and office supplies.

Tipping fees, $182,500, are the cost of transporting and disposing of waste and recyclables collected at the Amherst transfer station.

SOLID WASTE

Capital Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$		-	70,000	-	-	-	--
Existing Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	-	70,000	-	-	-	--

Significant Changes:
None.

Major Components:
None.

(Photo of roll off truck purchased with a grant)

SOLID WASTE

Debt Service:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	-	-	-	-		-	--
Interest	$	-	-	-	-		-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	-	-	-		-	--

Significant Changes:

None.

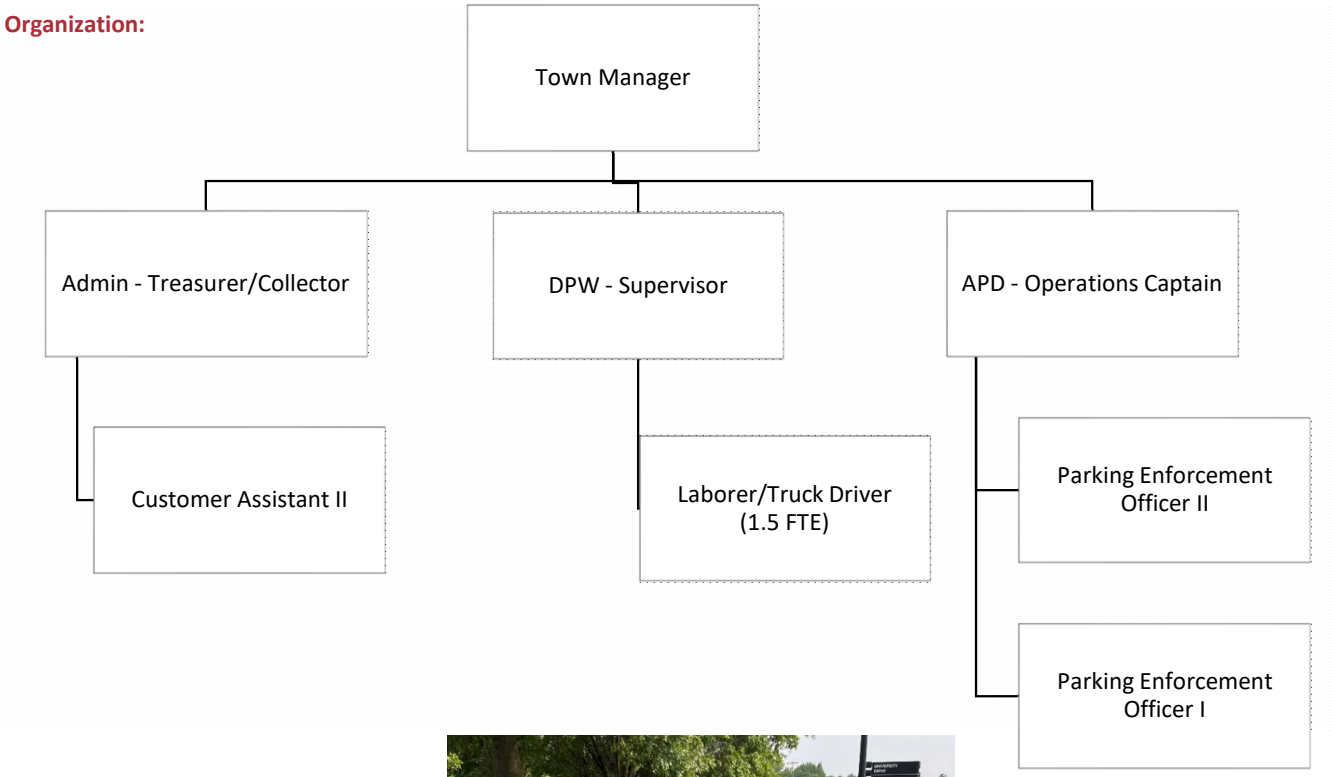
Major Components:

None.

TRANSPORTATION

Function: To provide a parking and public transportation systems and infrastructure that meets the needs of residents, visitors, and businesses, and that can be supported through fees and other alternative non-tax revenue sources.

Organization:



(Photo of Valley Bike station)

TRANSPORTATION

Recent Accomplishments:

- Installed parking kiosks on North Pleasant Street adjacent to Kendrick Park, South Pleasant Street, and Boltwood Avenue.
- Installed 2 DC fast charging EV chargers in the North Pleasant Street parking lot.
- Established new and reconfigured parking spaces on Boltwood Avenue in front of Town Hall.

Key Challenges & Long Range Objectives:

- To maintain adequate parking spaces for residents, visitors, and businesses.
- To develop new revenue sources for the Transportation Fund (parking garage, additional parking spaces, etc.).
- To develop internal policies and staffing to better coordinate management of the parking system.
- To transition away from single space meters to kiosks and online payments.

Status of Prior Year Objectives:

- To maximize the efficiency and availability of existing parking supply. **ONGOING**
- To install 2 electric vehicle charging stations in the North Pleasant Street Lot. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To install parking kiosks on North Pleasant Street adjacent to Kendrick Park, South Pleasant Street and Boltwood Avenue. **ACCOMPLISHED**
- To identify additional on-street parking options. **ONGOING**
- To review parking fine levels and recommend changes. **ONGOING**

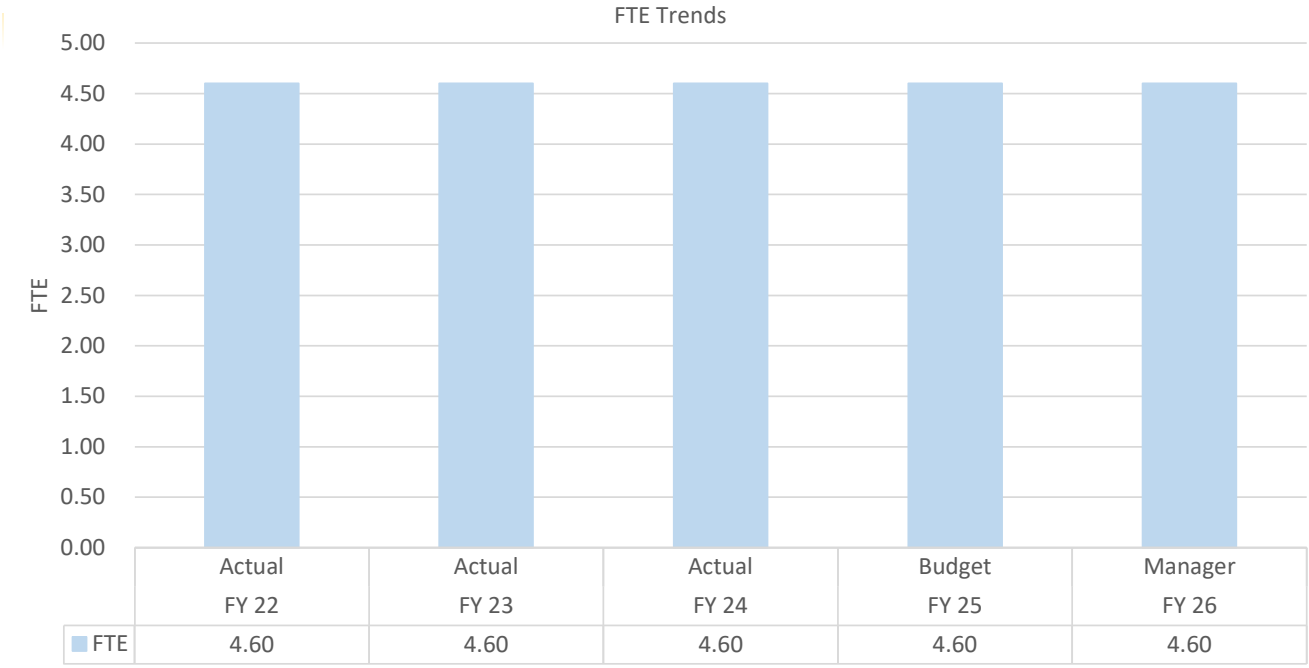
Upcoming Objectives:

- To maximize the efficiency and availability of existing parking supply.
- To identify additional on-street parking options.
- To review parking fine levels and recommend changes.

TRANSPORTATION

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 -25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues	$	680,600	708,213	731,703	738,085	738,984	899	0.1%
Interest and Late Fees	$	800	12,072	22,231	-	-	-	--
Other	$						-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	681,400	720,285	753,934	738,085	738,984	899	0.1%
Returned Capital	$	-	737	-	-	-	-	--
Other Financing Sources		-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Retained Earnings	$	-	-	136,938	136,938	-	(136,938)	-100%
Total Revenues	$	681,400	721,022	890,872	875,023	738,984	(136,039)	-15.5%
		-	-	-	-			
Operating Budget	$	602,865	623,184	588,172	731,023	714,984	(16,039)	-2.2%
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Capital Program	$	-	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	(120,000)	-83.3%
Total Appropriation	$	602,865	648,184	628,172	875,023	738,984	(136,039)	-15.5%
Indirect Costs to General Fund	$	-	-	-	-		-	--
Total Expenditures	$	602,865	648,184	628,172	875,023	738,984	(136,039)	-15.5%

Staffing Trends:

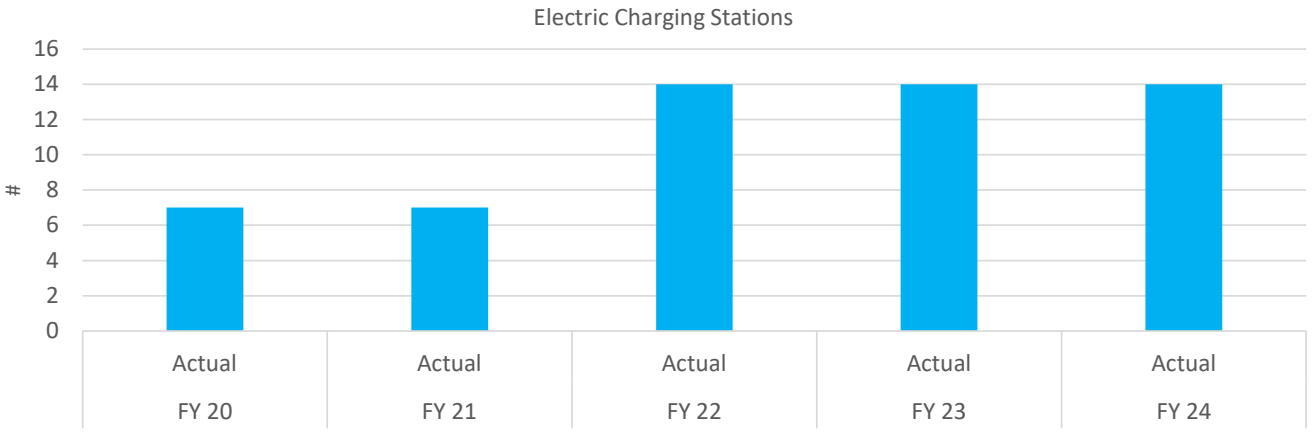


TRANSPORTATION

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Street Meters Maintained	339	357	344	344	204
Handicapped Spaces	21	21	21	21	26
Lot Meters Maintained	12	12	12	16	22
Electric Charging Spaces Maintained	7	7	14	14	14
Stolen and Demolished Meters	0	0	5	13	3
Meter Repairs	35	35	41	68	56
Tickets Issued	9,704	9,449	9,323	8,219	8,496
Traffic Enforcement/Special Events	32	29	50	50	50
Meter Enforcement (hours)	4,133	4,267	3,385	3,360	3,200
Boot Uses/Releases	47	0	49	24	8
Parking Permits Issued	829	543	648	573	570
Collection Rate of Total Issues	77%	80%	80%	72%	70%
Hearings/Appeals	855	646	688	497	426
Annual Meter Revenue per Space					
North Pleasant Street Lot	$406	$116	$243	$261	$396
Boltwood Garage - Upper	$1,013	$598	$946	$905	$1,039
Boltwood Garage - Lower	$197	$237	$270	$228	$254
Street Meters	$719	$167	$262	$310	$453
Amity Street Lot	$1,691	$298	$1,464	$1,839	$2,202
Main Street Lot	$1,686	$826	$1,358	$1,384	$0
Spring Street Lot	$769	$531	$745	$722	$725
Debt Issues Outstanding	1	0	0	0	0
Capital Projects					
Departmental Equipment	0	0	1	1	0
Existing Facilities	0	0	0	0	0

Notable Trends:

Meter revenues per space improved from FY21 and where revenue was significantly impacted by the pandemic.



For more information, visit the Parking in Amherst webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/732/Parking-in-Amherst

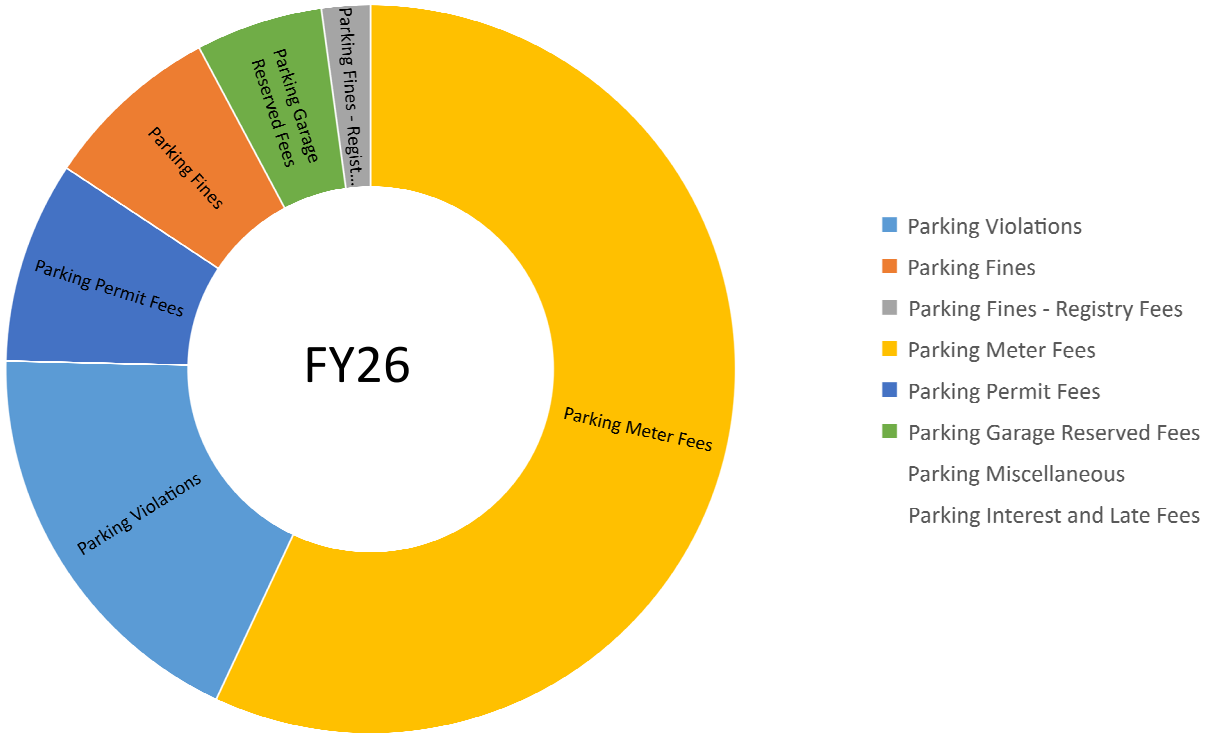
TRANSPORTATION

Revenue Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Parking Violations	$	136,695	110,490	107,041	136,000	136,000	-	--
Parking Fines	$	58,725	41,305	38,840	58,350	58,350	-	--
Parking Fines - Registry Fees	$	17,600	11,530	8,460	16,000	16,000	-	--
Parking Meter Fees	$	413,276	439,442	456,332	420,000	420,899	899	0.2%
Parking Permit Fees	$	19,666	63,171	87,456	66,135	66,135	-	--
Parking Garage Reserved Fees	$	33,360	41,600	33,200	41,600	41,600	-	--
Parking Miscellaneous	$	1,275	675	375	-	-	-	--
Parking Interest and Late Fees	$	800	12,072	22,231	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	681,397	720,285	753,934	738,085	738,984	899	0.1%

Significant Changes:

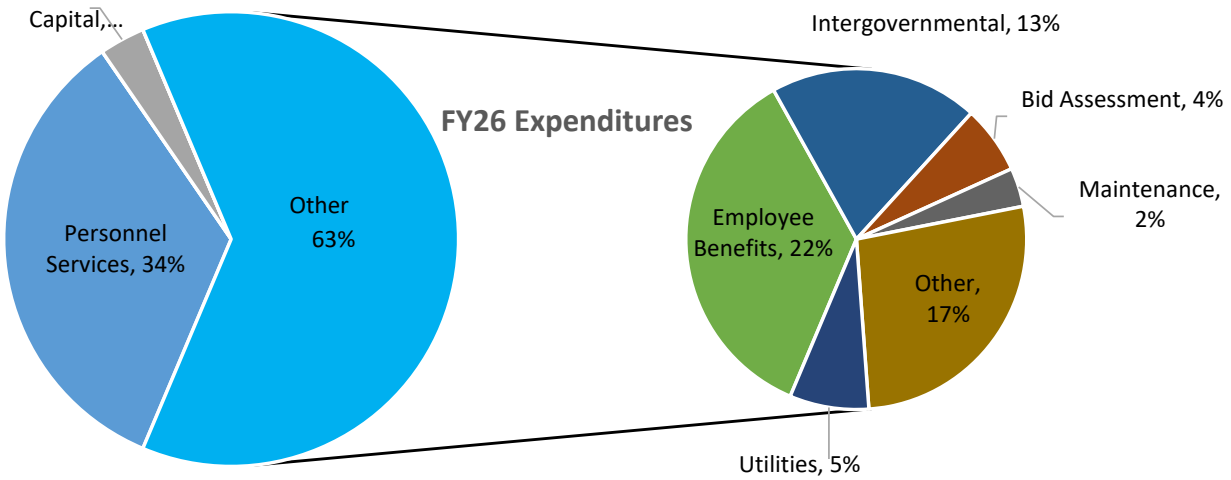
No Changes.

Major Components:



TRANSPORTATION

Expenditure Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Personnel Services	$	221,507	233,484	199,067	248,944	251,695	2,751	1.1%
Operating Expenses	$	381,358	389,700	389,105	482,079	463,289	(18,790)	-3.9%
Capital Outlay	$	-	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	(120,000)	-83.3%
Debt Service	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Indirect Costs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	602,865	648,184	628,172	875,023	738,984	(136,039)	-15.5%



Major Components:

Personnel Services includes funds for two full time Parking Enforcement Officers, a Parking Clerk, and one and one-half Maintenance Workers. The Procurement Officer is shared with the General Fund, Sewer Fund, and Water Fund. Also included are funds for one part-time Parking Enforcement Officer.

Employee Benefits are $164,901 for health insurance, retirement, and other employee benefits, including a payment of $26,902 into the OPEB Trust Fund.

Intergovernmental of $91,831 includes funds for the PVTA subsidies and taxes to the General Fund for parking facilities.

The Business Improvement District (BID) Assessment is $30,000.

Utilities, $34,902, for electricity costs.

Other includes supplies, utilities, technical services, subsidies, and Valley Bikeshare.

TRANSPORTATION

Capital Detail:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Departmental Equipment	$	-	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	(120,000)	-83.3%
Existing Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
New Facilities	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	25,000	40,000	144,000	24,000	(120,000)	-83.3%

Significant Changes:

Only one capital project planned for FY26.

Major Components:

$24,000 to purchase parking kiosks.

TRANSPORTATION

Debt Service:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Principal	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Interest	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Appropriation	$	-	-	-	-		-	--

Significant Changes:

None.

Major Components:

None.

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Grant Fund Summary & Detail

Overview

The following section provides a summary and additional details about grant funding by department.

GRANT FUNDS EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

Budget:		FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Community Services	$	1,893	81,885	2,019	-	-
Conservation	$	500,424	483,457	676,733	47,441	253,450
Council on Aging	$	63,648	22,226	34,467	79,364	77,443
CRESS	$	-	-	174,956	590,306	605,828
Dispatch	$	114,485	139,425	139,445	140,234	141,287
Fire	$	42,708	71,369	90,578	23,527	55,460
General	$	356,146	4,186,423	1,055,664	2,131,073	2,368,961
Information Technology	$	63,248	-	-	63,808	306,742
Library	$	77,680	5,531	11,731	1,142,605	1,538,306
Planning	$	866,128	1,102,397	437,416	1,132,133	494,792
Police	$	178,314	171,075	184,626	157,614	68,476
Public Works	$	654,698	274,219	992,892	1,583,902	7,942,616
Schools						2,115,166
Total Expenditures	$	2,919,371	6,538,007	3,800,528	7,092,005	15,968,527

Significant Changes:

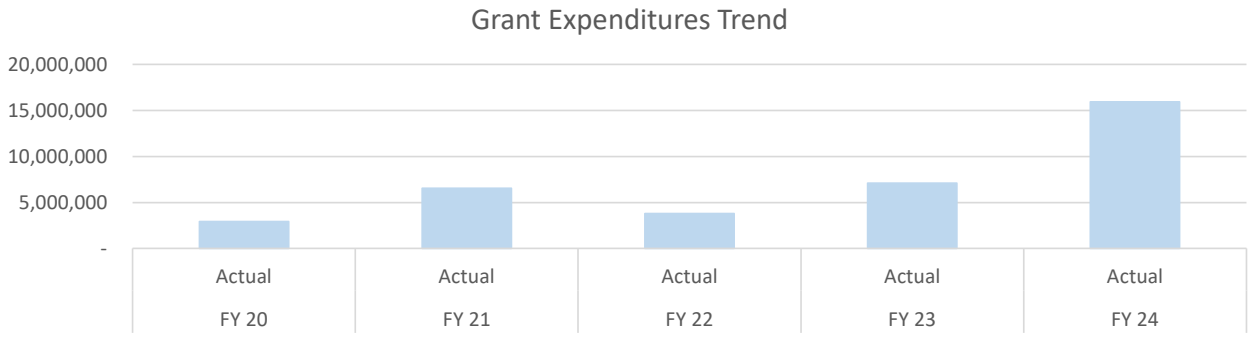
FY 20 significant grant expenditures include: Chapter 90 Funds, LAND (Local Acquisitions for Natural Diversity) Grant, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), Department of Justice (DOJ) Domestic Violence Grant.

FY 21 significant grant expenditures included: Chapter 90 Funds, PARC (Parkland Acquisitions and Renovations for Communities) Grant, Massachusetts Volkswagen (VW) Grant, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA), Coronavirus Aid, Relief, and Economic Security Act (CARES), and Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA).

FY 22 significant grant expenditures included: Chapter 90 Funds, DOT Shared Streets Grant, PARC (Parkland Acquisitions and Renovations for Communities) Grant, MassDEP Fearing Brook Floodplain Creation Grant, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, Green Communities Grant, DHCD Housing Choice Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), Department of Justice (DOJ) Domestic Violence Grant, Stanton Foundation Dog Park Grant, and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA).

FY 23 significant grant expenditures included: Chapter 90 Funds, State Aid to Libraries, Department of Public Health Equitable Approachs to Public Safety grant, MassWorks Grant, Mass Board of Library Commissioners Construction Grant Program, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), Department of Justice (DOJ) Domestic Violence Grant, and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA).

FY 24 significant grant expenditures included: State Aid to Libraries, Department of Public Health Equitable Approachs to Public Safety Grant, MassWorks Grant, Mass Board of Library Commissioners Construction Grant Program, State 911 Department Support and Incentive Grant, CDBG (Community Development Block Grant), PARC Grant, LWCF (Land Water Conservation Fund) Grant, MVP Grant, Mass DWSRF (Drinking Water State Revolving Fund) Grant Program, MSBA (massachuseets School Building Authority) Grant, and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA).



GRANT FUNDS EXPENDITURES SUMMARY

FY 25 Grant Awards Details:

NAME OF GRANT	PURPOSE	AWARD AMOUNT	DURATION
COMMUNITY SERVICES:			
CDBG-Community Development Block Grant Program	FFY23 CDBG - Infrastructure improvements to East Street Neighborhood Park, Belchertown Road, South East Street Extension; microenterprise assistance (32 businesses); social services (family stabilization; food pantry, ESOL, homelessness prevention, youth mentoring).	$1,650,000.00	July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2026
CDBG-Community Development Block Grant Program	FY25 CDBG - North Pleasant St infrastructure improvements, microenterprise assistance program, social services (mobile food market, food pantry, youth services, ESOL, homlessness prevention.)	$ 925,000	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2027
CONSERVATION:			
Municipal Energy Technical Assistance (META) Grant	To fund a consultant to perform a study to determine efficacy & scope of building retro-commissioning.	$ 15,000	April 4, 2024 - Sept 30, 2025
Energy Efficiency & Conservation Block Grant (EECBG)	To purchase an electric pick up truck for the Facilities Department.	$ 76,500	Jan 8, 2025 - Jan 8, 2027
FY25 Dam & Seawall Repair Program	To complete the necessary design work and filing of permits needed to repair the Puffer's Pond Dam & Dike.	$ 250,000	Dec 21, 2024 - June 30, 2027
MassTrails Program Grant	Hickory Ridge Accessible Trail Connection	$ 109,585	July 31, 2024 - Dec 31, 2026
SENIOR CENTER:			
Highland Valley Elder Services Title III Grant-Caregivers Grant FY 24	To increase participation of older adults in Wednesday Morning Café.	$ 4,000	Oct 1, 2023 - Sept 30, 2024
FY25 Mass Executive Office of Elder Affairs Grant	Senior Center Modernization: to be used for Wayfinding & Hybrid Enhancement.	$ 24,000	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FY25 Mass Executive Office of Elder Affairs Grant #2	Wellness learning community.	$ 6,000	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FY23 Earmark for Senior Center	To support community outreach and programs to seniors to help reduce social isolation	$ 15,000	July 1, 2022 - June 30, 2023
FY 25 Formula Grant	To support community outreach and programs to seniors to help reduce social isolation	$ 80,265	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
DISPATCH:			
FY25 State 911 Dept Support and Incentive Grant	Reimbursement of personnel costs for Public Safety Answering Point and Regional Emergency Communication Centers	$ 168,008	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FY25 STATE 911 Dept Training Grant	Reimbursement of training-related costs associated with the 9-1-1 system	$ 20,972	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FIRE:			
FY25 SAFE and Senior SAFE Grant	The SAFE grant program is to teach fire safety education in local schools and to senior citizens	$ 9,798	April 9, 2025 - Dec. 30, 2025
MDU Grant	To ensure the Mass Decontamination Units assigned to AFD will be maintained in a state of readiness in the event of an emergency	$ 2,000	ongoing
FY25 Firefighter Equipment Grant	For the purchase of handheld thermal imagers.	$ 25,000	Jan 31, 2025 - June 30, 2025
FY25 Firefighter Equipment Grant #2	For the purchase of SCBA facepieces.	$ 12,292	April 17, 2025 - June 30, 2025
FY25 Earmark - DFS	Funds for the purchase or turnout gear and other equipment for the AFD.	$ 125,000	Jan 7, 2025 - June 30, 2025
FY 25 Emergency Management Program Performance (EMPG) Grant	For the purchase of a mask leak/fit tester.	$ 9,500	Nov 14, 2024 - June 30, 2025
Hazard Mitigation Grant Program	For updating local Hazard Mitigation Plans/Goals.	$ 34,200	Jan 10, 2024 - May 1, 2026
FY25 (23) Assistance to Firefighters Grant	For the purchase of complete sets of turnout gear.	$ 297,091	Aug 28, 2024 - Aug 27, 2026
GENERAL:			
Massachusetts Cultural Council - Cultural Districts Initiative Funding	Financial assistance to encourage the development and success of the Amherst Center Cultural District.	$ 15,000	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FY25 Equitable Approaches to Public Safety (EAPS) Grant	To support the implementation of the CRESS program	$ 449,949	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FY22 Earmark for COVID-19 Recovery Needs	To support translation services, promote engagement and inclusion, and facilitate participation in civic activities for BIPOC and ESL communities	$ 80,000	Feb 10, 2022 - June 30, 2027
LIBRARY:			
MBLC- Mass Board of Library Commissioners Construction Grant	For construction of an addition to Jones Library	$ 13,871,314	July 1, 2021 - June 30, 2026
PLANNING:			
FY25 Municipal ADA Improvement Grant	To remove barriers and improve access to the Munson Memorial Library, including an accessible entranceway and doors.	$ 100,000	Nov. 25, 2024 - June 30, 2025
POLICE:			
OVW-Grants to Improve the Criminal Justice Response	Town of Amherst, Umass and Hadley - continuation of a regional, collaborative project to respond effectively for women victimized by domestic, stalking, sexual, or dating violence.	$ 321,924	Oct 1, 2023 - Sept 30, 2026
FY25 Municipal Road Safety (MRS) Program	Highway Safety Traffic Enforcement & pedestrian/bike safety	$ 33,800	Nov 1, 2024 - Sept 15, 2025
PUBLIC WORKS:			
EOEEA DWSP Grant Program	For the purchase of 11.11 acres of property at Sand Hill Road in Town of Shutesbury across the street from a trail-head that leads to a 252 acre conservation area owned by the Town of Amherst.	$ 65,220	July 11, 2024 - June 30, 2025
EOEEA DWSRF Grant Program	Cybersecurity Improvements: Implement OT Network Security Monitoring, Vulnerability Management.	$ 50,000	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
FY25 EOEEA MVP Action Grant Program	To complete the projected entitled "Fort River Watershed Improvements for Flood & Water Quality Resiliency."	$ 1,179,700	Aug 2, 2024 - June 30, 2026
FY24 Fair Share Grant (Chapter 90)	Additional Chapter 90 funds	$ 383,386	July 1, 2024 - June 30, 2025
MassWorks Infrastructure Program	This project is part of an effort to improve Belchertown Road in the East Amherst Village Ctr. & includes sidewalk improvements to enhance pedestrian connectivity of the Village Center.	$ 755,000	March 16, 2023 - June 30, 2025
MassWorks Infrastructure Program	To support a public infrastructure project at University Drive/Amity St.	$ 1,940,000	Feb. 18, 2025 - June 30, 2026
FY25 Inland Dredging Pilot Round	To support the Atkins Reservoir Sedimentation Basin Dredging Project.	$ 260,000	Aug 12, 2024 - June 30, 2026

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Revolving Fund Summary & Detail

Overview

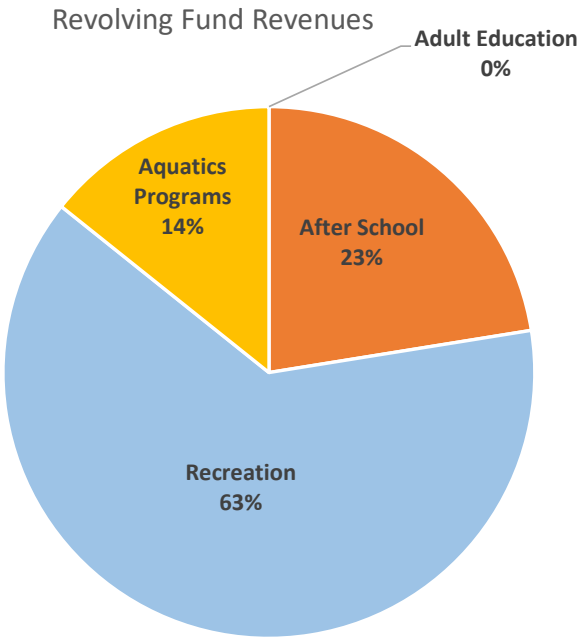
The following section provides a summary and additional details about the revolving fund for recreation programs.

REVOLVING FUND SUMMARY

Revenues:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Adult Education	$	4,729	5,397	7,652	6,000	-	(6,000)	-100.0%
After School	$	129,983	180,611	194,790	180,000	185,000	5,000	2.8%
Recreation	$	410,040	511,333	598,101	580,221	520,750	(59,471)	-10.2%
Aquatics Programs	$	-	-	-	-	117,500	117,500	--
Total Revenues	$	544,752	697,341	800,543	766,221	705,750	(60,471)	-7.9%
Expenditures:								
Adult Education	$	3,798	7,326	6,406	6,000	-	(6,000)	-100.0%
After School	$	130,239	176,536	186,028	180,000	185,000	5,000	2.8%
Recreation	$	416,141	493,700	568,639	580,221	520,750	(59,471)	-10.2%
Aquatics Programs	$	-	-	-	-	117,500	117,500	--
Total Expenditures	$	550,178	677,562	761,073	766,221	705,750	(60,471)	-7.9%
Fund Gain/(Loss)	$	(5,426)	19,779	39,470	-	-	-	--

Significant Changes:

The Adult Education revolving fund is being closed due to little activity and will be combined with the regular Recreation Revolving fund. A new revolving fund under Mass General Law Ch 44, sec 53 E ½ is proposed for Aquatics Programming. This is a strategic move to focus attention on swim programs and realize new revenues that can go toward future aquatics programming.



REVOLVING FUND SUMMARY

Revolving Fund Overview:

Revolving funds are used to manage fee based activities. Unlike the General Fund, Revolving Funds can carryover unexpended funds at year end hence the name Revolving Fund. Only certain activities are legally authorized to have Revolving Funds.

Adult Education: This fund is ending in FY25. The adult education revolving fund has only been running one program for many years and it nolonger makes sense to track this seperately. The one program will be merged in the adult education section of the regular recreation revolving fund.

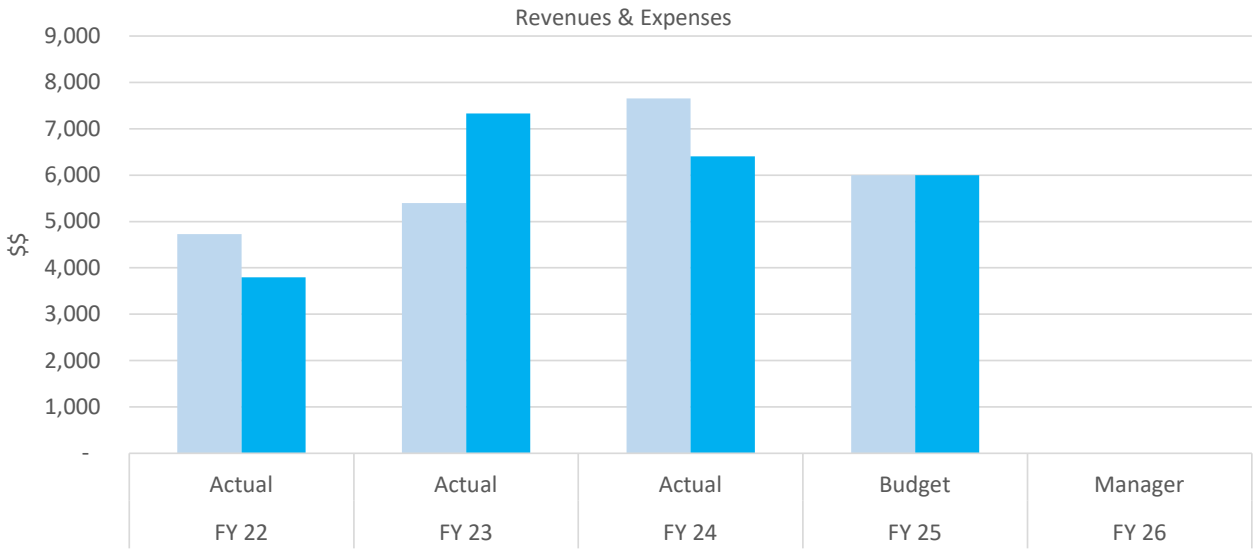
After School: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's After School programming. Expenses include wages for the staff and supplies. Tuition is charged for enrollment in this program. The Town provides subsidies to offset the tuition for income eligible families. Tuition payments are recorded in the Revolving Fund as revenue.

Recreation: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's Recreation programming. Expenses include supplies and payments to instructors. A fee is charged for participation in these programs. These fees get recorded in the Revolving Fund as revenue.

Aquatics Programs: This fund manages all of the costs associated with the Town's Indoor Aquatics programming. Expenses include supplies and payments to instructors, lifeguards, pool rentals, uniforms, etc. A fee is charged for participation in these programs. These fees get recorded in the Revolving Fund as revenue.

ADULT EDUCATION REVOLVING FUND

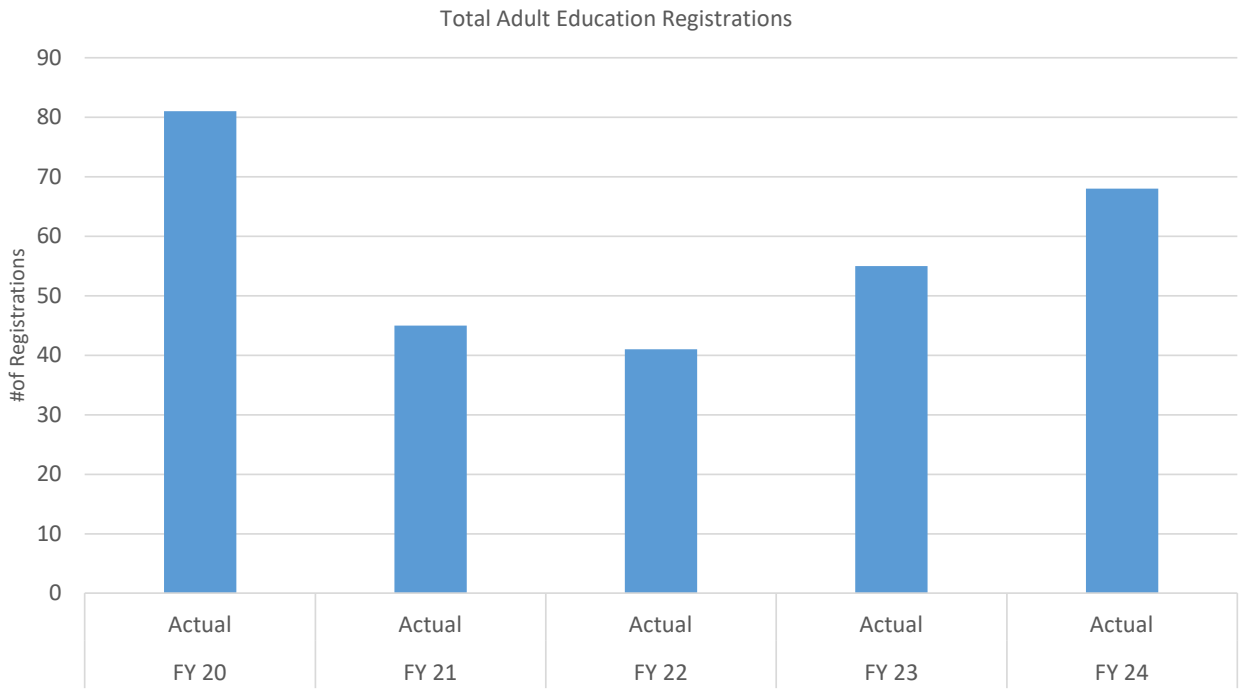
Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues						N/A		
Performing Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Visual Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Health Programs	$	4,729	5,397	7,652	6,000	-	(6,000)	-100.0%
Hobbies Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Personal Development	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Sports Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	4,729	5,397	7,652	6,000	-	(6,000)	-100.0%
Use of Fund Balance	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	4,729	5,397	7,652	6,000	-	(6,000)	-100.0%
Operating Expenses						N/A		
Performing Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Visual Arts	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Health Programs	$	3,798	2,326	4,406	4,000	-	(4,000)	-100.0%
Hobbies Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Personal Development	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Sports Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Misc. Programs	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Expenses	$	3,798	2,326	4,406	4,000	-	(4,000)	-100.0%
Admin. Reimbursements	$	-	5,000	2,000	2,000	-	(2,000)	-100.0%
Total Expenditures	$	3,798	7,326	6,406	6,000	-	(6,000)	-100.0%



ADULT EDUCATION REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Registrations	81	45	41	55	68
Performing Arts	0	0	0	0	0
Visual Arts	0	0	0	0	0
Health Programs	76	45	41	55	68
Hobbies Programs	5	0	0	0	0
Personal Development	0	0	0	0	0
Sports Programs	0	0	0	0	0

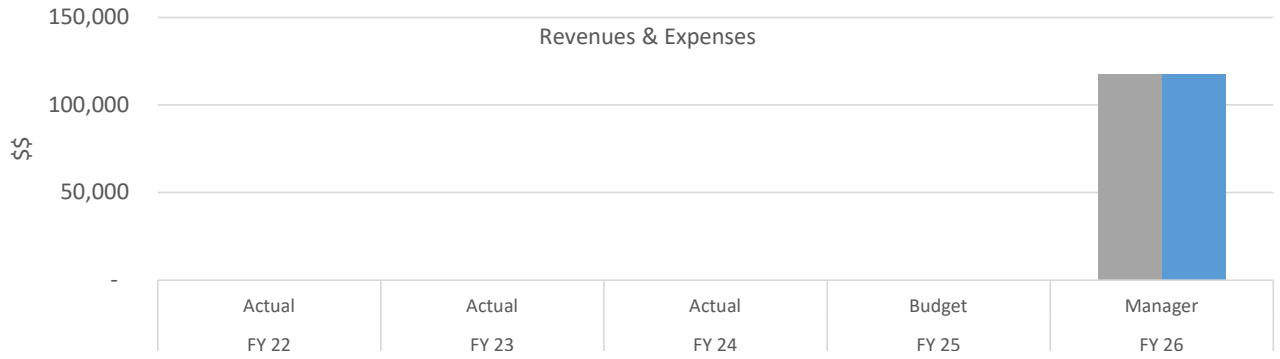
Notable Trends:
The only program currently active is Qi Gong. This will be the last year for this fund. This activity will move into the regular recreation revolving fund.



For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3535/Adult-Programs

AQUATICS PROGRAMS REVOLVING FUND

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues								
Amherst United	$	-	-	-	-	65,000	65,000	--
Indoor Lessons	$	-	-	-	-	16,000	16,000	--
Adaptive Lessons	$	-	-	-	-	6,500	6,500	--
Masters Swimming	$	-	-	-	-	7,000	7,000	--
Open Swim	$	-	-	-	-	3,000	3,000	--
Birthday Parties	$	-	-	-	-	1,000	1,000	--
Adult Lessons	$	-	-	-	-	5,000	5,000	--
Stroke & Turn Clinics	$	-	-	-	-	8,000	8,000	--
Dive Clinics	$	-	-	-	-	3,000	3,000	--
Pool Rentals	$	-	-	-	-	3,000	3,000	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	-	-	-	-	117,500	117,500	--
Use of Fund Balance	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	-	-	-	-	117,500	117,500	--
Operating Expenses								
Pool Rental	$	-	-	-	-	14,000	14,000	--
Full-Time Salary	$	-	-	-	-	70,183	70,183	--
Fringe Benefits	$	-	-	-	-	9,600	9,600	--
Extra Help/Staff Payroll	$	-	-	-	-	15,917	15,917	--
Administrative Software	$	-	-	-	-	900	900	--
Meet Fees	$	-	-	-	-	800	800	--
Trainings	$	-	-	-	-	200	200	--
Small Equipment	$	-	-	-	-	500	500	--
Cleaning Supplies	$	-	-	-	-	200	200	--
Uniforms	$	-	-	-	-	1,200	1,200	--
Credit Card Fees	$	-	-	-	-	4,000	4,000	--
Subtotal Expenses	$	-	-	-	-	117,500	117,500	--
Admin. Reimbursements	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Expenditures	$	-	-	-	-	117,500	117,500	--

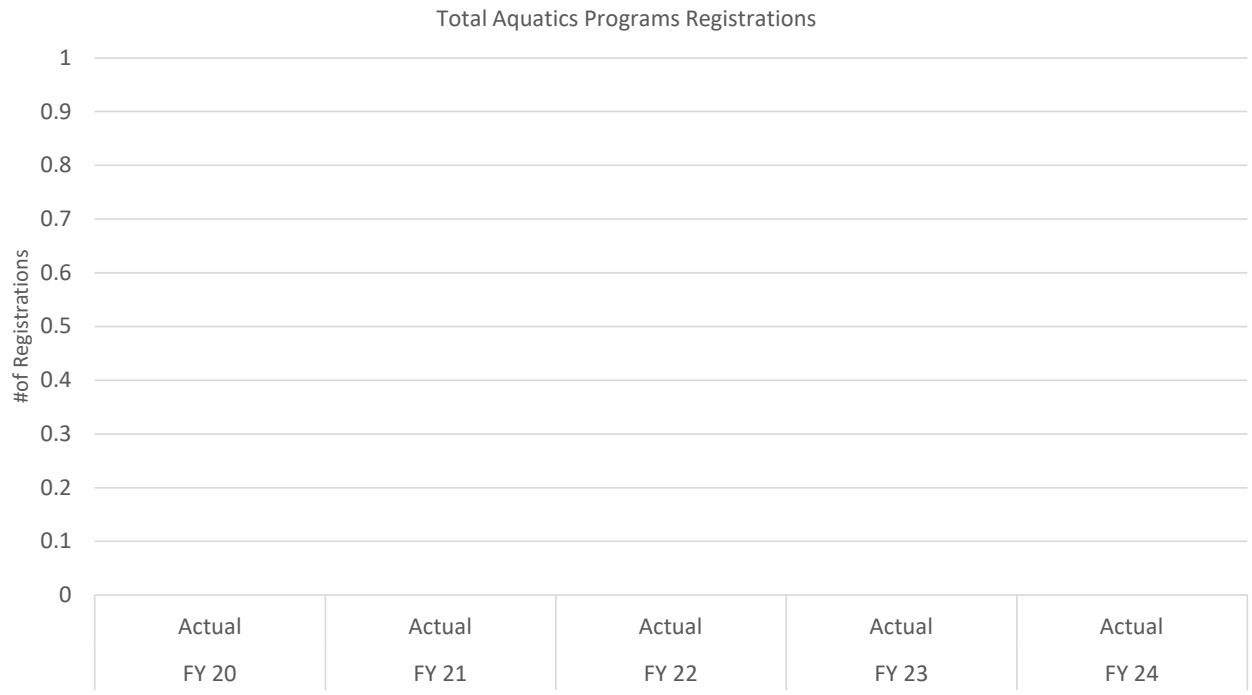


AQUATICS PROGRAMS REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Registrations	0	0	0	0	0
Amherst United	0	0	0	0	0
Indoor Lessons	0	0	0	0	0
Adaptive Lessons	0	0	0	0	0
Masters Swimming	0	0	0	0	0
Open Swim	0	0	0	0	0
Birthday Parties	0	0	0	0	0
Adult Lessons	0	0	0	0	0
Stroke & Turn Clinics	0	0	0	0	0
Dive Clinics	0	0	0	0	0
Pool Rentals	0	0	0	0	0

Notable Trends:

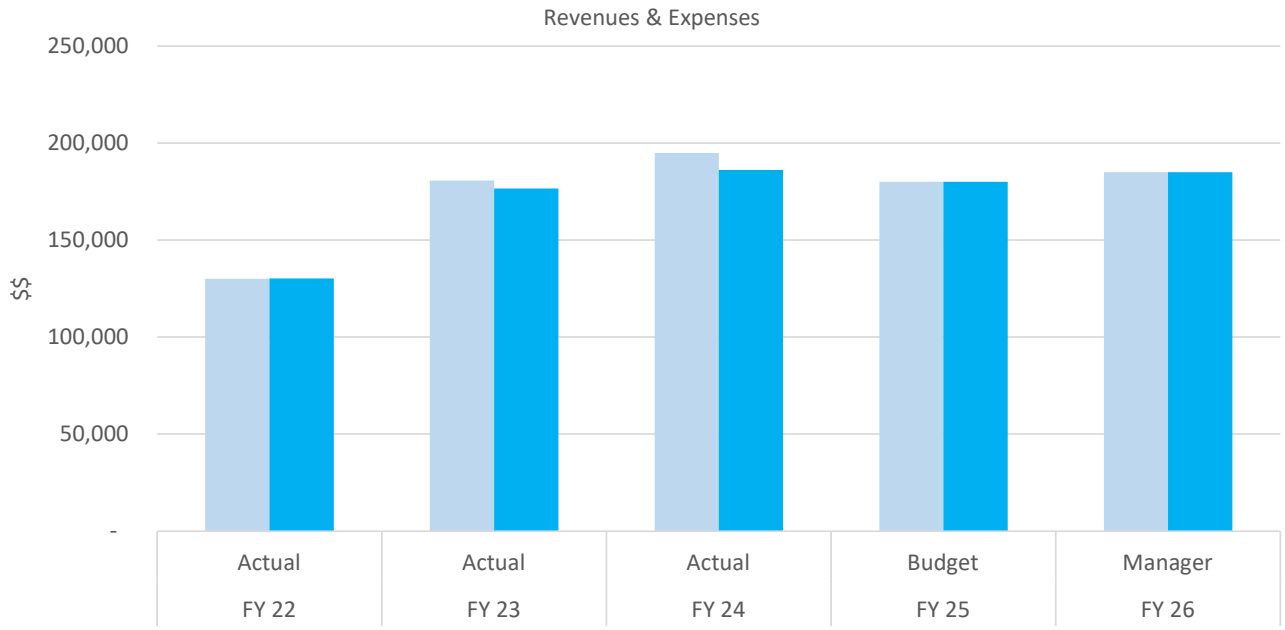
This is a newly proposed revolving fund for FY26 to better track aquatics programs. See activity for the indoor pools for prior years in the Recreation revolving fund below.



For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3564/Recreation-Department

AFTER SCHOOL REVOLVING FUND

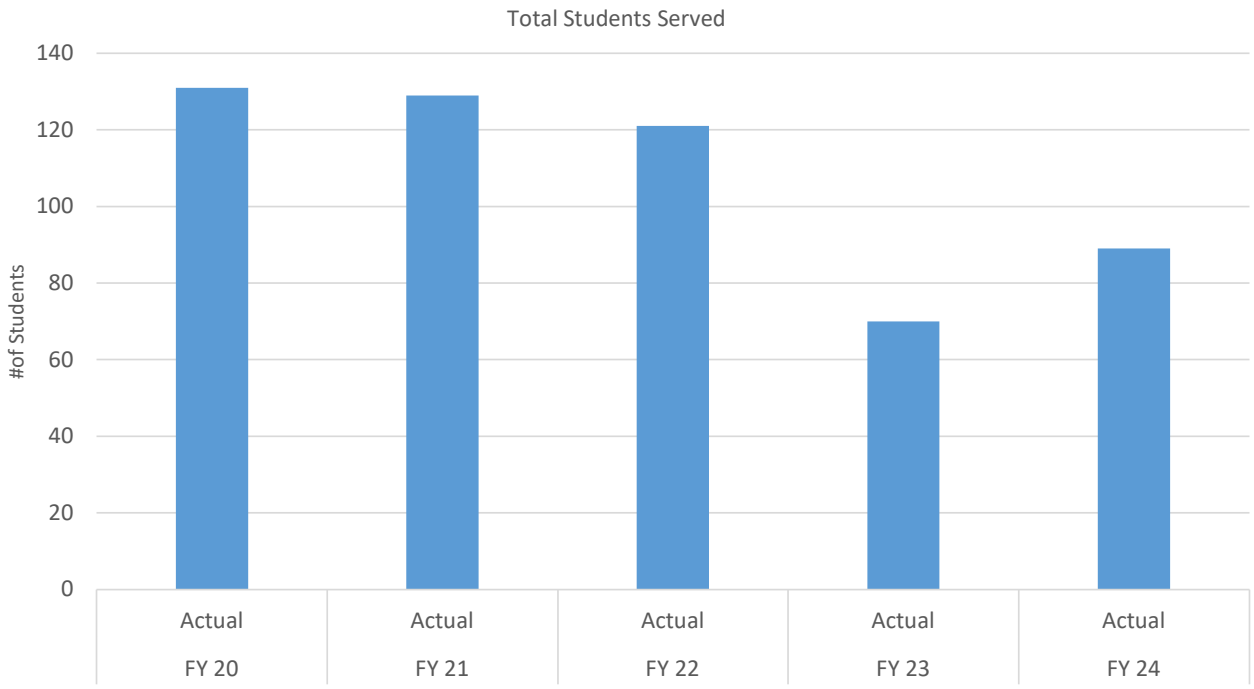
Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues								
Tuition	$	78,850	166,271	173,260	130,000	155,000	25,000	19.2%
Tuition Subsidies	$	51,132	14,340	21,530	50,000	30,000	(20,000)	-40.0%
Gifts/Donations	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Subtotal Revenues	$	129,983	180,611	194,790	180,000	185,000	5,000	2.8%
Use of Fund Balance	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	129,983	180,611	194,790	180,000	185,000	5,000	2.8%
Operating Expenses								
Personnel Services	$	87,760	121,658	128,909	123,700	132,000	8,300	6.7%
Benefits	$	15,647	16,490	16,982	17,400	18,000	600	3.4%
Professional Development	$	1,264	1,672	1,207	1,000	2,000	1,000	100.0%
Supplies	$	1,671	2,404	2,317	2,500	2,500	-	0.0%
Food	$	13,031	15,217	15,252	14,400	10,000	(4,400)	-30.6%
Advertising	$	-	-	-	-	-	-	--
Other	$	1,866	1,096	1,158	3,000	2,500	(500)	-16.7%
Subtotal Expenses	$	121,239	158,536	165,825	162,000	167,000	5,000	3.1%
Admin. Reimbursements	$	9,000	18,000	20,203	18,000	18,000	-	0.0%
Total Expenditures	$	130,239	176,536	186,028	180,000	185,000	5,000	2.8%



AFTER SCHOOL REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Students Served	131	129	121	70	89
School Year	131	129	121	70	89
Summer	0	0	0	0	0
Subsidies Provided (# of families)	41	35	27	21	22
School Year	41	35	27	21	22
Summer	0	0	0	0	0

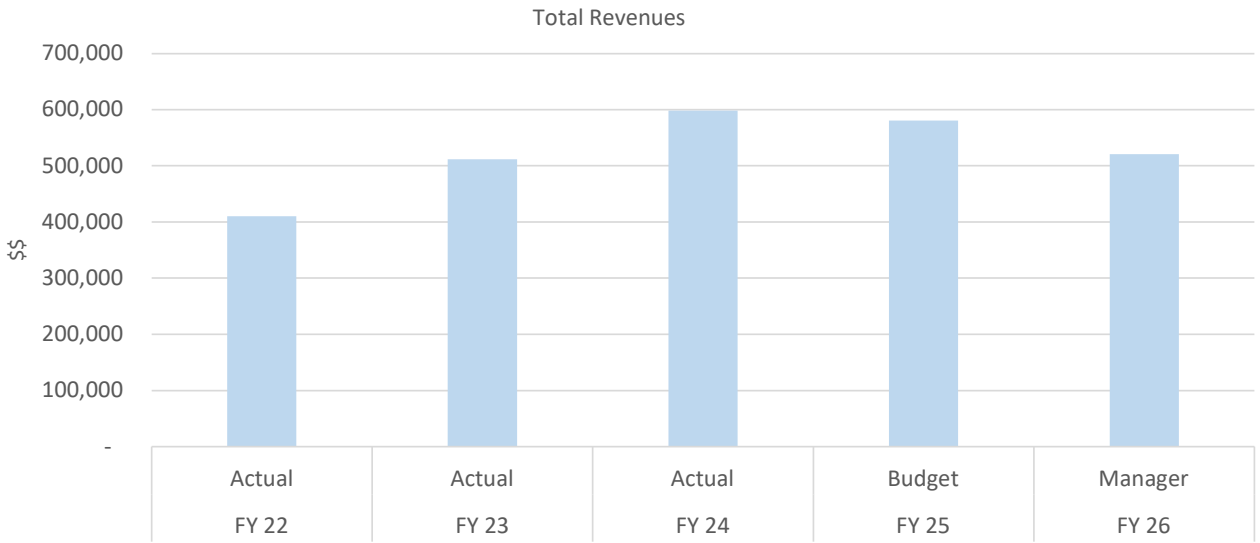
Notable Trends:
Enrollment went up slightly and we were able to accommodate that rise in interest.



For more information, visit the Amherst After School webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/345/PrimeTime

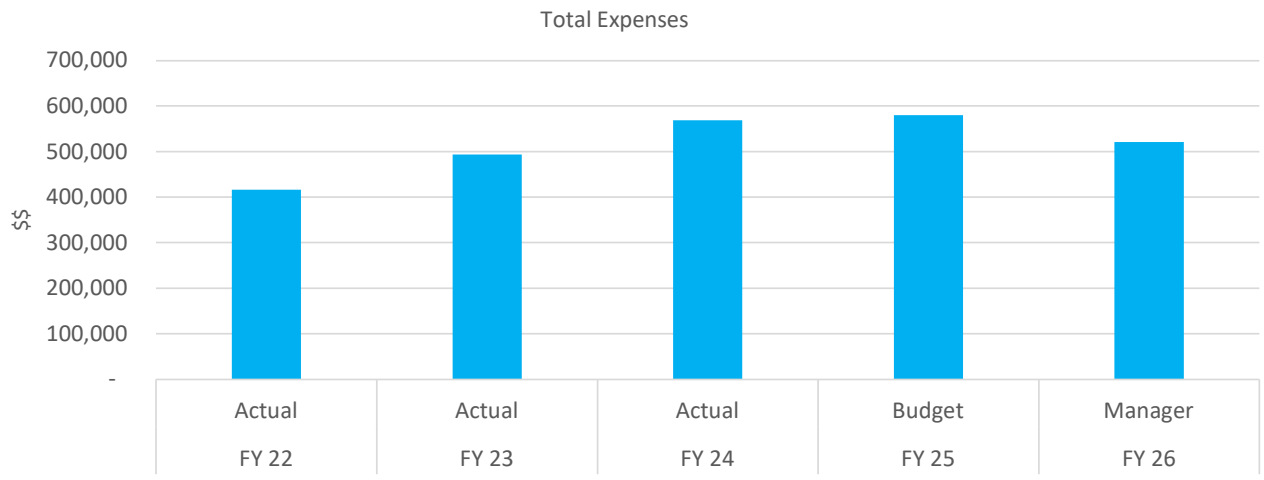
RECREATION REVOLVING FUND

Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Revenues								
Purchase of Services								
Printing/Advertising	$	-		-	-	-	-	--
Misc.	$	5,279	1,252		26,626		(26,626)	-100.0%
Youth Programs								
Instructional Classes	$	2,661	1,906	2,370	-	5,000	5,000	--
Day Camps	$	153,085	81,385	149,718	120,225	157,024	36,799	30.6%
Sports Camps	$	68,464	69,640	74,326	110,500	70,000	(40,500)	-36.7%
NUTC	$			-	-	-	-	--
Youth Sports Leagues	$	100,500	129,917	138,333	100,375	83,000	(17,375)	-17.3%
Downhill Skiing	$			-	-	9,400	9,400	--
Vacation Camps	$	8,931	15,064	15,759	18,320	18,820	500	2.7%
Adult Programs								
Sports Leagues	$	7,042	15,070	17,923	10,000	14,217	4,217	42.2%
Open Gyms	$		2,959	6,650	4,175	3,200	(975)	-23.4%
Health Programs	$			-	-	5,500	5,500	--
Family Programs								
Special Events	$		8,291	14,302	30,000	18,000	(12,000)	-40.0%
Community Theater	$		111,286	97,574	95,000	114,894	19,894	20.9%
Field/Facility Activities	$	20,675	24,655	21,660	18,500	21,695	3,195	17.3%
Miscellaneous Programs	$	9,759	13,254	20,959	19,000	-	(19,000)	-100.0%
Indoor Pool	$	31,373	36,654	38,527	27,500	-	(27,500)	-100.0%
Subtotal Revenues	$	407,770	511,333	598,101	580,221	520,750	(59,471)	-10.2%
Use of Fund Balance	$	2,270	-		-	-	-	--
Total Revenues	$	410,040	511,333	598,101	580,221	520,750	(59,471)	-10.2%



RECREATION REVOLVING FUND

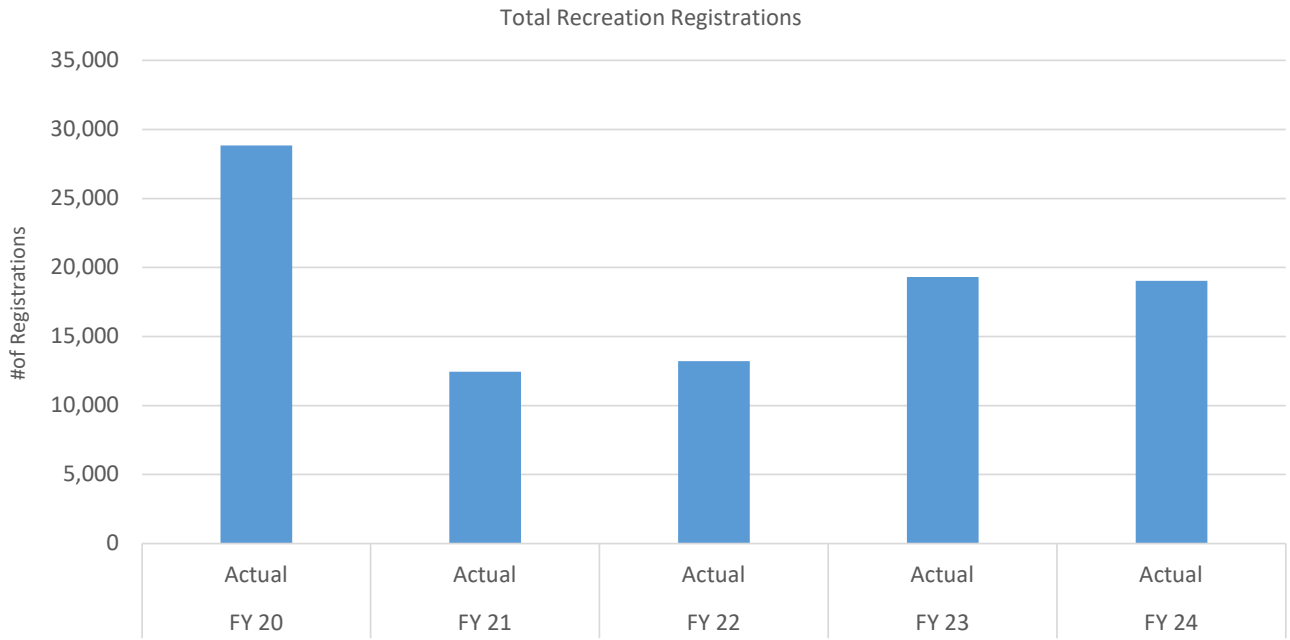
Budget:		FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual	FY 25 Budget	FY 26 Manager	FY 26 - 25 Change	Percent Change
Operating Expenses								
Purchase of Services								
Extra Help	$		15,341	116	26,626	3,948	(22,678)	-574.4%
Printing/Advertising	$	22,961	780	27,366	22,900		(22,900)	--
Postage	$			-	-	-	-	--
Credit Card Services	$	11,611	18,174	19,793	-	32,000	32,000	100.0%
Food & Bev Supplies	$	6,387	7,286	7,951	7,000	-	(7,000)	--
Youth Programs								
Instructional Classes	$		216	600	-	1,000	1,000	100.0%
Day Camps	$	79,409	90,246	72,625	103,790	108,328	4,538	4.2%
Sports Camps	$	52,981	4,763	40,248	63,000	38,000	(25,000)	-65.8%
NUTC	$			-	-	-	-	--
Youth Sports Leagues	$	75,298	105,747	43,138	65,470	42,000	(23,470)	-55.9%
Downhill Skiing	$			435	-	8,760	8,760	100.0%
Vacation Camps	$	1,272	6,368	4,989	12,800	10,412	(2,388)	-22.9%
Adult Programs								
Sports Leagues	$	1,225	920	1,059	7,400	7,400	-	0.0%
Open Gyms	$				900	-	(900)	--
Health Programs	$		150	5,053	-	4,406	4,406	100.0%
Family Programs								
Special Events	$	1,500	22,373	25,296	25,000	30,000	5,000	16.7%
Community Theater	$		85,901	77,618	73,704	92,296	18,592	20.1%
Field/Facility Activities	$	1,804	5,469	818	5,500	500	(5,000)	-1000.0%
Miscellaneous Programs	$	49,667	33,327	17,130	8,131	1,700	(6,431)	-378.3%
Indoor Pool	$	30,076	28,587	48,302	20,000	-	(20,000)	--
Subtotal Expenses	$	334,190	425,650	392,538	442,221	380,750	(61,471)	-13.9%
Administrative Reimb.	$	81,951	68,050	176,101	138,000	140,000	2,000	1.4%
Total Expenses	$	416,141	493,700	568,639	580,221	520,750	(59,471)	-10.2%



RECREATION REVOLVING FUND

Service Levels:	FY 20 Actual	FY 21 Actual	FY 22 Actual	FY 23 Actual	FY 24 Actual
Youth Programs					
Instructional Classes	87	0	0	0	0
Day Camps	782	646	506	612	616
Sports Camps	491	515	312	542	543
NUTC	198	0	0	0	0
Youth Sports Leagues	697	425	500	568	611
Downhill Skiing	32	0	0	0	0
Vacation Camps	42	0	71	66	67
Adult Programs					
Sports Leagues	411	122	200	251	478
Open Gyms	700	600	500	814	840
Family Programs					
Special Events	20,506	10,000	11,000	12,000	12,000
Community Theater	4,544	0	0	4,280	3,627
Indoor Pool	254	150	125	150	212
Boltwood Project	8	0	0	0	0
Miscellaneous Programs	81	0	0	20	30

Notable Trends:
Adult Sports Leagues grew in offerings and popularity. Community Theater had a less popular show which dropped ticket sales. Indoor pool offerings and programs expanded which increased enrollment.



For more information, visit the Amherst Recreation webpage at:
https://www.amherstma.gov/3564/Recreation-Department

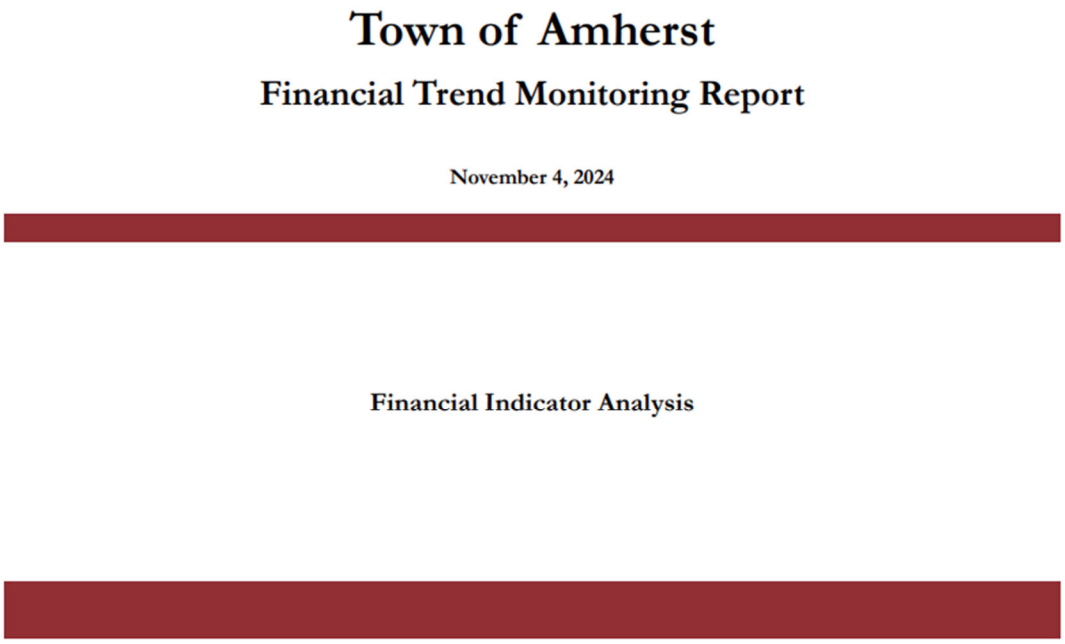
Informational Section

"He who fails to plan is planning to fail."

- Winston Churchill

Financial Indicators Report

The Financial Indicators report is presented to the Town Council each fall as a kickoff to the budget process. The report contains a wide array of current and historical financial information. The report includes an analysis of trends and projections for the next budget year. Click here to view the full report.



Town of Amherst

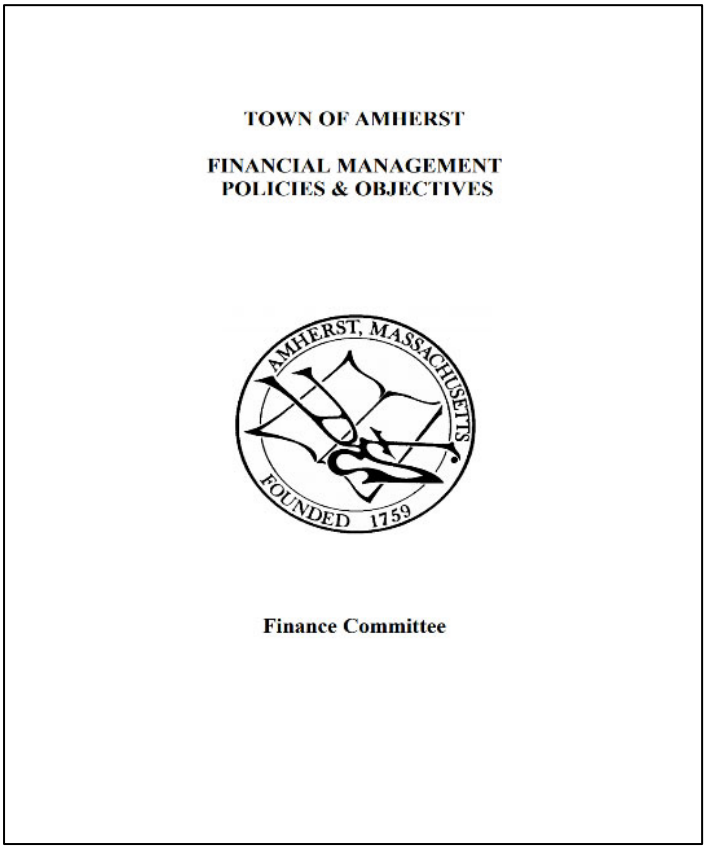
Financial Trend Monitoring Report

November 4, 2024

Financial Indicator Analysis

Financial Policies

The Town maintains Financial Policies that promote sound decision making. Click here to view these policies.



TOWN OF AMHERST

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT
POLICIES & OBJECTIVES

AMHERST, MASSACHUSETTS
FOUNDED 1759

Finance Committee

Debt Management

An important function of the Finance Department is to effectively manage the debt of the Town. Debt is created whenever the Town borrows funds to pay for a project such as building repairs, new vehicles, public works projects, etc. The borrowing can be short-term or long-term and is added to our debt schedule. Debt is paid from various sources but usually from funds appropriated for capital projects each year.

Using debt to finance projects is a prudent way to spread payments out over several years and to preserve remaining capital funds for smaller projects. Borrowed funds include debt service costs or interest that must be paid by the Town. Interest rates fluctuate and that can affect the timing of when the Town utilizes debt for a project. An important factor in determining the interest rate is the Town's bond rating. Reports on the Town's bond rating can be found at https://www.amherstma.gov/122/Finance.

When planning for debt, staff use an integrated approach that combines the debt schedule with the Capital Improvement Program. This ensures all capital projects are recorded. Below is an illustration of the Town's current debt obligations.

	FY2025	FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029	FY2030	FY2031	Future Years
General Fund								
Municipal:	1,021,786	1,402,350	2,968,043	2,574,482	2,505,797	2,460,861	1,907,451	20,132,150
Municipal: Debt Excluded	691,807	2,125,643	2,899,294	3,165,794	3,260,569	3,273,657	3,292,796	80,360,094
Regional School District Debt (Amherst Share):		485,000	800,000	800,000	800,000	800,000	800,000	800,000
CPA Fund Debt	340,456	176,550	315,250	375,000	370,000	365,000	360,000	1,345,000
General Fund Total	**2,054,049**	**4,189,543**	**6,982,587**	**6,915,276**	**6,936,366**	**6,899,518**	**6,360,247**	**102,637,244**
Enterprise								
Sewer Fund Debt	1,006,034	1,150,624	1,224,025	1,190,475	1,056,800	1,026,625	808,825	4,175,500
Water Fund Debt	862,162	1,396,904	1,576,349	1,546,876	1,447,405	1,114,659	1,093,465	23,150,126
Enterprise Total	**1,868,196**	**2,547,528**	**2,800,374**	**2,737,351**	**2,504,205**	**2,141,284**	**1,902,290**	**27,325,626**
TOTAL DEBT SERVICE (ALL FUNDS)	**3,922,244**	**6,737,071**	**9,782,961**	**9,652,628**	**9,440,571**	**9,040,803**	**8,262,537**	**129,962,870**

	FY2025	FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029	FY2030	FY2031	Future Years
General Fund								
Municipal:								
Crocker Farm Gym Floor -	30,000		70,000	70,000	70,000	70,000	40,000	-
East ST School Renovations	71,400							-
Fire Department Pumper - (FY22)	463,500							-
I-Net Loop	71,250	68,850	67,050	65,250	63,450	56,650		-
Jones Library General Construction -		85,495	1,332,025	1,104,550	1,076,550	1,077,300	1,076,800	17,693,900
Police Facility Chiller - 1	82,400	382,950						-
Police Facility Chiller - 2		576,000	374,400					-
Public Works Sweeper	68,650	68,300	63,000					-
School Feasibility Study	99,795	97,500	94,000	90,500	87,000	83,500	80,000	139,750
Short Term Interest Expense	59,791	123,255	200,000	200,000	200,000	200,000		-
Public Works Facility Engineering	75,000		347,568	335,982	324,397	312,811	301,226	-
Ladder Truck			210,000	204,000	198,000	192,000	186,000	846,000
Fire Department Pumper - (FY24)			174,000	168,200	162,400	156,600	150,800	-
Fire Station Engineering							72,625	1,452,500
Public Safety _- Radio System			36,000	336,000	324,000	312,000		-
Municipal: Total	**1,021,786**	**1,402,350**	**2,968,043**	**2,574,482**	**2,505,797**	**2,460,861**	**1,907,451**	**20,132,150**
Municipal: Debt Excluded								
Elementary School Project - Part 2 of 3		1,435,293	2,209,194	2,476,444	2,572,469	2,582,307	2,603,946	15,887,750
Elementary School Project - Part 1 of 3	691,807	690,350	690,100	689,350	688,100	691,350	688,850	15,887,750
Elementary School Project - Part 3 of 3								48,584,594
Municipal: Debt Excluded Total	**691,807**	**2,125,643**	**2,899,294**	**3,165,794**	**3,260,569**	**3,273,657**	**3,292,796**	**80,360,094**
Regional School District Debt (Amherst Share):								
Total Capital Assessment (RSD)		485,000	800,000	800,000	800,000	800,000	800,000	800,000
Regional School District Debt (Amherst Share): Total		**485,000**	**800,000**	**800,000**	**800,000**	**800,000**	**800,000**	**800,000**
CPA Fund Debt								
Ann Whalen Unit Preservation (Housing) (CPA)								-
ARHS Track and Field	32,000		80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	320,000
Belchertown Road land (SRO) purchase (CPA)	81,385	74,250	71,500	68,750	66,000	63,250	60,500	57,750
Groff Park (CPA)								-
Jones Library Special Collections	40,000		100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000	100,000	500,000
Kendrick (CPA)	37,450	36,050						-
Rock Farm So. East Street (CPA)								-
Rolling Green Unit Preservation (Housing) (CPA)	81,600							-
Valley CDC - SRO Studio Apts Northampton rd	68,021	66,250	63,750	56,250	54,000	51,750	49,500	47,250
Fort River Elementary School Rec Field				70,000	70,000	70,000	70,000	420,000
CPA Fund Debt Total	**340,456**	**176,550**	**315,250**	**375,000**	**370,000**	**365,000**	**360,000**	**1,345,000**
General Fund Total	**2,054,049**	**4,189,543**	**6,982,587**	**6,915,276**	**6,936,366**	**6,899,518**	**6,360,247**	**102,637,244**
Enterprise								
Sewer Fund Debt								
Amherst Woods Phase II	231,250	223,850	218,300	212,750	207,200	201,650	196,100	381,100
Gravity Belt Thickener - Engineering	102,534	102,534	100,350	96,850	93,350	89,850	86,350	230,650
Harkness Construction	239,000	234,875	230,625	226,250	221,750	217,125	212,375	410,000
Pine street extension - SEWER	67,250	65,750	64,250	62,750	61,250	59,375	57,500	161,250
Replace Gravity Belt Thickener Construction	250,000	366,641	285,000	277,875	270,750	263,625	256,500	2,992,500
Short Term Interest Expense		44,974						-
So East St Sewer Pump Station #4	116,000	112,000	108,000	104,000				-
WWTP Facilities Assessment			217,500	210,000	202,500	195,000		-
Sewer Fund Debt Total	**1,006,034**	**1,150,624**	**1,224,025**	**1,190,475**	**1,056,800**	**1,026,625**	**808,825**	**4,175,500**
Water Fund Debt								
Centennial - First award FY24 (SRF)		384,564	394,348	394,387	394,428	394,469	394,512	18,513,256
Centennial - Second award FY25 (SRF)		34,597	261,301	258,039	254,777	251,515	248,253	3,332,370
Centennial Water Treatment Facility Engineering	78,300	75,700	73,750	71,800	69,850	62,900	56,100	-
Northampton Road Water Main Replacement	101,662	101,662	107,700	104,700	101,700	98,700	95,700	937,850
Pine street extension - WATER	67,250	65,750	64,250	62,750	61,250	59,375	57,500	161,250
Short- Term Interest		28,081						-
Water Meters	84,450	81,450	74,200	72,100				-
Well #4	41,650	40,250	34,200	33,300	32,400	31,500	30,600	-
Centennial Water Treatment Facility	488,850	582,850	566,600	549,800	533,000	216,200	210,800	205,400
Water Fund Debt Total	**862,162**	**1,394,904**	**1,576,349**	**1,546,876**	**1,447,405**	**1,114,659**	**1,093,465**	**23,150,126**
Enterprise Total	1,868,196	2,545,528	2,800,374	2,737,351	2,504,205	2,141,284	1,902,290	27,325,626
TOTAL DEBT SERVICE (ALL FUNDS)	3,922,244	6,735,071	9,782,961	9,652,628	9,440,571	9,040,803	8,262,537	129,962,870

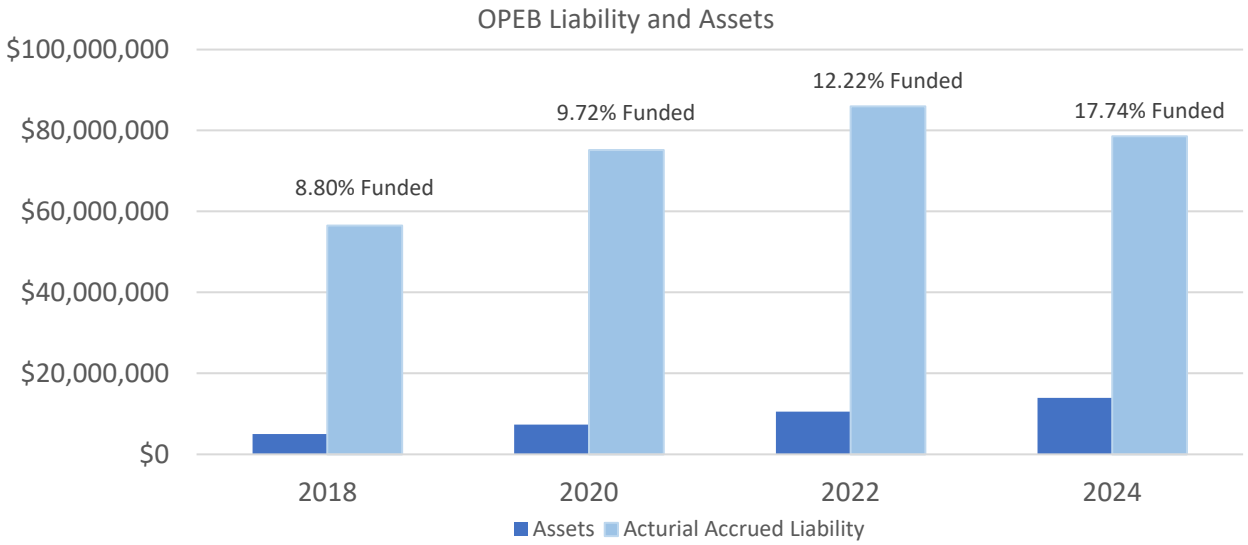
Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB)

The Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB) requires municipal governments to calculate their Other Post-Employment Benefit (OPEB) liability each year. Other Post-Employment Benefits are benefits owed to current and future retirees outside of a pension. The largest two for Amherst are health and life insurance. The Town pays a portion of health insurance and life insurance for all eligible employees. When an employee retires, the Town continues paying a portion of their insurance costs for the rest of their lives.

The Town's OPEB liability is calculated by a professional actuary and is an estimate of the Town's entire obligation for current and future retirees. The estimate is based on many variables including life expectancy, medical cost inflation, and the percentage of employees who will retire from the Town. The figure is large but the Town is only required to pay for the current year benefit costs for current retirees.

Since the OPEB liability is quite large and there is an expectation that retiree health insurance costs will continue to rise, most Towns are setting aside funds each year to start paying down this future obligation. Setting aside funds now also helps better align the full cost of an employee with the resources needed to pay for that employee.

Amherst has established a plan to set aside funds and has been following this plan successfully for almost a decade. The funds go into a dedicated OPEB trust fund that can only be used for retiree OPEB costs. These funds are invested to grow the balance of the trust. The following chart compares the OPEB liability to the assets that have been set aside.



This budget proposes a contribution of $855,902 towards the Town's OPEB liability. This figure includes contributions from Enterprise Funds.

Capital Improvement Program and Capital Inventory

The Capital Improvement Program establishes a five-year plan for addressing the capital needs of the Town. The Town follows a thorough and comprehensive approach to developing the Capital Improvement Program that includes involvement from key stakeholders. Click here to view the complete plan which includes an inventory of all of the Town's capital assets.

Community Preservation Act

The Community Preservation Act (CPA) was passed by the State Legislature as Chapter 267 of the Acts of 2000. The act is designed to help Massachusetts cities and towns preserve and plan for their communities' futures and to raise funds to accomplish their Historic Preservation, Open Space, Recreation, and Community Housing goals.

Amherst adopted the CPA at its 2001 Annual Town Election, established a Community Preservation Act Committee (CPAC), and authorized the Town to levy a 1% surcharge on property tax bills to raise funds to address our Community Housing, Historic Preservation, Open Space, and Recreation needs. Amherst elected to exempt from the surcharge the first $100,000 of assessed value of each property's assessment. By accepting the CPA, Amherst became eligible to receive state funds that match a percentage of the funds raised locally each year. A few years later in 2008, residents voted to increase the levy to 1 ½ %, and in 2015 the residents voted to increase the levy to the maximum allowed of 3%.

Spending CPA-generated funds must be approved by Town Council. The CPAC receives all requests for use of CPA funds. The CPAC reviews and then recommends selected projects to the Town Council based on project quality and funds available. The law requires that at least 10% of the Town's CPA funds be allocated to projects in each of the following areas: Historic Preservation, Open Space, and Community Housing. Funding for Recreation is permitted but not at a mandated percentage; and counts toward the Open Space allocation.

Each year, CPAC completes a report summarizing its recommendations. Those reports can be found at https://www.amherstma.gov/929/Community-Preservation-Act-Committee.

Risk Management

The Town faces numerous risks inherent to its mission of providing high quality services to thousands of residents. Town staff utilizes different strategies to help mitigate these risks and protect the assets of the Town and taxpayer funds.

Physical Assets: The Town has property and casualty insurance for its buildings, vehicles, and equipment. This insurance provides protection in a situation where a Town asset is damaged or destroyed.

Personnel: The Town Manager, working with the Human Resources Department, promulgates policies and procedures to promote the legal and ethical performance of work by Town employees. These policies also help employees by creating a rewarding, productive, and safe working environment. The Town purchases various types of insurance such as injured on duty insurance or employment practices insurance to protect taxpayers against unpredictable costs.

Taxpayer Funds: The Treasurer manages all the funds of the Town. The Treasurer follows an investment policy to help maximize returns and minimize any risk. The Treasurer also employs financial advisors to provide additional expertise and advice.

American Rescue Plan Act

The Town of Amherst was allocated $11.9 million through the American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA). Under this act, passed by the federal government in March 2021, Massachusetts state, county, tribal and local entities received federal aid to respond to the public health and economic impacts of the public health emergency created by the COVID-19 pandemic.
The Town has allocated the full $11.9 million in ARPA funds. Below are highlights of the projects completed or nearing completion:

- **Resident Emergency Aid:** $300k was allocated to residents with emergency housing and utility needs, of which to date all $300k has been awarded to 144 Amherst community members.
- **Small Business Startup, Growth and Technology Grants:** A total of $69k was awarded in eight startup, ten growth, and one technology grants.
- **Drake:** Awarded $300k to support the creation of the Drake and its programming. The Drake has successfully generated significant downtown activity, welcomed over 24,000 attendees, and served as an economic boost for downtown.
- **Survival Center**: Awarded $200k to continue meal delivery for residents in need. All funds have been used.
- **Homeless Shelter and Affordable Housing:** $995k has been spent on the purchase of the former VFW site and site cleanup. An additional $612k was used towards an affordable housing project in conjunction with Wayfinders.
- **Emergency Medical Staff and CRESS:** $812k was allocated to fund four new permanent EMS staff, and $145k for the implementation of the new CRESS department.
- **Public Health:** $272k was allocated to hire administrative support and to increase the public health nurse to full time, with the remaining funding allocated to providing translation services throughout the town.
- **Senior Center:** Allocated $31k to provide transportation to medical appointments and the Senior Center.
- **Pre-Kindergarten Programs:** $150k was allocated to support programs targeted to pre-k needs through June 2025.
- **Recreation Programs and Facilities:** The Recreation Department was allocated $185k to be used towards needs assessment and resulting programming. $15k was used to repair trails that were significantly used during the pandemic. And additional $284k was allocated to facility repairs and ADA-related upgrades. These repairs were completed by the end of calendar year 2024.

- **Premium Pay and Revenue Replacement:** $348k was paid to essential Town staff during the pandemic and $481k was used as revenue replacement for parking and sewer enterprise funds.

- **Staffing:** $170k was used for the COVID Ambassadors and Community Engagement; $44k was used for the establishment of the Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion department; $119k was used for the Capital Project Manager; and $316k was allocated for the ARPA grants manager as well as required legal and audit fees.

- **Technology:** $235k was allocated to IT upgrades including Cybersecurity, and Fiber and Wi-Fi upgrades downtown and at recreation facilities.

- **Resident Oversight Board:** $75k is being used for the envisioning and training for the Resident Oversight Board.

- **Sustainability:** A total of $526k was awarded for sustainability projects, including Town wide usage reports; a sustainability intern; funding for the Amherst Mobile Market; the creation of the Community gardens; and providing heat pumps to low-income homeowners.

- **Public Restroom:** $269k has been allocated to install a public restroom on Kendrick Park. This project is projected to be completed by summer of 2025.

- **Bangs Center Renovation:** $335k has been used to towards design services to access building needs.

- **School Assessment**: An additional amount of $355k was added to the public school assessment in FY25.

- **Health Expenses**: $3.82 million was used to offset health insurance expenses of public employees, during FY25.

- **Misc.**: $100k used towards the repair of the Wastewater System Pump #4, $8k towards water filtration stations at Town buildings, $30k for initial planning at the schools for the 6th grade move to ARMS; $75k towards FEMA/CARES expenses not covered by initial Covid relief funds.

For more information on the ARPA grant, please visit https://www.amherstma.gov/3656/American-Rescue-Plan-Act.

The following definitions explain the meaning of some of the terms frequently used in documents and discussions related to the Town's financial matters:

Abatement	A reduction or elimination of a real or personal property tax, motor vehicle excise, a fee, charge, or special assessment imposed by a governmental unit. Granted only on application of the person seeking the abatement and only by the committing governmental unit. (See Commitment.)
Accounting System	The total structure of records and procedures that identify, record, classify, and report information on the financial position and operations of a governmental unit or any of its funds, account groups, and organizational components.
Accrued Interest	The amount of interest that has accumulated on the bond since the date of the last interest payment, and in the sale of a bond, the amount accrued up to but not including the date of delivery (settlement date). (See Interest.)
Additional Assistance	A state aid program that provides unrestricted general fund revenue to a certain number of communities through the Cherry Sheet. Additional Assistance evolved from the old resolution aid formula of the 1980s, but following state budget cuts, it was level funded beginning in FY 92 and then subsequently reduced.
Adopted Budget	The resulting budget that has been approved by vote of the Town Council.
Agency Fund	One of four types of Fiduciary Funds. It is used to report resources in a purely custodial capacity by a governmental unit. Agency funds generally involve only the receipt, temporary investment, and periodic transfer of money to fulfill legal obligations to individuals, private organizations, or other governments. For example, certain employee payroll withholdings typically accumulate in an agency fund until due and forwarded to the federal government, health care provider, and so forth.
Allocation	The distribution of available monies, personnel, buildings, and equipment among various Town departments, divisions, or cost centers.
Amortization	The gradual repayment of an obligation over time and in accordance with a pre-determined payment schedule.
Annual Budget	An estimate of Expenditures for specific purposes during the Fiscal Year and the proposed means (estimated Revenues) for financing those activities.
Appellate Tax Board (ATB)	A board appointed by the Governor that has jurisdiction to decide appeals from local decisions relating to property taxes, motor vehicle excises, state owned land valuations, exemption eligibility, property classification, and equalized valuations.
Appropriation	An authorization granted by a town meeting, city or town council, or other legislative body to expend money and incur obligations for specific public purposes. An appropriation is usually limited in amount and as to the time period within which it may be expended. (See Encumbrance, Free Cash).
Assessed Valuation	A value assigned to real estate or other property by a government as the basis for levying taxes. In Massachusetts, assessed valuation is based on the property's full and fair cash value as set by the Assessors. (See Fair Market Value.)
Assessment Date	The date property tax liability is fixed. In Massachusetts, property taxes are assessed as of January 1 prior to the fiscal year. Assessors determine the physical status of taxable real and personal property, its ownership, fair cash value and usage classification as of

	that date. By local option (M.G.L. Ch. 59 §2A), the physical status of real property on June 30 is deemed to be its condition on the previous January 1.
Audit	An examination of a community's financial systems, procedures, and data by a certified public accountant (independent auditor), and a report on the fairness of financial statements and on local compliance with statutes and regulations. The audit serves as a valuable management tool for evaluating the fiscal performance of a community.
Audit Committee	A committee appointed by the Town Council, with specific responsibility to review the community's independent audit of financial statements and to address all issues relating to it as well as those outlined in the accompanying management letter.
Audit Management Letter	An independent auditor's written communication to government officials, separate from the community's audit. It generally identifies areas of deficiency, if any, and presents recommendations for improvements in accounting procedures, internal controls and other matters.
Audit Report	Prepared by an independent auditor, an audit report includes: (a) a statement of the scope of the audit; (b) explanatory comments as to application of auditing procedures; (c) findings and opinions; (d) financial statements and schedules; and (e) statistical tables, supplementary comments, and recommendations. Almost always accompanied by a management letter.
Available Funds	Balances in the various fund types that represent non-recurring revenue sources. As a matter of sound practice, they are frequently appropriated to meet unforeseen expenses, for capital expenditures or other one-time costs. Examples of available funds include Free Cash, Stabilization Fund, Overlay Surplus, and enterprise Retained Earnings. (See Reserves.)
Balance Sheet	A statement that discloses the assets, liabilities, reserves, and equities of a fund or governmental unit at a specified date.
Balanced Budget	A budget in which receipts are greater than (or equal to) expenditures. A requirement for all Massachusetts cities and towns.
Betterments (Special Assessments)	A special property tax that may be assessed to the property owners of an area whenever part of a community benefits from a public improvement, or betterment (*e.g.*, water, sewer, sidewalks, etc.), to reimburse the governmental entity for all, or part, of the costs it incurred in completing the project. Each property parcel receiving the benefit is assessed a proportionate share of the cost which may be paid in full or apportioned over a period of up to 20 years. In this case, one year's apportionment along with one year's committed interest computed from October 1 to October 1 is added to the tax bill until the betterment has been paid.
Block Grant	A Federal grant of money awarded by formula under very general guidelines that allow grantees broad latitude in spending activities. Recipients are normally state or local governments.
Bond	A means to raise money through the issuance of debt. A bond issuer/borrower promises in writing to repay a specified sum of money, alternately referred to as face value, par value or bond principal, to the buyer of the bond on a specified future date (maturity date), together with periodic interest at a specified rate. The term of a bond is always greater than one year.
Bond Anticipation Note (BAN)	Short-term debt instrument used to generate cash for initial project costs and with the expectation that the debt will be replaced later by permanent bonding. Typically issued for a term of less than one year, BANs may be re-issued for up to five years, provided

	principal repayment begins after two years (M.G.L. Ch. 44 §17). Principal payments on school related BANs may be deferred up to seven years (increased in 2002 from five years) if the community has an approved project on the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) priority list. BANs are full faith and credit obligations.
Bond Authorization	Action of town meeting or a city or town council authorizing the executive branch to raise money through the sale of bonds in a specific amount and for a specific purpose. Once authorized, issuance is by the treasurer upon the signature of the manager, mayor, or select board. (See Bond Issue.)
Bond Issue	The actual sale of the entire, or a portion of, the bond amount authorized by a town meeting or city council.
Bond Rating	A credit rating assigned to a municipality to help investors assess the future ability, legal obligation, and willingness of the municipality (bond issuer) to make timely debt service payments. Stated otherwise, a rating helps prospective investors determine the level of risk associated with a given fixed income investment. Rating agencies such as Moody's, Standard and Poor's, and Fitch ICBA, Inc. use rating systems which designate a letter or a combination of letters and numerals where AAA is the highest rating and C1 is a very low rating.
Bonds Authorized and Unissued	Balance of a bond authorization not yet sold. Upon completion or abandonment of a project, any remaining balance of authorized and unissued bonds may not be used for other purposes but must be rescinded by town meeting or the city or town council to be removed from community's books.
Budget	A plan for allocating resources to support particular services, purposes, and functions over a specified period of time.
Budget Calendar	The schedule of key dates or milestones which a government follows in the preparation and adoption of the budget.
Budget Message	A statement by the Town Manager that, among other things, offers context by summarizing the main points of a budget, explains priorities, describes underlying policies that drive funding decisions, and otherwise justifies the expenditure plan and provides a vision for the future.
Business-Type Activities	One of two classes of activities reported in the GASB 34 government-wide financial statements. These activities are financed in whole or in part by fees charged to users for goods or services. Some examples are enterprise (M.G.L. Ch. 44 §53F½), special revenue (M.G.L Ch. 41 §69B) water, and municipal electric funds.
Capital Assets	All tangible property used in the operation of government, which is not easily converted into cash, and has an initial useful life extending beyond a single financial reporting period. Capital assets include land and land improvements; infrastructure such as roads, bridges, water and sewer lines; easements; buildings and building improvements; vehicles, machinery, and equipment. Communities typically define capital assets in terms of a minimum useful life and a minimum initial cost. (See Fixed Asset).
Capital Budget	An appropriation or spending plan that uses borrowing or direct outlay for capital or fixed asset improvements. Among other information, a capital budget should identify the method of financing for each recommended expenditure, *i.e.*, tax levy and rates, and identify those items that were not recommended. (See Capital Asset, Fixed Asset).
Capital Improvements Plan (CIP)	A blueprint for planning a community's capital expenditures that comprises an annual capital budget and a five-year capital plan. It coordinates community planning, fiscal

	capacity and physical development. While all of the community's needs should be identified in the plan, there is a set of criteria that prioritizes the expenditures.
Capital Outlay Expenditure Exclusion	A temporary increase in the tax levy to fund a capital project or make a capital acquisition. Exclusions require two-thirds vote of the select board or city or town council (sometimes with the mayor's approval) and a majority vote in a community wide referendum. The exclusion is added to the tax levy only during the year in which the project is being funded and may increase the tax levy above the levy ceiling.
Capital Projects Fund	Fund type used to account for financial resources to be used for the acquisition or construction of major capital facilities (other than those financed by proprietary funds).
Cash	Currency, coin, checks and bankers' drafts on hand or on deposit with an official or agent designated as custodian of cash and bank deposits.
Cash Basis of Accounting	An accounting method that records and recognizes revenues when cash is received and expenses when cash is paid out of the Town treasury.
Cash Book	A source book of original entry, which a treasurer is required to maintain, for the purpose of recording municipal receipts, adjustments to balances, deposits to municipal accounts, and disbursements through warrants.
Cash Management	The process of monitoring the ebb and flow of money in and out of municipal accounts to ensure cash availability to pay bills and to facilitate decisions on the need for short-term borrowing and investment of idle cash.
Cash Receipts	Any money received by a municipality or its departments whether by cash, check or electronic transfer.
Certificate of Deposit (CD)	A bank deposit evidenced by a negotiable or non-negotiable instrument that provides on its face that the amount of such deposit, plus a specified interest, is payable to the bearer or to any specified person on a certain date specified in the instrument, at the expiration of a certain specified time, or upon notice in writing.
Chapter 61 Land	Forest, agricultural/horticultural, and recreational lands valued according to M.G.L. Ch. 61, 61A, and 61B. Land is valued at its current use rather than the full and fair cash value. The commercial property tax rate is applicable for land defined under these chapters.
Chapter 70 School Funds	The school funding formula created under the Education Reform Act of 1993 by which state aid is distributed through the Cherry Sheet to help establish educational equity among municipal and regional school districts.
Chapter 90 Highway Funds	State funds derived from periodic transportation bond authorizations and apportioned to communities for highway projects based on a formula under the provisions of M.G.L. Ch. 90 §34. The formula is based on three variables: local road mileage (58.33%) as certified by the Massachusetts Highway Department (MHD), local employment level (20.83%) derived the Department of Employment and Training (DET), and population estimates (20.83%) from the US Census Bureau. Local highway projects are approved in advance, and then later on the submission of certified expenditure reports to MHD, communities receive cost reimbursements to the limit of the grant. Under the formula, communities with a larger number of road miles receive proportionately more aid than those with fewer road miles.
Charges for Services (User Charges or Fees)	The charges levied on the users of particular goods or services provided by local government requiring individuals to pay for the private benefits they receive. Such charges reduce the reliance on property tax funding.

Charter School Aid	A component of Ch. 70 state aid provided to a municipality for public education. Beginning in FY 99, no new charter aid has been included in Ch. 70 aid, and any Charter Aid distributed in FY 98 and prior years has been included in FY 99 base aid, in Ch. 70 aid, and any Charter Aid distributed in FY 98 and prior years has been included in FY 99 base aid.
Chief Procurement Officer (CPO)	An individual defined under M.G.L Ch. 30B §2 and authorized to procure supplies or services for a governmental body.
Cherry Sheet	Named for the cherry-colored paper on which they were originally printed, the Cherry Sheet is the official notification to cities, towns and regional school districts of the next fiscal year's state aid and assessments. The aid is in the form of distributions, which provide funds based on formulas and reimbursements that provide funds for costs incurred during a prior period for certain programs or services. Cherry Sheets are located at www.mass.gov/dls. (See Cherry Sheet Assessments, Estimated Receipts.)
Cherry Sheet Assessments	Estimates of annual charges to cover the cost of certain state, regional, and county programs.
Cherry Sheet Offset Items	Local aid that may be spent without appropriation in the budget, but which must be spent for specific municipal and regional school district programs. Current offset items include school lunch grants, School Choice Receiving Tuition and public libraries grants. (See also Offset Receipts.)
Cherry Sheet Receipts	M.G.L. Ch. 58 §25A provides that the Commissioner of Revenue estimate the state's funding of local reimbursement and assistance programs as authorized by law and appropriated by the legislature. Local assessors are required to use these figures when determining the local property tax rate.
Classification Of the Tax Rate	Each year, the select board or city or town council vote whether to exercise certain tax rate options. Those options include choosing a residential factor to adopt (M.G.L. Ch. 40 §56) and determining whether to offer an open space discount (Ch. 61, 61A and 61B), a residential exemption (Ch. 59 §5C), and/or a small commercial exemption (Ch. 59 §5I) to property owners.
Collective Bargaining	The process of negotiating workers' wages, hours, benefits, working conditions, etc., between an employer and some or all of its employees, who are represented by a recognized labor union.
Commercial, Industrial, Personal Property (CIP)	A group of three property types used to describe the effect of multiple tax rates. A municipality can take a number of actions to shift the levy burden associated with a single tax rate from Open Space and Residential categories to the CIP categories.
Commitment	An authorization to collect taxes, fees, or other charges due to a municipality. For example, the assessors' commitment of real estate taxes authorizes the collector to pursue and receive payment from property owners.
Community Preservation Act (CPA)	Enacted as M.G.L. Ch. 44B in 2000, the Community Preservation Act permits cities and towns accepting its provisions to establish a restricted fund from which monies can only be appropriated for a) the acquisition, creation and preservation of open space; b) the acquisition, preservation, rehabilitation, and restoration of historic resources; and c) the acquisition, creation and preservation of land for recreational use; d) the creation, preservation and support of community housing; and e) the rehabilitation and restoration of open space, land for recreational use and community housing that is acquired or created using monies from the fund. Acceptance requires town meeting or city or town council approval, together with referendum approval by majority vote. The local program is funded by a local surcharge of up to 3% on real property tax bills and

	matching dollars from the state generated from registry of deeds fees. (See DOR IGR 00-209 as amended by IGR 01-207 and IGR 02-208).
Computer Assisted Mass Appraisal (CAMA)	An automated system for maintaining property data, valuing property, notifying owners, and ensuring tax equity through uniform valuations.
Consumer Price Index (CPI)	The statistical measure of changes, if any, in the overall price level of consumer goods and services. The index is often called the "cost-of-living index."
Cost-Benefit Analysis	A decision-making tool that allows a comparison of options based on the level of benefit derived and the cost to achieve the benefit from different alternatives.
Cost Of Living Adjustment (COLA)	Reference to language in municipal contracts that provide for annual or periodic increases in salaries and wages for employees over the course of the contract. The amount of an increase is most often negotiated based on a community's ability to pay but is sometimes tied to the annual change in a specified index, *i.e.*, Consumer Price Index (CPI).
Debt Authorization	Formal approval by a two-thirds vote of town meeting or city or town council to incur debt, in accordance with procedures stated in M.G.L. Ch. 44 §§1, 2, 3, 4a, 6-15.
Debt Exclusion	An action taken by a community through a referendum vote to raise the funds necessary to pay debt service costs for a particular project from the property tax levy, but outside the limits under Proposition 2½. By approving a debt exclusion, a community calculates its annual levy limit under Proposition 2½, then adds the excluded debt service cost. The amount is added to the levy limit for the life of the debt only and may increase the levy above the levy ceiling.
Debt Limit	The maximum amount of debt that a municipality may authorize for qualified purposes under state law. Under M.G.L. Ch. 44 §10, debt limits are set at 5% of EQV for a city and by petition to the Municipal Oversight Board, cities can receive approval to increase their debt limit to 10% of EQV.
Debt Service	The repayment cost, usually stated in annual terms and based on an amortization schedule, of the principal and interest on any particular bond issue.
Debt Statement	Reference to a report, which local treasurers are required to file with the DOR, showing authorized and issued debt, debt retired, and interest paid by a community during the prior fiscal year, as well as authorized but unissued debt at year-end. Also known as the "Statement of Indebtedness."
Deferred Revenue	Amounts that do not meet the criteria for revenue recognition. Also, earned amounts that are not yet available to liquidate liabilities of a current period.
Deficit	The excess of expenditures over revenues during an accounting period. Also refers to the excess of the liabilities of a fund over its assets.
Demand	Notice to a delinquent taxpayer of overdue taxes typically mailed soon after the 30-day, or otherwise determined, payment period has ended.
Department	A principal, functional, and administrative entity created by statute and the Town Manager to carry out specified public services.
Department Of Revenue (DOR)	State department responsible for collecting a wide variety of taxes, providing taxpayer support, and administering programs related to municipal finance through the Division of Local Services (DLS).

Deputy Collector	If 14 days after the mailing of a demand payment is not received, the collector may issue warrants to one or more deputy collectors authorizing them to collect delinquent taxes, commonly motor vehicle excise. For outstanding excise, the deputy may mark licenses/registrations or provide evidence (*e.g.*, death absence, poverty, insolvency or other inability of the persons assessed to pay) that the accounts are uncollectable. All amounts collected by the deputy collector should be deposited to a municipal bank account from which the deputy may be paid his compensation by check signed by the collector once the tax payments have cleared (M.G.L. Ch. 60 §92). However, if a community requires all receipts be paid over to the treasurer, the deputy collector must be paid through the warrant process. (See DOR IGR 90-219)
Designated Unreserved Fund Balance	A limitation on the use of all or part of the expendable balance in a governmental fund.
Division Of Local Services (DLS)	A division within the DOR (Department of Revenue) responsible for helping Massachusetts cities and towns achieve sound and efficient fiscal management through technical assistance, training, and oversight. DLS bureaus are responsible for ensuring the fairness and equity of local property taxation, the accuracy and quality of local accounting and treasury management, interpreting state laws that affect local governance, distributing local aid, maintaining a comprehensive databank on local finances, and auditing local school districts.
Education Reform Act of 1993	State law that authorized the seven-year Ch. 70 funding program for education and that established spending targets for school districts as a means to remedy educational inequities. Scheduled to end by FY 00, the program has been extended, pending agreement on further reforms.
Emergency Spending	M.G.L. Ch. 44 §31 allows a community to spend in excess of appropriation in cases of major disasters that pose an immediate threat to the health or safety of persons or property, following the emergency declaration by council or select board and the approval of the Director of Accounts.
Eminent Domain	The power of a government to take property for public purposes. Frequently used to obtain real property that cannot be purchased from owners in a voluntary transaction. Property owner receives fair compensation (market value at the time of the taking) as determined through court proceedings.
Encumbrance	A reservation of funds to cover obligations arising from purchase orders, contracts, or salary commitments that is chargeable to, but not yet paid from, a specific appropriation account.
Enterprise Funds	A fund authorized by M.G.L. Ch. 44 §53F½ that is a separate accounting and financial reporting mechanism for municipal services for which a fee is charged in exchange for goods or services. It allows a community to demonstrate to the public the portion of total costs of a service that is recovered through user charges and the portion that is subsidized by the tax levy, if any. With an enterprise fund, all costs of service delivery—direct, indirect, and capital costs—are identified. This allows the community to recover total service costs through user fees if it chooses. Enterprise accounting also enables communities to reserve the "surplus" or retained earnings generated by the operation of the enterprise rather than closing it out to the general fund at year-end. Services that may be treated as enterprises include, but are not limited to, water, sewer, hospital, and airport services. Amherst has four: water, sewer, solid waste, and transportation. Both the costs and the revenues of the enterprise are segregated from other finances of the Town.

Equalized Valuations (EQV)	The determination of an estimate of the full and fair cash value of all property in the Commonwealth as of a certain taxable date. EQVs have historically been used as a variable in distributing some state aid accounts and for determining county assessments and other costs. The Commissioner of Revenue, in accordance with M.G.L. Ch. 58 §10C, is charged with the responsibility of biannually determining an equalized valuation for each city and town in the Commonwealth.
Estimated Receipts	A term that typically refers to anticipated local revenues listed on page three of the Tax Recapitulation Sheet. Projects of local revenues are often based on the previous year's receipts and represent funding sources necessary to support a community's annual budget. (See Local Receipts.)
Excess Levy Capacity	The difference between the levy limit and the amount of real and personal property taxes actually levied in a given year.
Exemption	A discharge, established by statute, from the obligation to pay all or a portion of a property tax. The exemption is available to particular categories of property or persons upon the timely submission and approval of an application to the assessors. Properties exempt from taxation include hospitals, schools, houses of worship, and cultural institutions. Persons who may qualify for exemptions include veterans, blind individuals, surviving spouses, and persons over 70 years of age.
Expendable Trust	A fund, administered by the treasurer, from which both principle and interest can be expended for the purposes specified and agreed upon when the money was donated or transferred to the community. (See Trust Fund; Non-Expendable Trust.)
Expenditure/Expense	An outlay of money made by municipalities to provide the programs and services within their approved budget.
Fair Market Value/Full and Fair Cash Value (FFCV)	Fair cash value has been defined by the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court as "fair market value", which is the price an owner willing but not under compulsion to sell ought to receive from one willing but not under compulsion to buy. It means the highest price that a normal purchaser not under peculiar compulsion will pay at the time and cannot exceed the sum that the owner after reasonable effort could obtain for his property. A valuation limited to what the property is worth to the purchaser is not market value. The fair cash value is the value the property would have on January first of any taxable year in the hands of any owner, including the present owner" (Boston Gas Co. v. Assessors of Boston, 334 Mass. 549, 566 (1956).
Fiduciary Funds	A repository of money held by a municipality in a trustee capacity or as an agent for individuals, private organizations, other governmental units, and other funds. These include expendable trust, non-expendable trust, pension trust, and agency funds.
Financial Advisor	An individual or institution that assists municipalities in the issuance of tax-exempt bonds and notes. The public finance department of a commercial bank or a non-bank advisor usually provides this service.
Financial Statement	A presentation of the assets and liabilities of a community as of a particular date and most often prepared after the close of the fiscal year.
Fiscal Year	Since 1974, the Commonwealth and municipalities have operated on a budget cycle that begins July 1 and ends June 30. The designation of the fiscal year is that of the calendar year in which the fiscal year ends. For example, the 2000 fiscal year is July 1, 1999 to June 30, 2000. Since 1976, the federal government fiscal year has begun October 1 and ended September 30.

Fixed Assets	Long-lived, tangible assets such as buildings, equipment and land obtained or controlled as a result of past transactions or circumstances.
Fixed Costs	Costs that are legally or contractually mandated such as retirement, taxes, insurance, debt service costs, or interest on loans.
Foundation Budget	The spending target imposed by the Education Reform Act of 1993 for each school district as the level necessary to provide an adequate education for all students.
Free Cash	Remaining, unrestricted funds from operations of the previous fiscal year including unexpended free cash from the previous year, actual receipts in excess of revenue estimates shown on the tax recapitulation sheet, and unspent amounts in budget line-items. Unpaid property taxes and certain deficits reduce the amount that can be certified as free cash. The calculation of free cash is based on the balance sheet as of June 30, which is submitted by the community's auditor, accountant, or comptroller. Important: free cash is not available for appropriation until certified by the Director of Accounts. (See Available Funds.)
Full Accrual	A method of accounting that recognizes the financial effect of transactions, events, and interfund activities when they occur, regardless of the timing of related cash flows.
Fund	An accounting entity with a self-balancing set of accounts that are segregated for the purpose of carrying on identified activities or attaining certain objectives in accordance with specific regulations, restrictions, or limitations.
Fund Accounting	Organizing the financial records of a municipality into multiple, segregated locations for money. A fund is a distinct entity within the municipal government in which financial resources and activity (assets, liabilities, fund balances, revenues, and expenditures) are accounted for independently in accordance with specific regulations, restrictions or limitations. Examples of funds include the general fund and enterprise funds. Communities whose accounting records are organized according to the Uniform Municipal Accounting System (UMAS) use multiple funds.
Fund Balance	The difference between assets and liabilities reported in a governmental fund. Also known as fund equity. (See also Undesignated Fund Balance.)
General Fund	The fund used to account for most financial resources and activities governed by the normal town meeting/city council appropriation process.
General Ledger	The accountant's record of original entry, which is instrumental in forming a paper trail of all government financial activity.
General Obligation Bonds	Bonds issued by a municipality for purposes allowed by statute that are backed by the full faith and credit of its taxing authority.
Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP)	Uniform minimum standards and guidelines for financial accounting and reporting that serve to achieve some level of standardization
GIS (Geographical Information System)	A computerized mapping system and analytical tool that allows a community to raise information on a parcel, area or community wide basis. It also allows parcels to be identified and sorted on the basis of certain specified criteria. The system can integrate assessors' property data, water and sewer line networks, wetlands, floodplains and as well as other data.
Government Finance Officers Association (GFOA)	A nationwide association of public finance professionals.

Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB)	The ultimate authoritative on accounting and financial reporting standard setting body for state and local governments.
Governmental Funds	Funds generally used to account for tax-supported activities. There are five different types of governmental funds: the general fund, special revenue funds, capital projects funds, debt service funds, and permanent funds.
Grant	A contribution of assets by one governmental unit or other organization to another. Typically, these contributions are made to local governments from the state and federal government. Grants are usually made for specific purposes.
Hotel/Motel Excise	A local option since 1985 that allows a community to assess a tax on short-term room occupancy. The community may levy up to 4% of the charge for stays of less than 90 days at hotels, motels, and lodging houses.
House 1 (Governor's Budget Proposal)	Designation given to the Governor's annual budget request, which is submitted to the House of Representatives by the fourth Wednesday of January. Except that a newly elected governor has eight weeks from the day he/she takes office to submit a budget. The budget is designated House 1 in the first year of the two-year legislative session and House 1A in the second year.
Indirect Cost	Costs of a service not reflected in the operating budget of the entity providing the service. An example of an indirect cost of providing water service would be the value of time spent by non-water department employees processing water bills. A determination of these costs is necessary to analyze the total cost of service delivery. The matter of indirect costs arises most often in the context of enterprise funds.
Inside Debt	Municipal debt incurred for purposes enumerated in M.G.L. Ch. 44, §7, and measured against the community's debt limit as set under Ch. 10. Consequently, the borrowing is inside the debt limit and referred to as inside debt. (See also Outside Debt.)
Interest	Compensation paid or to be paid for the use of money, including amounts payable at periodic intervals or discounted at the time a loan is made. In the case of municipal bonds, interest payments accrue on a day-to-day basis, but are paid every six months.
Interest Rate	The interest payable, expressed as a percentage of the principal available, for use during a specified period of time. It is always expressed in annual terms.
Internal Controls	The policies and procedures established by management to ensure the integrity and comprehensiveness of the data collected by the accounting system for use in internal and external financial reports, as well as the overall control environment in which the government operates.
Land Court	Established in 1898, the Land Court has the exclusive jurisdiction to foreclose rights of redemption on a property in tax title.
Levy	The amount a community raises through the property tax. The levy can be any amount up to the levy limit, which is re-established every year in accordance with Proposition 2½ provisions.
Levy Ceiling	A levy ceiling is one of two types of levy (tax) restrictions imposed by M.G.L. Ch. 59 §21C (Proposition 2½). It states that, in any year, the real and personal property taxes imposed may not exceed 2½% of the total full and fair cash value of all taxable property. Property taxes levied may exceed this limit only if the community passes a capital exclusion, a debt exclusion, or a special exclusion. (See Levy Limit.)
Levy Limit	A levy limit is one of two types of levy (tax) restrictions imposed by M.G.L. Ch. 59 §21C (Proposition 2½). It states that the real and personal property taxes imposed by a city or

	town may only grow each year by 2½% of the prior year's levy limit, plus new growth and any overrides or exclusions. The levy limit can exceed the levy ceiling only if the community passes a capital expenditure exclusion, debt exclusion, or special exclusion. (See Levy Ceiling.)
Lien	A legal claim against real or personal property to protect the interest of a party (i.e., a city or town) to whom a debt is owed (i.e., taxes). In the case of real property, the lien in favor of a municipality automatically arises each January 1, but must be secured through other action. On other property, a lien must be recorded to become secure.
Line-Item Budget	A budget that separates spending into categories, or greater detail, such as supplies, equipment, maintenance, or salaries, as opposed to a program budget.
Local Aid	Revenue allocated by the Commonwealth to cities, towns, and regional school districts. Estimates of local aid are transmitted to cities, towns, and districts annually by the "Cherry Sheets." Most Cherry Sheet aid programs are considered general fund revenues and may be spent for any purpose, subject to appropriation.
Local Appropriating Authority	In a town, the town meeting has the power to appropriate funds, including the authorization of debt. In a city, the city or town council has the power upon the recommendation of the Town Manager.
Local Receipts	Locally generated revenues, other than real and personal property taxes. Examples include motor vehicle excise, investment income, hotel/motel tax, fees, rentals, and charges. Annual estimates of local receipts are shown on the tax rate recapitulation sheet.
Long-Term Debt	Community borrowing, or outstanding balance at any given time, involving loans with a maturity date of 12 months or more. (See Permanent Debt.)
Mass Appraisal	Use of standardized procedures for collecting data and appraising property to ensure that all properties within a municipality are valued uniformly and equitably.
Massachusetts General Laws (M.G.L.)	Laws passed by the Massachusetts legislature. The M.G.L. is organized by chapters with multiple sections in each chapter. Currently there are 282 chapters (see www.mass.gov/legis/laws/mgl/index.htm). Note that laws enacted prior to the current legislative session are in one location and those enacted in the current session are located in a separate location.
Massachusetts Municipal Depository Trust (MMDT)	An investment program, founded in 1977 under the supervision of the State Treasurer, in which municipalities may pool excess cash for investment.
Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA)	Administers the state program that reimburses cities, towns, and regional school districts varying percentages of their school construction costs depending on the wealth of the community or district and the category of reimbursement. Projects that received their first reimbursement payment prior to July 26, 2004 will continue to get annual state payments to offset the related annual debt service. Thereafter, cities, towns, and regional school districts will receive a lump sum amount representing the state's share of the eligible project costs. (See DLS Bulletin 200420B.)
Minimum Local Contribution	The minimum that a city or town must appropriate from property taxes and other local revenues for the support of schools (See Education Reform Act of 1993.)
Motor Vehicle Excise (MVE)	A locally imposed annual tax assessed to owners of motor vehicles registered to an address within the community. The excise tax rate is set by statute at $25.00 per $1,000 of vehicle value. Owner registration and billing information is maintained by the State

	Registry of Motor Vehicles and is made available to a city or town, or to the Deputy Collector who represents it.
Municipal Charges Lien	For delinquent water (M.G.L. Ch. 40 §§42A-F), sewer (M.G.L. Ch. 83 §§16AF), and trash (M.G.L. Ch. 44 §28C(f)) charges, a community may lien these amounts on the property tax provided the enabling legislation is accepted and a certificate of acceptance is on file at the Registry of Deeds. For other unpaid local charges and fees, a community may adopt M.G.L. Ch. 40 §58 separately for each purpose in order to lien each upon the property tax. The lien is created by recording a listing of a particular type of charge or fee (by parcel of land and by name) at the Registry of Deeds.
Municipal Data Bank	Located within the Division of Local Services (DLS), the Municipal Data Bank collects, organizes, stores, and publishes historical financial information on cities and towns, regional districts and the Commonwealth. Public access to the data is available through links at the DLS website at www.mass.gov/dls.
Net Assets Unrestricted (Formerly Retained Earnings)	An equity account reflecting the accumulated earnings of an enterprise fund that may be used to fund capital improvements, to reimburse the general fund for prior year subsidies, to reduce user charges and to provide for enterprise revenue deficits (operating loss).
Net School Spending (NSS)	School budget and municipal budget amounts attributable to education, excluding long-term debt service, student transportation, school lunches and certain other specified school expenditures. A community's NSS funding must equal or exceed the NSS Requirement established annually by the Department of Education (DOE) (See Education Reform Act of 1993).
Net School Spending Requirement	Sum of a school district's minimum local contribution and the Chapter 70 aid received in a given fiscal year (FY). Municipalities and regional school districts must appropriate funds sufficient to the net school spending requirement. In addition to the NSS requirement funds need to be appropriated to support costs of student transportation, fixed assets, long term debt service, and other costs not part of the NSS. Ch. 194 §126 of the Acts of 1998 limits the net school spending requirement for regional vocational districts to 150% of the foundation budget. When the net school spending requirements exceed 150% of the foundation budget, the required local contributions of the member towns are reduced proportionately. Any reduction is applied to any below foundation districts to which the municipality belongs.
New Growth	The additional tax revenue generated by new construction, renovations and other increases in the property tax base during a calendar year. It does not include value increases caused by normal market forces or by revaluations. New growth is calculated by multiplying the assessed value associated with new construction, renovations and other increases by the prior year tax rate. The additional tax revenue is then incorporated into the calculation of the next year's levy limit. For example, new growth for FY 19 is based on new construction, etc. that occurred between January and December 2017. In the fall of 2018, when new growth is being estimated to set the FY 19 levy limit, the FY 18 tax rate is used in the calculation.
Non-Allocated Receipts	Municipal receipts that need not be expended in a particular way due to their source. Non-allocated receipts are listed on page 3 of the Tax Rate and Pro Forma Recapitulation form. Specifically excluded are offset receipts, enterprise funds, and revolving funds.
Non-Expendable Trust	A trust fund administered by the treasurer, from which principle, but not interest, can be expended for the purposes specified by the donor or agreed upon when the money was donated or transferred to the community. (See Trust Fund; Expendable Trust.)

Non-Recurring Revenue Source	A one-time source of money available to a city or town. By its nature, a non-recurring revenue source cannot be relied upon in future years. Therefore, such funds should not be used for operating or other expenses that continue from year-to-year. (See Recurring Revenue Source.)
Objects Of Expenditures	A classification of expenditures that is used for coding any department disbursement, such as "personal services," "expenses," or "capital outlay."
Official Statement	A document prepared for potential investors that contains information about a prospective bond or note issue and the issuer. The official statement is typically published with the notice of sale. It is sometimes called an offering circular or prospectus.
Offset Receipts	A local option that allows estimated receipts of a particular department to be earmarked for use of the department and appropriated to offset its annual operating budget. If accepted, M.G.L. Ch. 44 §53E limits the amount of offset receipts appropriated to no more than the actual receipts collected for the prior fiscal year. The Director of Accounts must approve use of a higher amount before appropriation. Actual collections greater than the amount appropriated close to the general fund at year-end. If actual collections are less, the deficit must be raised in the next year's tax rate.
Operating Budget	A plan of proposed expenditures for personnel, supplies, and other expenses for the coming fiscal year.
Other Amounts to Be Raised (see Tax Recapitulation Sheet)	Amounts not appropriated but raised through taxation. Generally, these are locally generated expenditures (*e.g.*, overlay, teacher pay deferral, deficits) as well as state, county, and other special district charges. Because they must be funded in the annual budget, special consideration should be given to them when finalizing the budget recommendations to the city or town council or town meeting.
Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB)	Employees of state and local governments may be compensated in a variety of forms in exchange for service that will not be received until after their employment with the government ends. The most common type of these post-employment benefits is a pension. Post-employment benefits other than pensions generally take the form of health insurance and dental, vision, prescription, or other healthcare benefits provided to eligible retirees, including in some cases their beneficiaries. They may also include some type of life insurance. As a group, these are referred to as OPEB.
Outside Debt	Municipal borrowing for purposes enumerated in M.G.L. Ch. 44, §8, the debt incurred for which is not measured against the community's debt limit per Ch. 10. Consequently, the borrowing is outside the debt limit and referred to as outside debt. (See Inside Debt.)
Overlay Reserve (Provision for Abatements & Exemptions)	An account established annually to fund anticipated property tax abatements, exemptions, and uncollected taxes in that year. The overlay reserve is not established by the normal appropriation process, but rather is raised on the tax rate recapitulation sheet.
Overlay Deficit	A deficit that occurs when the amount of overlay raised in a given year is insufficient to cover abatements, statutory exemptions, and uncollected taxes for that year. Overlay deficits must be provided for in the next fiscal year.
Overlay Surplus	Any balance in the overlay account of a given year in excess of the amount remaining to be collected or abated can be transferred into this account. Within ten days of a written request by the chief executive officer of a city or town, the assessors must provide a certification of the excess amount of overlay available to transfer. Overlay surplus may

	be appropriated for any lawful purpose. At the end of each fiscal year, unused overlay surplus is "closed" to surplus revenue; in other words, it becomes a part of free cash.
Override	A vote by a community at an election to permanently increase the levy limit. An override vote may increase the levy limit no higher than the levy ceiling. The override question on the election ballot must state a purpose for the override and the dollar amount.
Override Capacity	The difference between a community's levy ceiling and its levy limit. It is the maximum amount by which a community may override its levy limit.
Payments In Lieu Of Taxes (PILOT)	An agreement between a municipality and an entity not subject to taxation, such as charitable or educational organizations, in which the payer agrees to make a voluntary payment to the municipality. By law, a city or town must make such a payment to any other community in which it owns land used for public purposes.
Permanent Debt	Borrowing by a community typically involving a debt service amortization period of greater than one year. (See Long-Term Debt.)
Personal Property	Movable items not permanently affixed to, or part of the real estate. It is assessed separately from real estate to certain businesses, public utilities, and owners of homes that are not their primary residences.
Personnel Costs	The cost of salaries, wages, and related employment benefits.
Preliminary Tax Bill	The tax bill for the first two quarters of the fiscal year sent, no later than July 1, by communities on a quarterly tax billing cycle. The tax due on a preliminary tax bill can be no greater than the amount due in the last two quarters of the previous fiscal year.
Principal	The face amount of a bond, exclusive of accrued interest.
Property Tax Levy (See Levy)	The amount a community raises through the property tax. The levy can be any amount up to the levy limit, which is re-established every year in accordance with Proposition 2½ provisions.
Proposition 2½	State law enacted in 1980 that regulates local property tax administration. Major provisions of this legislation are located in M.G.L. Ch. 59 - Assessment of Local Taxes §21C and relate to the determination of a levy limit and levy ceiling for each town.
Proprietary Funds	Funds that account for government's business-type activities (e.g., activities that receive a significant portion of their funding through user charges). The fund types included in proprietary funds are the enterprise fund and the internal service fund. The internal service fund accounts for certain central services (*e.g.*, data processing, printing, postage, motor pool) and then allocates the cost among departments or funds within the governmental unit.
Provision for Abatements & Exemptions	(See Overlay Reserve.)
Public Employee Retirement Administration (PERAC)	The Public Employee Retirement Administration oversees and directs the state retirement system and administers benefits for members.
Purchase Order	An official document or form authorizing the purchase of products and services. Outstanding purchase orders are called encumbrances.
Quarterly Tax Bills	Local option to issue two estimated (or three estimated when authorized by the General Court) property tax bills followed by two (or one, if three estimated) regular bills by prescribed dates.

Raise And Appropriate	A phrase used to identify a funding source for an expenditure or expenditures, which refers to money generated by the tax levy or other local receipt.
Real Property	Land, buildings, and the rights and benefits inherent in owning them.
Recap Sheet	(See Tax Rate Recapitulation Sheet.)
Receipts Reserved	Proceeds that are earmarked by law and placed in separate accounts for appropriation for particular purposes. For example, ambulance receipts.
Receivables	An expectation of payment of an amount certain accruing to the benefit of a city or town.
Reconciliation Of Receivables	Periodic process where the accountant and collector compare records to confirm amount of taxes outstanding. DOR requires an annual reconciliation of receivables without variances to be submitted with a balance sheet as a prerequisite to certifying a community's free cash.
Recertification/Triennial Certification	The Commissioner of Revenue, through the Bureau of Local Assessment, is required to review local assessed values every three years and to certify that they represent full and fair cash value (FFCV). Refer to M.G.L. Ch. 40 §56 and Ch. 59 §2A(c).
Recurring Revenue Source	A source of money used to support municipal expenditures, which by its nature can be relied upon, at some level, in future years. (See Non-Recurring Revenue Source.)
Reserve Fund	An amount set aside annually within the budget of a city (not to exceed 3% of the tax levy for the preceding year) or town (not to exceed 5% of the tax levy for the preceding year) to provide a funding source for extraordinary or unforeseen expenditures. In a town, the finance committee can authorize transfers from this fund for "extraordinary or unforeseen" expenditures. Other uses of the fund require budgetary transfers by town meeting. In a city, transfers from this fund may be voted by the city or town council upon recommendation of the town manager or mayor.
Reserves	Money accumulated for future expenditure. The General Fund savings account and the Stabilization Fund are general reserves that may be used for a wide variety of purposes. Some reserves are available only for restricted purposes, for example, the Pension and Insurance reserve.
Rating Agencies	This term usually refers to Moody's Investors Service, Standard and Poor's Corporation, and Fitch ICBA, Inc. These are the three major agencies which issue credit ratings on municipal bonds.
Residential Exemption	A municipality can grant a residential exemption of a dollar amount that cannot exceed 20% of the average assessed value of all residential class properties. The exemption reduces, by the adopted percentage, the taxable valuation of each residential parcel that is a taxpayer's principal residence. Granting the exemption raises the residential tax rate and shifts the residential tax burden from moderately valued homes to apartments, summer homes and higher valued homes.
Retained Earnings	An equity account reflecting the accumulated earnings of an enterprise fund that may be used to fund capital improvements, to reimburse the general fund for prior year subsidies, to reduce user charges and to provide for enterprise revenue deficits (operating loss).
Revaluation	The assessors of each community are responsible for developing a reasonable and realistic program to achieve the fair cash valuation of property in accordance with constitutional and statutory requirements. The nature and extent of that program will depend on the assessors' analysis and consideration of many factors, including, but not

	limited to, the status of the existing valuation system, the results of an in-depth sales ratio study, and the accuracy of existing property record information. Every three years, assessors must submit property values to the DOR for certification. Assessors must also maintain current values in the years between certifications so that each taxpayer in the community pays his or her share of the cost of local government in proportion to the value of his property. (See Recertification.)
Revenue Deficit	The amount by which actual revenues at year-end fall short of projected revenues and are insufficient to fund the amount appropriated. In such a case and unless otherwise funded, the revenue deficit must be raised in the following year's tax rate.
Revenues	All monies received by a governmental unit from any source.
Revolving Fund	Allows a community to raise revenues from a specific service and use those revenues without appropriation to support the service. Wages or salaries for full-time employees may be paid from the revolving fund only if the fund is also charged for all associated fringe benefits.
Schedule A	A statement of revenues, expenditures and other financing sources, uses, changes in fund balance and certain balance sheet account information prepared annually by the accountant or auditor at the end of the fiscal year. This report is based on the fund account numbers and classifications contained in the UMAS manual.
School Choice Aid	A component of Chapter 70 state aid provided to a municipality for public education. If a district is spending below the foundation budget and it was a "sending" district under school choice in the prior fiscal year (FY), the district generally receives school choice aid in an amount equal to any increase in its prior year estimated gross school choice liability, when compared to the previous year.
Short-Term Debt/Temporary Debt	Outstanding balance, at any given time, on amounts borrowed with a maturity date of 12 months or less.
Special Assessments	(See Betterments.)
Special Revenue Fund	Funds, established by statute only, containing revenues that are earmarked for and restricted to expenditures for specific purposes. Special revenue funds include receipts reserved for appropriation, revolving funds, and grants from governmental entities and gifts from private individuals or organizations.
Stabilization Fund	A fund designed to accumulate amounts for capital and other future spending purposes, although it may be appropriated for any lawful purpose (M.G.L. Ch. 40 §5B). Communities may establish one or more stabilization funds for different purposes and may appropriate into them in any year an amount not to exceed 10% of the prior year's tax levy. The total of all stabilization fund balances shall not exceed 10% of the community's equalized value, and any interest shall be added to and become a part of the funds. A two-thirds vote of town meeting or city or town council is required to establish, amend the purpose of, or appropriate money from the stabilization fund
Submitted Budget	The proposed budget that has been approved by the Town Manager and forwarded to the Town Council for its approval. The Council must act upon the submitted budget within prescribed guidelines and limitations according to statute and the Town Charter.
Supplemental Appropriations	Appropriations made by the Town Council after an initial appropriation to cover expenditures beyond original estimates.

Surplus Revenue	The amount by which cash, accounts receivable, and other assets exceed liabilities and reserves.
Tailings	Unclaimed municipal funds, or a repository, referred to as a "tailings account," for the retention, until eventual disposition, of unclaimed funds in the custody of a municipality. Tailings might include unclaimed tax refunds, vendor payments yet to clear, overages on the community's commitment, etc. (M.G.L. Ch. 200A)
Tax Rate	The amount of property tax stated in terms of a unit of the municipal tax base; for example, $20.80 per $1,000 of assessed valuation of taxable real and personal property.
Tax Recapitulation Sheet	A document submitted by a city or town to the DOR in order to set a property tax rate. The recap sheet shows all estimated revenues and actual appropriations that affect the property tax rate. The recap sheet should be submitted to the DOR by September 1 (in order to issue the first-half semi-annual property tax bills before October 1) or by December 1 (in order to issue the third quarterly property tax bills before January 1).
Tax Title	A collection procedure that secures a city or town's lien on real property and protects the municipality's right to payment of overdue property taxes. Otherwise, the lien expires if five years elapse from the January 1 assessment date and the property has been transferred to another owner. If amounts remain outstanding on the property after issuing a demand for overdue property taxes and after publishing a notice of tax taking, the collector may take the property for the city or town. After properly recording the instrument of taking, the collector transfers responsibility for collecting the overdue amounts to the treasurer. After six months, the treasurer may initiate foreclosure proceedings.
Tax Title Foreclosure	The procedure initiated in Land Court by a city or town treasurer to obtain legal title to real property already in tax title and on which property taxes are overdue.
Tax Title Redemption	The act of a property owner to pay overdue taxes, plus any fees, charges, other costs and interest, on real property that the community had placed in tax title to secure its lien. The taxpayer's right to redeem terminates when the treasurer files a petition to foreclose on the property in the Land Court.
Trust Fund	In general, a fund for money donated or transferred to a municipality with specific instructions on its use.
Undesignated Fund Balance	A requirement imposed by law, regulation or order without underlying financial support, thereby resulting in direct or indirect costs to the body made responsible for its implementation.
Uniform Municipal Accounting System	UMAS succeeds the so-called Statutory System (STAT) and is regarded as the professional standard for municipal accounting in Massachusetts. As a uniform system for local governments, it conforms to Generally Accepted Accounting Principles.
User Charges/Fees	A municipal funding source where payment is collected from the user of a service to help defray the cost of providing the service. Note that any increases in the fees must satisfy the three tests set forth in the so-called Emerson case. (See Emerson College v. Boston, 391 Mass. 415 (1984); DOR IGR 88-207.)
Warrant	An authorization for an action. For example, a town meeting warrant establishes the matters that may be acted on by that town meeting. A treasury warrant authorizes the treasurer to pay specific bills. The assessors' warrant authorizes the tax collector to collect taxes in the amount and from the persons listed, respectively.

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Appropriation Orders

"Service to others is the rent you pay for your room here on Earth."

- Muhammad Ali

ORDER DESCRIPTION					FUNDING SOURCES							
AMOUNT APPROPRIATED	ORDER NUMBER	FY2026 BUDGET ORDERS	DATE	COUNCIL VOTE	RAISE & APPROP	AMB RECEIPTS	CPA	OTHER FINANCING SOURCES	ENTERPRISE REVENUE	ENTERPRISE RETAINED EARNINGS	BORROWING AUTHORIZATION	TOTAL
												-
	26-01	REGIONAL SCHOOL ASSESSMENT METHOD										-
$ 19,744,008	26-02	REGIONAL SCHOOL BUDGET ASSESSMENT			19,744,008			-				19,744,008
	26-03	REGIONAL SCHOOL CAPITAL APPROVAL										-
												-
	26-04	APPROPRIATE FY26 OPERATING BUDGET										-
$ 7,777,403		RETIREMENT ASSESSMENTS			7,777,403							7,777,403
$ 600,000		OTHER POST-EMPLOYMENT BENEFITS (OPEB)			600,000							600,000
$ 29,497,920		MUNICIPAL OPERATING BUDGET:			26,697,920	2,800,000						29,497,920
		GENERAL GOVERNMENT										-
		PUBLIC SAFETY										-
		PUBLIC WORKS										-
		CONSERVATION & DEVELOPMENT										-
		COMMUNITY SERVICES										-
$ 2,394,154		LIBRARY SERVICES - (Total Library Budget $2,959,762)			2,394,154							2,394,154
$ 28,318,940		ELEMENTARY SCHOOLS			28,049,236			269,704				28,318,940
$ 4,189,543		DEBT SERVICE			3,937,993		176,550	75,000				4,189,543
		ENTERPRISE FUNDS:										-
$ 6,532,715		SEWER FUND							6,532,715			6,532,715
$ 6,412,566		WATER FUND							6,412,566			6,412,566
$ 640,119		SOLID WASTE FUND							640,119			640,119
$ 738,984		TRANSPORTATION FUND							738,984			738,984
												-
$ 5,473,865	26-05A	CAPITAL IMPROVEMENT PROGRAM - FY26 CIP			4,799,865	674,000						5,473,865
												-
	26-06	BORROWING AUTHORIZATIONS -GENERAL FUND									-	-
$ 1,100,000	A	PUBLIC SAFETY RADIO SYSTEM REPLACEMENT									1,100,000	1,100,000
												-
$ 1,835,136	26-07A	COMMUNITY PRESERVATION ACT :	4/7/2025	12-0			1,835,136					1,835,136
												-
												-
												-
$ 115,255,353					94,000,579	3,474,000	2,011,686	344,704	14,324,384	-	1,100,000	115,255,353